**The Revelation of John**
with Explanations of Rudolf Steiner


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## Foreword

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## 1

This is the revelation of the being of Jesus Christ, which God the Father gives us. To those who wish to serve and follow him, it is to show what happens in the future and what is approaching with rapid steps. He has rendered this revelation in images and sent it through his angel to his servant John;
2 and thus John bears witness to the divine Word of the world and to the destiny of Jesus Christ as witness, declaring what he himself has seen.
3 Blessed is the one who reads the prophetic words, and blessed are those who understand them when they hear them, and all who take into their souls what is written in this book. For the time is at hand.
4 John, to the seven congregations in Asia: Grace and peace, the touch of the spirit and harmony of the soul be granted to you from
the One who is,
the One who has become,
and the One who is to come,
and from the seven creative spirits before his throne,
5 and from Jesus Christ. Through his testimony he is the archetype of faith; he is the firstborn from the realm of death; he is the guiding spirit of all guiding spirits on earth. He has turned to us in love and, through the power of his blood, released the spell of sin that lay upon us.
6 He has established us in true royal dignity and made us priests before the divine ground of the world, his Father. To him belong all spiritual light and all power of the soul from one aeon to the next. Amen.
7 Behold, he comes in the clouds. Every eye shall see him, including the eyes of those who pierced him. All generations on earth shall experience what it means to encounter him. Yes, Amen.
8 “I am the Alpha and the Omega,” says the Lord our God,
the One who is,
the One who has become,
the One who is to come,
the ruler of all.
9 I, John, your brother and companion in destiny, both in all trials and in the inner kingdom and in the enduring strength that we possess as those united with Jesus, was on the island of Patmos. There I was to share in the divine Word of the world and to be deemed worthy of bearing witness to the suffering of Jesus.
10 On the Lord’s day I was transported into the realm of the spirit and heard behind me a mighty voice like the sound of a trumpet.
11 It said: “Write in a book what you see and send it to the seven congregations: to Ephesus, Smyrna, Pergamum, Thyatira, Sardis, Philadelphia, and Laodicea.”
12 And I turned to see the one whose voice was speaking to me. When I turned, I saw seven golden lampstands,
13 and in the midst of the lampstands a figure like the Son of Man, the spiritual human being, clothed in a long, flowing robe, with a golden belt around his chest,

14 with a white head, its hair shining like white wool and like snow, and eyes as though they were flames of fire,
15 feet as though they were glowing gold ore in a furnace, and a voice like the roar of great torrents of water.
16 In his right hand he held seven stars; from his mouth came something like a sharp, two-edged sword, and his face shone like the sun in all its strength.
17 When I saw him, I fell at his feet as though dead. But he laid his right hand upon me and said: “Do not be afraid. I am the First and the Last,
18 and the Living One. I died, and yet I bear the life of the world through all the aeons. The keys to the realm of death and shadow are mine.
19 Write down what you see: the present and the future.
20 This is the mystery of the seven stars you see in my right hand and of the seven golden lampstands. The seven stars are the angels of the seven congregations, and the seven lampstands are the seven congregations themselves.”

**2**

Write to the angel of the congregation in Ephesus: Thus speaks the one who holds the seven stars in his right hand and walks among the seven golden lampstands:
2 I see through your deeds and recognize your efforts and your endurance. But I also see that you cannot bear those who are weak in the face of evil. You have tested those who claim to be apostles and found that they have no right to that claim and are of a lying spirit.
3 You have endurance. For the sake of my name you have taken hardship upon yourself and have not grown weary.
4 But I have this charge against you: you have departed from your first love. Keep alive the remembrance of the heights from which you have fallen.
5 Change your mind and act again in accordance with your original nature. If you do not, I will come and remove your lampstand, unless you undergo this change of heart.
6 Yet you can recognize yourself by your revulsion toward the ways of the Nicolaitans, which I also abhor.
7 Whoever has ears, let them hear what the Spirit says to the congregations. To the one who passes the trial I will give food from the tree of life that stands in God’s paradise.
8 And write to the angel of the congregation in Smyrna: Thus speaks the First and the Last, who was dead and came through again into life.
9 I know and see the weight of your destiny and your poverty, and yet you are rich. I also see the spiritual mockery of those who falsely call themselves Jews, but who in truth belong to the spiritual community of Satan.
10 Do not fear the sufferings that lie ahead. Behold, the adversary is preparing to cast some of you into chains. This will happen as a test for you. Ten days of severe destiny lie before you. Be strong in heart unto death, and then I will give you the crown of life.
11 Whoever has ears, let them hear what the Spirit says to the congregations. The one who passes the trial will suffer no harm from the second death, the death of the soul.
12 And write to the angel of the congregation in Pergamum: Thus speaks the one who has the sharp, two-edged sword.
13 I know and see where you dwell. You live where Satan’s throne stands. You hold fast to the power of my being and have not denied your faith in me, not even in the days of Antipas, who was killed among you as my faithful witness, in the place where satanic power dwells.

14 But I must nevertheless reproach you. Some among you hold fast to the teaching of Balaam, who taught Balak to lay a snare before the children of Israel by enticing them to eat food sacrificed to idols and to engage in sexual rites.
15 There are also among you those who similarly hold fast to the teaching of the Nicolaitans. Strive for a change of heart.
16 If you do not, I will come upon you suddenly and fight against them with the sword of my mouth.
17 Whoever has ears, let them hear what the Spirit says to the congregations. To the one who passes the trial I will give the hidden manna and a white stone, and on the stone a new name will be inscribed, which no one knows how to speak except the one who receives it.
18 And write to the angel of the congregation in Thyatira: Thus speaks the divine Son, whose eyes are like flames of fire and whose feet are like glowing gold ore.
19 I know and see your deeds: your love, your faith, your willingness to help, and your endurance. Your later deeds surpass the earlier ones.
20 But I have this against you: you allow the woman Isabel to act freely. She calls herself a prophetess and teaches and seduces those who serve me into spiritual fornication and into eating food sacrificed to idols.
21 I gave her time to change her consciousness, but she does not wish to change her mind or abandon spiritual fornication.
22 Behold, I cast her onto a bed, together with all those who have sinned against the spirit with her. They will be struck by severe destinies unless they yet undergo a change of heart and turn away from their deeds.
23 Her children will be delivered to the power of death. All the congregations shall recognize that I Am, and that I know how to examine hearts and reins, and that I give each of you the destiny corresponding to your deeds.
24 But now I also speak to those among you in Thyatira who have not accepted this teaching and who, as people say, have not penetrated the depths of satanic being. I will impose no new burden on you.
25 Only this I urge you: gather and hold fast to what you have attained, and so prepare yourselves for my coming.
26 To the one who passes the trial and faithfully continues the work through my power until the goal is reached, I will give authority
27 of the I, authority over all peoples; and that one will shepherd the nations with an iron staff and shatter them like earthen vessels. The same authority of the I will belong to that person which I received from my Father.
28 And I will give that person the morning star.
29 Whoever has ears, let them hear what the Spirit says to the congregations.

**3**

And write to the angel of the congregation in Sardis: Thus speaks the one who has power over the seven divine creative spirits and the seven stars. I see through your deeds. You have the name of a living being, yet you are dead.
2 Strive to awaken in your consciousness, and strengthen what is still alive in your soul, lest it too die. I cannot affirm that your deeds possess full reality before the divine countenance.
3 Revive within yourself the memory of all that you have received and heard from the spiritual worlds. Preserve it within you and change your mind. If you do not awaken to a higher consciousness, I will come like a thief; you will not know at what hour I come upon you.
4 Yet you have a few in Sardis who have kept their garments clean of stains and tarnish. They will walk with me in white garments, for they are worthy.

5 The one who passes the trial will likewise be clothed in white garments, and I will not erase that person’s name from the book of life. I will acknowledge that name before my Father and before his angelic realms.
6 Whoever has ears, let them hear what the Spirit says to the congregations.
7 And write to the angel of the congregation in Philadelphia: Thus speaks the one who is holy, the one who is true, who holds the key of David. When he opens, no one shuts; when he shuts, no one opens.
8 I see through your deeds. Behold, I have made an open door stand before you, and no one can shut it. Your strength is still small, but you have kept my word in your soul and have not denied my name.
9 Behold, I will cause some from the community of the satanic spirit, who falsely and in a lying spirit call themselves Jews, to come and bow down at your feet. For they shall recognize that I love you. You have kept the word of my patience in your heart,
10 and therefore I will preserve you in the hour of the great temptation that is now coming upon all humankind. All the inhabitants of the earth must undergo this trial.
11 I am coming swiftly and unexpectedly. Gather and hold fast to what you have attained inwardly, so that no one may take your crown.
12 I will make the one who passes the trial a pillar in the temple of my divine Father. That person will never again leave the temple. I will inscribe upon that person’s being the name of my divine Father, and the name of the city of God, the New Jerusalem, which descends from my divine Father out of heaven, and my own new name.
13 Whoever has ears, let them hear what the Spirit says to the congregations.
14 And write to the angel of the congregation in Laodicea: Thus speaks the Amen, who through the testimony of his being makes faith and knowledge true, the divine creative principle of the world.
15 I see through your deeds: you are neither cold nor hot. If only you were cold or hot!
16 But because you are lukewarm, neither cold nor hot, I will spit you out.
17 You say, “I am rich, I have everything, and I lack nothing.” You do not know how wretched and miserable you are, how blind and naked.
18 I advise you to acquire from me gold refined in fire, so that you may become rich again; and white garments, so that you may be clothed and the shameful nakedness of your being may no longer be exposed; and finally ointment for your eyes, so that you may see again.
19 Those whom I educate through blows of fate are those I love. Therefore, do everything you can to change your mind and consciousness.
20 Behold, I stand at the door and knock. If anyone hears my voice and opens the door to me, I will enter and share the sacred meal with that person, and that person with me.
21 The one who passes the trial I will raise up to sit enthroned with me, just as I too have conquered.
22 Whoever has ears, let them hear what the Spirit says to the congregations.

**4**

After this I saw: Behold, a door stood open in heaven. And the first voice, which had reached my ear like the sound of a trumpet, said: “Come up to me! I will show you what happens in the future after all that has gone before.”
2 At once I was lifted up into the realm of the spirit. Behold, a throne stood in heaven, and a figure sat upon the throne.
3 The one seated there shone like jasper and carnelian. Around the throne arched a rainbow whose light gleamed like an emerald.
4 Around the throne stood twenty-four thrones, and upon them sat twenty-four elders, clothed in white garments, with golden crowns on their heads.

5 From the throne flashed lightning; voices sounded and thunder rolled, and seven flaming torches burned before the throne. These are the seven divine creative spirits.
6 Before the throne was something like a glassy sea, as though formed of crystal. In the midst and around the throne were four living creatures, covered with eyes in front and behind.
7 The first creature resembled a lion, the second a bull, the third had a face like a human, and the fourth was like a flying eagle.
8 Each of the four creatures had six wings; all around and within they were full of eyes. Without ceasing, day and night, they cried: “Holy, holy, holy is the Lord, the divine ruler of all, the One who has become, the One who is, the One who is to come.”
9 Whenever the creatures offer spiritual light, dignity of soul, and sacrifices of thanksgiving to the one seated on the throne, who bears life through all the aeons,
10 the twenty-four elders fall down in worship before the one enthroned, before the one who bears the life of the world from one aeon to another. They lay their crowns before the throne and say:
11 “You, Lord our God, are worthy to receive radiant spirituality, dignified soul-being, and active creative power, for you created all things. By your will all things have existence and form.”

**5**

Then I looked and saw in the right hand of the one seated on the throne a book written on the outside and inside, sealed with seven seals.
2 And I saw a mighty angel proclaiming in a loud voice: “Who is worthy to open the book and break its seals?”
3 Yet no being in heaven, on earth, or beneath the earth was able to open the book or read it.
4 I wept bitterly because no one was found worthy to open the book and read it.
5 Then one of the elders said to me: “Do not weep! Behold, the Lion from the tribe of Judah, the Root of David, has passed the trial. He can open the book and break its seven seals.”
6 And I looked: there, in the midst of the throne and the four creatures and among the elders, stood a Lamb, as though it had already been sacrificed. It had seven horns and seven eyes. These were the seven divine creative spirits, to whom the whole earth has been assigned as a field of activity.
7 The Lamb came forward and took the book from the right hand of the one seated on the throne.
8 When it took the book, the four creatures and the twenty-four elders fell down before the Lamb. Each held a harp and golden bowls filled with incense; these are the prayers of those devoted to the spirit.
9 And they sing a new song: “You are worthy to receive the book and break its seals, for you were sacrificed and have made satisfaction before God for people from every tribe, language, people, and race.
10 You have made them kings and priests before the paternal ground of the world. They will be kings over the earth.”
11 And as I looked, I heard the voices of many angels around the throne, the creatures, and the elders; their number was ten thousand times ten thousand and a thousand times a thousand.
12 They said in a mighty voice: “The Lamb who was sacrificed is worthy to receive all power, all fullness, all wisdom, all strength of the I, all dignity of the soul, all light of the spirit, and all power of blessing.”
13 And I heard every created being in heaven, on earth, beneath the earth, and in the sea, and all beings active therein, saying:
“To the one seated on the throne and to the Lamb belong all power of blessing, all dignity of the soul, all light of the spirit, and all creative power through all the aeons to come.”
14 And the four creatures said, “Amen!” And the elders fell down in worship.

**6**

And I saw: the Lamb opened one of the seven seals, and I heard one of the four creatures speak with a voice like thunder: “Come!”
2 And I saw: behold, a white horse, and its rider held a bow. A crown was placed upon his head, and he rode out as a conqueror, to conquer again.
3 When it opened the second seal, I heard the second creature say: “Come!”
4 Another horse came forth, fiery red. Its rider was given power to take peace from the whole earth, so that people would slaughter one another. He carried a great sword in his hands.
5 When it opened the third seal, I heard the third creature say: “Come!” And I saw: behold, a black horse, and its rider held a pair of scales in his hand.
6 And I heard a voice in the midst of the four creatures say: “A measure of wheat for a denarius, three measures of barley for a denarius. But do not harm the oil and the wine.”
7 When it opened the fourth seal, I heard the voice of the fourth creature say: “Come!”
8 And I saw: behold, a pale horse, and the name of its rider was Death, with the realm of the dead following him. They were given authority over a quarter of the earth, to kill with the sword, through hunger and death, and by the beasts of the earth.
9 When it opened the fifth seal, I saw beneath the altar the souls of those who had suffered sacrificial death for the sake of the divine Word and their testimony.
10 They cried out in a loud voice: “Holy and true ruler of the world, how long will you delay judgment, which will avenge our blood upon the inhabitants of the earth?”
11 A white garment was given to each of them, and they were told to rest for a little while longer, until the destinies of their fellow servants and their brothers, who were to suffer death as they had, had also been fulfilled.
12 And I saw when it opened the sixth seal: a great earthquake arose. The sun became black like a garment of mourning made of hair, and the full moon turned blood-red,
13 and the stars of heaven fell to the earth, as when a fig tree sheds its leaves in a violent wind.
14 The sky withdrew like a scroll being rolled up. Every mountain and island was moved from its place.
15 The kings of the earth, the great ones, the commanders of armies, the rich, the mighty, every slave and every free person hid in ravines and among the rocky clefts of the mountains,
16 and they said to the mountains and rocks: “Fall upon us and hide us from the face of the one seated on the throne and from the wrath of the Lamb!
17 The great day of divine wrath has come; who can stand before it?”

**7**

After this I saw four angels standing at the four corners of the earth. By their power they held back the four winds of the earth, so that no wind would blow on the earth, the sea, or the crown of any tree.
2 And I saw another angel rising from the place where the sun rises. He bore the seal of God’s life-forming powers and called in a loud voice to the four angels, to whom the earth and the sea had been entrusted:
3 “Do no harm to the earth, the sea, or the treetops until we have placed our seal on the foreheads of those who serve our God.”
4 And I heard the number of those who were sealed: one hundred and forty-four thousand from all the tribes of the children of Israel were to receive the seal:

5 twelve thousand sealed from the tribe of Judah, twelve thousand from the tribe of Reuben,
from the tribe of Gad, twelve thousand;
6 from the tribe of Asher, twelve thousand;
from the tribe of Naphtali, twelve thousand;
from the tribe of Manasseh, twelve thousand;
7 from the tribe of Simeon, twelve thousand; from the tribe of Levi, twelve thousand; from the tribe of Issachar, twelve thousand;
8 from the tribe of Zebulun, twelve thousand;
from the tribe of Joseph, twelve thousand;
from the tribe of Benjamin, twelve thousand sealed.
9 After this I saw: behold, a great multitude that no one could count, from every nation, tribe, race, and language. They stood before the throne and the Lamb, clothed in white garments, with palm branches in their hands.
10 They cried in a loud voice: “Salvation belongs to our God, who is seated on the throne, and to the Lamb!”
11 All the angels stood around the throne, the elders, and the four creatures, and they fell on their faces before the throne in worship of the divine ground of the world,
12 saying: “Amen! The blessing, the revelation, the wisdom, the offering of thanksgiving, the dignity of the soul, the power of the world, and the strength of the spirit belong to our God throughout all the aeons. Amen.”
13 One of the elders answered and said to me: “Who are these clothed in white garments, and where have they come from?” I said to him, “Lord, you know.”
14 He said to me: “These are the ones who come out of the great suffering. They have washed their garments and made them shining white in the blood of the Lamb.
15 Therefore they can stand before the divine throne and serve him day and night in his temple. The one seated on the throne will shelter them and dwell over them.
16 They will hunger no more and thirst no more; neither the heat of the sun nor any other burning heat will overcome them.
17 For the Lamb in the midst of the throne will be their shepherd and guide them to the springs from which the water of life flows. And God the Father will wipe every tear from their eyes.”

**8**

When it opened the seventh seal, a deep silence arose in the spiritual worlds for half a cycle of time.
2 And I saw the seven angels who stand before God the Father, and seven trumpets were given to them.
3 Another angel came and stood at the altar with a golden censer. He was given much incense to offer with the prayers of all those devoted to the spirit upon the golden altar before the throne.
4 The incense rose from the angel’s hand, together with the prayers of those devoted to the spirit, before the face of the Godhead.
5 Then the angel took the censer, filled it with fire from the altar, and hurled it down to the earth. There were peals of thunder, voices sounded, lightning flashed, and the earth shook.
6 And the seven angels who held the seven trumpets prepared to sound them.
7 The first sounded his trumpet: hail and fire mixed with blood arose and came pouring down upon the earth. A third of the earth was burned up, a third of all the trees was burned up, and all green grass was burned up.
8 The second angel sounded his trumpet: something like a great mountain burning with fire was hurled down and fell into the sea.

9 A third of the sea turned to blood, a third of all living creatures in the sea died, and a third of all ships were destroyed.
10 The third angel sounded his trumpet: a great star fell from heaven, burning like a torch. It struck a third of all the rivers and springs of water in its course.
11 The name of the star is “Wormwood.” A third of all the waters turned to wormwood, and many people died from the water, which had become bitter.
12 The fourth angel sounded his trumpet: a blow struck a third of the sun, a third of the moon, and a third of the stars, so that a third of them was darkened. The day lost a third of its light, and the night likewise.
13 And as I watched, I heard an eagle flying through the zenith of the sky, crying in a loud voice: “Woe, woe, woe to all who dwell on the earth, because of the blasts of the remaining trumpets, when the three last angels sound their trumpets!”

**9**

And the fifth angel sounded his trumpet. Then I saw a star that had fallen from heaven to earth. The key to the well of the abyss had been given to it.
2 It opened the well of the abyss, and smoke rose from the well, like the smoke of a mighty furnace, so that the sun and the whole atmosphere were darkened by the smoke from the abyss.
3 Out of the smoke came swarms of locusts that spread over the whole earth. They were given a power like that of scorpions on the earth.
4 But a voice told them not to harm the grass of the earth, or any green thing, or any trees, but only to attack the people who did not bear God’s seal on their foreheads.
5 They were not permitted to kill these people, but only to torment them for five months. The torment they caused was like the pain inflicted when a scorpion stings a person.
6 In those days people will long for death but will not be able to find it. They will wish to die, but death will flee from them.
7 The forms in which the locusts appeared resembled horses equipped for war. On their heads they seemed to wear golden crowns, and their faces resembled human faces.
8 They had hair like women’s hair, and their teeth were like lions’ teeth.
9 They wore breastplates as if made of bronze, and the sound of their wings was like the clatter of war chariots drawn by many galloping horses.
10 They had tails and stingers like scorpions, and through their tails they had the power to bring harm upon people for five months.
11 They had as their king the angel of the abyss, whose name in Hebrew is Abaddon and in Greek Apollyon.
12 The first woe has passed. Behold, two more woes are yet to come.
13 And the sixth angel sounded his trumpet. I heard a certain voice coming from the four horns of the golden altar before the face of the Godhead.
14 It said to the sixth angel who was sounding the trumpet: “Release the four angels bound at the great river Euphrates.”
15 And the four angels were released from their bonds. They had been prepared for this hour, this day, this month, and this year, to kill a third of humankind.
16 The number of the mounted armies was twenty thousand times ten thousand. I heard their number.
17 In my visionary consciousness I saw the horses and their riders wearing breastplates of fiery red, hyacinth blue, and sulfur yellow. The horses’ heads were like lions’ heads, and from their mouths came fire, smoke, and sulfurous vapor.

18 A third of all people were killed by these three destructive forces: the fire, the smoke, and the sulfurous vapor that came from the horses' mouths.
19 The great power of the horses lay in their mouths and in their tails. Their tails were like serpents with striking heads, and with them they wrought destruction.
20 The remaining people, who had not fallen victim to these plagues, still did not change their minds or abandon their practices. They did not stop worshipping demons and idols of gold, silver, bronze, stone, and wood, although these can neither see nor hear nor move.
21 They did not change their minds or abandon their way of life, shaped by death-dealing forces, poison, fornication, and egoism.

**10**

And I saw another angel of great strength descending from heaven, wrapped in a cloud. A rainbow shone around his head, his face was like the sun, and his feet resembled pillars of fire.
2 He held an open little book in his hand. He placed his right foot on the sea and his left on the land.
3 He cried out with a mighty voice, like the roar of a lion. The seven thunders answered his cry with their voices.
4 When the seven thunders spoke, I wanted to write down their words. Then I heard a voice from heaven saying: "Seal up what the seven thunders have spoken; do not write it down!"
5 And the angel whom I had seen standing on both sea and land raised his right hand toward heaven
6 and swore by the one who bears the life of the world through all the aeons, who created heaven and all beings in it, the earth and all beings upon it, and the sea and all beings in it: that the time was not yet here,
7 but that it would come in the days when the seventh angel raised his voice and sounded his trumpet. Then the mystery of the Godhead would be fulfilled, as God's servants, the prophets, had proclaimed.
8 And the voice I had heard from heaven spoke to me again: "Go and take the open book from the hand of the angel standing on the sea and on the land!"
9 I went to the angel and asked him to give me the little book. He said to me: "Take it and eat it. It will be bitter in your stomach, though in your mouth it will be sweet as honey."
10 I took the little book from the angel's hand and ate it. It tasted sweet as honey in my mouth, but after I had eaten it, my innermost being was filled with bitterness.
11 Then I was told: "You must prophesy again before races and nations and languages and many kings."

**11**

A measuring rod like a staff was given to me, and I heard these words: "Rise and measure the divine temple and the altar and those who worship in it.
2 But count the forecourt outside the temple entirely as the outer world. You need not measure it, for it has been assigned to the pagan nations. They will trample the holy city for forty-two months.
3 And I will call forth my two witnesses. Clothed in mourning garments, they will proclaim the spiritual Word for twelve hundred and sixty days.
4 These are the two olive trees and the two lampstands that stand before the Lord of the earth.
5 If anyone wishes to harm them, fire will come from their mouths and consume their enemies. Anyone who wishes to harm them must die.
6 They have authority to shut the sky so that no rain falls during the days of their prophetic work. They also have authority to turn water into blood and to strike the earth with every kind of plague whenever they wish.

7 When their testimony is complete, the beast that rises from the abyss will wage war against them, conquer them, and kill them.
8 Their corpses will lie in the streets of the great city, which spiritually bears the name Sodom and Egypt. Their Lord was also crucified there.
9 For three and a half days, people from every race, tribe, language, and nation will look at their corpses, and no one will allow their bodies to be placed in tombs.
10 The inhabitants of the earth will rejoice and celebrate their deaths, exchanging gifts with one another, because these two prophets had made life difficult for those who dwell on the earth.
11 After three and a half days, the spirit of life from the divine worlds entered them again. They stood up on their feet, and great terror seized everyone who saw them.
12 They heard a mighty voice from heaven saying to them: “Come up!” And they ascended into the heavenly sphere in the currents of cloud-power. Their enemies had to witness this too.
13 At that hour a great earthquake occurred. A tenth of the city collapsed, and seven thousand human souls died in the earthquake. The survivors were seized with terror and bowed before the luminous revelation of God in the heavenly spheres.
14 The second woe has passed; a third is approaching swiftly.
15 And the seventh angel sounded his trumpet. Mighty voices rang out in heaven, saying: “The cosmos has become the kingdom of our Lord and of the Christ-being sent by the Father. He will be king of this kingdom through all the aeons.”
16 The twenty-four elders, seated on their thrones before God, fell on their faces in worship and said:
17 “We offer you our thanks, O Lord, divine ruler of all, you who are, who have become, and who are to come. You have taken up your mighty power and become king of the kingdom.
18 The nations of the world burn with rage, but your wrath against the world has also awakened. The time has come for the destiny of the dead to be decided. The fruits of each person’s life will be granted to them: to your servants the prophets, to all who are devoted to the spirit and revere your name, both small and great. Those who have sown destruction on earth will reap destruction.”
19 Then God’s temple in heaven was opened, and the altar of the divine covenant became visible in the sanctuary. Lightning flashed, voices sounded, thunder rolled, the earth shook, and a mighty hailstorm filled the air.

**12**

A great and exalted image appeared to the visionary gaze in the realm of the spirit: a woman clothed with the sun, the moon beneath her feet, and a crown of twelve stars upon her head.
2 She was pregnant and cried out in the labor and pain of childbirth.
3 Then another image appeared in heaven: behold, a great fiery-red dragon with seven heads and ten horns. On its heads it wore seven crowns,
4 and with its tail it swept away a third of all the stars from heaven and threw them to the earth. The dragon stood before the woman who was about to give birth, ready to devour her child as soon as it was born.
5 The woman gave birth to a son, who is to shepherd all nations with an iron staff. The woman’s child was caught up to God and to his throne.
6 The woman fled into the wilderness. It had been ordained in the divine plan of the world that she should go there. She was to sustain her life there for twelve hundred and sixty days.
7 War broke out in the spiritual spheres. Michael and his angels fought against the dragon, and the dragon fought with his angels.
8 But its power failed, and no place of activity remained in heaven for its host.

9 The great dragon was thrown down—the serpent of the beginning, at once diabolical and satanic in nature, the deceiver of all humankind. He was thrown down to earth, and all his angels with him.
10 And I heard a great voice in heaven: “Now salvation and power and the kingdom of our God have been established, and the creative power of the Christ sent by him. The accuser of our brothers has been cast down. He can no longer spread darkness around them day and night before the face of God.
11 They have conquered him through the blood of the Lamb and through the Word of the world to which they bore witness. They did not love their own lives, and they did not fear death.
12 Therefore rejoice, you heavens and you beings of the spheres! But woe to the earth and the sea, for the adversary has come down to you, burning with furious anger, because he knows his time is short.”
13 When the dragon saw that he had been thrown down to earth, he began to persecute the woman who had given birth to the son.
14 The woman was given the two wings of the great eagle so that she could fly into the wilderness, to the place appointed for her, where she would be sustained for three and a half times, far from the serpent’s presence.
15 The serpent poured a flood of water from its mouth after the woman, to sweep her away in a torrent.
16 But the earth came to the woman’s aid: it opened its mouth and swallowed the streams of water that the dragon had spewed from its mouth.
17 The dragon became furious with the woman and went off to wage war against the rest of her offspring, those who hold fast to the divine purposes of the world and follow the destiny of Jesus as witness.

**13**

As I watched, I stood on the sand by the sea. And I saw a beast rising out of the sea. It had ten horns and seven heads, ten crowns on its horns, and on its heads names expressing hostility toward the spirit.
2 The beast I saw resembled a leopard, but had feet like a bear and a mouth like a lion. The dragon gave it its power, its throne, and great authority.
3 One of its heads seemed to have been mortally wounded, but its fatal wound was healed. The whole earthly world followed the beast in amazement. They worshipped the dragon because it had given such authority to the beast.
4 They worshipped the beast and said: “Who is like the beast, and who would dare to fight against it?”
5 It was given a mouth to utter boastful words and words hostile to the spirit, and authority to act for forty-two months.
6 It opened its mouth to hurl blasphemies against the divine world, against the divine name, against the sphere of the divine dwelling, and against all beings who dwell in the heavenly spheres.
7 It was given power to wage war against people devoted to the spirit and to conquer them. It was given dominion over every tribe, nation, language, and race.
8 All the inhabitants of the earth will worship the beast, except those whose names have never been written in the book of life belonging to the self-sacrificing Lamb, since the foundation of the world.
9 Whoever has ears, let them hear!
10 If anyone sows captivity, that person will reap captivity; whoever wields the killing sword will fall by the killing sword. What alone proves itself here is the endurance and faith of those devoted to the spirit.
11 Then I saw a second beast. It rose from the solid earth and had two horns like a lamb, but its speech was like that of a dragon.
12 It exercises, in the presence of the first beast, all the authority of the first beast, working magically. It causes the earth and all its inhabitants to worship the first beast, whose mortal wound had been healed.

13 It performs great magical deeds, even making fire come down from heaven to earth in the sight of people.
14 It deceives the inhabitants of the earth by the wonders it is able to perform in the presence of the first beast. It tells the inhabitants of the earth to make an image of the beast that had been wounded by the sword and yet lived.
15 It is allowed to give breath to the image of the beast so that the image can speak. It does this because it wants all who refuse to worship the image of the beast to be put to death.
16 It also causes everyone—small and great, rich and poor, free and enslaved—to receive a mark on the right hand or on the forehead.
17 No one may buy or sell unless they bear the mark, the name of the beast, or the number of its name.
18 Here wisdom itself speaks. Let anyone with understanding calculate the meaning of the beast's number. It is the number of a human being, and its number is six hundred and sixty-six.

**14**

And I saw: behold, the Lamb stood on Mount Zion, surrounded by the one hundred and forty-four thousand who had his name and his Father's name written on their foreheads.
2 I heard a voice from heaven like the roar of great torrents of water and the rumble of mighty thunder. Yet the voice I heard was also like the playing of harpists playing their harps,
3 singing a new song before the throne, before the four creatures, and before the circle of elders. No one could learn the song except the one hundred and forty-four thousand who had been freed from bondage to earthly things.
4 These are those who have not defiled their spiritual being through what is merely of the soul, and so are virginal in nature. They follow the Lamb wherever he goes. They have been set apart from humankind as the beginning of a new humanity belonging to God the Father and the Lamb.
5 No deceit is found on their lips; they are without blemish.
6 And I saw another angel flying through the zenith of heaven. He carried the eternal Gospel to proclaim to those who dwell on earth, to every nation, tribe, language, and race.
7 He said in a loud voice: "Revere the divine world as the source of all revelation. The hour of divine judgment has come. Worship the Creator of heaven and earth and the sea and all the springs of water."
8 Another angel followed and said: "Fallen, fallen is great Babylon, which has given all the nations of the world the wine and frenzy of its fornication."
9 A third angel followed the two and said in a loud voice: "Whoever worships the beast and its image and accepts its mark on forehead or hand
10 will drink the wine of divine fury, poured unmixed from the cup of God's wrath. That person will endure torment by fire and sulfur before the holy angels and the Lamb.
11 The smoke of their torment will rise through all the aeons, and they will have no rest day or night—those who worship the beast and its image and accept the mark of its name.
12 What alone proves itself here is the endurance of those devoted to the spirit, who hold fast to the divine spiritual purposes and to the faith that took form in Jesus."
13 And I heard a voice from heaven saying: "Write! Blessed are the dead who from now on die in the power of Christ." "Yes," says the Spirit, "they will rest from their labors, for the true fruits of their lives will not be lost on their soul's journey."
14 And I saw: behold, a white cloud, and upon the cloud a figure like the Son of Man. On his head was a golden crown, and in his hand a sharp sickle.
15 Another angel came out of the temple and cried in a loud voice to the one coming on the cloud: "Swing your sickle and reap, for the time of harvest has come; the earth's harvest is ripe."
16 The one seated on the cloud swung his sickle over the earth, and the earth was harvested.

17 Another angel came out of the temple in heaven, and he too had a sharp sickle.
18 Yet another angel came from the altar, the one who had authority over fire. He called loudly to the angel with the sharp sickle: “Swing your sharp sickle and gather the grapes from the earth’s vineyard, for the grapes are ripe.”
19 The angel swung his sickle over the earth, harvested the vineyard, and threw the grapes into the great winepress of the divine will of destiny.
20 The winepress was trodden outside the city, and blood flowed from it, rising as high as the horses’ bridles for a distance of sixteen hundred stadia.

**15**

Then the visionary gaze was shown another great and astonishing sign in heaven: seven angels with the seven final trials, in which the gravity of the divine will of destiny reaches its fulfillment.
2 I saw what looked like a sea of crystal mixed with fire. Those who had conquered the beast, the temptation of its image, and the number of its name stood beside the crystal sea, holding the harps of God.
3 They sang the song of Moses, the servant of God, and the song of the Lamb: “Great and marvelous are your works, O Lord, divine ruler of all. Your ways lead to the being of the Good and to truth, you King of all nations. Who would not stand in reverence before you?
4 Who would not acknowledge your being as the source of all revelation? You alone are holy. All nations will come to worship before your face, for now your higher ordinances have been clearly revealed.”
5 After this I saw the temple opened in heaven, the tabernacle of divine self-testimony.
6 The seven angels carrying the seven trials came out of the temple. They were clothed in pure, shining linen and wore golden belts around their waists.
7 One of the four creatures gave the seven angels seven golden bowls filled with the impulses of the will of the divine Being, who bears the life of the world through all the aeons.
8 The temple was filled with smoke from the spiritual light and strength of soul of the divine Being. No one could enter the temple until the seven trials carried out by the seven angels were completed.

**16**

And I heard a mighty voice speaking from the temple to the seven angels: “Go and pour out the seven bowls of the divine will upon the earth!”
2 The first went and poured out his bowl upon the earth. Then a foul, destructive sore broke out on the people who bore the mark of the beast and worshipped its image.
3 The second poured out his bowl into the sea, and it became like the blood of a corpse, and every living, ensouled creature in the sea died.
4 The third poured out his bowl into all the rivers and springs of water, and all the water turned to blood.
5 And I heard the angel of the waters cry: “You bear the true being within you, you who are, who have become, and who are holy.
6 For they have shed the blood of the holy ones and the prophets, and now you have given them blood to drink. They have brought this fate upon themselves.”
7 And I heard a voice from the altar saying: “Yes, Lord, divine ruler of all, your judgment leads to truth and to the being of the Good.”
8 The fourth poured out his bowl upon the sun.

9 It was given to him to scorch people with fiery heat. People burned in the fierce heat and cursed the name of the divine power that could impose such trials upon humankind. They did not find the path of changing their minds and closed themselves to divine revelation.
10 The fifth poured out his bowl upon the throne of the beast. Its kingdom was plunged into darkness, and people gnawed their tongues in agony.
11 They cursed the divine power of heaven because of their agony and sores. They did not find the path of changing their minds and did not turn away from their deeds.
12 The sixth poured out his bowl upon the great river Euphrates. Its water dried up, preparing a way for the kings from the lands of the sunrise.
13 And I saw three unclean spirits, like frogs, coming from the mouth of the dragon, the mouth of the beast, and the mouth of the false prophets.
14 They are demonic spiritual beings that produce magical effects. They go out to the kings of the whole world to gather them for the war that will be unleashed when the great day of the divine ruler of the world arrives.
15 “Behold, I come like a thief. Blessed is the one who knows how to keep watch and preserve their garments, so that they need not walk naked and have their shame exposed.”
16 The spirits gathered the kings at the place called in Hebrew Armageddon.
17 The seventh poured out his bowl into the atmosphere. Then a mighty voice came from the temple, from the throne, saying: “It is accomplished!”
18 Lightning flashed, voices sounded, thunder rolled, and a great earthquake occurred, unlike any since people have lived on earth—so mighty was that earthquake.
19 The great city split into three parts, and the cities of all nations collapsed. Babylon the Great came to the mind of the Godhead, and she was to be given the cup of the wine of the divine will as a cup of wrath.
20 Every island fled, and the mountains disappeared.
21 Huge hailstones, seemingly weighing a hundredweight each, fell from heaven upon the people. They cursed the divine world because of the suffering caused by the hail; the suffering was exceedingly great.

**17**

One of the seven angels who had the seven bowls came and spoke to me: “Come! I will show you the judgment of the great prostitute who sits on many waters,
2 with whom the kings of the earth have committed fornication, and whose impure wine has made the inhabitants of the earth drunk.”
3 In the spiritual realm he carried me away into a wilderness. There I saw a woman sitting on a scarlet beast, covered all over with names blaspheming the spirit, and having seven heads and ten horns.
4 The woman was clothed in purple and scarlet, and adorned with gold, precious stones, and pearls. In her hand she held a golden cup filled with abominations and unclean beings born of her fornication.
5 On her forehead was written a name, a mystery: “Babylon the Great, the mother of all harlotry and all abominations on earth.”
6 I saw the woman drunk with the blood of those devoted to the spirit, the blood of those who had confirmed the destiny of Jesus through their own destiny. When I saw her, I was filled with great astonishment.
7 Then the angel said to me: “Why are you astonished? I will tell you the mystery of the woman and of the beast that carries her, the beast with seven heads and ten horns.

8 The beast you saw once existed, is now absent, but will rise again from the abyss and then meet its destruction. The inhabitants of the earth, whose names have never been written in the book of life since the foundation of the world, will be astonished when they see the beast that existed in the past, is absent now, and will appear in the future.
9 Here is the mind that has been raised to wisdom. The seven heads are seven mountains on which the woman sits.
10 They are also seven kings. Five have fallen, one is, and one has not yet come; when he comes, he will remain only a short time.
11 The beast that existed and is absent is itself an eighth king, yet it also belongs to the seven; it will meet its destruction.
12 The ten horns you saw are ten kings who have not yet begun to reign, but they will receive royal power for one hour together with the beast.
13 They are all of one mind, and they will place their strength and authority at the service of the beast.
14 They will wage war against the Lamb, but the Lamb will overcome them, for he is Lord of lords and King of kings. Those with him are the called and chosen, all who have faith."
15 He said to me: "The waters you saw, on which the great prostitute sits, are races and multitudes, nations and languages.
16 The ten horns you saw, and the beast, will one day turn against the great prostitute in hatred. They will leave her desolate and naked, consume her flesh, and burn her with fire.
17 For God the Father has placed in their hearts a purpose by which, in the end, they must act according to his will. Thus they serve this single purpose by placing their kingdom at the service of the beast, until the aims of God's Word are fulfilled.
18 The woman you saw is the great city that rules over all the kings of the earth."

**18**

After this I saw another angel descending from heaven. He had great authority, and the whole earth was illuminated by the spiritual light that shone from him.
2 He cried out with a piercing voice: "Fallen, fallen is Babylon the Great! It has become a dwelling place of demons and a prison for every kind of unclean spirit and every ominous and ill-omened bird. All nations have drunk the wine of its intoxication and fornication;
3 the kings of the earth have shared in its fornication, and the merchants of the earth have grown rich through the impulses of its sensual craving."
4 Then I heard another voice from heaven saying: "Leave the city, you who are my people. Do not be drawn into fellowship with its transgressions, lest
5 you too suffer the blows of its fate. Its transgressions reach from earth up to heaven; the discerning gaze of divine thoughts rests upon its deviations.
6 Repay it as it has repaid you; give it twice as much as it has done to you. Pour it a double measure of the cup it offered you to drink.
7 Give it torment and grief in proportion to its self-glorification and sensual craving. For it says in its heart: 'I sit as queen; I am no widow, and I shall see no sorrow.'
8 Therefore, in a single day its fate will strike it: death, mourning, and hunger; and it will be consumed by fire. For mighty is the Lord God who judges it.
9 The kings of the earth who shared in its fornication and sensual indulgence will weep and lament over it when they see the smoke of the fire in which it burns.
10 They will stand far away, terrified by its torment, and say: 'Woe, woe, great city, Babylon, mighty city! In a single hour your judgment has come.'
11 The merchants of the earth will weep and mourn over it, because no one buys their goods anymore:

12 gold, silver, precious stones and pearls; fine linen, purple, silk and scarlet; costly woods and vessels of ivory, precious wood, iron and marble;
13 cinnamon, spices, incense, myrrh and frankincense; wine and oil, fine flour and grain; cattle, sheep, horses and chariots—and the bodies and souls of human beings.
14 ‘The luxurious life your greedy soul desired has vanished from you; all your wealth and splendor are gone, and you will never recover them.’
15 The merchants who traded in these things, and grew rich through her, stand far away, terrified by her torments.
16 They weep and mourn, saying: ‘Woe, woe, great city, clothed in fine linen, purple and scarlet, adorned with gold, precious stones and pearls!
17 In a single hour such wealth has been laid waste.’ And every shipmaster, all who sail, sailors, and all whose work is connected with the sea stood far away.
18 When they saw the smoke of the fire in which she burned, they cried: ‘What city was ever like this great city?’
19 They threw dust on their heads and cried, weeping and mourning: ‘Woe, woe, great city! All who had ships at sea grew rich from her treasures. In a single hour she has been laid waste.’
20 Rejoice over her, you heavens, and all you holy ones, apostles, and prophets, for God has carried out his judgment on her for your sake.”
21 Then a mighty angel lifted a great stone, like a millstone, and threw it into the sea, saying: “So Babylon, the great city, will be thrown down with one mighty stroke, and will never rise again.
22 Never again will the sound of harpists, singers, flute players, or trumpet players be heard in you. No craft of any kind will be practiced in you, and the sound of a mill will never again be heard in you.
23 The light of no lamp will ever shine in you again, nor will the voices of bridegroom and bride ever again be heard in you. Your merchants were the great ones of the earth, and with your sorcery all nations were deceived.
24 In you was found the blood of prophets and holy ones, the blood of all who suffered sacrificial death on earth.”

**19**

After this I heard a mighty voice, like that of a great multitude in heaven: “Hallelujah! All salvation and revelation, all the power of the worlds, belong to the God whom we serve.
2 His judgments lead to truth and to the being of the Good. He has judged the great prostitute who corrupted all earthly existence through her fornication, and he has avenged the blood of his servants shed by her hand.”
3 And once again the voices said: “Hallelujah! The smoke of her burning will continue to rise from one aeon to the next.”
4 Then the twenty-four elders and the four creatures fell down and worshipped the exalted divine Being seated on the throne, saying: “Yes, Amen, Hallelujah!”
5 A voice came from the throne: “Praise our God, all you who serve him and are devoted to him, all who bow before him in reverence, small and great!”
6 And I heard a voice like that of a great multitude, like the roar of many waters and the rumble of mighty thunder: “Hallelujah! The Lord our God, ruler of all, is King.
7 Let us rejoice and exult and praise his revelation, for the wedding of the Lamb is beginning; his bride has made herself ready.
8 She may clothe herself in shining, pure fine linen. The white garment is the higher being that shines in those devoted to the spirit.”

9 He said to me: “Write! Blessed are those invited to the wedding feast of the Lamb.” And he continued: “These are truly the words of God.”
10 I fell at his feet to worship him, but he said to me: “Do not do that! I am a fellow servant of yours and of your brothers. Hold fast to the destiny of Jesus as witness. Worship God the Father. In the destiny of Jesus as witness lives the spirit of prophecy, the power of what is to come.”
11 Then I saw heaven opened. Behold, a white horse! Its rider is the one who makes faith and knowledge true. Through his judgments and his struggle, moral being comes into existence.
12 His eyes are like flames of fire, and many crowns shine upon his head. A name is written on him that no one understands except himself.
13 He is clothed in a garment sprinkled with blood, and his name is called the Logos of God.
14 The armies of heaven follow him on white horses, clothed in pure white linen.
15 From his mouth comes a sharp sword with which he strikes the nations. He is their shepherd and bears the iron staff. He treads the winepress from which the wine of the divine will flows forth as the wrath of the ruler of the world.
16 On his garment and on his thigh is written the name: “King of kings and Lord of lords.”
17 I saw an angel standing in the sun. He cried with a loud voice to all the birds flying through the zenith of heaven: “Come, gather for the great feast of God,
18 to eat the flesh of kings, commanders, and mighty ones, the flesh of horses and their riders, and the flesh of all people, free and enslaved, small and great.”
19 I saw the beast and the kings of the earth with their armies gathered to wage war against the rider on the white horse and his army.
20 The beast was captured, along with the false prophet who had performed signs in its presence and deceived those who bore the mark of the beast and worshipped its image. Both were thrown alive into the fiery marshes where sulfurous flames blaze.
21 The rest were killed by the sword that came from the rider’s mouth, and all the birds gorged themselves on their flesh.

**20**

Then I saw an angel descending from heaven. He had the key to the abyss and a mighty chain in his hand.
2 He seized the dragon, the serpent of the beginning, the united diabolical and satanic power, and bound him for a thousand years.
3 He threw him into the abyss, shut it, and sealed it over him, so that he could no longer lead the people of the earth astray until the thousand years were completed. After that, he must be released for a short time.
4 I saw thrones, and those seated on them had been entrusted with the office of directing destiny. I also saw the souls of those who had been slain for their testimony to Jesus and for the divine Word of the world. They had worshipped neither the beast nor its image, and had not received its mark on their foreheads or hands. They came to life and reigned with Christ for a thousand years.
5 The rest of the dead did not come to life until the thousand years were completed. This was the first resurrection.
6 Blessed and holy are those who share in the first resurrection. The second death, the death of the soul, has no power over them. They will be priests of God and Christ and will reign with Christ for a thousand years.
7 When the thousand years are completed, satanic power will be released from its prison.

8 It will go out to deceive the nations at the four corners of the earth, gathering humankind—Gog and Magog—for war. Their number will be like the sand of the sea.
9 They marched across the whole earth and surrounded and besieged the stronghold of the holy ones and the beloved city. But fire came down from heaven and consumed them.
10 The diabolical power that had deceived them was thrown into the marsh of fire and sulfur, where the beast and the false prophet had already been thrown. They will suffer torment day and night through all the aeons.
11 Then I saw a great white throne and the one seated on it. Earth and heaven fled from his presence and could no longer be found within the world of space.
12 I saw the dead, great and small, standing before the throne, and books were opened. Another book was opened as well: the book of life. The dead were judged according to their deeds, as recorded in the books.
13 The sea gave up its dead, and the realm of death and shadows also gave up its dead. Each was judged according to their deeds.
14 Then the realm of death and shadows was also thrown into the burning depths of the fiery marsh. This is the second death, the lake of fire.
15 Anyone whose name was not found written in the book of life was also thrown into the lake of fire.

**21**

Then I saw a new heaven and a new earth. The old heaven and the old earth had passed away, and the sea was no more.
2 I also saw the holy city, the New Jerusalem, descending from heaven, from the very realm of the Godhead. In its beauty it was like a bride adorned for her wedding.
3 I heard a mighty voice from the throne saying: “Behold, the dwelling of God is among human beings. He will live among them, and they will be his people.
4 The Godhead itself will be with them and wipe every tear from their eyes. There will be no more death, mourning, cries of lament, or heavy burden, for the old world has passed away.”
And the one seated on the throne said: “Behold, I make all things new!”
5 He said: “Write! These are words of faith and knowledge.” And he said to me:
6 “It is accomplished. I am the Alpha and the Omega, the beginning and also the goal of the worlds. To the thirsty I will give water from the spring of life freely, without conditions.
7 Whoever overcomes will inherit all this. I will be their God, and they will be my child.
8 But as for the fearful, those without faith, those who distort the human image, spread death around them, follow impure paths of the soul, practice dark magic, serve demonic powers, and falsify true being—in their case the fiery marshes of the abyss, blazing with sulfurous flames, open up. This is the second death, the death of the soul.”
9 One of the seven angels who had the seven bowls containing the seven final trials came and said to me: “Come! I will show you the bride, the wife of the Lamb.”
10 In the realm of the spirit he carried me away to a great, high mountain and showed me the holy city, Jerusalem, descending from heaven, from the very realm of the Godhead.
11 It shone with the light of God’s revelation. Its radiance was like that of the most precious gemstone, like crystal-clear jasper.
12 The city had a great, high wall with twelve gates. At the gates were twelve angels, and names were written on them—the names of the twelve tribes of the sons of Israel.
13 Three gates faced east, three north, three south, and three west.

14 The wall of the city rested on twelve foundations, on which were the twelve names of the twelve apostles of the Lamb.
15 The one speaking with me had a golden measuring rod to measure the city, its gates, and its wall.
16 The city was laid out as a square, its length equal to its width. He measured the city with the rod: twelve thousand stadia. Its length, width, and height were equal.
17 He measured the wall: one hundred and forty-four cubits, by human measure, which is also the measure of an angel.
18 The wall was built of jasper, and the city itself of pure gold, like transparent crystal.
19 The foundations of the city wall were adorned with every kind of precious stone: the first foundation with jasper, the second with sapphire,
20 the third with chalcedony, the fourth with emerald, the fifth with sardonyx, the sixth with carnelian, the seventh with chrysolite, the eighth with beryl, the ninth with topaz, the tenth with chrysoprase, the eleventh with hyacinth, and the twelfth with amethyst.
21 The twelve gates were twelve pearls, each gate made from a single pearl. The street of the city was pure gold, like transparent crystal.
22 I saw no temple in the city, for the Lord, the divine ruler of the world, is himself its temple, together with the Lamb.
23 The city needs neither sun nor moon to shine upon it, for the light of God's revelation illuminates it, and the Lamb is its lamp.
24 By its light the nations will walk, and the kings of the earth will bring their splendor into it.
25 Its gates will never be shut by day, for there will be no night there.
26 The spiritual treasures and values of the souls of the nations will be brought into the city.
27 Nothing unholy will enter it, nor anything that distorts the human image or falsifies true being. Only those whose names are written in the Lamb's book of life will enter.

**22**

He showed me a river: the water of life, bright and clear as crystal, flowing from the throne of God and of the Lamb.
2 In the middle of the city's street, and on either side of the river, stood the tree of life, bearing twelve kinds of fruit and yielding fruit every month. The leaves of the tree served as healing medicine for the nations; through them every curse loses its power.
3 The throne of God and of the Lamb will be in the city, and his servants will perform sacred service before him.
4 They will see his face, and his name will shine on their foreheads.
5 There will be no more night. They will need no lamp or other light, nor the light of the sun, for the Lord God himself will shine upon them, and they will reign through all the aeons.
6 He said to me: "These are words of faith and knowledge. The Lord, from whose divine source of being revelation comes to all prophetic spirits, has sent his angel to show his servants what is soon to take place.
7 Behold, I am coming in a moment. Blessed is the one who takes to heart the words in this book that point toward the future."
8 I, John, am the one who heard and saw these things. When I heard and saw them, I fell down at the feet of the angel who had shown them to me, to worship him.
9 But he said to me: "Do not do that! I am a fellow servant of yours and of your brothers, the prophets, and of those who take the words of this book to heart. Worship God the Father alone."

10 He also said to me: “Do not seal up the words of this book that point toward the future, for the time is near; the time has come!
11 Whoever is far from the Good now will remain far from the Good in the future. Whoever is now clouded will remain so in the future. But whoever now shares in higher being will be able to shape life from higher being in the future as well, and whoever is permeated by the spirit will continue to experience spiritualization.
12 Behold, I am coming suddenly, and I will be Lord of destiny. I will give each person the recompense of destiny corresponding to their deeds.
13 I am the Alpha and the Omega, the First and the Last, the beginning and also the goal of the worlds.
14 Blessed are those who cleanse their festal garments. They have authority over the tree of life and may enter the city through its gates.
15 Outside must remain the unholy, those who practice magic, follow impure paths of the soul, spread death around them, serve demonic powers, and falsify true being through their attitudes and deeds.
16 I, Jesus, have sent my angel to you to confirm these words for the congregations. I am the root and descendant of David, the radiant morning star.”
17 The Spirit and the bride say: “Come!” Let everyone who hears this call also say: “Come!” Let everyone who thirsts come; whoever wishes may freely take the water of life.
18 I myself make the prophetic words of this book an inner strength for everyone who hears them. For those to whom they mean nothing, the spiritual world will draw near through the trials they must undergo, the trials described in this book.
19 Whoever finds the words of this book too heavy a burden will have their share in the tree of life and the holy city taken away by the spiritual world, the things written about in this book.
20 The one who gives power to these words says: “Yes, I am coming soon.” Amen. Come, Lord Jesus!
21 May the grace of Jesus our Lord be with those who consecrate themselves to him.

## The Explanations of Rudolf Steiner.

### Chapter 1.

GA008

At the end of the New Testament stands a remarkable document, the Apocalypse, the secret revelation of Saint John. We need only read the opening words to feel the esoteric character of this book. “The Revelation of Jesus Christ, which God granted him, to show to his servants how the necessary events will shortly run their course; this is sent in signs by the angel of God to his servant John.”68 What is revealed here is “sent in signs.” Therefore we must not take the literal sense of the words as they stand, but seek for a deeper sense, of which the words are only signs. But there are also many other things which point to such a “secret meaning.” John addresses himself to seven communities in Asia. This cannot mean actual, material communities. For the number seven is the sacred symbolic number which must be chosen because of its symbolic meaning. The actual number of the Asiatic communities would have been different. And its esoteric character is further indicated by the manner in which John arrived at the revelation: “I was in the Spirit on the Lord's day, and heard behind me a voice like a trumpet, saying; What you see, write in a book and send it to the seven communities.” Therefore we are dealing with a revelation received by John in the Spirit. And it is the revelation of Jesus Christ. What became revealed to the world through Christ Jesus appears in an esoteric form. Such an esoteric sense therefore must be sought in the teaching of Christ. This revelation bears the same relationship to ordinary Christianity as the revelation of the Mysteries in pre Christian times bore to the folk religion. Hence the attempt to treat this Apocalypse as a Mystery appears justified.

John turned and saw “seven golden lights,” and “in the midst of the lights the image of the Son of Man, clothed with a long robe and with a golden girdle round his loins; his head and his hair were gleaming white like wool or snow, and his eyes were sparkling in the fire.” We are told (Rev.1:20) that “the seven lights are the seven communities.” This means that the lights are seven different ways of attaining to the divine. All of them are more or less imperfect. And the Son of Man “had seven stars in his right hand” (verse 16). “The seven stars are the angels of the seven communities” (verse 20). Here the “guiding spirits” (daemons) of the wisdom of the Mysteries have become the guiding angels of the “communities.” These communities are represented as bodies for spiritual beings. And the angels are the souls of these “bodies,” just as human souls are the guiding powers of human bodies. The communities are the paths to the divine in the imperfect, and the souls of the communities should become guides along these paths. For this purpose they themselves must grow in such a way that their leader is the being who has the “seven stars” in his right hand. “And out of his mouth issued a two-edged sharp sword, and his countenance in its glory was like the shining sun.” In the Mysteries this sword is also found. The neophyte was terrified by a “drawn sword.” This indicates the situation of one wishing to know the divine by experience, so that the “countenance” of wisdom may “shine upon him with a glory like the sun.” Through this experience John also goes. It is to be a test of his strength. “And when I saw him, I fell at his feet as dead; and he laid his right hand upon me and said: Do not be terrified” (verse 17). The neophyte must go through experiences which otherwise come to man only when he goes through death. His guide must lead him beyond the region where birth and death have meaning. The initiate enters upon a new life, “and I was dead, and behold, I became alive throughout the cycles of life; and I have the keys of Death and the Realm of the Dead.”—Thus prepared, John is lead onward in order to learn the secrets of existence. “After this I looked, and behold, the door to heaven was opened, and the first voice which became audible sounded to me like a trumpet, and said Come up hither, and I will show you what will happen after this.” The messages of the seven spirits of the communities announce to John what is to occur in the material, physical world in order to prepare the way for Christianity; what he now sees “in the Spirit” leads him to the spiritual, primal source of things, hidden behind physical evolution, but which will be realized in a spiritualized age in the near future by means of physical evolution. The initiate experiences now in the Spirit what is to happen in the future. “And immediately I was withdrawn into the realm of Spirit. And I beheld a throne in heaven, and one seated on the throne. And he who sat there appeared like the jasper and carnelian stone; and a rainbow surrounded the throne that looked like an emerald.” In this way the primal source of the material world is described in the pictures in which it clothes itself for the seer. “And in the sphere around the throne were twenty-four thrones, and seated upon the twenty-four thrones were twenty-four elders, clothed in white flowing garments, and with golden crowns upon their heads.” (chapter 4, verses 1, 2)—Beings far advanced upon the path of wisdom thus surround the primal source of existence, to gaze on its infinite essence and to bear testimony to it. “And in the midst of the throne, and around the throne, were four living creatures, full of eyes in front and behind. And the first living creature was like a lion, and the second like a bull, the third looked like a human being, and the fourth was like a flying eagle. And each of the four living creatures had six wings, full of eyes all round and within, and day and night they never cease to proclaim: Holy, holy, holy, the God, the Almighty, who was, and is, and is to be.” It is not difficult to perceive that the four beasts represent the supersensible life underlying the forms of life presented by the material world. Afterward, when the trumpets sound, they raise their voices, that is, when the life expressed in material forms has been transmuted into spiritual life.

Thus the initiates describe what happened to them through the Mysteries. Menippus relates that he journeyed to Babylon in order to be taken to Hades and brought back again by the successors of Zoroaster. He says that on his travels he swam across the great water and that he passed through fire and ice. We hear that the mystics were terrified by a drawn sword and that “blood flowed.” We

understand such sayings when we know the point of transition from lower to higher cognition. We ourselves have felt how all solid matter, all the material world, has dissolved into water; we have lost the ground from beneath our feet. Everything we had previously experienced as living has been killed. The spirit has passed through material life as a sword pierces a warm body; we have seen the blood of sensuality flow.
GA008

GA093
Let us seek to conceive what it means to have foresight on higher planes. Let us suppose you have water in a pond. You can foresee that the pond will become frozen if the temperature falls, so that skating and so on will be possible. In a similar way do we have [foresight] with the relationship of the so-called astral plane to the physical plane, that is to the world in which we are involved. If therefore one follows events on the astral plane one could then in fact see what will be, in a later period, with the help of astral happenings, as if it were a thickening of them. And so one can watch those astral events which subsequently step forth, solidified, on the physical plane. Physical events are nothing else than such thickened occurrences which have already taken place in the higher worlds.

An example: throughout antiquity there were mysteries. These had the task of receiving individual men and initiating them into the secrets of existence, or—as John of the Apocalypse says—showing what must ‘shortly,’ that is to say in the future, come to pass. In the precincts of such temples, the pupils who were to be received into the first degree were instructed. Now there was a further instruction for each successively higher level of development in the pupils. The first stage was for the candidates to purify their astral bodies. This meant that they did not merely embrace the ordinary bourgeois ethic; the bourgeois ethic was the preliminary requirement, what was then involved had to be followed in the strictest performance of duty. For, as the pupil progressively advanced to higher ideals, passing beyond the passions and instincts of ordinary life to yearnings above human pettiness, so purifying his sympathies and antipathies that the great world-embracing affairs of the human race became his own—as he reached out beyond himself in his feelings and perceptions, then he was on the way to completing what one calls the purification of the astral body. Then he was allowed to work upon the denser bodies. He was allowed to work upon his etheric body, and was no longer restricted to reshaping the soft, flexible and compliant astral substance of his soul and spirit bodies, but was allowed to work on his etheric body. He was then what is called a Chela. Such a Chela is one who acknowledges not only higher duties, who has undertaken not only enough purification to make humanity's duties his own, but is so advanced that he has outgrown the lower and higher affairs of individual nations and even of individual creeds. His gaze is now addressed to the life of the whole of humanity. And through his by now thoroughly structured etheric body he becomes a participant in the great affairs of the building of the earth. To do all this, the following must happen.

The Chela has to immobilise all the forces which hinder his work on his etheric body. If you have a human being before you, he has indeed a physical body, an etheric body and an astral body. The Chela has refined his astral body, and is allowed to work upon his etheric body. What happens when the astral body has been purified? What then penetrates the etheric body?—that which is organised in the astral body. The things which live in the astral body stamp themselves on the etheric body. The more you work at your astral body, the more you can redress its defects; the astral substance is thin and soft, you can always bring it back into balance again. However, if a person has begun to develop his etheric body as a Chela, then these qualities stamp themselves on the etheric body, and that is much more permanent. The man who made his earthly defects permanent would thereby become dangerous as a member of humanity. Hence the constant stress on necessary purification. The etheric body is stamped by the forces that work on it. Think of it separated from the physical body, it would then have quite a

different elasticity. If it is fixed in [the physical body] this is held in by the form; but so long as it remains there, it is at first too weak to stamp into itself what has undergone catharsis as astrality.

Therefore throughout ancient times the following had to be done. One had to set aside those forces which impeded the elasticity of the etheric body. That was achieved by bringing the whole physical body into a lethargic condition. The human being lay down, and the etheric body was drawn out of the physical body. While the physical body lay as if dead, the astral body came to be formed by its autonomous forces. That is the entombment, the [body] concerned being kept in a lethargic state for three to three and a half days. And then he could work on the etheric body. And then, after he had formed his etheric body in conformity with his astral body, he returned into his physical body. He had thus awakened an inner life in himself; he was one of the resurrected and was given a new name.

This was a transaction on the astral plane. Everything which I have described took place on the astral plane; the physical body had nothing to do with it. This event repeated itself in all the ancient mysteries. Every initiate knew it. Now imagine it densified, translated down into the physical plane, so that something [physical] has happened, through this event, which had previously only happened astrally; analogous to, for example, your having a piece of ice where you had water before. Many such astral events must combine, must flow together, for the physical thickening eventually to become possible. Through this means the Mystery of Golgotha became historically possible, it could be translated down on to the physical plane, in that, through the appearance of Christ, things happened on the physical plane which previously had happened over and over again on the astral plane. We learn to conceive, through this example, how the future is actually prepared in the occult brotherhoods.
GA093

GA104
At the beginning of the Apocalypse the writer says (I have tried to translate the first few words in such a way that they convey the true meaning): “This is the revelation of Jesus Christ which God gave unto his servant, to show in brief what must needs come to pass. This is put in symbols and sent through an angel to his servant John, who wrote these things.” He wishes to describe it in brief; what does this mean? It means in other words: “If I were to describe in detail all that will take place from now up to the goal of the earth evolution, I. should have to write a very great deal, but I will show it to you in a short sketch.” This the translators who could not penetrate into the spirit of the Apocalypse have translated as “to show what must shortly come to pass.” They thought that what is described in the Apocalypse was to happen in the near future. But it ought to read: “I will briefly describe what will take place.” The original text fully admits of the true interpretation I have tried to give in the introduction to Seals and Columns.

So when we look back into the primeval past we see the first condition of our earth, that of ancient Saturn which at the beginning of its existence did not even shine. It consisted of a kind of warmth. You would not have been able to see it as a shining globe, but had you approached you would have come into a warmth space, because it then consisted only of warmth.

Someone might now ask: Did then the development of the world begin with Saturn? Have not perhaps other conditions brought about that which became Saturn? Was not Saturn preceded by other incarnations? It would be difficult to go back before Saturn because only with Saturn begins something without which it is impossible to go beyond Saturn, namely, that which we call time. Previously there were other forms of being; that is to say, we cannot really speak of a “before,” because time did not yet exist. Even time had a beginning! Before Saturn there was no time, there was only eternity, duration. All was then simultaneous. Only with Saturn did it come about that events followed one another. In that

state of the world where there is only eternity, duration, there is also no movement. For time belongs to movement. There is no circulation, no revolution; there is duration and rest. As one says in Spiritual Science: there is blissful rest in duration. That is the expression for it. Blissful rest in duration preceded that Saturn condition. The movement of the heavenly bodies only entered with Saturn. The path indicated by the twelve signs of the Zodiac was conceived of as signs, and the time during which a planet passed through one of these constellations was spoken of as a cosmic hour; twelve cosmic hours, twelve hours of day and twelve of night! To each cosmic body, Saturn, Sun and Moon, is reckoned a consecutive number of cosmic hours which are grouped into cosmic days; and of these periods of time seven are outwardly perceptible and five are more or less outwardly imperceptible. We distinguish there-fore seven Saturn revolutions or seven great Saturn days and five great Saturn nights. We might also say five days and seven nights, for the first and last "days" are twilight days. We are accustomed to call these seven revolutions, these seven cosmic days, Manvantaras, and the five cosmic nights, Pralayas. If we wish to have it exactly correspond to our reckoning of time, we reckon two planetary conditions together, that is, Saturn and Sun, Moon and Earth; and we then get twenty-four revolutions. These twenty-four revolutions form important epochs in the representation of the world and we picture these twenty-four revolutions ruled by beings in the universe who are represented in the Apocalypse as the twenty-four Elders, the twenty-four rulers of the cosmic revolutions, the cosmic periods. In the seal (shown by Dr. Steiner) they are typified as the cosmic clock. The numbers on the clock are here only interrupted by the double crowns of the Elders to indicate that these are the Time-Kings because they rule the revolutions of the cosmic bodies.

The initiate sees this when he first looks back into the picture of the past. We must now ask: Why does the initiate see this picture? Because in it are represented symbolically in astral pictures the forces which have formed the human etheric body in its present shape, and corresponding with this the physical body. Why this is so you may easily imagine. Imagine a man lying in bed. With his astral body and "I" he leaves the physical body and etheric body. But now the physical and etheric bodies as they are to-day, belong to the present physical human body; and to the present etheric body belong the astral body and the "I." This physical and this etheric body cannot exist alone. They have become what they are because the astral body and "I" have been membered into them. Only a physical body which contains neither blood nor nerves can exist without an astral body and "I." That is the reason why the plant can exist without astral body and "I," because it has neither blood nor nervous system, for the nervous system is connected with the astral body and the blood with the "I." There is no being having a nervous system in the physical body which is not permeated by an astral body and there is no human being having a blood system in the physical body into which the "I" has not entered. Think of what you do every night. You callously desert your physical and etheric bodies and leave them with the blood and nervous systems to themselves. If it merely depended upon you, your physical body would have to die every night through your deserting your nervous and blood systems; it would die the very moment the astral body and "I " left the physical and etheric bodies. But the spiritual investigator sees how other beings, higher spiritual beings, then occupy it. He sees how they pass into it and do what man does not do in the night, namely, take care of the blood and nervous systems. These are the same beings, however, who have created man, in so far as he consists of a physical body and etheric body, not only to-day but from incarnation to incarnation. They are the same beings who caused the first rudiments of the physical body to originate upon ancient Saturn and who formed the etheric body upon the Sun. These beings who from the very beginning of the Saturn and Sun periods have ruled in the physical and etheric bodies, now rule every night while man is asleep and basely leaves his physical and etheric bodies, surrendering them to death, so to speak; they penetrate and take care of his blood and nervous systems.

Hence, too, it is comprehensible that at the moment when the astral body touches the etheric body in order to imprint itself in it, man is then pervaded by those forces which have formed him; he then sees the picture of the forces which are symbolized in the seal. That which upholds him in life and connects him with the whole universe flashes out at this moment of initiation. He sees what has formed the two members of his being, the physical body and etheric body, that which preserves their life every night; but he himself has still no share in it for he cannot yet work into these two principles of his being. If it depended upon man, the physical body and the etheric body, which during the night lie on the bed, would be condemned to a plant existence, for he leaves them to themselves. Hence to man the state of sleep is an unconscious condition such as the plant always possesses.

Now what has happened, in the case of an ordinary man, with that which has withdrawn during sleep? What has become of the astral body and the "I"? These also are unconscious during the night. The ordinary man experiences nothing in his astral body during sleep at night. But suppose a person were passing through the seven stages of the John-initiation—those important stages in Christian initiation—he experiences not merely what has been described up to now; quite apart from the fact that when the astral body touches the etheric body he is able to develop clairvoyant power, something else would come about. He becomes conscious of the soul-peculiarities, the human soul-qualities of the astral and devachanic worlds from which his soul is really born. To this picture is added a still higher symbol which seems to fill the whole world. To this symbol of the old initiation there is added for one who passes through the stages of the initiation of John something else which may best be represented by the first seal. The Christian initiation possessed this as the symbol of the old initiation. We are now presenting these things from the standpoint of Christianity, which, however, has to receive then and change them into something different. He sees a spiritual vision (Rev. i, 12) of the Priest-king with the golden girdle, with feet which seem to consist of cast metal, his head covered with hair as of white wool, out of his mouth a fiery sword flaming and in his hand the seven cosmic-stars, Saturn, Sun, Moon, Mars, Mercury, Jupiter, Venus.

The form in the centre of the second picture seal was only indicated in the old initiation as the fifth of the group-souls. It is that which only existed germinally in ancient humanity and only came forth as what is described as the Son of Man who rules the stars when he fully appears to man in his true form.

Thus from this symbolical representation we must first of all clearly understand that the separation of the various principles in present-day humanity—physical body and etheric body on the one hand and astral body and "I" upon the other—may be so considered, that each may contribute its part, as it were, to initiation, first of all through the form of initiation when the astral body touches the etheric body, when the four group-souls flash out, and then in the treatment of the astral body so that this too acquires the ability to see. Previously the highest vision in the super-sensible world had only reached as far as a kind of plant experience of the world. Through the Christian initiation a higher stage of initiation is reached in the astral body.

Here you have the two things mentioned at the beginning of the Apocalypse described from the principle of initiation itself. The writer of the Apocalypse has, however, described them in the reverse order, and rightly so. He first describes the vision of the Son of Man, the appearance of Him Who is, Who was and Who is to come—and then the other. Both are symbols of what the initiate experiences during initiation.

Thus the "I" will be the pledge for the highest goal of man. But at the same time, if it does not discover love, if it hardens within itself, it is the tempter that plunges him into the abyss. For it is that which separates men from one another which brings them to the great War of All against All, not only to the

war of nation against nation (for the conception of a nation will then no longer have the significance it possesses to-day) but to the war of each single person against every other person in every branch of life; to the war of class against class, of caste against caste and sex against sex. Thus in every field of life the “I” will become the apple of discord; and hence we may say that it can lead on the one hand to the highest and on the other hand to the lowest. For this reason it is a sharp two-edged sword. And he who brought the full Ego-consciousness to man, Christ Jesus, is, as we have seen, symbolically and correctly represented in the Apocalypse as one who has the sharp two-edged sword in his mouth.

We have represented it as a high achievement of man that just through Christianity he has been able to ascend to this concept of the free “I.” Christ Jesus brought the “I” in all its fullness. Hence this “I” must be expressed by the sharp two-edged sword which you already know from one of our seals. And the fact that this sharp two-edged sword proceeds from the mouth of the Son of Man is also comprehensible, for when man has learnt to utter the “I” with full consciousness it is in his power to rise to the highest or sink to the lowest. The sharp two-edged sword is one of the most important symbols met with in the Apocalypse.
GA104

GA104a
The Revelations of John seek to tell us what will happen in the course of time. The Apocalypse is written in pictures that express the appearance of the eternal spirit of the world. John, who beholds them, is to record these highest mysteries.

We are, to begin with, concerned with seven communities, represented symbolically by seven lamp stands and seven stars. The stars are the communities' geniuses watching over them.

In the second vision John sees the four apocalyptic living beings, the lion, the bull, the eagle, and Man, surrounding a throne where sits the spirit of God. Twenty-four elders are sitting around the throne of the spirit of God. “And I saw in the right hand of him who was seated on the throne a scroll written within and on the back, sealed with seven seals.” (Rev. 5:1) A lamb opens the book. The book contains, with the opening of the first four seals, what is expressed symbolically in the four apocalyptic riders; with the opening of the fifth seal the martyrs appear. These are those who have lifted themselves up to knowledge and life in the spirit. The opening of the sixth seal is followed by a horrible earthquake. With the seventh the revelation becomes audible: the seven trumpets sound forth. Mysterious pictures are then revealed; for example, a being whose legs are like two pillars, one foot stands in the sea, the other on the earth. “Then I saw another mighty angel coming down from heaven, wrapped in a cloud, with a rainbow over his head, and his face was like the sun, and his legs like pillars of fire. He had a little scroll open in his hand.” (Rev. 10:1,2) John must eat the secret of this book. Then a woman appears dressed with the sun, and the moon at her feet.

We read further: “And I saw a beast rising out of the sea, with ten horns and seven heads, with ten diadems upon its horns and a blasphemous name upon its heads.” (Rev. 13:1) The sound of trumpets accompanies this vision. The victory of good over evil is shown us in a picture. A beast is shown which, in a certain sense, is supposed to represent to us the principle of evil. It is the beast with seven heads and ten horns.

Then a beast appeared with two horns like a lamb, a beast that will appear in the future. “Then I saw another beast which rose out of the earth; it had two horns like a lamb and spoke like a dragon. It exercises all the authority of the first beast ... And it causes all, both small and great, both rich and poor, both free and slave to be marked on the right hand or the forehead so that no one can buy or sell unless

he has the mark, that is, the name of the beast, or the number of its name. This calls for wisdom; let him who has understanding reckon the number of the beast, for it is a human number, its number is six hundred and sixty-six." (Rev. 13: 11, 16–18)

It is further related how all enemies are eliminated: Michael conquers the dragon, the evil elements; then a new world arises.

Christian esotericism sees the earth as the body of Christ. When Christian esotericism speaks of the body of Christ, it is speaking of the planetary body of the earth. Therefore, you must take words such as the following seriously: "He who ate my bread has lifted his heel against me." (John 13:18) When we eat the bread of the earth we are treading on it with our feet.

If so, the writer of the Apocalypse can say even something more. We have seen that Seth was an initiate. Abel was a man of God who voluntarily lived from what was given to him. Cain was a farmer who himself built whatever he needed. Two lines of development are spoken of. One could be called the Seth or Abel direction, while the other included those who themselves had to change the form of everything. They will have to work for a long time; therefore tilling the soil, the work of the farmer has always been a symbol for those who transform the earth. The children of Abel or Seth stand over against the servants of Cain, who are the successors of Cain or the people of Cain. Those who have received revelations from the beginning have seen from the beginning, but also those who diligently work and strive will become initiates and behold the one who is the spirit of the earth, the planetary spirit of the earth. If the writer of the Apocalypse wants to indicate that the spirit of the planet will be seen by those who themselves transform the earth, then he will say: "All eyes will see Christ Jesus, also those who have pierced him." Therefore, the writer of the Apocalypse says, right at the beginning, "Behold, he is coming with the clouds, and every eye will see him, everyone who pierced him." (Rev. 1:7) Those are, at the same time, words that describe the goal, the essence, the leitmotif of the Apocalypse. Precisely these profound words show us that the Apocalypse is really a prophetic book, that we can read from it the future that is here portrayed in pictures. It is our task as Theosophists to see things that Christ Jesus could not speak about in those days because the people could not yet understand. But he did point to them with signs.

Until the time of Christ only a few specially chosen people were initiated. After severe testing they were permitted to learn the teachings that can now be found in my book Theosophy.3 One had to wait a long time until the higher degrees of vision were permitted. Only the most initiated knew the tradition of how to carry out an initiation. If someone wanted to become a pupil, as a first step they had to do this, as a second step, that, and so forth. The initiation concluded when the pupil had gone through the preparatory stages and was led by the wise ones into the mysteries themselves. That took place in a state of consciousness called "ecstasy," a state of existence outside the physical body. It was connected with a diminution of consciousness, but at the same time with a vision of the spiritual world. An inner schooling consisting of certain will impulses, meditations, and a purification of the desires brought the pupil to a point where the last step was possible. Then the pupil was put by the initiator into a state that lasted three and a half days, a state like the one we enter when we fall asleep at night. External sense impressions disappeared. When we are asleep, nothing enters into the place where the sense impressions of sight and sound have disappeared, but with those being initiated a new world appeared. They were surrounded by a new world, a world of astral light, not the darkness, nothing of what today's human being experiences in the night appeared to them. The darkness was permeated by spiritual light and beings that are incarnated within the spiritual light. These beings became visible in the astral light. Then, after awhile, the astral world full of flowing light began to resound with the music of the spheres. What had merely been seen earlier began to be heard; it was a pure, spiritual music. External music is

only a shadow-like reflection of the sounds of the spheres the seer hears, the seer who also perceives the inside of spiritual beings. Suppose we enter a large room filled with people; only when they begin to speak do they reveal their inner life to us. That is how it is in the spiritual world. First the beings become visible, then the inner life of the beings speaks to us. That is the harmony of the spheres.

Then, when the initiates were led back to vision of the physical world, they experienced themselves fully transformed into new human beings. Everyone who returned in this way then typically expressed: “My God, my God, how you have glorified me!” (Compare Matt. 27:46 and Mark 15:34)

And so they returned, knowledgeable concerning the spiritual world out of their own experience. They were then seen as messengers from the spiritual world. What they had experienced up to the point of entering the spiritual world was prescribed precisely, stage by stage.

Although the rites of initiation were not recorded exactly, still there were canons of initiation containing prescriptions for all the steps. Everywhere, whether in the Egyptian schooling of Hermes, or in the Persian school, or in the Greek mysteries, or with the Druidic or Drotten mysteries, there were typical, traditional rules concerning what was to be experienced by anyone wanting to become an initiate. For he was to experience that life in the spirit would conquer death. These books of initiation contained what had to be gone through.

What in the past had been experienced only in secret became historical fact in Christianity. What could be described of Herme' experience took place in inner mysteries, at locations far removed from profane eyes.

In Christianity, for the first time, something was experienced as an external physical event that otherwise only took place in the mystery centers. The course Christ's life followed is the same as that experienced by all initiates when, to begin with, they had their etheric bodies lifted out of their physical. Everything that Christ Jesus experienced physically, on the physical plane, they had experienced in the etheric realm. Their last words were also, “My God, my God, how you have glorified me!” They had experienced earlier in the etheric body what Christ experienced in a physical body. In this way the prophecies of the prophets were fulfilled. This one time only experience of Christ represents the greatest decisive turning point in our world history and separates it into two parts.

All the ancient mysteries looked toward him who was to come, who will live on the physical plane so as to found a new world order. The new initiation is what will occur through the impulses he gave. We find a portrayal of this in the Apocalypse. It tells us how initiation will proceed until Christ Jesus comes again in a new form. The Apocalypse refers to the time when an organ for receiving Christ will be developed. The time until Christ Jesus again will approach is described in the Apocalypse. We will understand the individual words if we adopt the way of thinking of one who has experienced such an initiation. We remember here the words of Christ—if we understand them we will also understand the Apocalypse—“Before Abraham was, I am.” (John 8:58) Christ directs his view from the past over to the present because for him there is an eternal present.

If we wish to understand what is meant by this we need only remember the fourfold human being who consists of physical body, etheric body, astral body, and I. When the I lights up in the course of evolution then the astral and etheric bodies are changed; and then finally the physical body too. The I is here for eternity; it is born out of the womb of a higher spirituality. Whether we look into the past or into the future, this I is what is eternal. If we observe an individual we can ask the question: What transformation has this person's I gone through? If we look back to the great Atlantean flood and then

further back we do not find the I in a body such as exists today. At that time we were in a state wherein we could not think as well as we can now. When we look into the future we find the I in bodies ever more perfect, bodies having a perfection that we today with our thinking cannot even imagine. We cannot now imagine the perfection of thinking, the purity of feeling, and so forth in the future bodies of humankind. Initiates must make use of the form the human body has at any given time. Christ, too, had to use the ordinary form of the human body in his time. Still, when we look deeper we see in him a stage of evolution that humankind will only achieve in the distant future. Christ Jesus was the first born among those who could overcome death.

Let us compare the two ways of developing. The human being is born, goes through a life on earth, dies, goes through an astral condition, through devachan, and is then born again. When we go back to the beings who were present before the Lemurian age we have beings who do not die and are not reborn. They are constantly exchanging sheaths, as we do between physical birth and death. Then a certain revolution enters in. Today, human beings alternate between spiritual and physical life. With the group souls of animals it happens this way: Individual animals discard their bodies but the group souls themselves never die.

If we try to imagine the very highest being, the one who was as highly developed at the beginning as others will be at the end of evolution, then we have the image of Christ. He was the I that was as highly developed at the beginning as the human being will be at the end. “Grace to you and peace from him who is and who was and who is to come ...” (Rev. 1:4) He is the first and the last.

The one who gives the Revelation to John is thus described. It is a Christian book; that is proven by the passage that reads: “... and from Jesus Christ the faithful witness, the first born of the dead and the ruler of kings on earth. To him who loves us and has freed us from our sins by his blood and made us a kingdom, priests to his God and Father, to him be glory and dominion forever and ever. Amen.” (Rev. 1:5,6)

Christianity represents the greatest possible individualization of the human being, the freedom of the human being as an individual. At the beginning of the human race we see small communities held together by blood ties. Love was limited to those of the same blood. Now Christ Jesus comes and expands all ethnic groups and communities to include all of humanity. All ethnic religions are overcome through him. Christianity is the religion of the world. Within it there are only human beings; Christianity knows only human beings. Christianity would never be able to speak of the community of religions, but only of community of human beings. An age began when the secret mysteries became accessible to everyone through the mystery of Golgotha, which was placed in the center of the world. The chosen priests and kings gradually cease to exist. A final state is pointed to wherein everyone is a priest and a king, a state wherein all distinctions are swept away and all human beings are made equal. Therefore, the Apocalypse speaks of: “... a Kingdom, priests to his God and Father.” (Rev. 1:6)

We have seen that the Apocalypse is a book of initiation. It describes the steps to be taken by a candidate for initiation in order to develop the highest vision of the spiritual world. We have seen that acquiring knowledge of all aspects of the physical plane is the first step. Those to be initiated must raise themselves to the astral plane, and then to the devachanic plane. It has become clear to us that human beings who raise themselves to the astral plane are surrounded by a world of pictures, which are much more real than anything we call pictures in our poor language. These astral pictures are much more real than what exists here. These pictures experienced by the seer are the fundamental forces of the physical world. The physical world is formed out of this world of pictures. When human beings have worked through to the astral plane, then they raise themselves to the devachanic plane; this plane's

world of pictures resounds with the so-called music of the spheres, which constitutes the inner being of all things. Progressing then from the astral plane to the devachanic the seer hears for the first time what the Pythagorean school characterized as “the music of the spheres.” The music of the spheres finds only an abstract expression in what we call the higher numbers. But what are ordinary numbers and measure? What are the numbers physicists speak about when they discover wave motion, when they speak of oscillations? What are these numbers compared with what our ears hear when they hear the sounds themselves? What we find in the philosophical books concerning the “mysticism of numbers” is nothing more than a babbling. But what Pythagoras described is what the seer perceives after the spiritual ear has been opened, when it hears the sounds that make the wave movement or hears what is expressed in such wave movement. The devachanic world is nowhere else. You can remain standing in the same location and experience the physical world fading away. The world is enlivened with colors and forms—and then you can experience that this world of light is penetrated by tones.

In the Apocalypse you will find a description of how Christian mysticism describes the devachanic world. If you raise yourself to that elevated condition as the servant of the Lord did, then you first experience what is taking place on the physical plane. This is described to us in a certain way in the seven letters to the seven communities. Then the enlightenment achieved through knowledge of the physical plane is put into signs in the seven seals. When human beings raise themselves to the astral plane they experience a world flooded with light, pictures, and forms. That is described to us in the picture of the man surrounded by the four living creatures, of the lamb receiving from his hand the book with the seven seals. As these picture-seals are unsealed the astral world comes to meet us, and the trumpeting angels signify the harmony of the spheres on the plane of devachan.

With the Apocalypse we are confronted by a book of initiation. Such a book is, at the same time, always a prophetic book. One who experiences the events of the astral and devachanic planes also, at the same time, experiences the events of the future—a profound mystery of the future is present here. What is found today on a higher plane will appear in the future on the physical plane. Place yourself with a seer presently on the astral plane; the seer can only rise to this world if his or her spiritual eye is opened. Think of everything that you experience on the astral plane condensed, grown solid like water to ice; then you have the condition of your own physical world in the near future. The present, today, in the astral world, is the future in the physical, so that the seer can see today the future state of humankind on the astral plane. Initiation means, at the same time, penetrating the secrets of future events. Hence, the Apocalypse is first of all a book of initiation and secondly, a prophetic book. This prophetic wisdom we want now to illuminate a little more closely; we want to see how this wisdom encompasses the meaning of the evolution of our humankind.
GA104a

GA346
Consider this image: Someone writes the content of a book. It is sent to the printing house—a seemingly pedantic, philistine image, perhaps, yet one that may nonetheless serve your purpose. The book is printed and goes out into the world in any number of copies—numerically distinct from one another, yet identical in content. There is one thing to which you are directed at the very beginning of the Apocalypse—one thing revealed by Christ Himself to John: for "this is the revelation of Jesus Christ, received by His servant John" (Rev. 1:1). The content is one, yet it is multiplied through the self-generation of this very content out of the wisdom of the supersensible worlds.

Consider this image: Someone writes the contents of a book, and it is sent to the printing press. This is what it means to understand the Apocalypse of John. In the deeper sense of the term, it also means understanding the Word: Christ has ordained us as priests. You have sensed what is meant when the

author of the Apocalypse says that Christ himself anointed him as a priest. This anointing as a priest occurs when one perceives how the content of the Apocalypse came into being within John. When one senses that people today who wish to become priests do so by bringing the "I"—as it appears in the Apocalypse—into being within themselves, then the "I" becomes apocalyptic; and in that state, the "I" is priestly.

The phrase "I am the Alpha and the Omega" (Rev. 1:8) can only be understood if one knows that, in ancient times, the sound "A"—Alpha—was not the abstract, isolated, and meaningless component of a word that we perceive it to be today; rather, it was a sound truly worthy of bearing a name.

You see, in writings such as the Apocalypse of John, much is still expressed in the language of the mysteries; it can only be understood if it is translated out of that language. It should come as no surprise that the author of the Apocalypse employs the language of the mysteries, for in his time, this was still familiar to people. Back then, they knew that sounds are supersensible entities—that "Alpha" represents the human being as a supersensible entity at his origin; that moving from "Alpha" to "Beta" signifies a transition from the human being toward the world—including the divine world—and that by passing through all the sounds of the alphabet to reach "Omega," one encompasses the entire divine world within oneself.

This is Alpha: the man of warm who lives in a state of wonder—the man of Saturn. And the first thing that man perceived as the world—as the shell of the world—namely the skin, is Beta: the house, this dwelling place of man. Man within his house, within his temple. And the house was the first thing that man received from the world; the skin—Beta.

And as we move through the alphabet, we are, in effect, moving through the world. By gradually taking in everything that constitutes the world and uniting it with his entire being—until, one day, during the Vulcan stage, he has united the full scope of the world, this entire vast universe to which he belongs, within himself—man will become what he was at the beginning of the Saturn stage of evolution, while also becoming the entire world. He will be the Alpha and the Omega—man, with everything that constitutes the world united within him. With the words "I am the Alpha and the Omega" from the Apocalypse of John, we have described what man will become by the end of the Vulcan stage. At the conclusion of the Vulcan evolution, man, too, will be able to say: I am the Alpha and the Omega.

What has, for us, shrunk into a mere poverty of imagination is the intuitive element of the Word—the second thing that John affirms, bears witness to, and communicates. What we might call "perception" in relation to the supersensible, the apocalyptic writer presents as the *appearing* of Christ. Thus, we must say: Behold the appearing of Jesus Christ—given by God to show His servants what must take place in the near future.

I shall interpret the word later.

God brought this into the form of the Word and sent it, through His angel, to His servant John. John, in turn, has affirmed this Word of God and the appearing of Jesus Christ—that which he himself has seen.

What John received from God—both the Word and what he beheld—is what he now seeks to impart to men.
GA346

**Chapter 2.**

GA008
The Apocalypse is addressed to seven communities. What does this mean? We need only single out one of the messages to perceive the sense. In the first of these is said: “Write to the angel of the community of Ephesus: The words of him who holds the seven stars in his right hand, who walks in the midst of the seven golden lights. I know your deeds and what you have suffered and also your patient endurance, and that you will not support those who are evil, and that you have called to account those who call themselves apostles, and are not, and that you have recognized them as false. And you are enduring patiently and building up your work upon my name, and you have not grown weary of it. But I demand from you that you should attain to your highest love. Realize then from what you have fallen, change your thinking and accomplish the highest deeds. If you do not, I will come and move your light from its place, unless you change your thinking. But this you have, that you despise the deeds of the Nicolaitians, which I also despise. He who has an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the communities: To him who is victorious I will give food of the tree of life, which is in the Paradise of God.” (Rev. 2:1–7)—This is the message addressed to the angel of the first community. The angel, who represents the spirit of his community, has entered upon the path marked out by Christianity. He is able to distinguish between the false adherents of Christianity and the true. He wishes to be Christian, and has founded his work on the name of Christ. But it is required of him that he should not bar his own way to the highest love by errors of any kind. He is shown the possibility of taking a wrong course through such errors. Through Christ Jesus the path toward attainment of the divine has been marked out. Patient endurance is needed for further advancement in the sense of the first impulse. It is possible to believe too soon that one has grasped the right sense. This happens if someone allows himself to be led part of the way by Christ and then, after all, leaves this leadership by surrendering himself to false ideas about it. Thereby he relapses into his lower self. He has left the “first love.” The knowledge arising out of material perception may be raised into a higher sphere, becoming wisdom by being spiritualized and made divine. If it does not reach this height, it remains among transitory things. Christ Jesus has pointed out the path to the Eternal. With unwearied, patient endurance knowledge must follow the path leading to its apotheosis. Lovingly it must follow the steps which transform it into wisdom. The Nicolaitians were a sect who took Christianity too lightly. They saw but one thing: Christ is the divine Word, the eternal wisdom which will be born in man. Therefore they concluded that human wisdom is the divine Word. Hence it follows that one need only pursue human knowledge in order to realize the divine in the world. But the meaning of Christian wisdom cannot be construed thus. The knowledge which begins as human wisdom is as transitory as anything else unless it is changed into divine wisdom. You are not thus, says the “Spirit” to the angel of Ephesus; you have not relied merely upon human wisdom. You have trodden the Christian path with patient endurance. But you must not believe that the very highest love is not needed to attain this goal. For this a love is necessary which far surpasses all love for other things. Only this is the “highest love.” The path to the divine is an infinite one, and it must be understood that when the first stage has been reached it can be only the preparation for ascending to ever higher stages. In this way, through the first of the messages is shown how they should be interpreted. The sense of the others can be found in a similar manner.
GA008

GA104
Let us see whether the seven consecutive letters really contain something corresponding with the character of the seven consecutive cultural epochs. Let us try to understand what the tenor of these letters would have to be if they were to correspond with what has just been said. The writer thinks: In

Ephesus is a community, a church; it has accepted Christianity but colours it with the tone of the first cultural epoch—strange to external_ life, not filled with love for that which is the real task of post-Atlantean humanity. The one who directs this letter to the community is satisfied that they had put away the worship of gross sensuality and turned to the spiritual life. We know what the writer of the Apocalypse means from the circumstance that Ephesus was the place where the Mysteries of the chaste Diana were cultivated; he indicates that the turning away from matter specially flourished there, the renunciation of the sensual life and the turning to the spiritual; but, “I have this against thee, that thou hast left thy first love,” the love which the first post-Atlantean site should have, which expresses itself in looking upon the earth as the field in which the divine seed must be sown.

How, then, does he who dictates this letter characterize him-self? He describes himself as the forerunner of Christ Jesus, as the leader of the first cultural epoch. Christ Jesus speaks as if through this leader or master of the first age of civilization, that age when the initiates looked up to the spiritual world. He says of himself that he holds the seven stars in his right hand and the seven golden candlesticks. The seven stars are nothing else than symbols for the seven higher spiritual beings who are the leaders of the great ages of civilization. And of the seven candle-sticks we are expressly told that they are spiritual beings who cannot be seen in the sense world. Reference is also made to these in clear words in the Yoga initiation; but he also shows that man never works according to evolution if he hates external works, if he ceases to love external works. The community at Ephesus forsook the love for external works. So it is quite rightly said in the Apocalypse, “Thou hatest the works of the Nicolaitanes.” “Nicolaitanes” is nothing else than a designation for those who express life merely in a material sense. In the time referred to in this letter there was a sect called the Nicolaitanes, who considered the external fleshly sensual life of primary importance. “This you shall not do,” says the one who inspires the first letter. “But do not forsake the first love,” says he also, “for inasmuch as you love the external world you vivify it, you exalt it to spiritual life.” “He that hath ears to hear, let him hear; to him that overcometh will I give to eat not merely of the perishable tree, but of the tree of life.” That is, he will be able to spiritualize the life of the senses and so elevate it to the altar of the spiritual life.

The representative of the second age of civilization is the community or church at Smyrna. The leader of humanity addresses this one through his second ancestor, the inspirer and master of the ancient Persian civilization. The mental attitude of the ancient Persian was as follows: “There was once the God of Light who had an enemy, external matter, the dark Ahriman. At first I was united with the Spirit of Light, who first was there. Then I was membered into the world of matter, into which the backward and hostile power, Ahriman, instilled himself; and now, in conjunction with the Spirit of Light, I shall work upon matter and embody the spirit in it. Then, after the evil Deity has been conquered, the good Deity, the Spirit of Light, will reappear.” “I am the first and the last, who is killed in material life and made alive again in the spiritual resurrection.” So we read in the second letter, “I am the First and the Last, Which is, and Which was, and Which is to come, He who has become alive again” (Rev. I, 8). It would lead too far to go through every sentence in this way, but we must consider more closely the sentence which describes minutely how a person stands as a member of the community at Smyrna when he transforms it into the Christian principle. There we read that man gives life to dead matter, that he spiritualizes it. He is not destroyed by it. If he were, then death would be an event loading him to a spiritual life in which the results of this earthly life could have no place. Let us take a person who has not lived his life in such a way that he can gather its true fruits. He takes no fruits with him into the spiritual life. But only from these fruits can he live in the spiritual world. If, therefore, he brought with him no fruits he would experience the “second death.” By working in this earthly field he is saved from the “second death.” “He who hath an ear, let him hear what the spirit saith. He that overcometh shall not be hurt of the second death” (Rev. ii. 11).

Now we shall pass on to the community at Pergamos. It is the representative of the age when humanity came down more and more to the physical plane, when man saw in the starry script something that his spirit could understand, something that was given him in the third age of civilization. Man works by means of that which is within him. Through his having an inner being he can investigate the outer world. Only because he was gifted with a soul could he investigate the courses of the stars and invent geometry. This was called “exploration by the word,” and is expressed in the Apocalypse by the “ sword of my mouth.” Hence the one who caused this letter to be written, points out that the power of this age is an incisive word, a sharp two-edged sword. It is the Hermes word of the old priests, the word by which the powers of nature and the stars were explored in the old sense. That was the civilization gained primarily by means of the inner astral soul-forces of man in the physical world. If it were still achieved in that old form, it would verily be a two-edged sword, for then wisdom would be perilously near the edge between white and black magic, between that which leads to blessedness and that which ends in destruction. Therefore he says he well knows that where the representatives of this age dwell, there also is Satan's seat. This indicates all that could lead astray from the really great purposes of evolution; and the teaching of Balaam is none other than the teaching of the black magicians. For that is the teaching of the devourers of the people. The devourers of the people, the destroyers of the people, are the black magicians who work only in the service of their own personality and therefore destroy all brotherhood, they devour everything which lives in the people. But the good side in this civilization consists in man's beginning to purify and transform his astral body. This is called the “hidden manna.” That which is merely for the world, transformed into the food of the gods, that which is only for the egotistical man transformed into the divine, is called the “hidden manna.” All the symbols here indicate that man purifies his soul so as to make himself into the pure vehicle of Manas or the Spirit Self.

To this end, however, it is still necessary to pass through the fourth age of civilization, for then the Saviour appears, Christ Jesus himself. The community at Thyatira. Here he announces himself as the “Son of God,” who has “eyes like flames of fire and feet like brass.” He now announces himself as the Son of God. He is now the leader of the fourth age of civilization, when man has descended to the physical plane, when he has created his image even in the media of external culture. The period has now come when the Deity himself becomes man, becomes flesh, becomes person; the age in which man descended to the stage of personality, where in the sculptures of the Greeks the individualized Deity appears as personality, where in the Roman citizen personality comes into the world. At the same time this age had to receive an impulse through the Divine appearing in human form. Man, who had descended, could only be saved through God Himself appearing as man. The “I Am” or the “I” in the astral body had to receive the impulse of Christ Jesus. That which previously only existed as a germ, the “I” or the “I Am,” was to appear in history in the outer world. The Son of God may therefore, as the leader of the future, say, “And all the churches shall know the ‘I Am,’ which searches the minds and hearts” (Rev. ii. 23). Stress is here laid upon the “I Am,” upon the fourth principle of the human being. “As I have received from my Father; and I will give him the morning star” (Rev. ii. 28).

What does the morning star mean? We know that the earth passes through the conditions of Saturn, Sun, Moon, Earth, Jupiter, Venus and Vulcan. That is the way it is usually expressed, and it is quite correct. But I have already pointed out that the Earth-evolution is divided into the Mars period and the Mercury period on account of the mysterious connection existing in the first half of the earth-evolution between the earth and Mars, and in the second half between the earth and Mercury, so that in the place of Earth (the fourth period of evolution) we some-times put Mars and Mercury. We say that the earth in its evolution passes through Saturn, Sun, Moon, Mars, Mercury, Jupiter, Venus. And the most potent stellar force in the second half of the earth is seen in Mercury. Mercury is the star representing the directional force, the upward tendency in which man must be enveloped.

Here I come to a point where a little secret, so to say, must be unveiled, one which may only be divulged at this point. The teachers of spiritual wisdom have always had what might be called a mask for those who would only have misused it, especially in bygone times. They did not express themselves directly, but presented something which was intended to conceal the true state of affairs. Now the esotericism of the Middle Ages resorted to drastic measures and called Mercury Venus, and Venus Mercury. In truth if we wish to speak esoteric-ally, as the writer of the Apocalypse has done, we must speak of Mercury as the morning star. By the morning star he meant Mercury. “I have given the direction upwards to thine ‘I’ or ego, to the morning star, to Mercury.” You may still find in certain books of the Middle Ages which describe the true state of affairs, that the outer stars of our planetary system are enumerated thus: Saturn, Jupiter, Mars, Earth, and then comes, not as it is now, Venus, Mercury, but the reverse, Mercury, Venus. Therefore it says here, “Even as I received of my Father. And I will give him the morning star” (Rev. ii. 27, 28).

Now in order to understand these hosts more clearly we must consider two ideas which in a certain sense may serve as a key to certain chapters of the Apocalypse. We must study the ideas of the “first death” and the “second death.” What is the first death and what is the second death of man, or of humanity? We must form a clear picture of the ideas which the writer of the Apocalypse connected with these words. To this end we must once more recall to mind the elementary truths concerning human existence.

Now let us look at the future of mankind. The earth spiritualizes itself, that is, man must lose completely something which he now un his physical existence considers as belonging to him. We can form an idea of what will then happen to man if we consider the ordinary course of his life after death. He loses the physical body at death. It is to this physical body that he owes the desires and inclinations which bind him to the ordinary life; and we have described what man experiences after death. Let us take a person who is fond of some particularly dainty food. During life he can enjoy this, but not after death. The desire, however, does not cease, for this is seated, not in the physical body but in the astral body, and as the physical instrument is absent it is impossible to gratify this desire. Such persons look down from kamaloca to the physical world which they have left; they see there all that could give them satisfaction, but they cannot enjoy it because they have no physical instrument for the purpose. Through this they experience a burning thirst. Thus it is with all desires that remain in man after death and are related to the physical world, because they can only be satisfied through physical instruments. This is the case every time after death; each time man sees his physical body fall away, and as something remains in him from this physical body it still urges him to the ordinary world of the physical plane, and until he has weaned himself from this in the spiritual world he lives in the fire of desire.

Now imagine the last earthly incarnation before the spiritualization of the earth, the laying aside of the last physical body. Those who are now living on the earth will have progressed so far through the Christ-principle that, in a certain way, it will not be very difficult for than to lay aside the very last physical body; they will, however, be obliged to leave something, for all that can give pleasure from the objects of this earth will have disappeared once and for all from the spiritual earth. Think of the last death possible in our earth evolution, think of the laying aside of the last physical body. It is this last death of the incarnations which in the Apocalypse is called the first death, and those who have received the Christ-principle see this physical body as a sort of husk which falls away. The etheric body has now become important to them for, with the help of Christ, it has become so organized that it is for the time being adapted to the astral body and no longer desires and longs for what is below in the physical world. Only through all that has been brought into the etheric body through the help of Christ do men

continue to live on in the spiritualized earth. Harmony has been produced between their astral and etheric bodies by the Christ-principle.

On the other hand there are those who have not received the Christ-principle. These do not possess this harmony. They too must lose the physical body, for there is no such thing in the spiritual earth. Everything physical must first be dissolved. It remains as desires for the physical, as the unpurified spiritual, as the spiritual hardened in matter. An etheric body remains which the Christ has not helped to be adapted to the astral body, but which is suited to the physical body. They are the souls who will feel hot fires of desire for physical sensuality; in the etheric body they will feel unappeasable, burning desire by reason of what they have had in the physical life and which they must now do without. Thus, in the next period, after the physical has melted away, we have men who live in an etheric body which harmonizes with the astral body, and we have others whose etheric body lives in discord because they desire what has fallen away with the physical body.

Then in the further stage of evolution there comes a condition where the spiritualizing of the earth has proceeded so far that there can no longer be even an etheric body. Those whose etheric body completely harmonizes with the astral body lay aside this etheric body without pain, for they remain in their astral body which is filled with the Christ-Being. They feel the laying aside of the etheric body as a necessity in evolution, for they feel within them the capacity to build it up again for them-selves because they have received Christ. Those, however, who in this etheric body desire what belongs to the past cannot retain this etheric body, when all becomes astral. It will be taken from them, it will be torn out of them, and they now perceive this as a second dying, as the “second death.” This second death passes unnoticed over those who have made their etheric body harmonize with the astral body through the reception of the Christ-principle. The second death has no power over then. But the others feel the second death when they have to pass over into the future astral form. The condition of humanity will then be such that those who have reached the goal of evolution will have entirely permeated their astral body with Christ. They will be ready to pass over to Jupiter. Upon our earth they have made the plan of the Jupiter evolution. This is the plan which is called the New Jerusalem. They live in a new heaven and a new earth, that is, Jupiter.

This new Jupiter will be accompanied by a satellite, composed of those who are excluded from the life in the spiritual, who have experienced the second death and are, therefore, unable to attain the Jupiter consciousness. Thus we have such men as have pressed forward to the Jupiter consciousness, who have attained to spirit-self; and such beings as have thrust away the forces which would have given them this consciousness. They are those who only upon Jupiter have attained to the “I”-consciousness of the earth, who exist there, so to speak, as man now exists on the earth with his four members. But such a man can develop himself only on the earth, the earth alone has the environment, the ground, the air, the clouds, the plants, the minerals which are necessary to man if he wishes to gain what may be gained within the four members. Jupiter will be quite differently formed, it will be a new earth, soil, air, water, everything will be different. It will be impossible for beings who have only gained the earth consciousness to live a normal life; they will be backward beings.
GA104

GA104a
First, seven letters to seven communities are placed before us. If human beings are to find the path to that great point in time, they must have something to hang on to, something that enables them to ennoble the seven sheaths of their human constitution, so that they are prepared when the time comes. There are places on the earth where, through religious exercises, the main emphasis is on the development of the physical body. In other places the emphasis is on the development of the etheric

body. In other locations the emphasis is on the development of the astral body, or the I. There will also be more and more places where special attention will be given to the development of manas, or budhi, or atma.5 We would not believe in reincarnation in the proper sense unless we would say: If a person has once been born in a location where the primary emphasis is on the physical body, then, another time, he or she would be born in a place where more attention was paid to the other bodies, and so forth.

Seven letters are directed to seven separate geographical regions where particular emphasis is placed on one of the seven parts of the human being. The first letter is directed to the Ephesians. They put great stock in the development of the physical body. The Phrygians in Smyrna emphasized the etheric body; in Pergamon people worked especially on the astral body.

We want to consider why seven geographical regions signify special kinds of development for humankind in relation to the seven members of the human being. Let us assume that someone lives in a region where the physical body is especially developed; if that person then neglects the physical body, it then becomes a caricature of what it might have become. If what is supposed to be brought to a certain perfection is not developed, then something arises inwardly that makes such a person receptive to the evil manifestations in the evolution of humankind.

The first letter is directed to the community in Ephesus, the place consecrated to Diana.6 It emphasizes the beautiful formation of the human body. Where does the development of the physical body lead? We can become increasingly clear about this if we realize that the physical body must be evermore purified, and must become more and more an expression of the etheric body. The etheric body must itself become an expression of the astral body, which in turn should become an expression of the I.

Numbers played a large role in the ancient Pythagorean schools. Let us remember that in the world of devachan, everything is ordered according to measure and number. Of course, this is the case with everything. What would it mean to seek the laws of nature, if they did not already exist? We weigh and measure the bodies of the world as we do substances on a smaller scale. We must put this fact together with another. We can think of this space as filled with the “sound forms” of a sublime musical composition, for example, the sounds of the “Good Friday Spell” from Wagner's opera Parzifal. That is the higher, soul form for what a physicist would express in numbers for the frequency of the sound vibrations. The spirit of these vibrations of the music flows through our souls. If we think of the numbers being heard by the ear of the spirit, then we have the music of the spheres. If a physicist would record in numbers the vibrations in the air he or she would record the magic of “Good Friday” just as little as a mathematician describes Pythagorean ideas in measure and number. The numbers express only the harmonies. When Pythagoreans wanted to express the four members of the human being, they expressed the harmony in the ratio: 1:3:7:12. That signifies the sound wherein the four numbers harmonize in the same way as do the four parts of the human being. The three sounds: I, the sound of the sun; II,—the sound of the moon; III, the sound of the earth—resound into the astral body.

Physical body: 12 Ephesus
Etheric body: 7 Smyrna
Astral body: 3 Pergamon
I: 1
Spirit self
Life spirit
Spiritualized human being

What comes forth from the earth, sun, and moon sound together in our astral body. But what comes forth from the planets sounds in our etheric body. There is a sevenfold influence from the planets on the etheric body, as there is from the seven musical intervals: the unison interval, major second, major third, perfect fourth, perfect fifth, major sixth, major seventh—Saturn, Sun, Moon, Mars, Mercury, Jupiter, Venus. These seven planets resound into our etheric body. There are twelve influences from the signs of the zodiac that resound into our physical body. The seer experiences twelve fundamental tones on the devachanic plane. They influence our physical body. Everything in the I, astral body, etheric body, and in the physical body resounds in tones.

One tone resounds in the I,
three tones in the astral body,
seven tones in the etheric body
and twelve tones in the physical body.

Altogether this results in harmony or disharmony.

There is an expression in occultism: the twelve goes into the seven, which means that the physical body is constantly becoming more like the etheric body. If the physical body sounds right then we can hear the seven tones of the stars through the twelve tones. “Become such that the twelve becomes the seven, that the seven stars appear” is said to the Ephesians, because with them the physical body is especially developed. They should turn to look at the seven stars. We know that the development of Christianity means a transition from the old forms of community based on blood ties to spiritual love, that the spiritual will take over from the flesh. Those who tell us that we should endeavor, above all, to insure that the sensual, the elemental gets its due—those people were called the Nicolaitans: They wanted to remain rooted in the material forces of the blood; hence, the warning concerning the Nicolaitans. They are the ones who will bring about the downfall.

Opposing them are those who want to overcome material evolution, who want spiritual life. The letter closes with the symbol of the tree of life: “He who has an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the churches. To him who conquers I will give some of the hidden manna ...” (Rev. 2:17)

The second letter is directed to the community that is supposed to be most concerned with the cultivation of the etheric body. The etheric body must gradually be developed into life spirit. The human being now goes through birth and death, but later this etheric body will become life spirit. Then it will have overcome death. In the Sermon on the Mount we read: “Blessed are those who pray for spirit, for they find through themselves the Kingdom of Heaven” (compare: Matt. 5:3) Those who pray for spirit are blessed; that means that soul permeates their life. Just as the physical body is developed by the Ephesians, so, too, in the second community, is the etheric body developed into a body of soul. When they strive for this blessing they are called “beggars for spirit”; they pray for a blessing through the enlivening of the etheric body. This is indicated by the words: “Be faithful unto death and I will give you the crown of life.” With these words the development of the etheric body is clearly expressed.

The Apocalypse is one of the greatest spiritual documents. There are hardly any great spiritual truths whose significance is not to be found there. The study of the Apocalypse is not without its connections to theosophical evolution.

If we divide the earth into seven zones geographically, a letter is directed to each. The first territory is one where human beings, particularly today, work to perfect their physical bodies into a higher form. In the second region etheric bodies are the focus and in the third astral bodies are especially cultivated. So

you will find one aspect emphasized in one territory, and another aspect in another. Think of these regions spread over the earth. What we refer to as the various peoples or folk groups cultivate particular parts of the human constitution: one folk especially develops the physical human being, another folk cultivates another aspect. But we have mentioned that it is not true to say that at one location only the astral body, at another only the physical body, is cultivated. In our various incarnations our souls must learn the lesson of each individual region. The seven letters are directed to every human being because every human being must pass through the seven stages of evolutionary development. The letter to the community in Ephesus is directed to a territory where the physical body is especially cultivated. The individual words characterize wonderfully just this kind of development. The third letter, to the Pergamonians, goes to the region where the astral body is particularly developed.

Let us keep together all the different facts we have discovered in the course of time. The evolution of the human being proceeds in such a way that the I works into the astral body, spiritualizing it. That part of the astral body transformed by the I is designated by the term “spirit self” or “manas.” Cultivating the astral body means, then, to work manas into the astral body. As much as you have cultivated your astral body—to that extent have you worked manas into it. In Christian esotericism the word “manna” means the same as manas; what is indicated as manna in the Bible is what we mean when we speak of the manasic nature flowing into the human being.

In the third letter we read: “He who has an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the churches (communities). To him who conquers I will give some of the hidden manna.” (Rev. 2:17) That is clearly stated; and with this letter the other side of the issue is also indicated, that those who do not undergo this development bring their bodies down, bring them into decline. In Christian esotericism the degeneration of the astral body is indicated in a very radical way.

In the Lemurian age the higher part of the human soul descended into the three human members. Remember, at that time the external human being was at a stage just somewhat higher than today's highest animals. From that time onward human beings have been working to form and develop their astral body because the soul is dependent on it. The soul is dependent on the astral body which, when the soul first entered it, was almost at the stage of animality. The progress of humankind consists just in this, that we work on the astral body, that we purify the animalistic emotions and instincts.

Assume for a moment the opposite; the consequence is not that the astral body remains unchanged but rather that it sinks down into a condition lower than it was in during Lemuria. Such neglect is portrayed as the temptations of Satan. For a Christian esotericist, “Satan” is a being who seduces human beings into bringing their astral bodies into decline rather than into ascent. When the writer of the Apocalypse wants to describe the other side, he says: If you develop your astral body then you will enjoy the heavenly manna. But there are regions where people do not develop the astral body—they experience the temptations of Satan. He describes this pull downward on the astral body: “I know where you dwell, where Satan's throne is ...” (Rev. 2:13)

The fourth letter—to the community in Thyatira—is addressed to the region where humanity's sense of personality finds expression. This I plays a large role with all those wanting to lead human nature into a descent. Especially in middle European esotericism, the I is presented altogether as the middle point, as what is actually active and at work within the human being. The human being is like a flowing together of forces, forces that flow together in the astral body, etheric body, and physical body; and the I is presented as what is at work on these three members. In Germanic mythology this is portrayed by the tree, the world-ash, the symbol for threefold human nature. The middle point for this threefold human nature is the I; through its incorporation in the three members it carries the entire tree of human growth

and evolution. “Ygg” is the ancient form for growth and evolution. You will find that in the ancient forms of speech as a characterization for what has been incorporated, the world-ash is called “Yggdrasil.” Yggdrasil means, “the carrying I”; and the name of the god who is connected with the formation of the I is also derived from it. In the course of evolution the human being first learned how to inhale; in Hebrew that is connected with the word “Jehovah.” In old High German that corresponds to Odin, who is a god of the wind and races around in storms. “Jach” (Jahweh) is the “blower,” and when we speak of Wotan, and his army that rushes here and there, then we are speaking of the Odem, who was necessary for the growth of the I. In Christian esotericism a very special value is placed on this word altogether. It is seen as the name for the eternal in the human being and is, therefore, portrayed as what carries the other bodies, as what forms their middle point. Consider only this passage: “... and he shall rule them with a rod of iron, as when earthen pots are broken in pieces, even as I myself have received power from my Father; and I will give him the morning star.” (Rev. 2:27,28) This I means the same thing as the actual name of Christ Jesus. Here, in almost every sentence, the word I appears again to tell us that it is the eternal in the human being. You will find this meaning expressed again and again by the words in the Apocalypse.

Now that we have seen what Theosophy has to say concerning the historical evolution of humanity, we will consider what the Apocalypse can tell us about it.

To understand this we must go beyond our culture back to the Greco-Latin cultural epoch, the fourth in our great post-Atlantean epoch. In spiritual science we calculate it to have begun in the eighth or ninth century of the pre-Christian age. Further back in the past we arrive at the Egypto-Chaldean cultural epoch, then the most ancient Persian age, concerning which the historical research of our day knows only the last faint echoes. Then we go further back to the primal holy age of the ancient Indian culture. In this way we finally arrive back at the time of the great Atlantean culture which is reported to us by all ancient religious writings. Before the great Atlantean water catastrophe, between Europe and America there existed the ancient Atlantean continent. That is where the precursors of humanity lived, those whom we call the Atlanteans.

We want to consider now the spiritual life of the Atlanteans; for, of course, the same souls who are present today lived there, but they were equipped with other soul abilities or states of consciousness that are of interest now to the spiritual researcher.

During the fullest blossoming of the Atlantean culture, we find the modern human being's capacity for perception present only in its first rudiments. The ancient Atlanteans did not see external objects as we do today, with sharply defined contours; they saw them rather surrounded by an aura. When they fell asleep at night, the external picture disappeared for them but they were conscious in the spiritual world. They had a dim form of clairvoyance. But they did not have any of what we today call counting and computation, the power of judgment or logical thinking. They had none of the mental abilities that our present-day culture has created; for example, they did not know about the power hidden in coal. Instead, they had magical abilities with which they could awaken the powers hidden in plant seeds and then put these powers in their service. In this way they possessed clairvoyant and magical powers. Those people in Atlantis best able to make use of their magical powers were the best technicians and engineers. What our present-day scholars and natural scientists represent, we can compare to the people most highly gifted with powers of clairvoyance in Atlantean times.

There were great mystery centers at that time. Our present-day mystery and occult schools work much more secretly than theirs did. The mystery centers of Atlantean times were generally known as both school and church. Piety and wisdom were cultivated at the same time. The leaders of that time can be

called the great teachers of the mysteries. They taught in these Atlantean oracles of which there were seven. Students who had become sufficiently mature were initiated into the mastery of magical powers and into a conscious vision of the spiritual world. Unlike our culture, which is limited to the three lower kingdoms, Atlantean wisdom stretched over the physical earth and beyond to spiritual realities. Present-day science limits itself to the three kingdoms that do not go beyond the earth. However, through clairvoyant development, the Atlantean initiate also achieved a vision and experience of higher spiritual beings that work beyond the earth, even up to the region of the stars.

During those times there were mystery centers that were especially concerned with the various planets in our solar system and the spiritual powers standing behind them. For this reason there were Mars, Venus, Sun, Jupiter, Mercury, Saturn, and Moon oracles. However, the greatest and loftiest was the ancient sun oracle. The initiates of this sun oracle could survey all the other oracles and watch over them. The great sun initiate of the sun oracle stood at the top; he saw prophetically the water catastrophe of Atlantis. Therefore, he had the task of seeing to it that the culture was guided through and beyond the catastrophe.

Now those human beings who had possessed the best talent for clairvoyance were of no use at all for the post-Atlantean cultures. These new cultures required the selection of people who had nothing left of the ancient magic. Like a sunrise over the great post-Atlantean culture, they developed the individual spiritual capacities of thinking and judgment in their first primitive forms. The simplest people were precisely those best suited for the future.

They were led by the great sun initiate to a colony near present-day Ireland; later they were led to the middle of Asia. Those were the people whose consciousness was already then closest to our present-day consciousness. Furthermore, for the sake of this advanced population copies of etheric bodies of the greatest initiates of the Atlantean oracle were incorporated into those individuals who came from the various oracles with the best aptitude for present-day culture. This was necessary for the future.

It is a law of spiritual economy that what has once been achieved for humankind is not lost. If we were to survey the various oracles we would find everywhere what is achieved through occult training; the etheric body is transformed and organized through and through by the I. The etheric body of ordinary people who have not undergone this transformation dissolves at death into the world ether. However, with the highest initiate something different happens. An etheric body transformed in this way is preserved for the blessing and healing of humankind. The great sun initiate preserved the etheric bodies of the seven great Atlantean initiates as spiritual treasure and took them along to Asia. These were then imprinted into seven of the very best individuals so that they grew up endowed with the etheric bodies of the greatest initiates of ancient Atlantis. Through many generations the great sun initiate exercised his educational skills on the health and spiritual discipline of the people so that he developed, so to speak, the very best human material.

These seven individuals were in external life simple people; they had their I and their astral body for themselves, but in certain states of consciousness their speaking was inspired by higher powers. They were then sent by the great sun initiate down to ancient India, to those still longing to return to the true primal home of humanity and who characterized everything external as maya or illusion. That was the chorus of the seven holy Rishis. What this chorus harmonized together as a spiritual symphony was the primal wisdom of the pre-Vedantic age. We are looking into an age much more ancient than the Vedas. What is written in the Vedas is nothing more than an echo; it reaches us only in broken rays through the wisdom of the holy Rishis.

Now we come to the ancient Persian culture. In place of the seven Indian teachers came the first Zarathustra. He was himself an initiated student of the great sun initiate, who stood behind the Rishis. Because of this he could proclaim the great teaching concerning the spiritual being of the sun, concerning Ahura Mazdao. We see here how the great teachers of humanity guided the evolution of human development in wisdom.

From the beginning the ancient Indians were protected from falling into materialism. Their longing for clairvoyance, for the spiritual, for the feeling of connectedness with God was still too great. The Persians, on the other hand, were farmers and fighters. Therefore, in order not to fall into materialism, they had to receive the teaching concerning the great Ahura Mazdao, the spirit of the sun, the highest being.

Zarathustra initiated one of his students in such a way that he brought the student's astral body to a higher stage of development. With another student he developed the etheric body to the highest stage of clairvoyant consciousness so that the student became able to read the Akashic chronicle by means of this etheric body which is, of course, always the vehicle for our memory.

Now, the first of these two students was reborn as Hermes, the great impulse giver for the Egyptian culture; his astral body was especially well developed. When he was reborn as the Egyptian Hermes, he bore within himself the astral body of the great Zarathustra and was therefore able to work with the intentions of Zarathustra.

The other student also became one of the most important personalities of post-Atlantean culture when he was born again as Moses. That is why Moses already as a child had to be brought to the point where his etheric body and I could be wholly influenced by Zarathustra's etheric body. For this reason he had to be placed in a basket deep in the water at a tender age;1 this is a symbol for his calling. And so he became the great Akashic visionary who could write down the pictures he perceived in the Akashic chronicle. These are the majestic images found in Genesis. In these ways events of the past are led over into the future—behind the scenes of the physical, external development of humankind.

Zarathustra was also able to become the greatest teacher of the fourth post-Atlantean cultural epoch. Living in the Near East in the sixth century before Christ's birth he was known as Zarathos or Nazarathos. He was the teacher of the most important Greek teachers and initiates—Pythagoras, for example, was his student.

These four post-Atlantean cultures were inspired by the great sun oracle of ancient Atlantis, and the culture of the ancient Hebrew nation continued to develop uninterupted on a parallel course—a subgroup of this Hebrew nation always living contemporaneously with one of the named cultural epochs. The ancient Indian culture was initiated in the secrets of the spiritual world and the planetary states; the ancient Hebrew ... [gap in the manuscript.] Then, living contemporaneously with the Persian culture of Zarathustra, the Hebrew ancestors developed a teaching much like that in Persia concerning Ormuzd and Ahriman, a teaching concerning good and evil. The third, the Egypto-Chaldean culture, then followed. The exodus out of Egypt under Moses' leadership took place at the same time. Then the Greco-Latin culture developed during the time of the great Hebrew initiate-prophets, Elijah, Jeremiah, and so forth. Already in primal ancient times these prophets had been given the idea of the great being, Ahura Mazdao, announced to them by Melchizedek. In this way, the same nuances were at work simultaneously in the Hebrew culture as in the other nations through the epochs.

Now, such cultures always had their second blossoming. That of Hermes soon encountered a decline. It had contained deep mysteries for the ancient Egyptian culture but had fallen in the worst way and entered into the most terrible decadence as black magic. The ancient Indian culture had fallen into decadence the least.

So we see how all that had appeared successively was still maintained in the ancient Hebrew nation. In various groups they preserved the feeling and the states of consciousness of various other cultures. These groups could be addressed with the names of the ancient cultures, according to how their states of consciousness had been maintained.

When the writer of the Apocalypse speaks of the “community at Ephesus” he means the representative of the first, the Indian culture; the Persian finds its representative in the “community at Smyrna”; the Egypto-Chaldean in the name of the “community at Pergamon”; and finally, the fourth, the Greco-Latin culture in the “community of Thyatira.” He was able to address the representatives of the four ancient cultural epochs in concurrently existing groups.

Then he looked further into the future and saw our cultural blossoming in the “community at Sardes.” The “community” following ours—for which we are consciously preparing through the theosophical movement—he characterizes with the name “Philadelphia.” After that, humanity will finally reach the “community at Laodicea,” where new impulses can no longer be brought forward. When we work and act in the fifth epoch as conscious representatives of the theosophical spiritual life we are introducing the age of Philadelphia or brotherhood.

The seven spirits of God, the seven stars, are what we find in theosophical teachings concerning the evolution of the earth through the planetary states. These teachings should lead us up to an understanding of the secrets of the stars and their spirits. In this way we enter consciously the community of Philadelphia when we absorb the teachings of spiritual science.

Let us look back again to the first epoch of our culture, to the holy Rishis who pointed to the Vishva Karman, whom, as clairvoyants, they saw by means of the etheric bodies of the Atlantean initiates they carried within them. The writer of the Apocalypse directed his spiritual gaze toward him and saw how he holds the seven star oracles, through the seven Rishis, in his hand. These holy, simple men wanted to awaken the spiritual senses of humanity by saying to human beings that the world surrounding them is just maya or illusion. Only the spirit standing behind the surrounding world could be called truth. The seven holy Rishis pointed to this spirit. Human beings had to descend into physical life; but in order to preserve them from a descent into matter that would be too deep. they first had to absorb the teaching concerning maya or illusion. The souls that are now living in our bodies have also lived in Indian bodies, and at that time learned to see matter as an illusion. But all around there were the souls of many human beings who were locked in the fetters of matter. For those souls incarnated again today it means that they are theoretical materialists. Among materialists those are the least harmful, for their materialistic thoughts will be driven out of them in the future when the earth will become devastated and only the soul will remain alive, the soul that they no longer believe in today. What is even worse is practical materialism. But this form of materialism was even more dangerous in ancient times because the memory of magic powers was still present; then this materialism always led to the practice of black magic. Therefore, at that time this materialism always signified the fall into the decadence of black magic. The writer of the Apocalypse always spoke of these people as Nicolaitans who have lost the first, the glorious love of the spirit. Therefore, when he wanted to praise he said that the Nicolaitans were hated.

We find the least amount of black magic in the ancient Indian culture. We find the greatest misuse in Egypt because the lofty teachings of Hermes went over into the art of black magic. Balaam is intended as a black magician. The writer of the Apocalypse directs his admonishment to the community in Pergamon in the verse: “But I have a few things against you: you have some there who hold the teachings of Balaam.” (Rev. 2:14) Common immorality is not meant here but rather the development of the powers in matter, black magic.

In the occult schools of the first age after Christ the Apocalypse was a favored book. The ancient mysteries founded the primal wisdom, the wisdom of the Atlanteans. The Christian mysteries, on the other hand, strive to direct their view to the future. They did this not only in order to know but also in order to stimulate their wills so that, with this spiritual treasure, humanity could pass through increasingly higher incarnations.

In the seven letters to the churches found in the Apocalypse we find a portrayal of the great main epoch of the seven post-Atlantean ages, from the mighty Atlantean water catastrophe to the event that is called the war of all against all.

We will now consider some important passages from the letters in order to show the compass of John's overview. He came from a cultural era when much was still taken for granted, much that, today, could appear to ordinary consciousness as forced.

The leading power behind these cultural epochs is presented with the seven stars in his hand. Looking at the cultural epoch that saw the outer world as maya or illusion, we find there the chorus of seven holy Rishis, who point to Vishva Karman. The writer of the Apocalypse sees him as the being who has the wisdom of the seven stars in his hand. Above all the writer of the Apocalypse must look into the future. Because he is speaking to the descendants of the Atlantean cultural epoch he refers to what lives in their memories. So he calls the Nicolaitans the representatives of black magic, who are excluded from the community that preserved the “first love.” Therefore, he says of those who have continued to keep themselves from becoming entangled in matter, that they will develop into the future. Those who hear this admonishment will easily find their way back into the spiritual world.

Then he speaks to the people of the second cultural epoch, the age of Zarathustra. He speaks to the followers of the great Zarathustra who have recorded their wisdom in the teachings of Hermes, who have preserved for us an echo of Zarathustra's teaching. Indications are given everywhere in these writings that people should not develop a love for dreamy wandering, that they should get to like life in the physical, sensible world. They are to see the sun as the expression of a being, the spirit of the sun, and they should look upon the stars as the bodies of the spirits who populate space. For this reason it was the concern of Zarathustra to show the physical-material world as the expression of the spirit. In this way the cultivation of the earth's fields should be like a cultivation of the physical body of God, who stands behind the physical world. The ancient Hebrew nation that existed parallel to the ancient Persian culture also looked up to this God. They also had a religious service to Zarathustra, which is indicated in Abraham's encounter with Melchizedek.

From this we see that remnants of the second cultural epoch remained. We know how mightily the great Zarathustra admonished the people to work with the earth but not to become slaves of matter. The power that wants to mislead people into thinking there is nothing but physical matter he calls Ahriman, the ahrimanic power. The danger arises through Ahriman that the human being may come to like physical life too much.

In the ancient Hebrew wisdom, Ahriman was given a name made up of two parts: Mephiz-Tophel, Mephistopheles. This is he who called to Faust, who believed in the spirit and went to the “Mothers,” that is, entered the spiritual world: “You are coming to nothing!” Like Faust, those who are seeking the spirit call back to the materialists: “In your nothing I know how to find all.” So the writer of the Apocalypse had to say: “Have no fear ... Some of you Tophel will weave into the prison of matter.” (Rev. 2:10) These are the ones who have become too wrapped up in matter.

We know that human beings must descend into various incarnations on the earth where they live their lives in physical, sensible bodies. Every life on earth is followed by a life in the spiritual world. One day this ring of reincarnations will be closed. The profound meaning of these reincarnations, if we understand well the second letter of the Apocalypse, is this: human beings should struggle through to a consciousness of self, to their I consciousness.

The soul saw the world so very differently in the ancient Indian epoch, and how much has the soul seen since then in other incarnations! Today we perceive in a way entirely different from earlier incarnations. As the soul ascends from stage to stage we acquire the concept of history. A thinking human being must say: There is a history of life in the spiritual world. Because in elementary theosophical teaching we cannot describe the life between death and a new birth in more detail we usually describe the life in devachan and kamaloca only in general terms. But it is different during each of the various cultural epochs; for souls always have something different to experience. We can describe this history only in separate characteristic features.

Let us look back to ancient Atlantis; human beings were still in their soul and spiritual home during life on earth. During the ancient Indian age human beings were still in the spiritual world at night and after they passed through the gate of death. In this original home it became light and bright around them. To the extent that people came increasingly to like this physical world, to that extent they lost their vision into the spiritual world; it became darker and darker for them.

During the Egyptian culture human beings already stood so firmly in the physical world that they had to be taught to live in such a way that they could find Osiris in the other world. Only in this way could the students still feel the light between death and a new birth. The teaching of The Book of the Dead and the “judges of the dead” should be understood in this way: Only by uniting with the Light of Osiris, the Osiris impulse, could human beings hope that the spiritual world would be filled with light and brightness for them.

Let us now look at the Greco-Latin age when people had become so fond of physical matter that they created physical forms incorporating ideals in the physical world. That is why a human being of that time could say, “Rather a beggar on earth than a king in the kingdom of shadows.”2 It is not merely a legend that people went into darkness when they descended into Hades. Humankind is in danger of losing itself in the world of the senses. That is why God had to descend into this sense perceptible world, this sense existence, and save it.

Zarathustra proclaimed Ahura Mazdao through the veil of the sensible-sensual world. Yahweh was proclaimed to Moses in the burning bush through the veil of the sensible-sensual world. Then the same power proclaimed himself as Christ in the body of Jesus of Nazareth. What then occurred had significance not only for the physical world but also for the spiritual world.

In the same moment when the blood flowed from the wounds of the redeemer, Christ appeared in the underworld to the souls who stood between death and a new birth. Below in the realm of matter the

blood is flowing and while it is flowing, the kingdom of the dead begins to become brighter and brighter. To the extent that our culture now begins to climb upward to a spiritual understanding of the fact of Golgotha, the brightness grows.

History is everywhere, in the physical and in the spiritual. The whole of our post-Atlantean cultural evolution has as its meaning the goal of leading humanity through the physical world while, at the same time, keeping awake faith in the spirit. It is always the same principle that manifests in the successive cultural epochs.

The writer of the Apocalypse turns his clairvoyant vision to the fact that these are people who are becoming one with matter, who are using up the spiritual forces they possess like an old inheritance without joining company with Christ. Such people would gradually lose devachan; kamaloca would last longer and longer and they would be captured, united with the gravity of earth.

Today only black magicians do this; ordinary human beings cannot yet close themselves off from all wisdom. The writer of the Apocalypse, however, must place everything in perspective in order to point out that the impulse of Christ is what saves human beings. For this reason the second letter says that it would be the "second death"—the "spiritual death" as Paul refers to it. The admonishment had to come in the second letter because this letter refers to the second cultural epoch. In the first post-Atlantean epoch this admonishment did not need to be directed to humankind.

In the second letter the leading spirit characterizes himself as "the alpha and the omega." (Rev. 1:8) In all of occultism there are certain symbols that dominate and always mean the same thing. In ancient Egyptian times value was placed on the formation of wisdom through the word; wisdom appeared then for the first time in rigorously delineated words. The Indian world did not yet place any value on knowledge; the culture of Zarathustra just as little. For this reason the divine power of the word in the mouths of human beings is everywhere signified by the "sword." Everywhere we find the sword employed as a symbol of the humanization of divine power. "And to the angel of the community in Pergamon wrote: 'The words of him who has the sharp two-edged sword.'" (Rev. 2:12) But through knowledge the human being can also most be misled into black magic.

In the Bible human beings experience the power of God that flows to them as "manna." Let us now consider the full character of this age. Yahweh reveals himself in the burning bush on Sinai. "Then Yahweh spoke to Moses: 'I am the I am.' And he spoke: 'You should say to the sons of Israel: 'The I am has sent me to you!'" (Exodus 3:13) With these words the people were told: The I am has sent me to you! Yahweh is the unpronounceable name of God. The name "I" can never be spoken to a human being from outside. It is the intimate name of God that human beings are only permitted to receive, sanctified in their hearts. It was written on the altar of the tabernacle. Therefore, we read: "To him who overcomes I will give some of the hidden manna and I will give him a white stone with a new name written on the white stone ... (Rev. 2:17) Those who received the I learned through an inner power of the spirit to recognize the name with the hidden manna. Through the fact that Christ revealed himself in a physical body on the earth, human beings are to learn not to disdain the earth like the ascetics, but to recognize that this earth has something to give them. And so, the thirst for existence should not be extinguished but we should purify our desires. The westerner should say: "Here work is done; here hands are in motion and what is achieved here is taken through the gate of death." It is not our intention to tell of miracles but, through legends, to come to realize what humanity has been given as wisdom.

We hear that Buddha had an important pupil, Cassapa. He was the one whose task it was to spread the teaching of Buddha. We are told in a legend that Cassapa did not die but disappeared into a cave. There

his physical body is being preserved until the day when the Maitreya Buddha appears. Then the mortal remains of Cassapa will be touched by the fire of heaven and dissolved.

Let us think our way into this teaching. How will there be people in the future who can understand the teaching of the Maitreya Buddha? Through the fact that the redeemer himself carried his own mortal remains to heaven after three and a half days. That means that those human beings who unite themselves with the impulse of Christ will take what they have achieved as the fruit of their lives with them and carry it into the spiritual world.

We will see how, by means of the connection with the principle of Christ, all the fruits of earthly existence can be carried into the spiritual world. The teachings of the Orient have always proclaimed the future coming of the Christ, even in their legends. Because we are to learn in the fourth post-Atlantean epoch how the earthly-physical element directly goes over into the spiritual world, this is presented to us with the phrase “he has eyes like a flame of fire” (Rev. 1:14) and we are told: “His feet were like burnished bronze, refined as in a furnace.—(Rev. 1:15) Later we read, “And all the communities shall know that I am he who searches mind and heart ...” (Rev. 2:23) Here we are told that Christ is the one who brings the “I am.” This inconspicuous little word must merely be read. The meaning is that the principle behind the “I am” will become the savior who leads us out of the material world. Word for word, line for line the text can be explained in this way.
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John writes by divine commission, under divine inspiration, to the angels of the seven churches. Thus, as he writes, he fully identifies himself as the one who is to give the angels of the seven churches counsel, admonition, a mission, and so on. How exactly should we create a mental image of this? Who must one have been referring to, for example, when speaking of the angel of the church in Ephesus, or Sardis, or Philadelphia? Who must one have been referring to? As incomprehensible as this may be to people today, back then there were certainly people whom we would today call educated—people with a Christian education, as we would say of those in a similar position today— there was certainly a core group of people back then who understood what this meant: A prophetic being, a seer like John, is writing; and because he is in this state of mind as he writes, he stands higher than the angels; he is writing to the angels of the churches. But even among those who understood this, the use of the word “angels” did not imply anything supernatural. The mental image was this: Christian churches have been founded and continue to exist; and the writer of the Apocalypse is mindful that he is addressing his letters to future times, in which what he has to say about these churches will come to pass. He is by no means speaking of present conditions. He is speaking of future conditions. But if those who, at that time, had to interpret—based on the traditional view derived from the ancient mysteries—who the intended recipient of the letter was, they would have identified him as the bishop presiding over the church.

On the one hand, they were quite aware that the true leader of the church is the supernatural Angelos; on the other hand, they would have referred to the bishop, the canonical administrator of the church. For it was the mental image at that time that someone who was the administrator of a congregation such as those in Sardis, Ephesus, or Philadelphia, as a dignitary, was the true earthly bearer of the supernatural Angelos being. Thus, in fact, John, as he writes, feels inwardly embraced by a higher being than the Angelos. He writes to the bishops of the seven churches as people who are imbued not only with their own angel—which everyone has—but who are imbued with the guiding, leading angel of the church.

And now he speaks of what he has to say to these churches, and he clearly points to the future. We must ask the question: Why are seven letters addressed to seven churches? These seven churches are, of course, representative of the various forms of paganism and Judaism from which Christ emerged. In those days, there was a much deeper understanding of concrete realities than there was later. In the era from which the Book of Revelation originates, people knew quite precisely, of course: there is, for example, the church in Ephesus, which once gave birth to the truly magnificent Mysteries of Ephesus, in which—as was quite common in ancient times—reference was made to the future appearance of Christ. There was a cult in Ephesus intended to mediate a connection between those offering sacrifices in Ephesus and the witnesses to the sacrificial rite, on the one hand, and the divine-spiritual powers—as well as the coming Christ—on the other. The ancient pagan community of Ephesus was likely the one that, through its prophetic foreshadowing of future Christianity and its pagan cult, stood particularly close to that Christianity.

That is why the letter to the angel of the church in Ephesus mentions the seven lampstands. The lampstands are, in fact, the churches themselves; this is explicitly stated in the Book of Revelation. The letter to the church in Ephesus, in particular, must be taken at face value, exactly as it is written. It is clearly pointed out that this church in Ephesus was, in fact, the one that embraced Christianity most fervently, the one that was devoted to Christianity with its first love; for it is said that it did not retain this first love. The author of Revelation wishes to speak in his letter about the future that lies ahead. Thus, even from the example of this letter of admonition to the church in Ephesus, we see that the apocalyptic writer characterizes the church's development in such a way that the church's focus is on what has been passed down from ancient times.

It was indeed the case that the individual communities referred to here represented different nuances of paganism or Judaism, that they had different cults, and that through these various cults they approached the divine worlds in different ways. And every letter always begins in such a way that one can see how, in each of these congregations, Christianity developed in a unique way out of the old pagan rituals.

One must simply be aware that in the early days of Christian development, people still possessed a state of mind that was truly quite different from today's state of mind, particularly that of Europe—in the East, of course, this is not the case. This view of the religious as a conceptual content that can be logically characterized was still very, very foreign—truly very foreign—to the ancient mystery concepts of the first Christian centuries. People used to say, for example: Christ is a manifestation of the mighty solar being. But the church in Ephesus, the church in Sardis, the church in Thyatira, and so on—each in its own way, based on its own worship—must strive toward him. Each can approach him in its own uniquely nuanced way. And the fact that this is fully acknowledged is, after all, implied throughout.

Take, for example, a church like that of Ephesus, which had to carry on the ancient, profound mysteries of Ephesus; it had to be different from, say, the church of Sardis. The church in Ephesus had a form of worship that was deeply permeated by the presence of divine-spiritual substances in earthly life. The priest who walked among the people in Ephesus could just as well have called himself a god as a human being. He knew himself to be the bearer of the god. The entire religious consciousness in Ephesus is actually rooted in theophany—the manifestation of the divine in human beings. The priesthood of Ephesus represented the respective god, and it was even a specific task to truly instill this theophanic aspect—this bringing forth of the divine—into people's souls.

Let us assume that, among the priestesses of Ephesus, the one who essentially embodied Artemis, Diana, the moon goddess, went about performing the ritual acts. The people were required not to

distinguish the earthly manifestation from the goddess herself—that is, to see the goddess in this earthly, human form. Ancient mystery rituals—public processions, for example—depicted people walking in single file who were the gods. And just as we must learn today to form adequate concepts of things, so too did people in those days have to train themselves to perceive and feel the divine in the person who was a priest or priestess.

It is therefore no wonder that, since the apocalyptic writer—as I have indicated—speaks in the language of the mysteries, he addresses the church in Ephesus specifically, where this particular way of thinking, feeling, and perceiving was most intensely developed. It was therefore natural for the church in Ephesus to see the most essential symbol of the cult in the seven lamps. These represented the light that lives on earth but is divine light.

Yesterday we referred to the seven churches, and we focused on the church in Ephesus from one particular perspective. The world is truly rich in perspectives, and many perspectives can come into play when considering one and the same thing. We can characterize the church in Ephesus as we did yesterday, and we will then see how Christianity developed within this one church out of pagan premises. But we can also point out how these impulses truly contained much of what constituted the fundamental structure of the early post-Atlantean era—more so than was the case in India during the later period. Thus, in what developed as Christianity in Ephesus, one can, in a certain sense, see the Christian continuation of the worldview and outlook on life of the early post-Atlantean era, whereas in the church of Smyrna—which is mentioned second in the Book of Revelation—the primordial Persian culture was initially lived out, which then transitioned into Christianity.

Pergamon, in turn, is cited as the community in which the third post-Atlantean culture flourished. When we allow the Epistle to the Church in Pergamon to sink in, we find that it refers, more or less explicitly, to the Word of Hermes, which was alive within that culture.

Then, in the letter to the church in Thyatira, we are referred to the culture we call the fourth post-Atlantean culture—that is, the one into which the Mystery of Golgotha itself falls. As we allow this significant epistle to take effect within us, we are reminded throughout just how directly the message of the Mystery of Golgotha truly worked.
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**Chapter 3.**

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(Rev. iii. 1): “And unto the Angel of the Church in Sardis write.” (We must feel that we ourselves are spoken to here.) “These things saith he that hath the seven Spirits of God, and the seven stars.” What are the seven Spirits and the seven stars? In accordance with the concept of the writer of the Apocalypse, man as we know him is an outer expression of the seven human principles we have enumerated. These are the principle of the physical body, of which the external physical body is the expression, the principle of the life body whose expression is the etheric body, the principle of the astral body. This last when transformed yields Spirit Self, the transformed etheric body, Life Spirit, and the transformed physical body, Spirit Man; in the centre is the “I”-principle. These are the seven spiritual constituents in which the divine nature of man is displayed as in the members of a leader. According to the technical expression used in occultism these seven principles are called the seven Spirits of God in man. And the seven stars are those from which we understand what man is to-day and what he is to become in the future. The consecutive stars of the incarnations of the earth, Saturn, Sun, Moon, Earth, Jupiter, Venus and Vulcan, are the seven stars which make the evolution of man

comprehensible. Saturn gave to man the plan for his physical body, the Sun that of his etheric body, the Moon that of his astral body, and the Earth has given him the “I” or Ego. The next three—Jupiter, Venus and Vulcan—develop the spiritual being of man. If we understand the call of the spirit who has these seven stars and the seven Spirits of God, the sevenfold nature of man in his hand, then we shall be studying Anthroposophy in the sense of the writer of the Apocalypse. To study Anthroposophy is to know that the writer is here referring to the fifth age of human evolution in the post-Atlantean epoch, to know that in our age, when man has descended most deeply into matter, we are again to ascend to spiritual life by following the great individuality who gives for our guidance the seven Spirits of God and the seven stars, in order that we may rightly proceed on our path.

And if we follow this path we shall bring into the sixth age the true spiritual life of wisdom and of love. The spiritual wisdom we have acquired will become the impulse of love in the sixth age, which is represented by the community expressing itself even in its name, the community of brotherly love, or Philadelphia. All these names are carefully chosen. Man will develop his “I” to the necessary height, so that he will become independent and in freedom show love towards all other beings in the sixth age, which is represented by the community at Philadelphia. In this way the spiritual life of the sixth age will be prepared. We shall then have found the individual “I” within us in a higher degree, so that no external power can any longer play upon us if we do not wish it; so that we can close and no one without our will can open, and if we open no opposing power can close. These are the Keys of David. For this reason he who inspires the letter says that he has the key of David: And to the Angel of the community in Philadelphia write: These things saith he that is holy, he that is true, he that hath the key of David, he that openeth, and no man shutteth; and shutteth and no man openeth. ... Behold, I have set before thee an open door, and no man can shut it” (Rev. iii. 7)—the “I” that has found itself within itself.

n the seventh age those who have found this spiritual life will flock around the great Leader; it will unite them around this great Leader. They will already belong so far to the spiritual life that they will be distinguished from those who have fallen away, who are lukewarm, “neither cold nor hot.” The little flock which has found spirituality will understand him who may then say, when he makes himself known, “I am he who contains in himself the true final Being towards which everything is steering.” For this final Being is described by the word, Amen. “And unto the Angel of the church of Laodicea write: Thus saith the Amen, he who in his being presents the nature of the end” (Rev. Iii. 14).

So we see that in the Apocalypse of John is presented the contents of an initiation. Even the first stage of this initiation, where we see the inner progress of the seven post-Atlantean ages, where we still see the spirit of the physical plane, shows us that we are dealing with an initiation of the Will. For this book can inspire our will at the present time when we know that we ought to listen to the inspirers who teach us, when we learn to under-stand what the seven stars and the seven Spirits of God signify, when we learn that we ought to carry the spiritual knowledge into the future.

In the last lecture we showed how the Apocalypse of John prophetically points to the cycle of human evolution lying between the great upheaval upon our earth which the legends of various peoples describe as a flood, and geology the glacial period on the one hand, and that event which we designate as the War of All against All on the other. In the epoch between these two events lies everything prophetically referred to in the Apocalypse—that book which reveals to us the beings of past ages in order to show what is to fire our will and our impulses for the future. We have also seen how we ourselves, in the spiritual movement to which we belong, should consider the words of the so-called fifth letter as a summons to action, to work. We have seen that we ought to follow that Being with the seven Spirits of God and the seven stars. Then we saw how, through this spiritual movement, the next

age is prepared which is represented by the community of Philadelphia, the age when—among all those who have under-stood the word of the summons—there is to be that brotherly love over the whole earth which is described in the Gospel of John. Afterwards another age, the seventh, will follow, which the writer of the Apocalypse describes by saying that on the one hand there is placed all that is bad in the community representing the seventh age, that is lukewarm, neither hot nor cold, that could not warm to the spiritual life and hence must fall away, and on the other hand those who have understood the word of invitation, those who will form his following who says, “I am the Amen,” that is: I am he who unites in himself the goal of the human being, who contains the Christ principle in himself.

Now let us keep for a later occasion all that could be added in further explanation of the several letters and in justification of the several names of the cities. To-day we shall pass on in our studies to that which presents itself to the pupil when he advances to the next stage of initiation. We were confronted by the seven sub-ages of the present cycle of humanity, and we have said that this entire cycle with its seven sub-ages is itself a small cycle contained in a longer period also containing seven epochs. Our epoch, which embraces seven ages, was preceded by the Atlantean epoch, during which were prepared the races whose echoes still exist. When the seventh age of our present epoch is at an end,it will be followed by another epoch again consisting of seven parts. The present epoch is preparing indirectly for the following one, so that we may say, our age of civilization will gradually pass over into one of brotherly love, when a comparatively small part of humanity will have understood the spiritual life and will have prepared the spirit and attitude of brotherly love. That civilization will then again divide off a smaller portion of human beings who will survive the event which will have such a destructive effect upon our epoch, namely, the War of All against All. In this universal destructive element there will be everywhere individuals who lift themselves above the rest of warring humanity, individuals who have understood the spiritual life and who will form the foundation for a new and different world in the sixth epoch.

Let us suppose some one wished to sleep through the Christian development. He would then live into the future until after the great War of All against All, but he would have nothing of the great love-principle of Christ which brings the Egos together, which makes communities of individuals. He would have everything which leads the Egos into the abyss. He would have the separating forces. This brings us to a consideration which may give rise to the question: Why does the unveiling of the first four seals provide such a comfortless picture? Because here come forth the men who wish to remain in these four preparatory civilizations in which is contained the old form of Lucifer that drives men asunder. Hence in the unveiling of the seals we are shown, too, how they got the form which they have acquired. They have slept through the event of Christ Jesus and are re-born in the forms which can be given them without the influence of the Christ-principle. Hence there appears again that which indicated the mere intelligence, the mere intellect; the horse appears four consecutive times. The old form of man appears which he obtains by receiving into himself the horse nature. This form appears at the opening of the seals.

And when the fifth seal is opened what is then brought to our notice? Those who in the preceding period have learned to understand the event of Christ Jesus! These are clothed in white garments, they have been passed by, figuratively they have been slain, they are those who are preserved for the spiritualization of the world. Thus it is the union with the Christ-principle which brings it about that men have these white garments and appear when the fifth seal is opened. Here we see a clear indication that the time when Christ appears is an important epoch for mankind; it is the epoch which brings it to pass that after the War of All against All the four ages will appear when those who have remained behind are tormented by the materiality which had proceeded with evolution and to which they have chained themselves; they are tormented by all the evils and torments of the coarsened, hardened

materiality. Everything which is now described in the breaking of the seals represents nothing else than the descent into the abyss. While in the fifth seal we are only briefly directed to those who are chosen, we are shown for the rest those who remain in materiality, who go down into the abyss, who assume the forms which existed previously because they did not progress, because they have not acquired the power to transform these shapes.

You may form a picture of it; imagine that your human forms were to-day made of India rubber; and within this rubber human body is your inner soul power which gives this rubber body its human form. Imagine that we take out the soul-force, then the rubber body would collapse. Men would receive animal forms. At the moment when you draw the soul out of this human body of rubber, man would manifest the animal form. What man has gained for himself is like something which he produces to-day by his own power. If you could observe what he formerly produced in the astral body you would see its likeness to the animal. It is really an inner force such as this which gives the rubber man the present form. Imagine that this power is removed, imagine man not fertilized by the Christ power; he springs back into the animal form. Thus it will happen to those who fall back. They will afterwards form a world beneath the present world, so to speak, a world of the abyss, where man will again have assumed animal shape.

Thus we learn to understand the direction evolution will actually take. That which is now prepared will come out again bit by bit in the future, just as that which was laid down in the Atlantean epoch has come out bit by bit in our epoch. I have said that in the last third of the Atlantean epoch a small colony was formed from which our civilizations have been derived, and from which the two following will also originate. It will be somewhat different in [the transition to] the next epoch which will succeed all these. There will not be a colony limited to one place, but from the general body of humanity will everywhere be recruited those who are mature enough to form the good, the noble, the beautiful side of the next civilization, after the War of All against All. This again is a progress as compared with the earlier Atlantean epoch when the colony developed in one small place, but with us there is the possibility that from all races of the world will be recruited those who really understand the call of the earth mission, who raise up Christ within themselves, who develop the principle of brotherly love over the whole earth; and indeed, in the true sense, not in the sense of the Christian confessions, but in the sense of the true esoteric Christianity which can proceed from every civilization. Those who understand this Christ-principle will be there in the period following the great War of All against All. After our present purely intellectual civilization, which is now developing in the direction of the abyss of intellect—and you will find that this is the case in every field of life—there will come a time when man will be the slave of the intelligence, the slave of the personality in which he will sink. To-day there is only one way of preserving the personality, and that is to spiritualize it. Those who develop the spiritual life will belong to the small band of the sealed from all nations and races, who will appear in white garments after the War of All against All.

We are now beginning to comprehend the spiritual world from our immediately present intellectual civilization. It is the aim of true Anthroposophy, from out of the present intellectual standards, to comprehend the spiritual world, and to gather together those who can understand the call to spiritualize the world. These will not form a separate colony but will be gathered from every nation and will gradually pass into the sixth age, that is to say, not yet beyond the great War, but primarily into the sixth age, for necessities still exist which are connected with old race ties. In our epoch, races and civilizations are still inter-mingled. The true idea of race has lost its meaning but it still plays a certain part. It is quite impossible at present for every mission to be carried out equally by every people. Certain nations are predestined to carry out a particular mission.

The nations which to-day are the vehicles of Western civilization were chosen to lead the fifth age to its zenith; they were the nations who were to develop the intellect. Hence wherever this civilization extends we have predominantly the civilization of the intellect, which is still not yet finished. This intelligence will spread still further, people will exercise still more of their spiritual forces in order to satisfy their bodily needs; to slay one another they will employ much greater spiritual forces before the great War of All against All. Many discoveries will be made in order to be able the better to carry on war, an endless amount of intelligence will be exercised in order to satisfy the lower impulses. But in the midst of it something is being prepared, with which certain nations of the East, the Northern part of the East, are gifted. Certain nations are preparing to emerge from a certain dullness and bring in a spiritual impulse with mighty force, an impulse which will be the opposite pole to intelligence. Before the sixth age of civilization, represented by the Community of Philadelphia, we shall experience something like a mighty marriage of peoples, a marriage between intelligence and intellect and spirituality. At the present time we are only experiencing the dawn of this marriage and no one should understand what is here said as a song of praise to our age; for one does not sing songs of praise to the sun when there are only the first signs of dawn. But we find remarkable phenomena when we compare East and West, when we look into the depths and foundations of the different nations.

This is only mentioned as a symptom of the future age when the spirituality of the East will unite with the intellectuality of the West. From this union will proceed the age of Philadelphia. All those will participate in this marriage who take into themselves the impulse of Christ Jesus and they will form the great brotherhood which will survive the great War, which will experience enmity and persecution, but will provide the foundation for the good race. After this great War has brought out the animal nature in those who have remained in the old forms, the good race will arise, and this race will carry over into the future that which is to be the spiritually elevated culture of that future epoch. We shall also have the experience that in our epoch, between the great Atlantean flood and the great War of All against All, in the age represented by the community at Philadelphia, a colony is being formed, the members of which will not emigrate but will be everywhere; so that everywhere there will be some who are working in the sense of the community of Philadelphia, in the sense of the binding together of humanity, in the sense of the Christ-principle.

Now if we understand what was said at the close of our last lecture, that after our present civilization will follow that which is characterized in our last lecture through the community of Philadelphia, we must particularly notice that from the sixth age will be taken those human souls who have to pass over into the following epoch. For, after the War of All against All—as we have already said—there will be expressed in the features all that is in our age being prepared in men's souls. The so-called seventh age will be of very little importance. We are now living in the fifth age of civilization; then follows the sixth, from which will proceed a number of people full of understanding for the spiritual world, filled with the spirit of brotherly love, which results from spiritual knowledge. The ripest fruit of our present civilization will appear in the sixth age. And that which follows it will be what is lukewarm, neither warm nor cold; the seventh age is something like an overripe fruit, which outlasts the War of All against All, but contains no principle of progress.

This was the case also when our culture originated. Let as think of the time before the Atlantean flood. We have said that it was in the last third of the Atlantean epoch—which men experienced on the land now covered by the Atlantic Ocean—when a small group was formed in the neighbourhood of the present Ireland, which had reached the highest stage of Atlantean civilization, and this group then migrated to the East, whence all later civilizations have proceeded. Let us keep this clearly in mind, let us think of this portion of the earth which now forms the ocean west of Ireland, let us think of a migration of people starting from there and going towards the East and from it a number of tribes

proceeding, which then populate Europe. All that is contained in the population of Europe originated in this way. The most gifted portion of the Atlanteans wandered towards central Asia; from there proceeded the various civilizations up to our own, as we have described. So we see that our present civilization originated in a small group of Atlanteans.

Atlantis, however, had seven consecutive stages just as our own civilization has seven stages which we know as the ancient Indian, ancient Persian, Assyrian-Babylonian-Chaldean-Egyptian-Jewish, the Graeco-Latin, our own and two further ones. It was in the fifth stage when this emigration began; so that the specially chosen population of Atlantis which lies at the foundation of our culture is taken from the fifth Atlantean race, for in Atlantis we may speak of races. A sixth and a seventh followed. These were, so to speak the lukewarm races. They also survived the great flood but there was no living sprouting force in them. They were related to the fifth Atlanteans civilization somewhat as the bark which is lignified and hardened is related to the sappy stem. These two races which followed the actual root-race were incapable of developing, they were overripe, so to speak.

You may still see stragglers of these old overripe races to-day, especially among the Chinese. This Chinese people is characterized by the fact that it has not identified itself with what was manifested in the fifth race, the root-race. It was when the etheric body entered into the physical body that man received the first germs which enabled him to say “I.” They had passed over that period; they had, however, thereby developed the high civilization which is known to-day but which was not capable of development. The fifth Atlantean race sent its people every-where, and they founded new civilizations, civilizations capable of growing and becoming more perfect. Indeed, this all developed from the ancient Indian civilization to our own. The sixth and seventh races of Atlantis allowed themselves to become hardened and therefore became stationary. As we have said, the Chinese civilization is a remainder of that ancient civilization. The old Chinese possessed a wonderful Atlantean heritage but they could not progress any further. Nothing remains uninfluenced from outside. You may examine ancient Chinese literature; it has been influenced from every direction, but its fundamental tendency bears the Atlantean character. This self-completeness, this capacity of making discoveries and going no further, could never bring the Chinese beyond a certain stage—all this proceeds from the character of Atlantis.

Just as it happened at that time with the fifth race, that it provided men who were capable of development and with the sixth and seventh, that they experienced a descent, so will it also be in our epoch. We are now looking with great longing towards the sixth civilization, to that which must be described as developing out of the spiritual marriage between West and East. The sixth stage will be the foundation for the new civilizations which will arise after the great War of All against All; just as our civilization arose after the Atlantean epoch. On the other hand, the seventh race of culture will be characterized by the lukewarm. This seventh age will continue into the new epoch, just as the sixth and seventh races of the Atlantean epoch continued into our epoch as races hardened and stiffening. After the War of All against All, there will be two streams in humanity: on the one hand the stream of Philadelphia will survive with the principle of progress, of inner freedom, of brotherly love, a small group drawn from every tribe and nation; and on the other hand the great mass of all those who are lukewarm, the remains of those who are now becoming lukewarm (Laodicea). After the great War of All against All, gradually the evil stream will be led over to good by the good race, by the good stream. This will be one of the principal tasks after the great War of All against All; to rescue what can be rescued from those who after the great war will only have the impulse to fight one another and to allow the “I” to express itself in the most external egoism. Such things are always provided for in advance in the spiritual guidance of humanity.
GA104

GA104a
The contents of the fifth letter (Rev. 3:1–6) are especially important for us. We read there that we have received the secret of the name through the teaching concerning the development of the earth, which is given to us by the “masters of wisdom and the harmony of feeling.”

I will cite only a very special passage. The sixth letter must be addressed to a community where budhi is especially cultivated. What does that mean? If manas is especially cultivated, and if the human being has become a knower, then what we previously knew will pass over into our living feelings; it becomes for us a natural, given, feeling. It becomes a passion for us. If you realize that justice should prevail, that justice should live, if you realize that humankind cannot live without the beautiful and the good, then you are on the way to develop budhi. If higher things have become your second nature, if your soul is fully permeated with enthusiasm for the beautiful and the true, then you are on the path to budhi. Budhi takes its substance from the realm of feelings; and atma from the realm of the will. And when humankind finally reaches the point where it has made enthusiasm for the good into a reality, then what is called the Christian ideal of brotherhood will have appeared. This sixth territory can receive its name only from the ideal of brotherhood, and “Philadelphia” is the city of brotherly love. If you read the relevant passage you will see the city described this way: “I know your works. Behold, I set before you an open door, which no one is able to shut; I know that you have but little power, and yet you have kept my word and have not denied my name.” (Rev. 3:8) They did not deny the name that comes from fraternal duty.

The seventh letter is taken from the realm of atma, the atma or breath of the human being. When we have come as far as the physical breath we take in, when the I has worked down into the physical body —perhaps you know that in Christian esotericism this is designated by the word “amen”—then the esotericist, when speaking of this, will refer to the “amen,” and to the Angel of the Church (community) in Laodicea write: “The words of the amen, the faithful and true witness, the beginning of God's creation.” (Rev. 3:14)

I have been able to select only some of the passages. If we could discuss everything, then you would see that we have messages for regions in our own time in these seven letters.
GA104a

GA346
The situation was quite different with the church in Sardis. This church was the Christian continuation of an ancient, highly sophisticated astrological observatory, where people truly understood how the movements of the stars were connected to earthly affairs, and where they interpreted everything that happened on earth—including the commands of both high and low authorities—from the stars. The church in Sardis had evolved from a mystery cult that relied to the highest degree on the exploration of the mysteries and life forces of existence as revealed by the night sky. Before one could speak of the church in Sardis as a Christian church, one had to speak of it precisely as the one that clung most firmly to the old, dreamlike state of clairvoyance, for it was precisely to this dreamlike clairvoyance that the nocturnal mystery of the macrocosm revealed itself. And where this ancient, dreamlike clairvoyance—preserved as tradition—was clung to, little attention was paid to what the day brings.

In this regard, the difference between the sun cult and the teachings about the sun in Ephesus and Sardis is truly very telling, insofar as one can indeed speak of ancient wisdom traditions in both Ephesus and Sardis. After all, in all these ancient mysteries—and the teachings of the mysteries were passed on to the laity—what was taught was what constituted science at that time, for there was no

science separate from the mysteries. In Ephesus, the doctrine of the Sun was such that a distinction was already made between, on the one hand, the five planets, which were believed to be: Saturn, Jupiter, Mars, Venus, Mercury, and, on the other hand, the Sun and the Moon. The Sun—which we today call a fixed star in contrast to the planets—was distinguished by separating it from the planets and venerating it as the day star—especially in Ephesus—because people saw in the Sun, from its rising to its setting, the life-giving principle.

That was not the case in ancient times in Sardis. In Sardis, people paid no attention to the daytime sun; they took its light for granted. But in the city of Sardis, it was not the daytime sun that mattered—only the night sun, which in the ancient mysteries was called the "midnight sun" and was regarded as equivalent to the planets. The moon was not distinguished from the other planets, and the sun was regarded as a planet truly equal to the others.

In Sardis, they listed them as follows: Saturn, Jupiter, Mars, Venus, Mercury, the Sun, the Moon. - That is not how it would have been done in Ephesus. In Ephesus, the order was: Saturn, Jupiter, Venus, Mercury on one side, and on the other side, the gods of day and night—the Sun and the Moon—who are closely associated with earthly life. — That, then, is the major difference, and all religious practices in Sardis were based on it.

In fact, during this early Christian period, the old pagan cult persisted in Ephesus—one that was oriented solely toward Christianity—while in Sardis, the aspect of the old pagan cult oriented toward astrology persisted, as I have just described. Therefore, it is only natural that the author of the Book of Revelation writes of Sardis: "He who has the seven spirits of God and the seven stars" (Rev. 3:1). Now it is not the lampstands standing on the altar, nor the light connected to the earth, but rather the light that stands above in the macrocosm.

You can see just how deeply the author of the Book of Revelation is still rooted in the ancient mystery traditions by answering this question: What does the author of the Book of Revelation reproach the church in Sardis for, and what should it pay particular attention to? First and foremost, he reproaches the church in Sardis for failing to stay vigilant and for failing to find the path to the sun of the day, the source of Christ.

And then there is the church in Sardis, which we discussed yesterday. I showed you how this church in Sardis was, in a certain sense, astrologically oriented—how it was oriented toward the service of the stars. But with this, the church in Sardis—as is certainly inevitable from a historical perspective—carries much of the past within it; yet above all, this very church carries the future within it. And now let us try to incorporate this into our spiritual view of the present. We are living in the fifth post-Atlantean epoch. When we look at what was part of Sardis's past, there is also something embryonic there that had not yet been fully realized at the time John wrote the Apocalypse. The entire tone of this fifth epistle is already different from that of the four preceding ones. In his letter to the church in Sardis, John points toward the future. The future to which he referred back then—which was, in a sense, embodied in Sardis in an embryonic form—is our time; it is the time in which we ourselves live.

This is where the priesthood must begin today. The priesthood must begin by regaining the ability to direct the gaze of the soul toward the heart of another human being. Very few people are capable of doing that today. Human beings remain terribly unknown to one another today. You see, when one reads the passage in the Book of Revelation—with a certain reverence, for one cannot read the Book of Revelation without reverence—about the white robes (Rev. 3:4–5) with which those who have fulfilled the task of the fifth cultural epoch must be clothed, one gets the impression: The point here is to look

deeply into this particular state of human consciousness through the priestly gaze, to get to know, so to speak, the human being as he now stands before us in the fifth post-Atlantean epoch. This is the admonition: to get to know the human being—not by the clothes he wears, not by what he represents in the outer world, but to get to know him by the garments of his soul. Through this letter to the church in Sardis, the author of the Apocalypse addresses this admonition directly to our present time.

It is true that when we read up to this letter to the church in Sardis in the Book of Revelation, we feel that what is written there is a direct call to the present. And as we continue reading, we can gain an even deeper understanding.

Just think about the following for a moment. Consider that the fifth post-Atlantean epoch is coming to an end. During this epoch, human beings will transform their consciousness in such a way that they will see through the workings, the activity, and the work of death itself. They will learn to see through it, but they will not see through it in such a way that the age they can reach stands before their soul at every moment. He will see the workings of death in themselves. He will constantly have death as a companion around him. Of course, he will have it around him, but what must be newly created in the various spheres of life is that human beings will need to possess a spiritual substance that makes this "having death standing beside them" appear to them as something natural. To have awakened within oneself the powers of eternal soul-vigil means being able to have death by one's side as a good friend and constant companion.

When you look out at your surroundings, you still see them today entirely in the light of the fourth post-Atlantean epoch. You see, in essence, life that carries death within it—in every plant, in every stone—but you do not see death because you do not yet see it within yourselves. But people will begin to see death more and more. So we will have to speak more and more to the people of the present, for as one sees death more and more, one's entire way of seeing is transformed.

Yes, to see death is to see many things that are completely hidden behind appearances today. In a certain sense, we see nature today as very stable because we do not look into certain subtle intimacies of nature at all. We walk through the countryside and see, for example, signs that read: "There is foot-and-mouth disease in this area."—In reality, something has happened at a deeper level in such a place, which can be viewed as comparable to what a storm-tossed sea or a volcanic eruption represents. And this is what will come to meet humanity in the sixth post-Atlantean epoch.

Because human beings do not yet perceive death, they see today only when, for example, Vesuvius erupts or when powerful earthquakes are detected by seismographs; but they do not perceive that tension in the etheric realm which manifests itself, for example, when a significant genius lives or is born in a particular region. Nor do people perceive those mighty powers and weaving of spirits, of which the stars and their configurations are merely the outward expression.

The fifth letter is unsealed: a horse no longer appears; there is no longer any mention of the horse. What is at stake is hinted at in an entirely different way. As we continue reading the letters, we find that they point in this way to a fundamental transformation that is taking place right now, in our own era.

And one cannot help but say: We must prepare ourselves to become the new, transformed church of Sardis. This new, transformed community of Sardis will have to understand that, after all, it is a trivial matter to know plants, animals, and stones, and that one truly knows all of this only when one finds the stars at work in every stone and every plant. Spiritually, too, the stars must fall from the heavens. One can already perceive this.

Now, Spiritual Science teaches us that a large number of plants are, in their flowering and in the release of their fragrance, nothing more than olfactory organs—true plant olfactory organs of immense subtlety. And what do they smell? They smell the scent of the world, which is always present. And the scent of the world emanating from Venus is different from that emanating from Mars or Saturn. For example, the scent of violets is the olfactory echo of what the violet perceives as the scent of the world. Such fragrant plants perceive from the scent of the world that which comes from Venus, Mercury, or Mars. Asafoetida, Ferula asa-foetida, perceives the scent of Saturn and reproduces it.

One has to explain to people—because they demand it—how, in a sense, the stars are falling. For what, after all, are the beings of the world other than what the stars bestow? If one speaks about these things in accordance with reality, one must say: The stars are indeed already falling, for they are inside the plants. Not only is the scent within them, but the plants themselves are true olfactory organs.

Now I had to explain that, while the scents of plants do indeed come from the planets, the colors of plants come from the power of the sun. I elaborated on this further using examples that illustrate the point. But one person was not satisfied and said, “You’ve overlooked why stones have colors, too.” “I understand,” he said, “why plants have colors, and that a plant growing in a basement, where the sun doesn’t reach, does indeed have form and fragrance, but because the sun doesn’t penetrate the basement walls, the plants remain pale, even to the point of being colorless. But what about stones?”

Now I had to explain: There is the sun’s daily course, the Earth’s rotation in 24 hours, and the annual cycle that brings about the seasons, causing the sun to rise to its zenith and set. But there is something else as well. Now I had to explain the Platonic cosmic year, I had to explain that the Sun’s spring vernal equinox—which it now has in Pisces—used to be in Aries, and before that in Taurus, in Gemini, and so on, and that over the course of 25,920 years it completes a full cycle through the entire zodiac with this constellation, meaning there is a daily cycle, an annual cycle, and a cosmic annual cycle of the Sun. And while the Sun’s annual cycle gives plants their colors, stones require the Sun’s world-year cycle to acquire their colors. In the colors of the stones—in the green of the emerald, the wine-yellow of the topaz, and the red of the corundum—lies the power that develops through the Sun’s passage through the Platonic world year.

You see, once you start talking about the world from a spiritual perspective, people begin to ask questions about earthly matters in such a way that they are no longer satisfied when you explain these earthly matters to them using the trivialities of our laboratories and dissection rooms. They want to truly understand, and then feel very satisfied to grasp the matter in the “Sardis” way, by drawing on the stars and their influence. After all, what else are we doing here but what the writer of the Apocalypse does: we are placing Sardis in the present.
GA346

**Chapter 4.**

GA008
The initiate experiences now in the Spirit what is to happen in the future. “And immediately I was withdrawn into the realm of Spirit. And I beheld a throne in heaven, and one seated on the throne. And he who sat there appeared like the jasper and carnelian stone; and a rainbow surrounded the throne that looked like an emerald.” In this way the primal source of the material world is described in the pictures in which it clothes itself for the seer. “And in the sphere around the throne were twenty-four thrones,

and seated upon the twenty-four thrones were twenty-four elders, clothed in white flowing garments, and with golden crowns upon their heads." (chapter 4, verses 1, 2)—Beings far advanced upon the path of wisdom thus surround the primal source of existence, to gaze on its infinite essence and to bear testimony to it. "And in the midst of the throne, and around the throne, were four living creatures, full of eyes in front and behind. And the first living creature was like a lion, and the second like a bull, the third looked like a human being, and the fourth was like a flying eagle. And each of the four living creatures had six wings, full of eyes all round and within, and day and night they never cease to proclaim: Holy, holy, holy, the God, the Almighty, who was, and is, and is to be." It is not difficult to perceive that the four beasts represent the supersensible life underlying the forms of life presented by the material world. Afterward, when the trumpets sound, they raise their voices, that is, when the life expressed in material forms has been transmuted into spiritual life.
GA008

GA104
That was approximately the condition at the beginning of the earth's evolution. This was first a kind of repetition of the Saturn condition and then of the Sun condition and then of the Moon condition. Now the most important thing for us to realize is that man really only becomes man in the present sense in the middle of the Earth evolution. In the Earth period also we have to distinguish seven conditions. We are now in the fourth. Three have gone before and three will follow. It was in the fourth principal cycle that our present human race was to become man. Now, just as in all the Rounds upon Saturn, Sun and Moon, certain beings reached the human stage (upon Saturn the Asuras or Original Forces, upon the Sun the Archangels, and upon the Moon the Angels), there were always beings who remained behind. Upon the Moon there were also beings who could no longer reach the human stage, backward Angels, shall we say, who could only catch up their human stage upon the Earth planet during the first three Rounds. Man reached this stage at the fourth. We therefore say: Before man three other kinds of beings passed through the human stage upon the earth, and the fourth to pass through the human stage upon the earth is man himself. At that moment in cosmic evolution when man is about to become man, all the beings who have been able to pass through the human stage, throughout Saturn, Sun, Moon and the first three Rounds of the Earth, are beings who have more or less progressed beyond man. But they are all able to look back, as it were, and remember the stage at which they themselves passed through the human stage. They could look down upon the evolving human being and say, "He is now becoming something which we have already been, something which we can understand; although we passed through the stage under different circumstances." For this reason they could guide and regulate his evolution from the spiritual world.

Let us enumerate how many of these beings there are who are able to look back at the human stage, who are able to under-stand evolving man. Seven from the Saturn evolution, plus seven from the Sun, plus seven from the Moon stage, plus three from the Earth; twenty-four beings in all. Twenty-four "Men" look down upon the present man. These are the beings whom for good reasons we have called the guides of evolution, the directors of time. Time is connected with evolution. They are the twenty-four Elders who meet us in the Apocalypse of John. They are the same beings who are described in the part relating to the secret of the seven seals. They are described as the real directors of history, the true Alpha and Omega. Thus we have also found the twenty-four Elders again here and you see how the Apocalyptist who wrote this important document has secreted in his pictures in a wonderful way what we ourselves are able to find from the study of the spiritual evolution of the world.

Now certain beings had remained behind at every stage; so that the backward Saturn beings came out upon the Sun as the first foundations of the present animal kingdom, and the backward Sun beings came out at the Moon stage as the first foundations of the present plant kingdom. Only upon the Earth

did a stage of evolution appear as the mineral kingdom. We have stressed the fact that upon the Moon there was as yet no mineral kingdom, man had as yet no rocks to walk upon. At the time when present man began to pass through the human stage, the first mineral masses, the first crystals appeared in the planet which then stood at a stage between the substances of the ancient Moon and the present earthly substance. This was the moment when the mineral kingdom burst forth, and you find this bursting forth described in a very unique manner in the Apocalypse of John where he says: “Around the throne it was crystallized like a glassy sea.” This “glassy sea” is to indicate the bursting forth, the budding forth of the mineral kingdom in its primary form. Thus we see that this secret of cosmic evolution is also indicated in the Apocalypse of John. And from it we have also learnt to perceive that to this degree the writer wishes to present to us in his mighty pictures exactly what we are able to recognize in the development of the earth from the spirit life itself. But in this way the Apocalyptist has led us, at the beginning of his book, to the heights where man can see the pictures of the future stages of evolution.
GA104

GA104a
The book portrays a real initiation, an ascent, to begin with, through learning on the physical plane. This step is portrayed in the words concerning the seven letters to the seven communities. The seven letters present what must first be learned. Then a number of pictures lead us to the astral plane. We see groups of beings undergoing transformation in the astral light: “... and he who sat there appeared like jasper and carnelian, and, round the throne was a rainbow that looked like an emerald.” (Rev. 4:3) “And before the throne there is as it were a sea of glass, like crystal.” (Rev. 4:6) The quality and being of the astral light is indicated by the transparency. In the astral light we can see through objects; they appear like glass. The entire astral world is like a glass sea.

The four living creatures then follow; they are to represent the human group souls. They were full of eyes within and without and had no peace day or night. There is constant movement in the astral world —astral eyes are everywhere and everything is transparent to them, both within and all around.

We see how, at first, the mysteries of the physical plane are described and then, out of the sealed book, the astral imaginations. They approach us in pictures.

After the seer has perceived the spiritual beings in the astral light for awhile, they begin to sound forth. This is described in the resounding of the trumpets when the sixth seal is opened. That is the condition of devachan. The seer becomes “clairaudient,” able to hear spiritual sounds—the spiritual ear is opened.

The stage then follows when the seer expands his consciousness over the entire earth. This is indicated in the swallowing of the book. It expresses the ascent into the higher regions of the spiritual worlds.

We determine time according to the movement of the heavenly bodies. Was the method for calculating time always the same as today's? Important things have changed. If we look into the past a little we see the Atlantean culture before the great flood on earth. The Lemurian age preceded it. If we go even further back into the past the earth, sun, and moon are still united in a single body. Back then time had to he determined differently than today. Day and night were entirely different. In Lemuria, conditions for the whole earth were the same as it is today at the north pole, half a year day and half a year night. When sun, moon, and earth were still one this unified mass moved through space. Already back then this movement was calculated by occult wisdom, just as today one calculates time according to the sun which moves across the sky through the signs of the zodiac. Eight hundred years before Christ the sun stood in the sign of Aries. Christ was originally worshiped under the sign of the cross, with a lamb

lying at the foot of the cross. The cross with Christ upon it appeared only in the sixth century. Before that the Bull, Taurus, was worshiped when the sun stood in its sign. Earlier, it was the Twin, Gemini, that was worshiped in Persia. The team of goats that pulled Thor's chariot had the same significance. Before that the Crab, Cancer, was worshiped, and so forth.

Before the Lemurian age the sun, moon, and earth, united in one body, moved forward in terms of the zodiac. Time was measured following this movement. For this reason, the twelve signs of the zodiac are characterized as the heavenly clock and drawn as such.



A planet alternates between pralaya, a cosmic night, and manvantara, a cosmic day, just as we alternately pass through day and night. The planet passes through the signs of the zodiac during both pralaya and manvantara; for that reason the twelve signs of the zodiac are counted twice, just as we also count two times twelve to equal twenty-four hours. The hours symbolize the signs of the zodiac. The united sun, moon, and earth also moved through the cosmic days and nights according to the heavenly clock. Then their separation occurred. But at that time human beings were not the same as we are now. The soul only gradually descended, and only gradually did the human being develop from the generic into a specific individual being. If one had taken together the generic souls of human beings during the Lemurian and Atlantean times, then one would have perceived something very strange. The aura of the human being is constantly changing; like all astral beings it is in constant motion. The generic souls were reflected in the forms of animals, for example, in sphinxes and so forth. The ancient Atlantean and Lemurian generic souls were constantly changing but they expressed themselves again and again in a fourfold way. The fourfold nature of human generic souls is characterized by the four living creatures of the Apocalypse: lion, bull, eagle, and Man. The lower human being is portrayed through these four living creatures, and the lamb symbolized the perfected human being—that is, the fifth living creature.

wice twelve heavenly constellations and four living creatures were once the regents of the world. Mighty cosmic powers ensouled the signs of the zodiac and the four living creatures. The twenty-four elders in the Apocalypse are the two times twelve stars on the world clock who were once rulers. The evolution of the human being can be portrayed in this drawing:



The lowest point designates clear day-consciousness. In pre-Lemurian times the human being had a dull clairvoyance. At that time human beings were closer to God than today. Then they acquired day consciousness. Human beings will take that consciousness with them in the course of their further evolution when they again approach God and become clairvoyant. Every point on the descending line corresponds to a point on the ascending line. If we could live backward we would see all the things that we will see in the future in a different, clairvoyant way. In the future we will again see the twelve spirits of the planets, and the sun, moon, and earth will once again be united, “... and the sun became black as sackcloth, the full moon became like blood ...” and so forth. (Rev. 6:12)

When the soul first descended from the womb of God it found a human animal on earth. These human animals looked grotesque; they needed to be transformed, overcome. In the future, there will also be such an animal to overcome. That is what the beast with the two horns would say to us.

Only someone who explains the Apocalypse within its entire context can understand it properly. The Apocalypse is a cosmic explanation of the world. The author was an initiate. He spoke of universal laws that apply to the world from the beginning to the decline, from the alpha to the omega.

We should allow the holy symbols given in the Apocalypse to work upon us. The sign of the Sun intelligence, for example, should not remain a mere sign for us; we should immerse ourselves in this sign until we feel it is no longer dead but flowing with life. The signs should be for us doors connecting the physical to the spiritual world. Then we have fulfilled our duty: to connect the physical and the spiritual worlds.

We find in early Atlantean times that human beings over wide, wide geographical regions were very similar in appearance. They broke down into groups of striking similarity. In the middle of the Atlantean age humankind still fell into four main groups. In the first stages of Atlantean development the members of the individual groups still resembled one another in a very pronounced way: only the groups were sharply distinguished. The clairvoyant today can see very little of what constituted the physical body at that time. It was still completely made up of a very soft material, much like certain fish in the ocean today that can barely be distinguished from the rest of the water. The air then was entirely permeated by the watery element and the human physical body was still very difficult to distinguish from the watery element surrounding it. However, the bones and nervous system were also already present as forces at that time. The human being only became a real earthly human being through a process of hardening.

If we wish to characterize the various human beings, borrowing, as it were, present-day images, then we can consider first those who had developed and condensed their physical nature the most. The occultist refers to them as the bull people. The people whose etheric body was developed the most, the aggressive people, the powerful ones, were called the lion people. A third group had an astral body that strongly ruled over the other members; that is the group referred to as actual human beings. Then there were the people who could be called the eagles, who had already developed a strong I. In this way they ruled over the others. We can speak of these four group souls, and a clairvoyant perceives them by looking back into those ancient times.

These four groups of people were characterized by whatever aspect had been most formed in them on the earth below. The bull people at that time had developed their digestive system the most; the lion people their heart and blood circulation ... [gap in the manuscript]. The clairvoyant can see four such group souls. That is what appears with initiation in the astral world. What then presents itself to the clairvoyant can be compared approximately with what those four animals are today. One who sees the evolution of humankind today with the view of an occultist sees this picture of the four human groups symbolized in these four animals.

The war of all against all will be an expression of the egotism that is always growing stronger, the egotism conjured forth by humanity today as the I is and will always become, stronger and stronger. That will be the end of the last post-Atlantean culture. This catastrophe will also have its mission, its usefulness in the ascent of the entire human race. However, the great war of all against all will be something much worse than war of the present-day with weapons. It will be a war of souls, of souls who no longer understand one another, a war of the classes. This future catastrophe is difficult for present-day consciousness to understand.

The Atlanteans were magicians. As we today use the powers asleep in coal, so the Atlantean used the forces in plant seeds. The forces in the seeds served them in their technology, in their industry.

There is a mysterious connection between these forces. As long as the Atlanteans used the seed forces properly, they were in harmony with the working of the forces of the air and water. However, from the middle of the Atlantean age onward, the Atlantean magicians increasingly approached their moral fall;

and in the mysteries of the black occult schools these magical forces were misused in a terrible way. They were placed in the service of the most horrible egotism. In this way the powers of air and water were increasingly excited which finally had to result in the mighty Atlantean water catastrophe. Today, those who know the secret of the use of these forces know full well that the use of such forces in our time means that powers of black magic are at work. Magic must never be made to serve when selfish purposes are involved. Hence, the employment of seed forces is not permitted today even to serve white magic. On the other hand, in Lemurian times the seed forces of the animals were used. But everywhere that the growth forces of animals are misused, horrendous forces of fire, the vulcanic element, are awakened.

Today these things are not so obvious. Today the feeling for one's self, the overwhelming egohood of people has brought about the drying up, the desolation of those regions of the earth that have developed this egotism to the greatest extent. It is absolutely true that this war of all against all is being prepared on the surface of the earth because a connection exists between the egotistical withering of the soul's forces and the paralyzation of the earth's productive powers. The Nordic myth of the Twilight of the Gods also tells us this.

We must understand the difference between the evolution of souls and the evolution of bodies. From epoch to epoch human souls find themselves again and again in different bodies. These souls will one day see the strife that will reign among the human souls who will be born in the last post-Atlantean age. This experience will be a lesson for them and will help to free them from egotism. Then they will be able to grow into an era where they will have the fruits of selfhood but without its disadvantages. An age will come with clairvoyant conditions similar to those prevailing in ancient Atlantis, but with this difference: human beings will have a free consciousness of self. We will then have learned, in these seven cultures of the post-Atlantean age, what can be achieved in the physical world. This self-perception or consciousness of self can only awaken in a physical body; but the human being must again subjugate the physical body. After the war of all against all, we will have achieved a stage of evolution where we live in a bodily nature in such a way that we are no longer slaves of our physical bodies.

The impulse for this development comes from the Christ principle. Christ even falls right in the middle between the age of the Atlantean catastrophe and the war of all against all. On the one hand we can thank the descent into matter for our consciousness of self within our physical bodily nature. On the other hand, we thank the Christ event for our ability to ascend with the achievements of the physical world. We thank the Christ principle for our ability to ascend to universal brotherly love, to the universal love of humanity, since we will again unite in groups with love for one another.

If we look back to the time of the original group souls of Atlantis and then into the future we see these four group souls appearing again. The lamb will stand in the middle as a sign for the love that will unite people who will then be living in a bodily nature that is less dense.
GA104a

GA346
The underlying mental image here is clear: if people want to share their tasks in the world, there must be twelve of them. They form a whole; they represent the twelve nuances. When people face the world as communities or congregations, this results in the number seven. People knew these things back then.

The author of the Apocalypse still writes from this supernatural understanding of numbers, and this is how he speaks throughout the rest of the Apocalypse. Today I want to focus first and foremost on

reading the Apocalypse. John draws our attention to one of the visions in which he sees the throne of Christ, the throne of the transfigured Son of Man, around which 24 elders are seated (Rev. 4:4). Here we have a nuance related to the number twenty-four. What does this nuance related to the number twenty-four mean?

Communities are subdivided into seven, while incarnate human beings on the physical Earth are subdivided into twelve. However, when it comes to viewing human beings as representatives of human evolution in the supersensible realm, we arrive at a different number. After all, there have been leaders of humanity who, from epoch to epoch, were tasked with revealing what humanity needed to receive—revelations that are simply inscribed in the world ether, also known as the Akashic Records. If we consider the successive great revelators of evolving humanity, we can see how what each individual revelator had to offer is inscribed in the supersensible realm.

In fact, one should not seek out such an individual as Moses, for example, merely as he was on Earth—nor merely as he is described in the biblical texts, for these are already recorded in the Akashic Records. One should seek out Moses as he sits on the throne of Christ. That which is eternal in his earthly existence—the enduring aspect sub specie aeternitatis—is firmly embedded in the world ether. However, there can only be twenty-four such human manifestations chosen for eternity, for with the twenty-fifth, a repetition of a previous one would occur. This was known in ancient times.

If people on Earth are to work together, there must be twelve of them. If human communities are to work together, there must be seven; the eighth would be a repetition of one of the seven. But if, sub specie aeternitatis, those who have become spiritualized in the course of human evolution—those who represent a stage of human development—are to work together, there must be twenty-four. These are the 24 Elders.

If we now consider these 24 elders—some of whose revelations are already here, while others are yet to come—we find them gathered around the throne of Christ as the synthesis, as the summation of all human revelations. But before this throne of Christ we have humanity itself, which is now understood as a human being in contrast to what stands as a part, as an individual stage of the human. I would like to say: Humanity in and of itself—as it must be understood—is depicted in the image of the four living creatures.

A magnificent image stands before us. The transfigured Son of Man in the center; on the throne, the individual stages of humanity through the succession of ages, represented by the 24 rulers of the 24 hours of the great world day; and, spread out over all of this beneath the image of the four living creatures, humanity itself, which must encompass all these individual stages. Something important and essential confronts us here.

What, then, is happening before the watchful gaze of the apocalyptic writer, who conveys God’s message to the angels of their congregations and thereby to all of humanity? What is happening there? When the four living creatures spring into action—that is, when humanity discovers its relationship to the Divine—the 24 rulers of the 24 hours of the great world-day fall prostrate before them. There they worship that which is higher—the whole human being—as opposed to what they themselves represent: a stage in human development. In the ancients, one truly saw this image, which the apocalyptic writer then presents to humanity. Except that in those earliest times, it was said: “The One who sits on the throne will come”—and the apocalyptic writer has to say: “The One who sits on the throne has already been here.”

Now, my dear friends, I would like to draw your attention to something I discussed over there in a completely different context—in the course on linguistics. There I had to explain how it is possible to experience sound, but also how humanity has, in fact, lost this experience of sound today. You need only create in your mental image how elements of the formative and essential Word are present in sound, and how, through the experience of these sounds, the most diverse—indeed, the most wondrous—content of the world can be shaped through the combination of some 32 sound elements. Imagine yourself in such a time—and there were indeed times when this was still a reality for humanity—imagine yourself in a time that lived quite vividly within these elements of sound and felt quite vividly the wonder that lies in being able to shape a world out of the experience of these 32 sound elements. One truly sensed, in the shaping of language and in the artistic formation of the word, the weaving of a spiritual reality that one witnesses while speaking. One experienced that gods dwell within the sounds.

If you take these 32 sounds, you'll easily be able to calculate that about 24 of them correspond to consonants and about seven to vowels—of course, these figures are always approximate— and you can now, in the spirit of the opening of the Gospel of John—"In the beginning was the Word"—shed light on that image, which can indeed also be understood as an apocalyptic one: The Alpha and the Omega are surrounded by the seven angels—the vowels—and by the 24 elders—the consonants. And so it was also felt that the mystery of the universe was wholly woven into and lived out—with the meaning I have already expounded—in what was intoned in the sacred language of the cult. And in the celebration of the cult, one felt the powerful presence of that which, in this symbolic image, represented the essence of the universe.
GA346

**Chapter 5.**

GA008
In the right hand of him who sits on the throne is the scroll in which the path to the highest wisdom is marked out (chapter 5, verse 1). Only one is worthy to open the scroll. "Behold the Lion of the Tribe of Judah, the Root of David, has conquered, so that he can open the scroll and its seven seals." The scroll has seven seals.c9 The wisdom of man is sevenfold. That it is designated as being sevenfold is again connected with the sacred character of the number seven. The mystical wisdom of Plato designates as seals the eternal cosmic thoughts which come to expression in things.69 Human wisdom seeks for these creative thoughts. But only the scroll which is sealed with them, contains the divine truth. The fundamental thoughts of creation must first be unveiled, the seals must be opened, before what is in the scroll can be revealed. Jesus, the Lion, has power to open the seals. He has given a direction to the great creative thoughts which, through them, leads to wisdom. The Lamb who was strangled and sacrificed his blood for God; Jesus, who bore Christ in himself and who thus, in the highest sense, passed through the Mystery of life and death, opens the scroll (chapter 5, verses 9–10).
GA008

GA096
You know that the Sun once separated from the Earth, but that in the distant future it will reunite with the Earth. The being that enables human beings to spiritualize themselves to such an extent that they can reunite with the Sun is referred to in occultism as the Intelligence of the Sun. This benevolent Sun Spirit is opposed by an evil one, the Demonic Principle of the Sun. Both forces are at work not only in the Sun, but they also send their effects down to Earth. The forces of the benevolent solar spirit enter plants, animals, and human beings; they give rise to life on Earth. The opposing principle of the solar demon—the force that stands in the way of the Earth's union with the Sun—is at work in the evil forces within human beings.

Since ancient times, there have been occult symbols for this. A heptagonal symbol represents the benevolent spirit of the sun. The seven corners symbolically represent the seven planets. The pentagram is the symbol of humanity. The occultist draws the stars in the form of seven eyes within the figure [of the septagram]. Encircled by a line, all the forces are intertwined. They bind everything together. This is also represented by occultists in the days of the week. If you follow this line, you will find the names of the days of the week in the direction of the line.



In ancient times, time could not yet be measured externally by the sun's rotation around the Earth. The ancient occultists conceived of specific rulers for the sun's orbit, and they were correct in doing so. The entire system revolves, and thus time was determined according to the cycle through the twelve signs of the zodiac: Aries, Taurus, Gemini, Cancer, Leo, Virgo, Libra, and so on. Now you know that in the evolution of a world system, a cycle is called a Manvantara, that each is followed by a Pralaya as a state of rest, and that such states alternate like day and night. Therefore, the day has twelve hours and the night has twelve hours. These twelve hours correspond to the great periods of the world day, which are governed by the ancient rulers of the zodiacal cycle. I would have to draw twenty-four Lords of the Cycle around this symbol. If I were to draw that for you, you would have the septagram here. You would then have here the seven eyes, which signify the seven stars, and the twenty-four ancient rulers —twelve for the day and twelve for the night.

The benevolent sun spirit is also called the Lamb. We have already spoken of the pentagram as a symbol of the human being. The black magician uses the pentagram so that the two "horns" point upward and the one—the tip—points downward. Upon completion of this development, the good ones have then developed seven "horns." This is the sign of the Christ Spirit.

Read the passage where John receives the book with the seven seals in light of this occult insight. Let us read it as it is described in the fourth chapter of Revelation. "And immediately I was in the Spirit. And behold, a throne was set in heaven, and on the throne sat One; and He who sat there was like jasper and sardius in appearance... And around the throne were twenty-four thrones, and on the thrones sat twenty-four elders"—whom I have presented to you during the twenty-four hours of World Day—day and night. And then, what follows in the fifth chapter: "And I looked, and behold, in the midst between the throne and the four living creatures and among the elders stood a Lamb, as though it had been slain, and it had seven horns and seven eyes, which are the seven spirits of God, sent out into all the earth." — This occult symbol underlies John's references to the mysteries of the world's existence in the Apocalypse. Only those who know these mysteries can begin to grasp how profound a book the Apocalypse is and what it means when the adversary of the Lamb is depicted as the beast with two horns. The symbol of the sun demon is depicted as follows:
GA096





GA104a
Das Zeichen der Intelligenz der Sonne ist

Das ist zugleich das okkulte Zeichen des Lammes. Das Lamm empfängt das Buch mit den sieben Siegeln. «Und ich sah, und siehe, mitten zwischen dem Stuhl und den vier Tieren und zwischen den Ältesten stand ein Lamm, wie es erwürget wäre, und hatte sieben Hörner und sieben Augen, das sind die sieben Geister Gottes, gesandt in alle Lande.» (Apk. 5, 6) Die sieben Ecken des Zeichens heißen «Hörner». Was bedeuten aber die «Augen»? - In okkulten Schulen sind zu den sieben Augen die Zeichen der sieben Planeten geschrieben. Nichts anderes bedeuten die sieben Augen als die sieben

Planeten, und die Namen der Planeten bezeichnen die Geister, die darin als Intelligenz inkarniert sind. «Saturn» ist der Name der Saturnseele. Die Namen der Planeten sind die sieben Planetengeister, die die Erde umstellen und Einfluß auf das menschliche Leben haben. Das Lamm, Christus, enthält alle sieben. Christus ist das Alpha und das Omega, die sieben Planeten verhalten sich zu ihm wie die Glieder zum ganzen Leibe. Wunderbar stellt die Verschlingung der Linien des Zeichens das Zusammenwirken der sieben Planeten dar. Vom Saturn steigt man zur Sonne herauf, von da herab zum Monde, dann zum Mars, Merkur und so weiter. In den Namen der sieben Wochentage ist das Gleiche ausgedrückt: Samstag, Saturday - Saturn; Sonntag - Sonne; Montag - Mond; Dienstag, Mardi - Mars; Mittwoch, Mercredi - Merkur; Donnerstag, Jeudi - Jupiter; Freitag, Vendredi - Venus. Christus ist der Regent aller dieser Weltkugeln; sie sind nur Teilhandlungen von ihm, er verbindet sie alle. In Rosenkreuzerschulen malt man als Zeichen für die Sonnenintelligenz oft ein Lamm hin.
GA104a

**Chapter 6.**

GA008
And as each seal is opened (chapter 6) the four living creatures declare what they know. At the opening of the first seal a white horse upon which sits a rider with a bowc10, appears to John. The first cosmic power, an embodiment of creative thought, becomes visible. It is directed into the right course by the new rider, Christianity. Strife is quieted by the new faith. At the opening of the second seal a red horse appears, on which again there is a rider. He takes peace, the second cosmic power, from the earth so that through sloth humanity may not neglect to cultivate the divine. The opening of the third seal reveals the cosmic power of justice, guided by Christianity; the fourth brings the power of religion, which has received new dignity through Christianity. The meaning of the four living creatures thus becomes clear. They are the four chief cosmic powers which are to receive new leadership through Christianity, War: the lion; Peaceful Work: the bull; Justice: the being with the human face; and Religious Enthusiasm: the eagle. The meaning of the third being becomes clear when it is said at the opening of the third seal: “A quart of wheat for a shilling, and three quarts of barley for a shilling,” and that the rider holds a balance. At the opening of the fourth seal a rider becomes visible whose name was “Death, and Hell followed him.” Religious justice is the rider (chapter 6, verses 6 and 7).

And when the fifth seal is opened there appear the souls of those who have already acted in the spirit of Christianity. Creative thought itself, embodied in Christianity, is manifested here. But by this Christianity is at first meant only the first community of Christians, which is transitory like other forms of creation.
GA008

GA101
Thus, every other member expresses itself in the human physical body to the extent that it extends into it. The blood pulses unconsciously because the ego, insofar as it is active within it, is unaware of its physical processes. Just as the nature of the other members is expressed in the physical body, so too is the nature of the other members expressed in the etheric body; only there it does not express itself “humanly,” but rather “animally,” and specifically in the form of certain animals, in a form that bears a certain resemblance to our external animal forms. Thus, what lies beneath the etheric body—the physical body—is expressed as a shadow image; this part of the etheric body, in which the physical member of the human being is expressed, is called the “human being” (it is written on the board). The astral body, the soul of feeling that expresses itself in the etheric body, is called the “lion” because of the similarity of its etheric form; the intellectual soul, which expresses itself in the etheric body, is

called the “Taurus” or the cow, and the consciousness soul, together with the Spirit-Self, is called the “eagle” because of the resemblance it has in its etheric form to the clairvoyant gaze.

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mineral | | | | Consciousness Soul/I/Spirit-Self or Manas |
| | | | Intellect Soul | |
| Plant | | Astral Body, Sensitive Soul | | |
| *Etheric Body (Animal)* | *Human* | *Lion* | *Taurus* | *Eagle* |
| Human | Physical Body | | | |

Here (in the diagram) you have the four symbols of the Apocalypse—man, lion, bull, and eagle—as the four expressions of the constituent elements of the human etheric body. From this you can see that those of our ancestors who conceived these profound symbols—these animal allegories for the human being—did not create them out of their imagination, philosophy, or speculation, nor out of any kind of cleverness, but rather from the world of facts, from the occult world of facts.

However, we must be clear that these four expressions do not manifest equally in every person; one expression predominates in one person, another in another. Of course, we must consider all of humanity in its development. If you consider where the physical body itself expresses itself most strongly, we find the strongest expression in the declining, red race—among the Native Americans—in the particular structure of the skeletal system that predominates there. If you wish to see where the etheric body is particularly expressed physically, you must look for it in another human race: in the black race, in the formation of the glands. In carbon excretion, you will find an expression of the plant nature. [Notes here are incomplete.] The people in whom the nervous system is particularly strongly expressed on the physical plane—and thus also the sensitive aspect—are found in the Malayan race, and the race in which the blood system is particularly expressed is the Mongolian race. The group of people who are beginning to develop the principle of Manas can be found in the Caucasian race. Thus you have derived the classification of human races from occult truths; what is found in modern humans is distributed throughout all of humanity, with one or the other predominating or receding in a particular human group.

Such differences can also be found in the etheric body of human beings. When the clairvoyant gaze observes the etheric body, just as the physical gaze observes the physical body, it finds human beings divided into human-humans, lion-humans, bull-humans, and eagle-humans. Their group-I is of an astral nature. The clairvoyant finds the human group-I situated on the astral plane between the animal group-I and the human individual-I. The further back in time we go, the more we find that human beings, in terms of their etheric body, assume one of these four forms, and we attribute to each of these four soul groups a human group soul: to one a human group soul, to another a lion group soul, to the third a bull group soul, and to the fourth an eagle group soul. You would only get a false mental image of this if you were to take these names, which are derived from physical animal forms, too literally. The etheric body of the lion-people is much more similar to the group soul of the lions than to the individual lion here on the physical plane. Christianity, based on the evangelists, had in its mental image that their souls are not like ordinary human souls but encompass entire groups of people, and compared Matthew to the human, Mark to the lion, Luke to the bull, and John to the eagle according to the inner character of their souls. This stems from the similarity that Christian esotericism attributed to the souls of the individual evangelists. We will understand this even more clearly when we see that humanity is, on the one hand, in a process of descent and, on the other hand, in a process of ascent. Here on Earth, at the

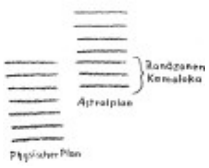
lowest point of materialism, humanity acquires the potential for the individual soul. Humanity has descended from ancient times, when the individual group souls were distinguished more precisely: the human-human, the lion-human, the bull-human, the eagle-human. When humanity ascends again in the future, they will retain their individual soul and, on a higher level with higher consciousness, will once again develop what they previously had only in a dim consciousness: the four group souls. This is why these characteristics are attributed to the evangelists in Christianity.

Let us hold on to this concept of the group souls of human beings for a while longer. These group souls existed much more in time, in succession, than in space, side by side. When we consider animal group souls—for example, a group of lions or a group of whales—we say that they have their collective group soul on the astral plane, existing side by side. But when we consider human group souls, we must focus more on time. A human group soul is born in the etheric, so to speak, at the boundary between the physical and astral planes at a certain time and transforms again at a certain time. These four types of group souls we have discussed are only the four main types; there are, however, countless intermediate stages. We have only indicated the most characteristic forms—human, lion, bull, and eagle—which can occur in all possible combinations.

And so it was said in occultism: The life of a group soul lasts 500 years; after 500 years, it becomes another; it is reborn without losing its consciousness.

When we consider the “I” of such a group soul and seek a means of expression for the “I” in the physical world, it is, of course, the blood. For the occultist, blood is the expression of fire—a substance glowing with fire. Just as the human physical body is the expression of earth, the etheric body the expression of water, and the astral body the expression of air, so the I, which is not yet bound to egoism, is the expression of fire. We therefore say—we will discuss this further tomorrow—that blood has met its death through egoism. The human ego “consumes itself in its own fire,” through itself. This is an occult expression. Only when a person overcomes selfishness does he attain immortality. The human group ego consumes itself in its own fire. When 500 years have passed, it burns up and creates a new form out of itself. In occultism, this was depicted as the group ego generally living for 500 years, then burning up and being reanimated from its own fire, and this was called the “Phoenix.” The beautiful legend of the Phoenix has its actual background here. The Phoenix is the Group-I with the characteristics of the four types, which burns itself up and restores itself after seven generations—a generation calculated as 75 lunar years of age.

This is the real background to the legend of the phoenix. Here you have further proof that ancient legends such as that of the Phoenix are drawn from the deepest occult realities. The aim here is not to speculate, but to demonstrate what has been taught in occult schools throughout the centuries, and what constitutes a genuine, actual experience, expressed through occult signs and seals.




When I say that the Group Soul is in the etheric realm at the boundary between the physical and astral planes, you must not create a mental image of a dividing line. If we start from the physical plane, we

have here (as shown in the diagram) seven subdivisions of the physical plane; then there would be seven subdivisions of the astral plane. Of these, the three lowest coincide with the three highest of the physical plane. We must view the astral plane as merged with the physical plane in such a way that the three uppermost parts of the physical plane are simultaneously the three lowest parts of the astral plane. We can speak of a border zone; this is the one that our souls cannot leave after death if they are still bound to the earth by desires. It is called Kamaloka.

All the forces at work within humanity arise from within, not from without. What exists as thought and feeling in one era takes on external form in the next. And the individualities that guide human development must implant within humanity, many millennia in advance, the thought-forms that are later to become external physical reality. Therein lies the function of thought-forms, which are inspired by such symbolic images as Noah's Ark, the Temple of Solomon, and even the four apocalyptic figures: man, lion, bull, and eagle. They have a very real significance. With this, we have discussed at some length the images that guide human beings when they surrender to them. It was also images that we cited yesterday in the four figures of the human, the lion, the bull, and the eagle; and it is images that we are speaking of today. The images lead human beings to participate in the world that immediately adjoins their own.
GA101

GA104
Now the whole of our fifth epoch of human evolution (including the various stages of civilization from the ancient Indian to our own), really exists in order to develop intelligence and reason and all that belongs to them. Nothing of this existed in the Atlantean epoch. Memory was present and also other qualities, but to develop the intelligence and what pertains to it—the turning of the attention to the outer world—is the task of the fifth epoch. If we direct our spiritual vision to the surrounding world and inquire, "To what do we owe the fact that we have become intelligent; what animal form have we put forth from ourselves in order to become intelligent?" curious and grotesque as it may appear, it is nevertheless true to say that if there were not around us the animals which belong to the horse nature, man would never have been able to acquire intelligence.

In former times men were aware of this. All the intimate relations existing between certain races of men and the horse originate from a feeling which may be compared with the mysterious feeling of love between the two sexes, from a certain feeling of what one owes to this animal. Hence when the new civilization arose in the ancient Indian age, it was a horse that played a mysterious role in religious ceremonial, in the worship of the gods. And all customs connected with the horse may be traced back to this fact. If you observe the customs of ancient peoples who were still clairvoyant such as, for instance, the old Germans, and notice how they placed horse-skulls in front of their houses, this leads you back to the fact that these people were aware that man has grown beyond the unintelligent condition by separating out this form. There was a profound consciousness that the acquisition of cleverness is connected with it. You need only remember the Odyssey and the wooden horse of Troy. Such legends contain deep wisdom, much deeper than our science contains. Not without reason is such a type as the horse employed in legend. Man has grown out of a form which once contained within it that which is now embodied in the horse; and in the form of the centaur, art still represented man as connected with this animal in order to remind him of the stage of development out of which he had grown, from which he had struggled free in order to become the present human being.

What thus took place in bygone times in order to lead to present humanity will be repeated at a higher stage in the future. It is not the case, however, that this would in the future have to run its course in the physical world. Those who become clairvoyant at the boundary between the astral and the devachanic

planes can see how man continually purifies and develops that which he owes to the separation from the horse nature. He will accomplish the spiritualizing of the intelligence. After the great War of All against All he will elevate to wisdom, to spirituality, that which to-day is merely reason, merely cleverness. This will be experienced by those who then will have reached the goal. The fruits of that which was able to develop in humanity in consequence of the separation of the horse nature will be manifested.

Now let us imagine one who clairvoyantly looks into the future of mankind. What will he see, what will it show him? Everything which man has prepared throughout the seven ages of civilization (for his soul was incarnated in the past civilizations and will again be incarnated in the future ones) will be there in a following age, and survive the great War of All against All into the more spiritual epoch. In each age he took what could be taken up. Think how your soul lived in the ancient Indian civilization! You then received the wonderful teachings of the Holy Rishis; although you have forgotten them you will re-member them again later. Then you progressed further from one incarnation to another. You have been able to learn what the Persian, the Egyptian and the Graeco-Roman civilizations made possible. All this is within your soul to-day, but it is not yet outwardly manifest in your countenance. You will live further into the age of Philadelphia and into the age which will be led by the "Amen." And a community of people will develop more and more who will manifest in their countenances what has been prepared in the various ages of our epoch. What is already working in your soul, that which you received in the Indian age, will appear in your physiognomy in the first sub-age of the epoch following upon the great War of All against All. And that which a man acquired in the ancient Persian age will change his countenance at the second stage. And so on, stage after stage. The spiritual teaching, which you who now sit here receive and unite with your souls, will bear its visible fruit in the epoch after the great war. You are now uniting with your soul that which the seven Spirits of God and the seven stars give. You carry it home. No one will read it in your faces to-day, nor even after centuries; but it will come after that great war. In the sixth epoch there will come a fifth age and then you will bear the image of it in your face; on your forehead will be written what you have now worked out, what are now your thoughts and feelings.

So step by step, after the great war, will issue and reveal itself all that is now hidden in the soul. Let us imagine the beginning of the great war; the soul which has heard the call which from age to age the Christian principle has uttered, will live on after all that is indicated in the "letters." What these ages can give has been given throughout seven ages. Let us imagine how the soul waits, how it waits on. It is sealed seven times. Each age of culture lays one seal upon it. Within you is sealed what the Indians wrote in the soul; within you is also imprinted what the Persians, the Egyptians, Greeks and Romans have written in the soul, and what our own age of civilization inscribes in it. The seals will be unloosed, that is, the things written there will be outwardly revealed after the great War of All against All. And the principle, the power, which brings it about that the true fruit of our ages of civilization shall be made manifest in the countenance, is to be found in Christ Jesus. Seven seals of a book must be opened. What is this book? Where is it?

We will explain what a book is according to the Bible. The word "book" occurs in the Bible only seldom. This must not be overlooked. If you search in the Old Testament you will find the word in Genesis (Gen. v. I): "This is the book of the generations of man; When God created man, in the likeness of God made he him; and he created him male-female, and blessed him, and called his name Adam." You may then open where you will, you will only find the word "book" again in the first Gospel (Matt. i. 1). "This is the book of the generation of Christ Jesus, the son of David, the son of Abraham. Abraham begat Isaac, and Isaac begat Jacob," etc. Again generations are enumerated. That

which flows through a long series is enumerated. And again the expression “book” appears here in the Apocalypse of John. It appears where it is said that the Lamb alone is worthy to open the book with the seven seals. The expression “book” has always the same significance, it is never used otherwise. We only need to understand the records literally. A book in our present sense is not intended. The Domesday book or register of landed property had the old signification of the word “book.” The word “book” is used where something is entered consecutively, where one thing depends upon another, where a possession is registered so that it may be handed down from generation to generation. In such a record we are dealing with something whereby a foundation is made for that which is handed on by heredity. In the Old Testament the word “book” signifies a document in which are recorded the generations transmitted through the blood. It is there used in no other sense than that the generations are recorded. It is used afterwards in the first Gospel in the same way for the recording of the lineage. Hence what follows consecutively in time is written in a “book.” By a book nothing else is ever intended than the recording of what follows in time, that is to say, approximately in the sense of a chronicle, a history.

The book of life which is now laid down in humanity, in which from age to age is written in the “I” of man that which each age supplies, this book which is written in the soul of man and which will be unsealed after the great War of All against All, this book is also meant here in the Apocalypse. In this book there will be the entries made by the various ages of civilization. Just as through the generations the entries were made in the genealogical tables of the old books, so it is here, only that in this case that which man spiritually acquires is written down. And as he acquires through intellectuality what it is possible to acquire in our age, the gradual progress of this development will be represented imaginatively by the symbol which corresponds with this quality. By having passed through the Indian age in a frame of mind in which he turned away from the physical world and directed his gaze towards the spiritual, man will, in the first age after the War of All against All, gain the victory over the things of sense. He will be the victor by acquiring what was written in his soul in the first age. Further, that which appeared in the second age, the conquest of matter by the ancient Persians, will appear in the second age after the War of All against All; the sword here signifies the instrument for the over-coming of the external world. That which man acquired in the Babylonian-.Egyptian age, when he learned how to measure everything correctly is seen in the third age after the great war, as that which is represented by the scales. And the fourth age shows us what is the most important thing, that which man acquired in the fourth age of our epoch through Christ Jesus and his appearance on earth; the spiritual life, the immortality of the “I.” All that is not fit for immortality, that which has to die, falls away; this must appear for the fourth age.

Thus everything that has been prepared throughout the ages of this present epoch comes out consecutively in the next, and it is indicated by the symbol which corresponds with the intelligence. If we read about the opening of the first four seals in the sixth chapter of the Apocalypse of John, we shall see that what is revealed expresses stage after stage in a mighty symbolism, what will in the future be revealed. “And I saw, and behold a white horse”—this indicates that the spiritualized intelligence comes forth. “And he that sat on him had a bow; and a crown was given unto him; and he went forth to conquer, and he conquered. And when he had opened the second seal, I heard the second beast say, ‘Come and see.’ And there went out another horse that was red. And to him that sat thereon was given power to take peace from the earth, and that they should kill one another.” (That that might be destroyed which is not worthy to take part in the ascent of humanity.) “And to him was given a great sword. And when he had opened the third seal, I heard the third beast say, ‘Come and see.’ And I beheld, and lo, a black horse; and he that sat on him had a pair of balances in his hand. And I heard a voice in the midst of the four beasts say, ‘A measure of wheat for a penny, and three measures of barley for a penny.‘” “Measure” and “penny” to indicate what humanity learned in the third age; the fruits are

carried over and unsealed. And in the fourth age Christ Jesus came to conquer death, and the manifestation of this achievement is seen. “And when he had opened the fourth seal, I heard the voice of the fourth beast say, ‘Come and see.’ And I looked and behold a pale horse; and his name that sat on him was Death, and Hell followed with him.” “Behold a pale horse”—this all falls away, falls into the race of evil; but that which heard the call, which overcame death, partakes in the spiritual life. Those who have understood the “I Am” and his call are those who have overcome death. They have spiritualized the intelligence. And now what they have become can no longer be symbolized by the horse. A new symbol must appear for those who have understood to follow the call of him who has the seven Spirits of God and the seven stars. They now appear under the symbol of those who are clothed in white garments, who have put on the robes of the immortal, eternal, spiritual life.

We are then further told how all that appears which goes upward to good and that which goes downward to evil. This is clearly expressed. “And when he had opened the fifth seal, I saw under the altar the souls of them that were slain because of the word of God and because of the testimony which they held; and they cried with a loud voice, saying, How long, O Lord, holy and true, dost thou judge and not avenge our blood on them that dwell on the earth? And white robes were given unto every one of them; and it was said unto then, that they should rest yet a little season, until there came to them their fellow-servants and their brethren, who should be killed as they were”—will be killed as to the external form and live again in the spiritual. How is this expressed?

Let us realize what according to Anthroposophy becomes of the external sense world. How have we described the seven stars? We went back to Saturn and showed how the physical human body originated, how it was constructed out of warmth. We then saw how the Sun appeared; we drew a mental picture of it. The sun is for us not merely a physical sun; it is the bringer of life which in the future of humanity will appear as the highest form of spiritual life. The moon is to us the element which retards the rapid march of life and slows man down to the necessary pace. Thus we see spiritual powers in sun and moon. And the knowledge we acquire through Anthroposophy also appears rightly symbolized in a future age; to our spiritual. vision the sun and moon appear as the forces which have constructed man. Symbolically the external physical sun and the external moon disappear, they become like a human being, but in an elementary form! “And I beheld when he had opened the sixth seal, and lo, there was a great earthquake; and the sun became black as sackcloth of hair, and the moon became as blood.” All this is the symbolical fulfilment of what we are seeking in spiritual life.

Thus we see that what is being prepared in this epoch is prophesied in significant pictures for the next epoch. We now carry invisibly within us the transformation which we take in hand with the sun and moon when the physical changes into the spiritual elements. When spiritual vision is directed toward the future, the physical disappears and the symbol of the spiritualizing of humanity appears before us.
GA104

GA104a
A seer such as the writer of the Apocalypse can already see the future evolution of humanity in the astral world. What will enter into evolution after the war of all against all is already being prepared. Those human beings called to carry evolution into the future, beyond the war of all against all, are already being prepared through the wisdom taught in Theosophy. In far-reaching ways, the spiritual stream of wisdom will become increasingly effective.

When the clairvoyant can observe the modern human being, it sees the etheric body extending a little bit beyond the upper part of the physical body. The etheric body of a man is feminine and the etheric body of a woman is masculine. The astral body, on the other hand, is a flowing structure, variable in

terms of color and form, changeable according to the inner life. If we raise our hand the impulse to do so comes from the astral body. When we walk, when we cry or laugh—that is caused by an impulse in the astral body having influence over the physical body. However, what has the most essential influence on human beings is their I. The I works in an altogether roundabout way through the astral body.

In ancient Atlantean times and in the Lemurian age, human beings were not only able to stretch out their different bodies, but they could also extend and "puff" them up. At that time the physical body was only a very small inclusion; on the other hand, the etheric and astral bodies were gigantic. The astral body might look like one kind of animal but was constantly changing and soon resembled another. Human beings constantly changed their physical form according to the desires and impulses living within them. The air then was filled with thick foggy mists much thicker and water-filled than our mountain fog. The human physical body had the most varied colorings and forms; one could already see in its gelatinous substance indications of the physical organization, for example the blood system and the skeleton. Toward the end of Atlantis the air was cleared of thick watery masses. Only then could human beings become the creatures of air and earth that we are today. Atlanteans did not see the sun at all the way it is seen today; it was seen as the mighty ring of the sun. Because the air was never free of water, there were never any rainbows. Only after the separation of water and air were rainbows possible. The entire process of the Atlantean flood is portrayed in the story of Noah and the rainbow. (Genesis 9:12–17)

It was also necessary for the beings on the earth to pass through their stages of evolution at very different times. If a portion of humanity in the early stages of Atlantis had not wanted to descend into a "densified" physical body, then the human form would have remained as it was—with all the instincts, desires, and passions still expressed in the physical form. However, there were beings that became solid, hardened at that time. Animals are nothing more than beings that entered into a hardened, dense condition too early. What the human being carries in the astral body today in terms of desires and passions has come to expression in the physical body of the various animals. Each of the groups of animals developed a particular instinct, and is "congealed" or solidified in it. During the Lemurian age it was the mammals; they are human passions that have congealed into a rigid form. What we carry within ourselves presents itself as a picture in the various animals. With human beings, the instincts have been gradually refined and we can hide them in our heart. The lowest instincts of the human being were first to fall into the physical world during eruptions of natural forces in the earlier times of Lemuria. The apes represent, so to speak, the last lower instincts to fall or be pushed into physical matter before the soul of the human being was itself hardened in matter. With some animals, horses for example, we still find today as a peculiarity the etheric body of the head extending beyond the physical head. That was the case with Atlantean human beings. A certain point in the human etheric body moved into the corresponding part of the physical body only in the last third of the Atlantean age. Only then were human beings able to develop a physical form appropriate for the spirit.

There are sixteen groups of human instincts and passions and so too, are there sixteen groups of animals. Zoology will one day understand how these sixteen groups were gradually "precipitated out" of the spiritual world. We can easily say how the various parts of the mammal groups were created. The formation of hoofs, for example, occurred when, in a very special way, animal nature closed off from the outer world. Claws were created through aggression. The hoofed animals express a very different stage of evolution than animals with claws. We see just such a contradiction expressed in the forms of the centaur and the sphinx.

This is portrayed in the second part of Faust, a very important book from the occult point of view. The Sphinx encounters Mephistopheles and laughs at him because of his horse hooves, which are a sign of a hardened nature, a nature that has egotistically closed itself off from the world.

If we cut our finger we feel pain; this shows us the bearer of feelings, the astral body. Earlier, when the human being's entire nature was still soft, the hair growth was also permeated by astral forces. We are told of Esau that he was covered with hair; he was still retarded in his development and in his power of judgment. For this reason Jacob could trick him, because Jacob had already come further in the development of his power of judgment, of his I. There are forces again working outward in human beings today. The more the I has mastery over the astral body, the more the physical body can also be molded and transformed. Today we have our karma within us like a life account, with a balance of everything we have prepared in our various incarnations. But because the human being's physical nature expresses very little of the I, we carry our karma inwardly and unmediated. But later it will show itself on the human face. Humankind will evolve in the future so that its karma is carried on the countenance. No longer will the fact that a human being is born into a specific race or in a specific climate be decisive for external appearances. There will be rather a class of good people and a class of evil people. Let us understand Paul correctly, who said: “I live, but it is no longer I who live, but Christ in me.” (Gal. 2:20) What is called “receiving the Yahweh-Christ being” will later show itself in human beings externally. Today it is still possible to be a rogue and yet hide it; but in the future, human beings will carry the mark of their inner life on their foreheads.

Let us look at the human being after the war of all against all. We can think of him or her as someone with radiant, good features and a noble benevolent expression. This will become the fate of those who have taken in spiritual impulses at the right time. All moral, intellectual, and spiritual forces will, in the future, confront us visibly in the external features of a human being. What is taken in today will be sealed into souls. After the seventh age, after the war of all against all, they will be unsealed.

That is what the writer of the Apocalypse sees in the seven seals that will gradually be broken. The book with the seven seals is not intended to be like our books or like ancient scrolls. What is intended is a succession of events. The succession of epochs is the concept of the Apocalyptic “books” as, for example, the Evangelist Matthew speaks of the succession of generations, of the lineage of Jesus of Nazareth. Orders of succession are created in this way. The book tells us that the power of the lamb can break the seals.

That gives us an idea of what is intended with the seven seals.

Let us now go from the past into the future. What does the writer of the Apocalypse think of the future? He speaks entirely in the following way: What you can see today on the astral plane is nothing other than the formation of the physical future of human beings. Look at what is on the astral plane and you will experience the future of humankind. There is no future that does not result from the present. You know that the human being is enveloped in an astral body that permeates the physical body. You know, too, that there are sense organs in the astral body that are entirely different from the sense organs in the physical body. We speak of the lotus blossoms or wheels. What the human being can develop today in terms of such astral senses, the human physical body will have in the future as physical senses. The astral is on the way to becoming physical. How do human beings form these organs of the future, which today are still astral? Through what we achieve today in terms of the true, the beautiful, and the good. Work and deeds of today form the foundation for organs in the future. There was a time when human beings did not have eyes—they couldn't perceive light and color. Human beings acquired eyes through their actions at that time. They had other organs previously—by turning to the light they

developed eyes. Present deed is future destiny; the deeds of the past were such that eyes could be created, and from your deeds in the present day, your sense organs of the future will be created. Human beings who are active in terms of the true, the beautiful, and the good will have normal organs in the future. If they strive against the true, the beautiful, and the good then they will have crippled organs in the future. It is impossible to erase what we do in the present. A deed laid down in the present in order that it emerge in the future is termed “sealed” in Christian esotericism. In terms of Christian esotericism one says: Today you have eyes that were nonexistent in the past but you did this or that. Your eyes were “sealed,” now they are “unsealed.” Your eyes are the “unsealing” of your past deeds. We have now the sealing of what will be unsealed on the physical plane in the future. For anyone who looks only at the physical plane, evolution is a book with seven seals. Anyone who looks at the astral plane can see all future organs already laid out. The organs reveal themselves as pictures. An esotericist would say: If you look to the middle point, which is characterized as the lamb, then the lamb will put the book into your hand; and the book is unsealed in such a way that what will have form in the future can only be expressed in pictures. Therefore, what can occur is expressed through pictures, piece by piece. In the first seal a future condition is portrayed pictorially by a horse, a further condition is revealed in the second seal through another horse and so forth. In order to discern the meaning we will consider one image, let us say, the third horse. This is the picture that appears when the third seal is broken. It is presented in the following way: “When he opened the third seal, I heard the third living creature say, ‘Come!’ And I saw, and behold, a black horse, and its rider had a balance in its hand.” (Rev. 6:5)

What does this mean? A future condition of the human being is here portrayed, a condition that proceeds from the evolution of the third member of the human being, the astral body, which has been worked on and purified by the I. An unpurified astral body is one that knows only itself, that finds everything that does not belong to it to be antipathetic. A purified astral body is one that receives everything coming to it weighed out with a just balance. If we rightly purify the astral body, an organ is created that can be expressed pictorially by a rider with a balance. An organ in the astral body arises for the human being out of just deeds in the present. This is expressed here pictorially. We could explain the other pictures in the same way. Then we would see the inadequacy of the usual explanations that are given.

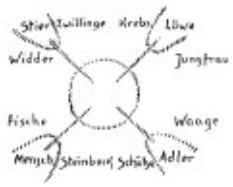
When the fifth seal is opened we are told something very significant: “When he opened the fifth seal, I saw under the altar the souls of those who had been slain for the word of God and for the witness they had borne ...” (Rev. 6:9) What happens to a soul that develops itself up to the fifth step? It is strangled in its lower soul; the impurities that cling to it are done away with, and the soul thereby appears clothed in innocence: “And they were each given a white robe ...” (Rev. 6:11) The soul is white; it has become innocent when it has developed to the fifth step.

With the community at Philadelphia the sixth age will begin. Except for these spiritual human beings the rest of humankind will be entirely wrapped up in the social life, submerged in the materialism that will be constantly growing stronger. People will master the forces of nature to a high degree, as we have seen with wireless telegraphy and aeronautics. It is not without consequences whether the air is filled with spiritual thoughts or with thoughts of material needs. This will engulf our entire planet. We are looking into an age when humanity will intrude in large measure into air and light-filled space.

What will be the fruits of this age? Seen in their true form it can be said that these electromagnetic waves will work back into the forces of the earth during a certain age. Then, according to good and evil, earthquakes and earth tremors will appear as the effects of human deeds. “When he opened the sixth seal I looked, and behold, there was a great earthquake; and the sun became black as sackcloth ...”

(Rev. 6:12) When the feelings of human beings are carried into the air, they change all of nature and something like a meteor shower appears. In this way human beings unleash the forces of nature, but their achievements do not go unpunished.
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If we imagine this circle to be the ancient solar sphere, then the archangels strive outward from it in all directions into cosmic space; the essence of the archangels spreads spiritually throughout the universe. In this expansion, the archangels were assisted by the fact that beings from the universe came forth to meet them. Just as the fire-elements of the Thrones once streamed in from the universe during the stage of the ancient Saturn, so now, as the archangels move outward, they are met by other entities—entities even higher than the Thrones—who provide them with aid, enabling them to remain out there in the spiritual world for longer than they otherwise could have.




We call these beings—which came forth from the spiritual realm to meet the archangels and received them—cherubim. They are a particularly exalted type of spiritual being, for they possess the power to welcome the archangelic entities with, so to speak, open arms. As these archangelic beings spread outward, the cherubim come to meet them from the reaches of the cosmos. Thus, surrounding the ancient solar sphere, we find the approaching cherubim. Just as our Earth—if I may use the comparison—is surrounded by its atmosphere, so too was the ancient Sun surrounded by the realm of the cherubim, for the benefit of the archangels. Consequently, when the archangels ventured out into the cosmic expanse, they beheld their great helpers.

And how did these great helpers approach them; what did they look like? Naturally, this can only be determined by a clairvoyant consciousness capable of reading the Akashic Records. These great universal helpers manifested in very specific etheric forms. Our ancestors—who, through their traditions, still retained an awareness of this significant fact—depicted the Cherubim as peculiar winged creatures, each with a distinct type of head: the winged lion, the winged eagle, the winged bull, and the winged human. For, in truth, the Cherubim approached from four directions. They drew near in forms that could subsequently be depicted exactly as we have come to know them—as the forms of the Cherubim. It is for this reason that the schools of the earliest initiates in the post-Atlantean era designated these Cherubim—who were advancing toward the ancient Sun from four directions—by names that eventually evolved into the terms: Bull, Lion, Eagle, and Human.

We shall hear more about this in greater detail; for today, let us focus on these four types of Cherubim that approached the Archangels. The situation on the "Old Sun" was such that when the Archangels—the beings who truly enlivened the Sun—ventured out into cosmic space, they were met from four directions by Cherubim—specifically, four types of Cherubim. This enabled the Archangel beings to remain for a longer period within the realm of spirit that surrounded the Old Sun than would otherwise have been possible. For the influence of these Cherubim acted upon the ancient Archangels in a highly enlivening way—enlivening in a spiritual sense. Yet, as these Cherubim drew near to the Sun, their influence necessarily manifested in other ways as well. After all, something present in a given space does not exert its effect in only one respect. Consider, for instance, two people in a room: one might wish for the room to be well-heated, while the other does not—yet the second person, by virtue of being there, also experiences the warmth. It was much the same with these Cherubim streaming in from cosmic space. They exerted the aforementioned influence upon those entities of the Old Sun that had, so to speak, ascended to the element of light and knew how to dwell within it. However, this element of light could only be acted upon during a "Sun-day"—that is, when light was streaming out into cosmic

space. There were also "Sun-nights," when no light streamed outward; yet, even then, the Cherubim remained in the heavens. During these periods, when the solar planet grew dark—becoming, in effect, nothing more than a mass of warm gases, devoid of luminosity—these warm gases circulated within the body of the Sun. Surrounding everything, the Cherubim were now present, exerting their influence—acting directly upon the dark, gaseous substance. Since these Cherubim could not interact with the Archangels in the usual way, they directed their influence into the dark "smoke"—the dark gas—of the Sun. Thus, just as influences were exerted upon the element of heat during the stage of Old Saturn, influences were now brought in from cosmic space to act upon this condensed heat—the gas of the Old Sun. It is to this influence that we owe the emergence, within the solar nebula of the Old Sun, of the initial germinal form of what we today call the animal kingdom. Just as the first rudiment of the human realm—in the form of the physical human body—originated during the stage of Old Saturn, so too did the first rudiment of the animal kingdom take shape on the Sun, emerging from that "smoke" or gas. On Old Saturn, the first germinal form of the human body was fashioned out of heat; on the Old Sun, the forms of the Cherubim—reflected within these solar gases—gave rise to the first, smoke-like, shifting physical rudiments of animal bodies.

Thus, what unfolds around the Sun in the form of Cherubim—that vast assembly of exalted beings—reaches out, as it were, with open arms toward the Archangels on one side, while on the other, during the "nights" of the Sun, it conjures the initial physical rudiments of the animal kingdom out of the solar gas. The animal kingdom, in its earliest physical configuration, emerges from the solar nebula. For this reason, those among our ancestors who, through the Mysteries, were acquainted with these profoundly significant matters of spiritual cosmology, referred to these entities—which acted upon the ancient Sun from various directions in cosmic space—as the "Zodiac." This is the original meaning of the Zodiac. On ancient Saturn, the foundation for humanity is first laid, as the substance that now constitutes the human physical body is poured forth—sacrificed—by the Thrones. On the Sun, the initial rudiments of the animal kingdom are formed: the first animal shapes are conjured out of the heat-substance (which has condensed into gas) by the reflected forms of the Cherubim. In this way, animals initially become solar reflections of the Zodiac. There exists a genuine, intrinsic relationship between the Zodiac and the animals that came into being upon the Sun. Our present-day animals are, in a sense, caricatured successors to those animals that originated on the Sun. Truly, it is not without reason that such names were given to these things. One should never assume that, in those ancient times, names were simply invented in an arbitrary fashion. Today, when an astronomer happens to discover a new body within the chain of planetoids, what do they do? They consult a reference book, select an unused name from Greek mythology, and bestow it upon the celestial body. In those eras when people sought to express the essence of a thing through its name—in those times when the Mysteries held great power—names were never merely assigned; rather, within the names bestowed back then, one can everywhere discover the profound significance of the thing itself.

The forms of our animals—even if they are distorted into caricatures today—are derived from the sphere of the universe, from the configuration of the zodiac as it existed in those times. You may notice that only four names from the zodiac are listed here; these are simply the primary designations for the Cherubim, for, in essence, each such Cherubic form possesses a kind of offspring or companion on either side—to its left and to its right. If you imagine each of the four Cherubic forms accompanied by two such companions, you arrive at twelve forces and powers within the solar sphere—forces that were already present, in a rudimentary sense, during the stage of Old Saturn. We have twelve such powers, which belong to the realm of the Cherubim and which fulfill their task—their mission—within the universe in the manner we have just described.

Now, you might ask: what about the conventional names of the signs of the zodiac? We shall say a word about that in the coming days, for the sequence of these names has undergone some changes. Usually, one begins counting with Aries, Taurus, Gemini, Cancer, Leo, followed by Virgo and Libra. Through a later transformation, the Eagle had to accept the designation "Scorpio"—for very specific reasons. Then come the two companions, Sagittarius and Capricorn. For certain reasons—which we shall also come to understand—the human figure is referred to as the "Water-man" or "Aquarius." And then come the Fishes (Pisces). Thus, you can see—shining through, as it were—the original form from which the zodiac emerged: it is still visible in the Bull (Taurus), in the Lion (Leo), and to some extent in the human figure, which in the common, exoteric terminology is called the "Water-man" or "Aquarius." Why the zodiac underwent this transformation is a subject we shall discuss in the days to come.
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On the Moon men developed up to the rank of the animal, so to speak, although they were not animals. Now, in dealing with the animal kingdom people have always quite justifiably distinguished between different grades of animals, and the animal men on the Moon appeared in three grades differing essentially from one another. In spiritual science these are termed the grades of the “Bull”, the “Lion”, and the “Eagle”. Those are typical configurations, as it were, of the animal world. The old Moon was inhabited by the three groups: Bull men, Lion men, and Eagle men.—Although these connotations apply in no way to our present bulls, lions, and eagles, the deteriorated character of those primordial Moon men which we call Lion-men is nevertheless expressed, to a certain extent, in the feline species; in the character of the hoofed animals there comes to expression the degenerated nature of the so-called Bull men, and so forth.—That describes the densified nature of man after a three-stage development. But on the sun dwelt the spiritual counterparts of these, also consisting of three groups. While the development of the astral principle on the Moon was shaping these three different animal men, the corresponding spiritual men arose on the sun as Angelical beings, spirit beings. These, too, are known as Lion, Eagle, and Bull, but as the spiritual counterparts of the others. So when you contemplate the sun you see spiritual beings whom you envision as the beautiful prototypes conceived in wisdom, while on the Moon you find something like hardened replicas of what dwells on the sun. But something in the nature of a mystery underlies all this.

These images down on the Moon are not without connection with their spiritual counterparts on the sun. On the Moon we have a group of primordial men, the Bull men, and on the sun a group of spirit beings connoted “Bull spirits”; and there is a spiritual connection between prototype and image. That is because the group soul is the prototype and acts as such upon the images. The forces proceed from the group soul and direct the image down below: the Lion spirit directs the beings who, as Lion men, are its image; the Eagle spirit guides the Eagle men, and so on. If these spirits up above had remained united with the Moon, bound to their replicas and inhabiting them, their activity would have been paralyzed; they could not have exercised the forces needed for the salvation and development of the images. They understood that they had to foster on a higher level what was destined to evolve on the Moon. The Bull spirit felt, I must care for the Bull men; but on the Moon I cannot find the conditions for my own progress, hence I must dwell on the sun and from there send down my forces to the Bull men.—And the same applies to the Lion spirit, and the Eagle spirit. That is the way evolution proceeded. Certain beings needed a sphere of action above those that were their physical images, so to speak. The latter required a lower, lesser field. In order to function effectually the spiritual beings had to sunder the sun from the Moon and then send down their forces from without. Thus we see on the one hand a development downward, so to say, and on the other, an upward trend.

The evolution of the old Moon (as a cosmic period) proceeds. By acting upon their images from without, the spiritual beings spiritualize the Moon, with the result that the latter can in time reunite with the sun. The prototypes take their images back into themselves, absorb them, as it were. Another world devachan comes about, a cosmic night. (This is also known as a pralaya, whereas stages like Saturn, Sun, and Moon are called manvantaras.) Following this cosmic night there issues out of the obscurity of the cosmic womb our Earth stage, whose mission it is to advance man to the stage at which he can add the ego, or ego bearer, to his physical, etheric, and astral bodies.

In the meantime, however, all previous evolution must be repeated; for whenever a higher stage is to be reached a cosmic law demands the repetition of all that had already taken place. The Earth had thus to pass once more through the old Saturn stage: again the first potential beginnings of the physical body evolved as out of the cosmic germ; and then followed a repetition of the Sun and Moon stages.

At this time sun, earth, and moon still formed a single body; but now a repetition of previous events takes place: the sun again splits off, and again those loftier beings that need this higher sphere for their development depart with the sun, carrying with them the finer substances they need for creating their cosmic sphere of action. Thus the sun left the Earth, which at that time still bore the moon within its body, and took with it those beings who were sufficiently advanced to find their further development on the sun. You will readily imagine that among these beings were to be found primarily those that had previously functioned as prototypes. All these beings, who during the old Moon period had attained to adequate maturity, progressed rapidly, with the result that they could no longer live in the denser substances and among the earth-plus-moon beings: they had to detach themselves and establish a new existence on the sun—our present sun.

Who were these beings? They were the descendants of those who, back in the old Moon state, had developed on the sun as the Bull, Lion, and Eagle spirits; and the loftiest of these, the most advanced, were those who had merged within themselves the natures of Eagle, Lion, and Bull in a harmonious unity. They are the beings that can be connoted human prototypes—spirit men in the true sense of the term. Keep in mind that among the spiritual beings, who during the old Moon period were to be found on the sun as Bull, Eagle, and Lion spirits, some had attained to a higher plane of development, and these are the Spirit Men proper whose dwelling place is now principally the sun. They are spiritual counterparts, so to speak, of what is in the process of evolution down below on the severed earth-plus-moon; but those that are developing down there are the descendants of the beings that had lived on the old Moon. Now, you can imagine that since a certain condensation, a solidification of these beings had already set in on the old Moon, a tendency to condense, to solidify, to dry out would be all the more pronounced in their descendants. Indeed, a sad and dreary period commenced for this sundered portion which then comprised earth-plusmoon. Above, on the sun, an ever fresher and livelier development, ever fuller life; below, on the Earth, misery and barrenness, steadily increasing rigidity.

Something now occurred without which evolution would have been brought to a standstill: the moon as we know it today separated from the earth-plus-moon body, and what remained is our present earth. In this way the coarsest substances withdrew before rendering the earth completely hard, and the latter was saved from total desolation.

Let us examine this more closely. Imagine you could have stood on this ancient heavenly body that consisted of earth-plus-moon. You would have beheld the sun out in space; and if you had been clairvoyant you would also have seen the spiritual beings described above. On the Earth you would have perceived a sort of solidification, of desolation, and it would have struck you that all about was nothing but aridity and death on the Earth; for the forces of the sun could gain no influence over all this

that was on its way to becoming a great cosmic graveyard.—And then you would have seen the body of the moon detach itself from the Earth. You would have seen the substances of the earth becoming malleable and plastic, with the result that the forces descending from the sun were once more able to act. And you would have seen the Bull, Lion, and Eagle spirits regaining their influence over the human beings that were their images. You would have understood that the moon, isolated, had lost some of its harmful influence through its withdrawal, for thenceforth it could act only from a distance; and that in this way the earth was rendered capable of receiving what the spiritual beings had to give.

The author of the Gospel of John calls the supreme force—which, emerging from the chaos of the universe during the Saturn evolution, provides the spiritual seed for the physical human form—the "Logos." He calls that which emerged on the Sun and became integrated with what had arisen on Saturn the "Life"—what we correspondingly call the etheric or life body. What was added on the Moon, he calls the "Light," for it is the spiritual light, the astral light. This astral light brings about a hardening on the separated Moon and a spiritualization on the Sun itself. What had come into being as a spiritualized entity was able to develop further and did indeed continue to develop. And when the Sun split off from the Earth once more, what had developed on the third stage shone into human beings. But human beings were not yet capable of perceiving what was shining into them from the Sun. It shaped the human being, acted as a force, but human beings could not perceive it.

We look back to the ancient Saturn stage and tell ourselves: that is where the first rudiments of the human physical body were formed. What we regard today as the physical body first took shape on Saturn, as it were, out of the chaos of the universe. Then came the Sun stage. The etheric body was added to the first form of the physical body. On the ancient Moon, the astral element was added, both to the forms that continued to develop on the separated Moon and to the spirits on the separated Sun. On the Moon live the images at the level of the animal realm; on the Sun live the spiritual archetypes. Finally, on Earth, a state gradually emerged through which human beings became capable of once again assimilating within themselves what had developed on the Sun as the astral element during the Moon's evolution and which now acted within them as a force. And now let us trace these four states as they are described to us in the Gospel of John.

In the very beginning, during the Saturn evolution, everything arose from the Logos. During the Sun evolution, life was present in the Logos. And from the animated Logos, light arose during the Moon evolution. And from the luminous and animate Logos, during the Earth's evolution on the Sun, light emerged in a higher form, while human beings emerged in a state of darkness. And from the Sun, the beings—who were the advanced spirits of the Bull, the Lion, the Eagle, and humanity—shone down as light upon the Earth into the forming human forms. But they were in darkness and could not comprehend the light that shone down upon them. — We must not, however, imagine this as physical light, but rather as the light that was the sum of the radiations of the spiritual beings—the spirits of the bull, the lion, the eagle, and humanity—who were the continuation of the Moon's spiritual evolution. - What streamed down was the spiritual light. Human beings could not absorb it; they did not understand it. It promoted their entire development, but without them being conscious of it: "The light shone in the darkness, but the darkness could not comprehend the light."

We have already heard that there were high spiritual beings who, when the Earth separated from the Sun, shifted their sphere of activity to the Sun itself. We have pointed out that the outer astral forms of these high spiritual beings, who have elevated themselves toward the Sun, were, in a sense, the spiritual counterparts of certain animal forms here on Earth. First there was the form of the Spirit of the Bull, the spiritual counterpart of those animal natures whose essential characteristic in their development is what one might call the nutritional and digestive system. The spiritual counterpart is, of course, something

spiritually exalted; the earthly image may appear to be something quite lowly. So we have high spiritual beings who have transferred their sphere of activity to the Sun and from there influence the sphere of the Earth, appearing there as the Bull Spirits. Others appear as lion spirits, whose counterpart is found in those animal forms that have developed, above all, the organs of the heart and blood circulation. Then we have spiritual beings who are counterparts of what we encounter in the eagle nature within the animal kingdom—the eagle spirits. And finally, we have spiritual beings who, as it were, harmoniously unite the other natures as in a great synthesis—the human spirits. These were, in a certain sense, the most advanced.

Now let us turn from there to the ancient initiation. It gave human beings the opportunity to see, face to face, the high spiritual beings who had gone before them. But depending on whether the ancient people had descended from Mars, Jupiter, Saturn, or Venus in accordance with the conditions of those times, they had to be initiated in different ways. That is why there were also a wide variety of oracle sites in Atlantis. There were oracles whose spiritual vision was primarily attuned to seeing those spirits we have characterized as the eagle spirits, while others saw the lion spirits, others the bull spirits, and still others the human spirits. This depended on the specific nature of the people to be initiated. This diversity was, after all, one of the distinctive features of the Atlantean era, and its echoes persisted well into our post-Atlantean era. Thus, in the Near East and in Egypt, you could find mystery sites where initiations were conducted in such a way that the initiates saw the high spiritual beings as bull spirits or as eagle spirits.

Out of the mysteries, external culture then emerged. Those who were able to see the high spiritual beings in the form of a lion also created, within the lion's body, a kind of image of what they had seen. However, they said: "These spirits are involved in the development of the human being," and so they gave the lion's body a human head. This later became the sphinx. Those who saw the spiritual counterparts as bull spirits expressed this by proclaiming their testimony of the spiritual world through the introduction of bull worship, which eventually led, on the one hand, to the worship of the Apis bull in Egypt and, on the other hand, to the worship of the Persian Mithraic bull. For what we find in the external cult practices of various peoples has flowed out of the initiation rites.

Thus, there were initiates everywhere who, in their spiritual vision, were more attuned to the bull spirits, others who were more attuned to the eagle spirits, and so on. In a certain sense, we can also describe the difference between the various types of initiation. For example, those who were initiated in such a way that the spiritual beings appeared to them in the form of bull spirits were specifically instructed in those aspects of human nature that, so to speak, contained the mysteries connected with the glandular system and the etheric body. And they were initiated into yet another realm of human nature: that which, so to speak, binds the human being firmly to the earth, that which is forged to the earth. All those who were initiated into the mysteries of Taurus understood this.

Let us try to put ourselves in the mindset of such an initiate. These initiates had received roughly the following teaching from their great teachers: Human beings have descended from divine heights. The first human beings were the descendants of divine-spiritual beings. Therefore, they led the first human beings back to their Father-God. Thus, human beings came down to Earth, passing from one earthly form to another. These people were particularly interested in what was bound to the Earth, and they took an interest in everything that people had experienced back then, when they counted the divine-spiritual beings among their fathers. — This was the case with the Taurus Initiates.

The situation was different for those initiated into the mystery of the eagle. They saw those spiritual beings that relate to human beings in a very peculiar way. But to understand this, we must at least say a few words about the spiritual nature of birds.

In the animals, which rank below humans because of their lower functions, we see beings that have, so to speak, hardened too early—beings that have not maintained their physical substance in a soft and supple state until the moment when they could have been incorporated into human form. In the bird kingdom, however, we find beings who, while not having assumed the lowest functions, have nevertheless skipped over the intermediate stage. They have, as it were, not descended deeply enough; they initially maintained themselves in substances that were too soft, while the others lived in substances that were too hard. And as evolution continued further and further, external circumstances forced them to become denser. Thus they were densified in a way that corresponds to a nature that is too soft—one that has not descended far enough to Earth. This is, admittedly, a crude and popular way of putting it, but it corresponds to the facts. Corresponding to these bird-like natures as archetypes are those spiritual beings who have also crossed the threshold upward, who have preserved themselves in a spiritual substance that is too soft, and who therefore, in their progress, have, as it were, soared beyond what they could have become at a certain point in time. They diverge upward, while the rest diverge downward. In a sense, the lion spirits and the harmonious spirits—who adhered precisely to the right moment—stand in the middle; these are the human spirits.

We have already seen how those who had received some aspect of the ancient initiation perceived the Christ event. They had previously been able to glimpse into the spiritual world, in a way that corresponded to their specific initiation. Those who had received the Taurus initiation—let us say, the initiates of a large part of the land of Egypt—knew: We can look up into the spiritual world; therefore, the high spiritual beings also appear to us in the counterparts to the Taurus nature in human beings. But now, said those who had drawn near to the Christ impulse, now what has appeared to us in its true form is the Ruler of the spiritual realm. What we had always seen before—what we had ascended to through the stages of our initiation—had presented us with a foreshadowing of the Christ. It is Christ whom we must place within what we saw before. When we recall all that we have seen—what the spiritual worlds have gradually revealed to us—where would it have led us if we had already been at the appropriate level back then? It would have led us to Christ! — Such an initiate described the journey into the spiritual world in terms of the Bull Initiation. But then he said: “The Truth that is within it is Christ.” — And a Lion initiate and an Eagle initiate spoke in the same way.

All of these initiation mysteries had their own specific rules regarding how the initiate was to be led into the spiritual world. The rituals differed depending on how one was to enter the spiritual world. And particularly in the Near East and in Egypt, there were the most diverse variations of the mysteries, where it was especially common to guide the initiates in such a way that they ultimately reached the nature of the bull, and there were initiations that led to the vision of the lion spirits, and so on.

Now, from this perspective, let us consider those who, through earlier initiations of the most varied kinds, had matured to the point of being able to feel the Christ impulse and to grasp Christ in the proper way. Let us consider an initiate who has passed through those stages that have led him to the vision of the human spirit. Such an initiate could say to himself: The true ruler of the spiritual world has appeared to me—it is Christ who lived in Jesus of Nazareth! What led me to this? My former initiation! He knew the path that leads to the vision of the human spirit. Thus he describes what a person experiences in order to attain initiation and to be able to recognize the Christ nature at all. He knew initiation as it was prescribed in those mysteries that led to human initiation. That is why the high initiate, who was in the body of Jesus of Nazareth, appeared to him in the image of the mysteries he

had undergone and come to know; and he described him as he himself viewed the matter. This is the case in the account according to Matthew. Therefore, an older tradition was certainly correct in associating the writer of the Gospel of Matthew with the figure depicted in the four symbols shown to you here on the capitals of the columns to the right and left, which we refer to as the Symbolum of Man. An older tradition identifies the writer of the Gospel according to Matthew with the Human Spirit. This stems from the fact that the writer of the Gospel of Matthew, so to speak, regarded his initiation into the Mystery of Man as his own starting point. For in the time when the Gospels were written, it was not yet customary to write biographies as we do today. At that time, what seemed most essential to people was that there was a highly initiated individual who had taken Christ into himself. How one becomes an initiate, and what one must go through as an initiate—that was what mattered most to them. Therefore, they skip over the day-to-day external events that seem so important to biographers today.

Those who described Jesus of Nazareth in their Gospels, however, portrayed him differently. To them, all external events paled in comparison to the stages that Jesus of Nazareth had to go through as an initiate. They described this, though each in his own way, according to what he knew.

Matthew describes it in the manner of the initiates who had been initiated into the human spirit. This initiation was closely related to Egyptian wisdom. — And now we can also understand how the author of the Gospel according to Luke arrived at his distinctive account. He was one who, in his earlier incarnations, had attained initiations that led to the Spirit of the Bull. He was able to describe what such an initiation entailed; he could say: A great initiate must have gone through these stages! And he described it in its characteristic tone. He was one of those who had previously lived primarily within the Egyptian mysteries. Therefore, it is no surprise to us that he highlights precisely that aspect which, so to speak, reveals the more Egyptian character of the initiation. Let us consider the writer of the Gospel of Luke in light of what we have now gained from this perspective. He said to himself: In that individuality that was in the body of Jesus of Nazareth lived a high-ranking initiate. I have come to understand how one progresses through the Egyptian mysteries to the Bull Initiation. I know that. — This particular kind of initiation was especially present in his mind. And now he said to himself: “The one who has become as high an initiate as Jesus of Nazareth has, in his earlier incarnations, undergone an Egyptian initiation in addition to all his other initiations.” - So in Jesus of Nazareth we have an initiate who has undergone the Egyptian initiation. The other evangelists knew this, of course. But it did not strike them as particularly important, because they were not so familiar with the initiation from this perspective. That is why no particular trait of Jesus of Nazareth caught their attention.

The individuality that lived within Jesus of Nazareth had also been initiated into the Egyptian mysteries. Hence the journey to Egypt. To whom, then, must this “flight to Egypt” have been particularly striking? To the one who knew it from his own life, and such a person therefore also described this particular journey because he knew what it meant. It is described in the Gospel of Matthew because the writer knew from his own initiation what a journey to Egypt had meant for many initiates in ancient times. And now that you know that the author of the Gospel of Luke was a person who was particularly familiar with the initiation from the Egyptian mysteries leading to the Service of the Bull, you will not find it unreasonable that an older tradition associates the author of the Gospel of Luke with the symbol of the bull. For good reasons—which there is not enough time to elaborate on here—he does not describe a journey to Egypt. But he does mention such typical events whose significance could best be assessed by someone familiar with the Egyptian initiation. The author of the Gospel of Matthew describes the connections between Jesus of Nazareth and Egypt in a more superficial manner through the journey to Egypt. The author of the Gospel of Luke views all the events he describes in the spirit imparted by an Egyptian initiation.

Now let us consider the author of the Gospel according to Mark. He omits all the background history and focuses specifically on describing the ministry of Christ in the body of Jesus of Nazareth over a period of three years. In this regard, the Gospel of Mark is in complete agreement with the Gospel of John. The author of the Gospel of Mark underwent an initiation that is very similar to those of the Near East, and even to the Greek initiations—if we may put it that way—the European-Asian-pagan initiations, which were the most advanced of their time. They are all reflected in the external world in such a way that a person of high stature—one who is, in a certain sense, initiated—owes his origin not merely to a natural event but to a supernatural one. Remember that the admirers of Plato, who sought to conceive of him in the proper way, had no particular interest in who Plato's biological father was. To them, Plato's spiritual nature outshone everything else. Therefore, they said: That which lived as the soul of Plato within the body of Plato—this Plato is born to us as a lofty spiritual being who enlivens lower humanity. And so they attributed the birth of the Plato who was precious to them—the awakened Plato—to the god Apollo. To them, Plato was a son of Apollo. In these mysteries in particular, it was customary not to concern oneself particularly with the previous life of the person in question, but rather to focus on the moment when the individual became what is so often mentioned in the Gospels: a son of the gods, a son of God. Plato, a son of God! This is how he was described by those who were his noblest admirers and his noblest connoisseurs.

We must be clear about what significance such a description had for the human lives of these Sons of the Gods on Earth. It was precisely during the fourth epoch that human beings became most attuned to the physical-sensory world and grew to love this Earth. They loved the ancient gods because they could depict how the leading sons of the Earth were, in fact, Sons of the Gods. That which walked upon the Earth was to be portrayed in this way.

The writer of the Gospel of Mark was one such person. He therefore begins by describing what took place after John's baptism. An initiation such as that undergone by the writer of the Gospel of Mark led to the recognition of the higher world through the image of the lion spirit. This is why an ancient tradition associates the writer of the Gospel of Mark with the symbol of the lion. And now let us look back once more at what we have already touched upon today—the Gospel of John.

We have said: The one who wrote the Gospel of John was initiated by Christ Jesus himself. This enabled him to offer something that contains, so to speak, the seed not only for the present-day effectiveness of the Christ impulse, but also for the effectiveness of the Christ impulse far into the future. He proclaims something that will remain valid far into the future. He is one of the Eagle Initiates who had transcended the ordinary stage. The writer of Mark presents what was normal for that time. What extends beyond that time, what shows us how Christ will work in the farthest future, what soars above all that is bound to the earth—we find this in John. That is why tradition associates John with the symbol of the eagle.
GA112

GA346
We have another indication, as it were, of what the secret of the seven churches is in the seven seals. We will describe the other meaning of the seven seals later, but when the fourth seal is opened, it corresponds to a secret of the fourth post Atlantean epoch, for a pale horse appears, and there is talk about the death which has come into the world. This touches upon one of the most important secrets of the Apocalypse—at least, it is very important for our time. In a way, death really entered into humanity during the fourth Post Atlantean epoch. You should make this clear to yourselves. One finds out what human nature is if one contemplates something like this; one can really get to know it quite well.

If we go back to the first, second and third post Atlantean epochs we find that the way man felt about himself, and his whole frame of mind was different in these early times than it became later. Man had a distinct inner feeling that he was growing into his earthly abode. Even though this consciousness had dimmed considerably by the time of the Mystery of Golgotha, men had a distinct memory in their ordinary consciousness that they had lived up in the spiritual world before their life on earth. In the first, second and third post Atlantean epochs, everyone knew that they had been a spiritual being before they had become a child. One doesn't find this, in external documents very much, but the fact is that people, took the continuation of their stay upon earth backwards into the spiritual world for granted. Human beings only began to feel that their life on earth was closed off by the two portals of conception or birth and death in the fourth post Atlantean epoch, which coincided with the Mystery of Golgotha.

This consciousness or attitude of soul first arose in the fourth post Atlantean epoch, so that this consciousness of being strictly enclosed by the boundaries of earthly life developed from about the eighth century before Christ up to the 15th century after the Mystery of Golgotha. A new consciousness is being prepared in the present epoch, but we're only at the beginning of it. Only about five centuries have elapsed since then, and this corresponds to about the third pre-Christian century with respect to the preparation of the fourth post Atlantean consciousness. The consciousness which they had then was quite different from the one they had when the fourth post Atlantean consciousness was fully developed. Likewise, most men today are not wearing the clothes of the new consciousness yet, but they are still wearing the consciousness of the fourth post Atlantean epoch. Our whole civilization tends to create this situation.

This is something which will arise evermore during the fifth post Atlantean epoch, namely, people will see death walking alongside them. To put it even more concretely: men will perceive an intimate fire process in themselves which is connected with the development of the consciousness soul. They will experience this development of waking consciousness like a kind of fire process which consumes them, especially at the moments when they pass over from sleeping to waking consciousness. The consciousness soul is a very spiritual thing, and spiritual things always consume material ones. The consciousness soul consumes material and etheric things in human beings through a kind of intimate fire process or transformation process.

This is something which men will perceive more and more in the course of this fifth post Atlantean epoch. Except that you shouldn't think that it's like a burning candle flame; one shouldn't think of it in such a physical way. Rather he will incorporate this proximity of death into his moral soul.

The situation with most people today is as follows. If you see how the good resolves and firm intentions which they have disappear in the next moment, hour, day or month, then in accordance with the prevailing, materialistic world view, one considers this to be something which simply occurs. But one will gradually begin to feel differently about this. One will begin to feel that a good intention which one was too weak to carry out weakens one's life and reduces one's moral value, and one will see that one becomes morally lighter and less significant in the universe thereby.

People will see all of this in a certain way during the sixth post Atlantean epoch. The sun and the stars and planets in their present form will have fallen down from the heavens. One will see the working and weaving of spirit where the materially abstract stars shine today. Thus the way that men see themselves will change a great deal in the course of the fifth post Atlantean age and the way they see the whole world around them will change greatly in the course of the sixth. For example, don't think that an

initiate sees the world like a non-initiate does. Something similar applies to successive stages of consciousness. Human beings see the world differently in successive epochs.

The fact that we are living at a time when man and the way the world looks are being transformed is indicated in a number of ways but also by the fact that there is a relative uniformity in the description of the first four letters. The first letter is unsealed and a horse appears, a white horse. The second letter is unsealed and a red horse appears, but it's a horse. The third letter is unsealed and a black horse appears, but it's a horse. The fourth letter is unsealed and a pale horse appears, but again it is a horse.

The fifth letter is unsealed and no horse appears; there is no mention of horses anymore. The decisive thing here is indicated in an entirely different way. If we go on reading the letters, we find that a very important transformation which is occurring during our age is pointed to in this way.

You see, this is an example, but on the other hand, one has to begin to carry this sensing of the stars and their beings into the present People will have to begin to see that the Christ is a sun being again. But this is what they fight most of all. But if I tell you such things, namely, if I tell you that our modern, fifth post Atlantean epoch must be the resurrected Sardis, in the way that this is concisely and wonderfully described in the fifth community and in the fifth seal, when these things are unsealed, if I say this to you, you will feel that one of our tasks is to develop this particular understanding of the Apocalypse today, namely, to be able to understand the tasks which are demanding our heartfelt attention every day. It doesn't do any good to merely interpret the Apocalypse today. We must put the Apocalypse into practice in everything we do, otherwise we might just as well forget about it. A desire to interpret it in order to satisfy one's curiosity doesn't have much value.

Now that we're gradually supposed to have death beside us as a companion in the fifth post Atlantean cultural age, as I said yesterday, we will need moral strength in order to bear this continual presence of death. In the immediate present and in the age where the consciousness soul and the accompaniment by death are beginning for us, it is important that this coincides with the time of Michael's reign—a reign that signifies an end in a certain sense and a kind of an attainment of perfection; or decadence and perfection at the same time.

At the time of the Mystery of Golgotha, Michael, who lived in the sun and who was the most important servant of the Christ spirit in the sun, experienced this event from the other side.

Humanity on earth experienced the Mystery of Golgotha in such a way that it saw the Christ approaching, whereas Michael and his hosts, who were still in the sun at that time experienced it in such a way that they had to say farewell to the Christ.

One must let the two poles of this event which surpassed everything else which was happening in the cosmos work upon one's soul,—the hosanna on earth when Christ arrived there, and his departure from Michael's hosts up above, for they belong together.
GA346

**Chapter 7.**

GA008
The sixth seal is opened (chapter 7), it is evident that the spiritual world of Christianity is an eternal world. The people seem to be permeated by that spiritual world out of which Christianity itself

proceeded. What it has itself created becomes sanctified. “And I heard the number of the sealed: a hundred and forty-four thousand who were sealed of all the tribes of the children of Israel” (chapter 7, verse 4). They are those who prepared for the eternal before Christianity existed, and who were transformed by the Christ impulse. The opening of the seventh seal follows. What true Christianity should mean for the world becomes evident.
GA008

GA104a
Every age between the Atlantean catastrophe and the great war of all against all has its own unique task for our development. In a new incarnation a human being never has the same task as in the last one. From incarnation to incarnation new tasks approach us, and so this post-Atlantean evolutionary age has worked on human beings in a special way. The whole epoch of earth evolution exists to make human beings fit particularly to develop the human I. In the last third of the Atlantean age, human beings were first equipped to draw the I toward the physical head. That is, the I, the spiritual basis for the experience of self that was only like a seed at the time, was pulled “down” toward the physical body, specifically, toward the human head. But the most significant impulse to have an effect on the I came through the event of Golgotha. All the preceding epochs had already worked in that direction. When we look back at the last third of Atlantean evolution we see that a certain point in the etheric head and the physical head did not then coincide, whereas today the etheric body of the head is approximately the same as the physical head. Because of this, human beings gradually came to develop their I, their sense of self. The rest of Atlantean evolution was used to make the human being fit to be a proper bearer of the I. Even at the end of Atlantean culture the brain was entirely soft, more or less like that of a hydrocephalic today, as part of an atavistic inheritance. The physical brain could only become firm enough through the arrival of the etheric brain. Still, even when the etheric head had fully entered the physical head in the ancient Indian age, it was not yet possible for this head to be a perfect bearer of the I. For this reason the ancient Indians longed for the spiritual world and had to be educated so that the I could gradually develop in them.

To begin with, the human being consists of the four members: physical body, etheric body, astral body, and the I. However, if we wish to investigate post-Atlantean evolution more precisely, we must also consider the ninefold aspect of the human being. This is the difference between the oriental and the northern mystery teachings. The I works to transform the astral body into manas or spirit-self, the etheric body into budhi or life-spirit, and the physical body, through breathing, into atma. In other words, the I transforms the astral body, the etheric body, and the physical body. But before this can happen consciously, it must have taken place through higher beings.

Today the conscious transformation of these members occurs only in schools of initiation. For example, in the last third of the Atlantean age the physical body was transformed to the point that it could be a bearer of an I, but this occurred unconsciously. What was transformed in the astral body is called sentient soul, the etheric body transformed in this way is called the intellectual soul, and the physical body thus unconsciously transformed is the consciousness soul. And only when human beings have developed the consciousness soul can the spirit-self gradually—and at first, unconsciously—be woven into them.

In the cultural epochs of our earth evolution, manas is gradually being formed and slipped into the astral body. After it has been prepared in the last third of the Atlantean age, the consciousness soul must again be transformed by the Yahweh-Christ principle in the next cultural epoch.

In the ancient Indian age the etheric body was permeated by the I, which by then had moved into the human being. In the ancient Persian age the astral body was permeated by the I, in the Egyptian age the I permeated the sentient soul; in the Greco-Latin age the intellectual soul was permeated by the I, in our culture, the I permeates the consciousness soul. In the age of "Philadelphia" the I will permeate the spirit-self, or manas. Then the human beings who, through theosophical-spiritual teachings, have made themselves capable of recognizing Christ will be in a position to see him in a new form of existence—in his delicate etheric body—for he will come again.

The I will be educated through wisdom, through Theosophy, so that it receives manas or spirit-self and will be able to recognize Christ again. Theosophical teachings have been given to humankind not in order to agitate for Theosophy but rather because they were necessary.

In the age represented by the seven seals something like a shower of meteorites will occur, caused by increasing materialism, and some human beings will ascend to a spiritual state. What the spiritualized human beings have acquired through their efforts in our post-Atlantean age will completely permeate them within. When, in the age of the sixth seal, everything that the human being has in terms of sentient soul, intellectual soul, and consciousness soul has been worked into the other members, human beings will have achieved the ability to create an external imprint of their inner life in their gesture, features, in their whole life. Because they have worked on their development they will be able, in the fourth, fifth, and sixth ages in the epoch of the seals, to use these three soul forces—the sentient, intellectual, and consciousness souls—to permeate and work on themselves in order to take in manas.

When the human being has gone through a cycle fully, so that nothing more remains to be done, this is characterized in occultism with a "0" or zero. Therefore, human beings will have permeated the three with four. For the next age, this permeation of the three with the four is expressed by multiplying three by four; they have gone through three cycles, that is through three zeros. This is expressed thus: twelve with three zeros: 12,000. "Then I saw another angel ascend from the rising of the sun, with the seal of the living God, and he called with a loud voice to the four angels who had been given power to harm earth and sea, saying, 'Do not harn the earth or the sea or the trees, till we have sealed the servants of our God upon their foreheads.' And I heard the number of the sealed, one hundred and forty-four thousand sealed, out of every tribe of the sons of Israel, twelve thousand sealed out of the tribe of Judah, twelve thousand of the tribe of Reuben ..." (Rev. 7:2–5) Then the various groups of people who have matured will be united in the community of Philadelphia for mature brotherhood when every soul will feel for others. All those who have been separated out of the various groups can now be multiplied together because they will live within one another. Their life together will be such that they will not disturb one another, such that one soul will work into another soul in complete harmony. Twelve times 12,000 gives the number 144,000.

These are the people who will constitute human society in the age of the sixth seal. The writer of the Apocalypse knows the secrets of all evolution, and he tells them in a language generally little understood. He does this because human beings will be able to develop their consciousness soul precisely through the exertion of energy required to penetrate such riddles.

What today is presented as Theosophy is appropriate for the present age. In later ages an entirely different form of wisdom will be given. The souls who are preparing themselves by taking in Theosophy will take in new forms of wisdom in the next age. What is exoteric culture today was mystery wisdom in ancient times.

In all the ancient mysteries there was a last stage wherein the student experienced the mystery of Golgotha. Therefore, the coffin in which the student experienced the crucifixion, the laying in the grave —and out of which, experienced the resurrection—this coffin was given the shape of the cross. Since the mystery of Golgotha, this fact has become exoteric.

The conservative attitude has always been opposed to making the esoteric exoteric. Hence, Christ was seen as someone who makes the esoteric manifest. But when the time for it has come, the esoteric must always be made manifest. Had we been able to follow the writer of the Apocalypse to the place where he spoke to his disciples, we would be able to hear what is spoken to us today.
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I have already shown that the Apocalypse is built up on the number principle—one of the occult principles—from a certain view point. From my explanations about the fundamental rhythmic numbers in the universe and in man earlier today you may have seen how deeply numbers are grounded in the universe, to the extent that they can disclose rhythmical things.

The buildup in accordance with numbers is quite natural with occult revelations which are written in the way that the Apocalypse of John is. According to the modern principle of initiation the visions that the Apocalypticer speaks about arise if one has Imaginations before one and Inspiration speaks into them. Then one sees the Imaginations spread out before one in a pictorial way and Inspirations speak through them. However, when this occurs one has a number principle whereby the number 7 is always the most perfect one for all occultists. This is practically a tenet of occultism: 7 is the most perfect number. The number principle enables one to follow things up. You shouldn't think that this number 7 has much content or that its content is very important for one. But it is of very great importance when one is listening to Inspirations. If one lives in the number seven one can understand Inspirations in many different ways.

Now we usually find other events sprinkled into the Apocalypse at the places where one set of seven goes over into the next one. that we run into here is very much in need of an explanation. If one only reads the Apocalypse in an external way one might think that there are so and so many numbers of human beings who have the seal of God on their foreheads in a particular epoch, so that they are among the fortunate ones who are rescued, or saved, or, however one wants to put it, whereas the others cannot be saved. This, is something which can be depressing if one reads the Apocalypse in a thoughtful way.

However, one should realize that there is always a difference between racial development and individual development in ancient writings. One should realize that no one felt at all depressed in earlier times when one said that so and so many will be saved in a particular race, whereas the others will be destroyed. No one included himself among these because one thought in a realistic way. It's just like today, where everyone is anxious to have his life insured.
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**Chapter 8.**

GA008
The seven angels who “stand before God” (chapter 8, verse 2) appear. Again these angels are spirits from the ancient Mystery-conceptions transferred to Christianity. They are the spirits who lead to the vision of God in a truly Christian way. Therefore what is next accomplished is a leading to God; it is an

“initiation” which is bestowed upon John. The announcements of the angels are accompanied by the signs necessary at initiations. “The first angel sounded and hail came out of fire mingled with blood, and it fell on the earth. And a third of the earth was burnt up, also a third of the trees was burnt up, and all the green grass was burnt up.” And similar things happen at the announcements of the other angels when they sound their trumpets. At this point we see we are not dealing with an initiation in the old sense but with a new one which should take the place of the old. Christianity should not be confined, like the ancient Mysteries, to a few elect. It should belong to the whole of humanity. It should be a religion of the people; the truth should be given to each one who “has ears to hear.” The ancient mystics were singled out from a great number; the trumpets of Christianity sound for every one who is willing to hear them. Whether or not he draws near, depends upon himself. This is why the terrors accompanying this initiation of humanity are so enormously enhanced. What is to become of the earth and its inhabitants in a distant future is revealed to John at his initiation. Underlying this is the thought that initiates are able to foresee in the higher worlds what is realized only in the future for the lower world. The seven messages represent the meaning of Christianity for the present age; the seven seals represent what is now being prepared for the future through Christianity. The future is veiled, sealed to the uninitiated; in initiation it is unsealed. When the earthly period is over, during which the seven messages hold good, a more spiritual time will begin. Then life will no longer flow on as it appears in physical shapes, but even outwardly it will be a copy of its supersensible forms. These latter are represented by the four animals and the other images contained in the seals. In a yet more distant future appears that form of the earth which the initiate experiences through the trumpets. Thus the initiate prophetically experiences what is to happen. And one who is initiated in the Christian sense experiences how the Christ impulse penetrates and continues to work in earthly life.
GA008

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When we look to the great leaders of humankind who are our pathfinders, we look to them as leaders who will show us how to go beyond the evolution of races in order to dwell in bodies that are more perfect in the future. The fact that a human being can say: I want to stay where I am! is expressed in a legend that has lived for a long time and found various explanations. However, it is really only explained by Theosophy. Think of the pathfinder whom we call Christ Jesus, the one who points to the passage in the Apocalypse we have just discussed. It is the passage he most often refers to—the place where he speaks of the overcoming of death. When you find human souls sitting along the way who are not interested in evolving—what do they experience? They must again and again be born in the same race because they have rejected the signal from the redeemer. This tragedy is expressed in the Ahasuerus legend;1 Ahasuerus, “the wandering Jew,” created his own destiny because he had pushed the redeemer away from himself.

We must, then, distinguish between the evolution of the soul and the evolution of races; and we are shown how souls climb ever higher. But we are also shown how races sink deeper and deeper in a terrible way.

We have now explained how present day evolution is described in the seven letters. We think of the letters as directed to the seven communities of our earth.

If we ascend higher we arrive at the place where the astral pictures go over into the devachanic, to the sounding of the trumpets. The Ahasuerus human beings form one group of humanity; the others will be those who can enter into other beings. Now, it will appear obvious to us that what has fallen behind must be described with pictures that can only be described as repulsive. While the souls that have developed further are hearing the trumpets, the others will have achieved the peak of egotistical

development. Those who have advanced, who have developed their souls, will live like lofty initiates today.
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All of this is really secreted in the Apocalypse. And if one takes these ideas in the Apocalypse that are given as Imaginations, they sometimes cut into one's heart in a terrible way. It's really horrible the way he talks about all kinds of suffering that will befall mankind on earth with regard to our age; we can only say that a great deal of this is already here as far as the spiritual aspects go.

Then of course there are mildly grand ideas like the angels who come down with incense and a censer. There's a reference to the smoke of incense. Then our gaze immediately falls upon a great deal which happened at the time of the Crusades. The trumpets go back to the Crusades. What we see in the sphere of the consciousness soul enters the consciousness soul of humanity during the Crusades epoch.

Here one finds that consciousnesses of individual personalities arise during the time of the Crusades and what is connected with this, who really had tremendously strong impressions from their experiences of the spiritual world. Here we really meet what I would like to call geniuses of piety. It's very important for us to realize that we meet geniuses of, religiousness there.
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**Chapter 9.**

GA104a
In the first age of earth’s last great culture, during the first trumpet call, our earth will become desolate as described in the seventh verse of the eighth chapter. With the second trumpet call, a great mountain burning with fire was thrown into the sea. With the third trumpet call a great star fell from heaven, blazing like a torch, and made life on earth bitter. The senses of the people then will become weaker; sun, moon, and stars will be darkened. Three cries of woe will be heard, then the last three physical states will arise. A star falls from heaven and the earth is in such a tumultuous upset that it is devastated. The physical earth is a place of punishment for those who have grown together with it. When the sixth trumpet sounds an angel speaks down from heaven: “Release the four angels who are bound at the great river Euphrates.” (Rev. 9:14) What lives on the earth and has not developed itself spiritually is intended here. Those human beings who have taken Yahweh-Christ into themselves will allow one another to exist in their individuality. Each of them will have risen above what remains of group souls at that time. What will still be present as groups will create streams and seas in the astral world. In other words, the astral body will shine and sparkle in the same way the ethnic masses that are individualized only to a small extent today create streams of astral group-soul substance. The teaching of Christ will flow against the Euphrates River. This is the teaching concerning the individuality of the human being, a teaching that has, through the light-impulse of Christ, illuminated the astral bodies of human beings. We see in the fourth Rosicrucian seal the picture of the book swallowed and taken into himself by the writer of the Apocalypse.
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You will be able to connect the stages which are described in the Apocalypse' with outer events. For instance, when Copernicanism takes hold and when materialism sets in one third of the human beings

are killed, that is, they stop developing their full spirituality. And the plague of locusts which is described in the Apocalypse is really very shocking.

This is a terrible truth, which is present, it's a truth, and when the Apocalypticer speaks about the plague of locusts during the trumpets epoch he is referring directly to human beings. Here again one can see how good the Apocalypticer's vision is, for such men in their astral body look exactly the way the Apocalypticer describes them—like etheric locusts with human faces.

It is the time of the Crusades, where we want to point to what was going on in men's consciousnesses, and not so much to the outer events that are described in history books,—it's the time when the seal age gave way to the trumpet age. People with a little depth to them have always had a feeling about the time of the Crusades which made them say: Ah yes, the trumpet sounds; if I look at the thing from supersensible viewpoints it's really terrible what is going on there with respect to human souls. However, men on earth don't hear the trumpets, even though they're there.

A great many people should be aware of this trumpet period, since we're living at the time of the 6th trumpet, and you know what the most important effects and characteristics of this trumpet are. We're told that a third part of the men are killed, as I mentioned. Of course this doesn't happen all at once. But this killing refers to the absence of an ego in those men who had already been prepared previously through their locust forms.
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**Chapter 10.**

GA008
And after it has been shown how everything that clings too closely to the transitory to attain true Christianity has met with death, there appears the mighty angel with a little scroll open in his hand, and which he gives to John (chapter 10, verse 9): “And he said to me Take it, and eat: it will be bitter to your stomach but sweet in your mouth like honey.” John was not only to read the little scroll; he was to absorb it, letting its contents permeate him. What avails any cognition unless man is vitally and thoroughly permeated by it? Wisdom should become life; man should not merely perceive the divine, but become divine himself. Such wisdom as is written in the scroll no doubt causes pain to the transitory nature: “it will be bitter to your stomach;” but so much the more does it make the eternal part happy: “but it will be sweet in your mouth like honey.”
GA008

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The evolution of our Earth is based on two things. Our Earth was preceded by what we call the Cosmos of Wisdom, and that was preceded by what we call—the word doesn’t say much, of course, but we must use it because it has become commonplace—the Cosmos of Strength, of Power. Wisdom and strength are what the Earth has inherited from earlier stages of development, from the old Moon and the old Sun. We shall see how this is also expressed within our Earth’s evolution by the fact that we name the first half of Earth’s evolution after the representative of solar power, Mars. For now we need only consider that within our Earth’s evolution, we have in Mars that which implanted iron into the Earth. We see in Mars the bringer of strength. And in that which governs the second half of Earth’s evolution, we have the representative of the old lunar evolution, Mercury, which incorporates into the Earth the Moon’s ancient legacy: wisdom. Thus, Earth’s evolution is composed of Mars- and Mercury-based development. It has inherited two strong, mighty forces. What it has inherited from the cosmos of strength is expressed in Mars, and what it has inherited from the cosmos of wisdom is expressed in

Mercury. The Earth itself is to bring forth love through its mission. This love is to reveal itself gloriously as the result of Earth's evolution. This is a very profound thought of the Apocalyptic writer. It is the profound thought that, moreover, ties in with the rest of Earth's evolution. (See the image of the fourth seal.)

Once again, join me in traveling back to the earliest Atlantean era—that time we spoke of when the air was still permeated with water. Human beings were still adapted to life in water. It was not until the middle of the Atlantean epoch that they had advanced far enough to break free from the water and set foot on solid ground. Up until the time when the Earth was in the middle of its development, we must regard water as the medium of human development just as much as we later regard solid earth. Solid earth, so to speak, only became the stage for human life relatively late. It is only half true to speak of the whole of Atlantis as if it were dry land. In many respects, it was not covered by the sea, but by a sort of intermediate state—such as air densely filled with water—and this water-air belonged to the element in which humankind lived. Only later did humankind become capable of living in the open air and standing on solid ground. This was, relatively speaking, not so long ago. So when we survey the Earth's evolution, we can say, symbolically speaking: On one side we have the Earth, and on the other side we have water. That is the earlier period. And from the water emerges one of the forces up to the first half of evolution, and from the Earth emerges the other of the forces. Up to the middle of the fourth period, we speak of the forces of Mars—the forces provided, so to speak, by the water—and we speak of the forces of Mercury in the later period, when the solid earth provides the supporting forces. This fits quite well with the idea that human beings are supported throughout their entire earthly mission by two pillars—those two pillars that you saw symbolically in the hall at the Munich Congress. These two pillars represent the two parts of the earthly mission, the two legacies that human beings have inherited from earlier times. And above them is symbolized that which is to be achieved through the Earth itself: love, living itself out, revealing itself in all its glory, supported by these legacies.

This is indeed how the apocalyptic writer describes it—as it appears to the person who ascends into spiritual realms. That is why what confronts us when we look beyond the Earth—what confronts us at the moment when the substance of the Earth dissolves its matter into the spiritual—is symbolically represented by what we see in the fourth seal. Of course, it must now appear in reverse, because it represents the future. We see the two forces that the Earth has inherited from the cosmos—wisdom and strength— and everything that manifests as the fulfillment of the Earth's mission appears to us as the power of love that humanity cultivates; and the whole appears to us as the personification of the human being of the future, so that the human being of the future, supported by these two forces and permeated by this power of love, symbolically confronts us here. The message of love—the book he holds before him—is a book that not only exerts an influence from the outside but one that he is to devour. There we see set before us the mighty image that appears to us here. "And I saw another angel of power"—that is, a being depicted in this way because it already stands above modern humanity—"coming down from the spiritual spheres," as the seer sees it, "clothed in a cloud, and his face was like the sun, and his feet like pillars, pillars of fire." These are the two forces we have spoken of, which the Earth has received as an inheritance. "And he had a little book open in his hand; and he set his right foot on the sea and his left on the earth." And John said to the angel, "Give me the little book." "And he said to me, 'Take it and eat it; and it will make your stomach churn, but in your mouth it will be sweet as honey.' — And I took the little book from the angel's hand and ate it; and it was sweet in my mouth as honey."

Here we have what must be revealed to us as the sensation that arises in the seer when he directs his gaze to the point where the Earth transitions from the physical-material to the astral-spiritual, where the Earth's mission is fulfilled. And when the seer sees this, he learns what is truly connected to this message of love, which entered as an impulse on the fourth stage of civilization: he learns already in

this present life, just as the apocalyptic writer learned, what bliss is and what can be set before humanity as bliss. But he learns it precisely in his present body; for even if a being of the highest order were to wish to live among human beings, it would have to incarnate in the flesh. And in many respects, the present body—precisely because it offers the spirit the possibility of ascending to great heights—also offers the possibility of suffering. Thus, while the soul of the seer—as described by the apocalyptic writer—can ascend into spiritual realms to receive the Gospel of love and can experience bliss in the spirit as sweet as honey, the seer nevertheless lives in a present-day body; and accordingly, he must express that the ascent within this present-day body evokes, in many respects, the opposite of that bliss. He expresses this by saying that the little book, even though it was as sweet as honey when he swallowed it, causes him fierce pains in his stomach. But this is only a faint reflection of what it means to be "crucified in the body." The higher the spirit ascends, the more difficult it becomes for it to dwell in the body. And this is, first and foremost, the symbolic expression for these pains: "To be crucified in the body."
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How did the human being become a knower? The answer is connected with the inhalation of air through the lungs, where the "used" blue blood is transformed into red blood. In this way the human being could take up the Odem, the breath of God. This is the becoming of the individual human I: through the infiowing of the Odem of God through which the human being became a knowing soul. A real tree is actually incorporated in the human being, a tree you can still see today if you study the human body. This is the tree created by the main arteries, which branch off into smaller and smaller capillaries throughout the entire body. There is no being in the world that can become a knowing being if it cannot, like a human being, take up the oxygen from the air—the oxygen that is so necessary to create red blood—so that human beings can take into themselves the tree of knowledge through the red blood.

The other tree, the tree of blue veins, has been taken away from the human being in terms of human mastery over it. It contains the used, blue blood which is a poison, filled with death. Before the human being descended from the bosom of God, it was the tree of life. By becoming earthly, the human being was divided into two parts, comprising the veinal and arterial, the blue and the red blood vessel systems. The blue blood streams up to the heart and must unite with what the plants give. The human being breathes out carbon dioxide; plants breathe in carbon dioxide and breathe out oxygen. In this way human breathing, which expresses itself in our actual "I-ness," is an intertwining of the red and blue "blood trees." This is, however, only possible if the human being has a tool, and that is the plant, without which the human being cannot live. The plant is what allows us to intertwine the blue and the red "blood trees."

The alchemy of the human being is this: what the plants do for us today, human beings in the future will be able to accomplish within and through their consciousness. What is outside the human being today will be intertwined within the physical body when we have taken in the entire plant world, when we have expanded our consciousness to include the entire world of plants. That is the future condition of humanity. Then, what exists outside in the natural world surrounding us will be entirely different.

Our entire cosmos will be changed with us. Earlier conditions will return at a higher level. There was a time when the earth and the sun were united with one another. At that time the human being existed within the being of the sun. But by entering into a physical body, the human being actually left the Mars state—and it is this state that someday humankind will once again attain. At that time the tree of life and the tree of knowledge were intertwined; at that time the human being did not need any external

tool. That will be the case again in the future. What humankind will have then attained has always been indicated symbolically by drawing the sun, and then indicating the earth at a higher stage of development—with the human being also more highly developed. What will bring human beings to that point is the union of the red and blue bloodstreams by means of an expanded consciousness. This is indicated with two metal pillars—those are the two bloodstreams—and the sun is what will be ... [omission in manuscript]. Then the blue blood tree will no longer be a tree of death.

The seer must see this condition in astral signs. To describe this condition the writer of the Apocalypse must indicate it with pictures. “Then I saw another mighty angel coming down from heaven wrapped in a cloud, with a rainbow over his head, and his face was like the sun and his feet were like pillars of fire.” (Rev. 10:1) We have here a picture of this condition. In the same way the entire Apocalypse is composed with occult signs.

What human beings take into themselves as spiritual substance and teaching will be their soul and spiritual life blood in the future. It will be the light that will ray forth from them as spirit. The human being stands firmly as on two feet—one foot on the Atlantean, the other on the post-Atlantean culture, as it were: on water and on earth. But humankind must take in wisdom, like swallowing a book. This figure points toward the spiritual world, he gives the book to the writer of the Apocalypse. He is supposed to swallow it. It will be indigestible for the lower human being but like honey for the higher, when it is not read but swallowed. Human beings equipped with modern logical thinking who have also become clairvoyant through occult training can also experience what the writer of the Apocalypse described. They can see the visions of the writer of the Apocalypse in the Rosicrucian seals. The seal with the two pillars is portrayed in the tenth chapter of the Apocalypse.
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However, what lives strongly in our time appears before the clairvoyant eye of the Apocalypticer as a figure that forms out of the clouds, has a face like a sun, goes over into a rainbow, and has fiery feet, of which one is planted on the ocean and the other on the earth. One could say that this is really the most significant vision that the present-day human soul should look at. For the thoughts that belong to spirit land are in the face which is born out of the clouds above. The rainbow is the feeling world in man's soul which belongs to the soul world. What is contained in the bodies of men who belong to the physical world is in the fiery feet that get their strength from the power of the earth which is covered by the ocean.

One could say that this points to a real cultural secret of the present, which is that there are three kinds of men, and not that each man is split into three parts. One can see this very clearly today. We have cloud men who can only think, whereas the two other parts—rainbow and fiery feet—remain stunted. We have rainbow men where the main development is in the feelings. They can only grasp Anthroposophy with their feelings and not with their minds. However, this type is also present in the outside world and not just in the Anthroposophical Society. They can only grasp the world with their feelings. These people's feelings are well developed but their thinking and will are stunted. Then there are people today who act as if they only had a hypertrophically developed will; their thinking and feeling are stunted; they charge like bulls and act in accordance with direct, outer impulses,—they're the fiery footed men.

The vision of John the Apocalypticer depicts these three kinds of men which we meet in life. We should become aware of this secret of our present-day civilization so that we can look at human beings in the right way. One can also discover them if one looks at larger world events.

Just look at what is, happening in Russia. We have the influence of the cloud man, of the man who mainly thinks, in whom feeling and will are neglected. They would like to surrender their will to a social mechanism, and their feelings are used by Ahrimanic powers because they don't have any control over them. They are thinkers, but since man on earth is organized in an Ahrimanic and Luciferic way, their thinking is like - - I will use an analogy that will seem like a perfectly natural one to anyone who knows spiritual science; it will only scare such people away who haven't worked their way into this kind of thing yet. If one takes the thoughts of Lenin and the others and one looks at these thoughts, that is, if one tries to imagine what the combined thoughts of Lenin, Trotsky, Lunacharski, etc., looks like, if one imagines what is growling and raging in the heads of leading Russians today, one gets what one calls a system of forces in physics. If one was a gigantic elemental spirit one could form clouds and arouse thunder and lightning up in the sky over a large territory with these forces. But they don't belong on earth. This image might surprise you, but anyone who can look into the occult depths of existence must say that the same forces that weave and live in the heads of leading Russians are also in the lightning that is formed in the clouds over our heads and that they flash the lightning down to the earth and roll the thunders. This is where these forces belong. Their action in leading Bolsheviks is out of place.

Now the people who stand within their race in such a way that they're really cloud men are confronted by others who are rainbow men. Their thinking is relatively inactive, they mainly like to use traditional thoughts and they are rather timid about approaching the spiritual world with their thoughts. One meets a large number of such rainbow men in central European regions.

Thinking and feeling get increasingly stunted the further we go west, where we find a pathological development of fiery footed men. One finds large numbers of such fiery footed human beings in the western part of Europe and presumably in America. So that we can divide the earth along these lines: In the east there are many cloud men, in the center many rainbow men, and in the west many fiery footed men.

If we take racial developments into account, one could say that something like a picture of the figure which we encounter here in the Apocalypticer is spread out over the earth, if one looks at it, spiritually from outside. One can't do this in a balloon or airplane, but if one would raise oneself up spiritually into the heights from a point in Westphalen and would look down at the earth, Asia would have a kind of a cloud form face with solar shapes, and one would see rainbow colors spread out over Europe, and further over would be the fiery feet, with one planted on the Andes in South America and the other in the Pacific Ocean. And then one has the earth underneath this image.

This is one of the most incisive prophecies that the Apocalypticer has for our time. This is something that is very important for priestly activities, for the great riddle of our time that developed with Napoleon consists of this. This striving of men into races and nations that has come to expression so incomprehensibly throúgh Wilsonianism today really only arose in a distinct way under the influence of Napoleonism, of the first Napoleon. The way that men are striving towards races and nations and the way that they basically want to bury all cosmopolitanism today is really quite terrible. But the reason for this is that this passage through the threshold, place is occurring.

Just as a human being splits up in the spiritual world when he develops further, so men on earth split up into regions that individual human beings remain unaware of, namely, into cloud men, rainbow men and fiery footed men. This splitting of men into three parts—which I described for individuals in How Does One Attain Knowledge of the Higher Worlds?, has occurred for humanity on earth; it's here. The

powerful sign which the Apocalypticer sketches is there in Asia, Europe, and the Americas. People cannot find the harmony between the three parts at first, and so they look for things in the split rather than in the union; which sometimes leads to rather strange results.
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**Chapter 11.**

GA008
Only through such an initiation can Christianity become actual on the earth. It kills everything belonging to the lower nature. “And their dead bodies will lie in the square of the great city, which spiritually is called Sodom and Egypt, where also their Christ was crucified.” This refers to the believers in Christ. They will be mistreated by the powers of the transitory world. But it is only the transitory members of human nature that will be ill treated, which the true essence will then have conquered. Thereby their destiny is a copy of the exemplary fate of Christ Jesus. “Spiritually Sodom and Egypt” is the symbol of a life which clings to the external and does not change itself through the Christ impulse. Christ is everywhere crucified in the lower nature. Where this lower nature conquers, everything remains dead. Human corpses cover the squares of the cities. Those who overcome the lower nature and bring about an awakening of the crucified Christ, hear the trumpet of the seventh angel: “The kingdoms of the world have become the kingdom of our Lord and of his Christ; and he shall reign from cosmic age to cosmic age” (chapter 11, verse 15). “And the temple of God in heaven was opened, and the ark of his covenant was seen within his temple” (verse 9). In the conception of these events the initiate sees the old struggle between the lower and higher nature renewed. For everything the neophyte formerly had to go through must be repeated in the one who follows the Christian path.
GA008

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What, then, must a person do to give a worthy form to the future embodiment of our Earth? They must ensure that the work they are now able to perform consciously is carried out in a Christ-like manner, so that the etheric body—which will be a reflection of this work—may integrate itself in a worthy manner into the spiritualized Earth. All parts of this body will be as human beings have made them. Whatever humanity has made of its physical body, it will bring into this spiritual Earth, and whatever takes shape from this will be the foundation for its further development. Just as your present soul develops within your present body—which you have inherited from the Moon—so will the future soul develop within whatever you yourselves make of your body. That is why the body—that which clothes and envelops the soul, the “I,” and which is inhabited by this “I”—is called the temple of the inner “I,” the temple of the divinity living within the human being, the temple of God. Thus, as you shape this body, you are building a future temple—that is, the new embodiment of the Earth. You build Jupiter in the correct proportions by shaping the human body in the right way. What, then, must come to light when the Earth has reached its destination? A temple of the soul that is harmonious in every respect. Therefore, the initiate is given the task of examining this temple, which humanity will then have built. The fact that the soul has done what is right will become evident when this temple of God is measured. “And a reed was given to me, like a measuring rod, and he said: ‘Arise and measure the temple of God and the altar and those who worship there. But cast out the outer court outside the temple!’” (Chapter 11, 1.) This means: Everything that was there for preparation must be cast out of the temple. Human beings first had to possess a physical body and an etheric body before they could work within it. This physical body and the etheric body—these are the outer court: they must fall away; cast them out. —That which human beings have created on their own, they retain. This is the temple in which new beings are to dwell during the age of Jupiter.

So we are living on a Earth that has become spiritual. We see how this Jupiter era is already being prepared in an exemplary way. We see, as a foreshadowing, how human beings bring with them the fruits of their earthly existence. And now we must be clear that, within this spiritual state of the Earth at a higher stage of development, everything that was there before reappears. Above all, the bearers of the spiritual currents upon which the Earth rests—and from which it emerged—reappear. The bearers of these currents reappear as living beings. In Elijah and Moses—if we follow the Christian tradition—we see the personal representatives of what appeared to us yesterday in the two pillars. Those who impart the teachings of the two pillars are regarded in Christian esotericism as Elijah and Moses. Elijah was the one who brought humanity the message from the one pillar, the pillar of strength; Moses was the one who brought it from the pillar of wisdom. “Moses” means wisdom or truth, and “Elijah” means—well, it is difficult to express the word in German—the guiding force, that which provides direction and impulse. Thus we see these two appearing in the world that has become spiritual, specifically at the stage of development they will have reached by then. For just as Christ appeared between Moses and Elijah during the “Transfiguration” according to Christian tradition, so the entire process at the end of Earth’s evolution appears in such a way that the Sun—the spiritual Sun of Love, the revelation of love’s mission on Earth—appears, supported by the Sun-Mars and Moon-Mercury, by Elijah and Moses. Just as we saw yesterday the two pillars that first appear before the initiate as symbols of strength and wisdom, with the Sun of Love above them, so can we now imagine the Earth’s evolution a step further; and in its liveliness, in its personal character, what constitutes one pillar will appear to us as Elijah, the other as Moses, and what lies above them as the actual Christ principle.
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The more humanity advances, the more energy is necessary in order to spiritualize those who have been left behind. For this reason those who are the most deeply initiated, Moses and Elijah, are called. Powerful forces are needed. Because they were already deeply initiated, they will be able in that distant future to stand so high that they will be able to work in a very special way. However, karma is a law to which all are subject; therefore, those who were initiated before the event of Golgotha must make up for the following.

The three and a half days required for initiation in ancient times were lost days in the initiates' development. Initiates had to leave their bodies during these three and a half days. Therefore, the I could not work on the transformation of its physical body, its etheric body, and its astral body. For this reason, in the future they must leave their physical body to the external world for three and a half days. Hence, we read, “For three days and a half ... gaze at their dead bodies.” (Rev. 11:9) Even the deeds that are sacrifices for humanity must find their cosmic compensation.

I have told you that initiates progress through various stages. They must transform not only something of their astral body, but also something of their etheric body, and even something of their physical body. In earlier times initiates were kept in a state such that their etheric body existed outside their physical body for three and one-half days while the physical body lay there as if dead. Meanwhile, the hierophant lead the etheric body through higher worlds.

The writer of the Apocalypse describes to us what a present-day initiate experiences. He describes it as something similar to the initiation process of three and one-half days. Remember that there is actually a passage in the Apocalypse that says two witnesses of God appear, who lie as if dead for three and one-half days and then again become alive: “... and those who dwell on the earth will rejoice over them and make merry and exchange gifts, because these two prophets had been a torment to those who dwell on

the earth. But after three and one-half days a breath of life from God entered them, and they stood up on their feet, and great fear fell on those who saw them." (Rev. 11:10,11) The Apocalypse speaks of these two prophets in addition to the leader of humankind, whom the people could see. You have here a description of a process of initiation. You see how everything fits together.
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So you see that the Apocalypticer clearly foresaw many things that are present in our time. And he knew that such an epochal period of time can be indicated with a number. I myself have indicated the approximate number of years which the development of the consciousness soul, intellectual or mind soul, etc., covers. I said that such a period lasts one twelfth of 25.920 years.

Now the place in the Apocalypse to which I'm referring gave me quite a bit of trouble for a while. For the Apocalypticer supposedly prophesies about things that will take one thousand two hundred and threescore days. They used to speak of days when they meant years. Anyway, the Apocalypticer mentions the number 1260. It took a lot of intensive research to discover that the 1260 days is really a printing error, as it were, in the Apocalypse that was handed down. It should say 2160 days. Then it agrees with what one can see today. It's quite possible that an un-clarity arose in some school where the things were handed down, because many numbers look like their mirror images to seers. However, this is something that is not too important when one feels one's way into the Apocalypse.

One has to be able to look at contemporary human beings in accordance with these categories in order to see the kind of crap game that is being played, although of course this is based on world karma. Here we must look at the age—which is really ours—which can say of itself that it is entering ever more into men's consciousness and into the consciousness soul. People previously saw the starry script written outside; they saw the contents of old traditions and old wisdom written outside. There is a kind of a memory of this man who is split into three in ancient books. Everything which the wise men proclaimed about the world in the mystery centers in Macedonia, Greece, Ephesus, Samothrace, Delphi and in other places in Asia Minor and elsewhere is the book which is preserved from ancient times, which is in the hand of the angel whose face is fashioned out of clouds, his chest out of a rainbow, and his feet out of fire, and he stands firmly in America with the rest of his body spread out over Europe and Asia. However, as consciousness men we can only keep this active and alive for ourselves if we have to look within ourselves for the source which enables us to learn how to see spiritual things. We must devour the book, which could previously only be brought from outside, and bring it into ourselves. This book which contains the world's secrets is sweet in the mouths of some people at first. People like to come to things which can give them spiritual views; so that they taste like honey to them. But as soon as one has to fulfill the exacting conditions in life which are connected with a spiritual comprehension of the world then what the Apocalypticer says is sweet as honey becomes a stomach ache, especially to the people who have become so materialistic today. These people find that the digestion of the spiritual nourishment that is so necessary for them is painful.

If we look at this, we have to admit that all of this dice throwing and confusion indicates that a force which can measure everything in a new way must come from the spiritual power that can be seen in threefold man. A reed, or really a measuring rod, is sent down from heaven, with which everything is to be measured in a new way. Just look at our time. Doesn't everything have to be measured anew? Shouldn't we add something like a cloud shape to that abstract Asian shape that we find on our maps, rainbow colors to Europe and fiery feet to the Americas? Don't we have to measure everything anew from the viewpoint of the spiritual life? After all, we're right m the midst of what the Apocalypse is showing us here.

GA346

**Chapter 12.**

GA008
As once Osiris was threatened by the evil Typhon, so now the “great Dragon, the old Serpent” (chapter 12, verse 9) must be overcome. The woman, the human soul, gives birth to lower knowledge, which is an adverse power if it does not raise itself to wisdom. Man must pass through that lower knowledge. Here in the Apocalypse it appears as the “old Serpent.” In all mystical wisdom from the remotest times the serpent has been the symbol of cognition. Man may be led astray by this serpent, by cognition, if he does not bring to life in him the Son of God who crushes the serpents head. “And the great Dragon was thrown out, that old Serpent, whose name is Devil, and Satan, the deceiver of the whole world: he was thrown down to the earth, and his angels were thrown down with him” (chapter 12, verse 9).

In these words one can read what Christianity would be. A new method of initiation. In a new form was to be attained what had been attained in the Mysteries. In them also the serpent had to be overcome. But this was no longer to take place in the same way. The one, the archetypal Mystery, the Christian Mystery, was to replace the many Mysteries of antiquity. Jesus, in whom the Logos became flesh, was to become the Initiator of the whole of humanity. And this humanity was to become his own community of mystics. Not a separation of the elect but a linking together of all is to occur. Each is to be able to become a mystic according to his maturity. The message sounds forth to all; he who has an ear, hastens to learn the secrets. The voice of the heart is to decide in each individual case.

This or that person is not to be introduced individually into the Mystery temples, but the word is to be spoken to all; then some will be able to hear it more clearly than others. It will be left to the daemon, the angel within each human breast, to decide how far he can be initiated. The whole world is a Mystery temple. Blessing is not only to come to those who *see* the wonderful processes in the special temples for initiation, processes which give them a guarantee of the eternal, but “Blessed are they who have not seen, and yet *believe*.” Even if at first they grope in the dark, nevertheless the light may come to them later. Nothing is to be withheld from anyone; the way is to be open to all.
GA008

GA104
If we now turn our gaze away from the Earth itself—from what is on it—and consider it in the context of the entire celestial sphere, we arrive at a very important point precisely at the moment we are now discussing. The Earth and the Sun were a single body. The Earth developed out of the Sun, and the Moon broke away. We have said that this had to happen in order to ensure the proper pace of development. But now that human beings have passed through these stages of development—having become spiritualized—they are ready to reunite with the forces present on the Sun. They can keep pace with the Sun. An important cosmic process is now taking place: the Earth is reuniting with the Sun. While what we have discussed is unfolding, the Earth is uniting with the Sun. We have said that the solar spirits descended to Earth at the event of Golgotha. We have said that this Christ principle will bring things as far as we have been able to describe. Now the Earth is ripening to unite with the Sun. And what was necessary to ensure that evolution does not proceed too rapidly—the Moon—will be overcome; humanity no longer needs it. The Moon’s powers will be overcome. In this age, humanity can unite with the Sun. Humanity will live within the spiritualized Earth and at the same time be connected to the power of the Sun, and humanity will be the conqueror of the Moon. This is depicted, as it is perceived, by the symbolic figure of the fifth seal: the woman who bears the Sun within her and has the Moon at her feet. We have arrived at the point where humanity is spiritualized, where humanity

once again unites with the forces of the Sun, where the Earth and the Sun are one body, and where the forces of the Moon will be overcome. (See the image of the fifth seal.)
GA104

GA104a
We stand now in the fifth sub-race of the fifth root race and are living toward the sixth and seventh sub-race, then the sixth ground-race. What does it mean to say that we are living toward these races? 4 It means that an understanding of Christ is contained in the sixth epoch—be it in the sixth epoch of the sixth subrace prophetically announced, or the sixth root race—for the human being who wants it. At that time there will be human beings who are Christ filled, who have been sealed; in the ages of future spirituality the opening up, the breaking of the seals of human souls will take place. That the five wise virgins have oil burning in their lamps, that the bridegroom finds illuminated souls, signifies that a portion of humanity will have revealed to it the mystery that is still today closed to humankind. The book with the seven seals will be deciphered for a portion of humankind. The writer of the Apocalypse, John, wants through signs to point to this time, wants to proclaim prophetically this age.

In one sentence we read: “And a great sign appeared in heaven ...” (Rev. 12:1) That means we are dealing in the Apocalypse with signs representing the great phases of the evolution of humanity. We must then decipher these signs. We remember that our present fifth root race was preceded by the Atlantean race, which was destroyed by a flood. What will destroy the fifth race? The fifth race has a special task: the development of egotism. This egotism will, at the same time, create what causes the downfall of the fifth root race. A small part of humankind will live toward the sixth main race; a larger part will not yet have found the light within. Because egotism is the fundamental power in the soul, the war of all against all will rage within this larger part of humanity. As the Lemurian race found its end through the power of fire, the Atlantean through water, so will the fifth race find its destruction in conflict between selfish, egoistic powers in the war of all against all. This line of evolution will descend deeper and deeper; when it arrives at the bottom everyone will rage against everyone else. A small part of humankind will escape this, just as a small part escaped during the destruction of the Atlantean race. It is up to every individual to find a connection to the spiritual life in order to be one of those to go over into the sixth root race. Mighty revolutions stand before humankind; they are described in the Apocalypse.

Repetitions such as we have seen in the evolution of the earth come again and again. The Atlantean culture will resurrect, spiritualized and raised into the heights, in the age of the seals when humankind will have consciously reacquired clairvoyance. In the age of the trumpets the Lemurian age will resurrect; human beings will be close to God, they will have completely spiritualized themselves. In the Lemurian age the earth still existed entirely within the element of fire. Human beings lived in fire before descending into a dense bodily nature—this will be repeated in a spiritual state. When the seventh trumpet sounds forth a kind of blessed state will come upon humanity. Then we come to a repetition of the time when the sun was separated from the earth. The human being, together with the earth, will have advanced to the time when the sun again unites with the earth. The earth will pass over into what is called an astral state. Human beings able to live in the astral world will raise up the finer part of the earth and then be united with the sun. The portion of the earth that has remained coarse will be united with the moon to form a new kind of moon. The kind of conditions prevailing during the Hyperborean age will enter in again, but at a higher stage of evolution. This is characterized by the woman clothed with the sun and having the moon at her feet. The beasts that rise up out of the sea or fall from heaven also belong to this whole stream of evolution that is pictured, as if captured in a moment of time. (Rev. 12:1–13:10)

If we consider that the human physical body was prepared for the human being during the ancient Saturn state, the etheric body during the Sun state, the astral body during ancient Moon, then we see how, in its way, this physical body is the most perfect member. It is the most evolved. If we could look into the miraculous structure of the physical heart, or the brain that is structured and organized with so much wisdom that physical science has not yet solved the riddles it presents, we would recognize this. The astral body is, indeed, a higher member but far less perfect; the etheric body has been perfected more than the astral but less than the physical. The I is the least perfect of all. For example, how little does the I understand the structures of the physical body.
GA104a

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We can say that man perceives divine things in solids and fluids during the Atlantean epoch (of course this is more in outer, physical matter), that in the fourth post Atlantean or Græco-Roman age man perceives spiritual things in wonderful aeriform, fluidic formations, and that now in the fifth post Atlantean age men's consciousness souls will become aware of aeriform, fiery things and aeriform, warm things which will appear more and more. This will permit something to arise before men in mighty pictures which the Greeks experienced in a soul way and the inhabitants of Atlantis experienced in a physical way.

Thus a time is approaching in human evolution when visions which have the clarity of thought will arise concerning past times on earth and thereby concerning the origin of man and everything which is connected with this. The appearance of the Darwinistic view which gave man a lowly origin on the basis of mere inferences precedes the inner perception of evolution, the wonderful Imaginations which will arise from the inner warmth which is connected with man's breathing process; they will arise like concrete, significant, colored visionary thoughts. Man will know what he was when he looks into a kind of a reflection of the Græco-Roman age and then behind this into what existed in Atlantis. This perception that is of considerable interest for us because it will begin soon is something where we look right into the Apocalypticer's heart, because it is so close to us. For this kind of perception which is almost upon us is what he indicates in a picture: a woman clothed with the sun, a dragon under her feet, giving birth to a baby boy.

And in fact the eyes of many human beings will be opened by this Imagination during the course of this century. Much understanding will radiate from this picture, and it is one which shines back into the Græco-Roman age where it was prepared at the soul level and brought into the shape in which it will appear in the near future, and where it took on a great variety of forms. There was Isis with the Horus child, and metamorphoses of this as the Christ-bearer with the Christ child, that lived in a wonderfully profound way precisely in the Græco-Roman age. They have been handed down through traditions.

In the near future men will look back at the way in which people saw such things in the clouds, that is, in aeriform-fluidic things during the fourth post Atlantean age. And they will also look back even further to what lived in physical, Atlantean events. It will be as if this picture of a sun-clad woman who gives birth to a little boy and who has a dragon under her feet was like the eyepiece of a spiritual telescope which points to something physical lying far back in the past which occurred between the earth and the planets and the sun sphere; earthly, physical things were connected much more closely with cosmic things at that time.

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Now let's add something else to this. Someone who grasps the world's secrets since the Mystery of Golgotha with initiation science will look upon the Christ as the sun being who was united with the sun before the Mystery of Golgotha. When the priests in the mysteries wanted to connect themselves with the Christ in pre-Christian times they looked up to the sun. Christ has become an earth spirit since the Mystery of Golgotha. We must look for Christ the sun spirit in earthly life and in earthly activities. Those who wanted to see him and commune with him before the Mystery of Golgotha had to raise themselves up to the sun.

However, this sun spirit which we must look upon as a male being when it came down to earth, is described in a brilliant way in the Apocalypticer s vision, through a vision that stands before us in an almost material form; similar events in earlier ages can also be described in this way, and I have often done so. It stands there as a splendid physical vision in the middle of the Atlantean epoch. After this point in time the wise men in the mysteries looked up to the sun, and they saw the Christ developing and becoming mature in the sun until he could go through the Mystery of Golgotha. However, when they looked back to this point in Atlantean evolution they saw a birth taking place outside in the cosmos in the sun.

For the priests who saw the Christ as a male being in the sun after his birth in the middle of the Atlantean period saw a female being in the sun before that. This is the important change that occurred in the middle of the Atlantean period. Before the middle of the Atlantean epoch one saw a cosmic woman in the sun's spiritual aura, the woman who was clothed with the sun. This woman who was clothed with the sun corresponded to what was happening in the heavens above the earth at that time, and as the Apocalypticer rightly describes it, she gives birth to a little boy, who is the same being that went through the Mystery, although it went through other forms beforehand. A kind of a birth which was really just a complicated metamorphosis took place at that time in the Atlantean period. One could see how the female sun gave birth to something that was male—to her son. Now what does this mean for the earth? Of course in the middle of the Atlantean period one felt much differently about something like the sun existence than one did later.

Today one looks upon the sun as if it were a collection of craters and burning masses; the present-day descriptions of this by physicists are really horrible. But at that time one saw something like what I just described: a real sun-woman with a dragon at her feet, giving birth to a little boy. The ones who saw something like this and understood it said: For the heavens this is the birth of Christ, and for us it is the birth of our ego.

Even though this ego only entered man's inner nature much later; since this point in the middle of Atlantis evolution occurred in such a way that although men were not as conscious of their ego in an elemental way as they are today, they became ever more conscious of it because the mysteries drew their attention to it. The sun enkindled the ego in man. And the sun's action continually enkindled the ego from outside through the birth which had happened along the lines of this Imagination, until the fourth post Atlantean age, when the ego entered into man. People felt this and they felt that man really belongs to the sun; this was a feeling which made a deep impression upon the human soul.

Now that we have become such delicate souls with respect to our inner experiences, we have no idea how stormy and wild soul experiences, were in earlier times. The fact that man's ego was given to him from the cosmos made him feel that his nature had changed completely. Before that he had mainly been dependent upon what was in his astral body. What was in his astrality worked into his soul and spirit, so that during this ancient time man had the idea: He's standing here (drawing), the sun is up there, the ego is not there yet, but the astral works down from the sun. Man has his astral body from the sun, the astral body which is not controlled by the ego and which has somewhat refined emotions but nevertheless animalized ones in it. The man who had become an ego and who had previously had nothing but an astral body bubbling through him had become an entirely different human being. However, all of this came from the sun.

Let's place the picture of the sun as it was at the beginning of the Atlantean period before us in a somewhat schematic way. It was permeated by a lively luster, which bubbled through the lower half of the sun being. Something was born out of this above, and one felt that there was an indistinct face here. Man felt that the emotions that seethed in his own astral body and everything that gave him his spiritual and soul nature originated in the lower part of the sun being. In the next stage men saw the sun like this (drawing). Things develop more clearly here, the face becomes more distinct, the figure begins to look something like a woman, who is to bring man control through the ego. The space down here where the animal elements are wriggling becomes ever smaller. Finally, the time comes when the woman is present in the sun and gives birth to a little boy and now has what was previously further up here under her feet, where the ego-bearing woman in the picture on the sun demonstrates how one controls the dragon—the astral world of the previous epoch—which is now under her feet. The battle of Michael and the dragon began in the sun at that time, and in fact this brought it about—one saw this as a physical phenomenon—that everything which was in the sun slowly moved towards the earth and became an ingredient of the earth. It became an earth content which thereby controlled man in his sub-consciousness, whereas the ego entered ever more into his consciousness.

These cosmic, mythological things that took place during the Atlantean epoch had their counter image in the Græco-Roman age when Isis with the Horus child became the Virgin with her Jesus boy. This will appear in a vision to those who look back in the next age which is almost upon us.

Man will see the sun-clad woman in this picture, who has the dragon under her feet that was thrown down to the earth by Michael, so that it cannot be found in the heavens anymore. This Imagination will appear in the age which will be followed by the one where the dragon is turned loose and where what I described to you yesterday will begin. It's a fact that deepened and extensive perception of past times on earth, man's origins and of the Christ being will soon arise in this Michael age. For Michael will concern himself with what the Apocalypticer points to and which will begin again in the Michaelic age, he will concern himself again with that draconic beast in human nature and in human evolution which he threw down.

When I tried to interpret the Apocalypse in Nuremberg in 1908 it was an entirely different time in the entire Anthroposophical movement. The main thing then was to interpret Anthroposophy by means of the Apocalypse, as it were. One can interpret a great deal through the Apocalypse, and the events in the world which it was important to mention at that time could already be seen in the Apocalypse. However, as I already mentioned a number of times, you should identify yourselves with the Apocalypse and realize that the Apocalypse describes a large number of events which proceed in accordance with multiples of seven. Since I pointed to the events which are connected with the woman clothed with the sun and the dragon under her feet, you will be able to tell in which Apocalyptic point of time we're living from the point of view of the experiences of the consciousness soul.

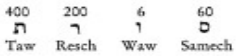
My lectures in 1908 dealt more with the evolution of mankind in general, and with the evolution of the astral body, but with respect to the consciousness soul which doesn't run parallel with the other evolutionary processes, but pushes into them we're really living in the age of the trumpet sounds today.
GA346

**Chapter 13.**

GA096
The symbol of the sun demon is depicted as follows:



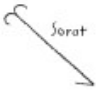
A secret is also hidden in the number of the beast, 666, of which it is also said: “It is the number of a man.” — According to Aramaic esoteric teachings, this number is to be read as follows: 400, 200, 6, 60. These four numbers correspond to the Hebrew letters ת (Tav), ר (Resh), ו (Vav), and ס (Samech). In Hebrew, one reads from right to left:




These letters symbolize the four principles that lead a person to complete hardening if he fails to transform them. Samech expresses the principle of the physical body, Vav that of the etheric body, Resh that of the astral body, and Tav the lower self, which has not risen to the higher self. Read together, they form the word “Sorat.” This is the occult name of the solar demon, the adversary of the Lamb.
GA096

GA101
You all know that there is such a thing as imaginative insight and occult symbols [in which imaginative insight is expressed]. I can only give you two occult symbols at this time. To discuss more would take us too far afield. The occult symbol for those forces that would have acted and set the course for the entire development of the Earth if the Sun had remained united with the Earth—that is, the occult symbol for those forces that would have spiritualized the Earth too soon—is this: In this symbol, the occult student can recognize the forces that would have led humanity rapidly toward spirituality. In contrast, if humanity had separated itself from the Sun along with the entire Earth but remained united with the Moon, it would very quickly have fallen prey to ossification and hardening. Had the Earth retained the Moon within itself, human beings would very soon have become a kind of puppet—marionettes. They would have descended too deeply into matter, just as they would have spiritualized too rapidly on the other hand if the Sun had remained connected to the Earth. Therefore, the Moon had to be separated from the Earth. And all those forces that were expelled and that today rule from the Moon and act upon the Earth from the outside—all these forces are symbolically represented in this sign, which looks like a double hook. This is the sign of the beast or the lamb with two horns from the Apocalypse.




One sign is called Nachiel, the other Sorat. This second sign is also known as the sign of the Earth Demonium. All those powers which the black magician develops through the use of such abominable methods lead, in an occult manner, to an increase on Earth of the forces belonging to the Earth’s demonic nature, forces that lead to the hardening of the Earth. If many people were to become black magicians, the result would be that the Earth would become increasingly similar to the Moon, whereas, on the other hand, through the forces of white magic, the Earth will become increasingly similar to the forces of the Sun, the forces contained in the sun’s rays.

So what would the prevalence of black magic on our Earth lead to? It would lead to the hardening of the globe, to the globe becoming a moon. The same forces that were separated from the moon—forces that had developed from the substance of the Earth—are still present as potential within the Earth's layers. Alongside all the forces that have the potential to become solar forces, there are also still forces present that have the potential to become lunar forces. Through white magic, the Earth is brought ever closer to the nature of the Sun; through the forces of black magic, it is brought closer to the nature of the Moon. Through white magic, everything must be overcome that does not lead, through the path of enlightenment and wisdom, to the mastery of spiritual forces. For all such procedures, such activities, as they have been called, do not lead to the mastery of spiritual powers through the path of wisdom, of insight, or through genuine inner looking; rather, they are eavesdropped upon from nature, by engaging in machinations and procedures with it through which powers are to be attained without enlightenment. Thus, the apocalyptic seal is in fact simultaneously the sign of the overcoming of black magic by white magic. Through the human powers that are transformed, solar powers are born from the human being himself, so that the lunar powers lie at the feet of man.
GA101

GA104
And now we must remember that only the more advanced portion of the beings—the portion imbued with the Christ principle—has undergone this development. They have come this far; but those who have become hardened in matter have fallen away, forming, so to speak, a kind of satellite planet of hardened, materialized matter. Now let us recall how, from an astral perspective, the human being appeared to the clairvoyant before descending to Earth as a physical being. Let us recall that we have specifically pointed out that the human being appeared in the four types of his group soul: in the form of the lion, the eagle, the ox, and the human. These four types of the group soul, so to speak, appear before us before the human being descends into the physical realm, before he becomes individualized. These four typical forms that the human being possessed before entering the physical body are not visible in today's physical human being; they are under the control of the soul. Like rubber, they have been pressed into the human form. In fact, it is true that when a human being is not in control of themselves—when their soul is silent, either because they are asleep or otherwise in a more or less unconscious state—one can still see today how the corresponding animal type emerges. But fundamentally, by descending onto the physical plane, the human being has overcome this animal type. When was human beings given the ability to overcome the animal type in the astral realm?

Let us recall that we spoke of the seven periods of Atlantean development. These seven periods consist of the first four and the last three. During the first four, human beings were still entirely group souls. Then, in the fifth period, the first impulse toward the I-soul arose. We thus have four stages of development in Atlantis in which human beings first evolve as group souls, and each of the first four Atlantean races corresponds to one of the typical animal forms—the lion, the eagle, the calf or bull, and the human. This transitions into the human form during the fifth epoch, when these typical forms fade away. Now imagine that human beings in the present age are permeated by the Christ principle and thereby increasingly overcome the animal nature. But if they are not permeated by the Christ principle, then they do not overcome the animal nature. The four typical heads—lion, eagle, bull, and human—remain, so to speak, as something that his form takes on again when it can emerge once more; and to these are added three others, originating from the last three races of Atlantean development, when humanity had already begun to be human. These three also remain if the human being does not work through his soul to ensure that this animal nature disappears. How, then, will the human being who has not embraced the Christ principle during our time appear on the spiritualized Earth? He will appear in material form; he will reappear in the forms from which he came. He has had these animal forms and has passed through three more besides. What could have overcome the animal nature has now been left

unused by him. The animal nature will emerge once more, in seven forms. Just as the four heads—the animal-man—once appeared in Atlantis, so too will seven such typical heads emerge from the transformed earth, from the astralized earth, and the spectacle that took place back then will repeat itself. The spiritual human was present in potential, but could not yet develop an individual form; instead, it formed the four animal heads. The spiritual human in its potential is also represented for that time by the woman who gives birth to the human. The human of the future is likewise represented by the woman who gives birth to the spiritual human. But that which has remained in the flesh is represented on the "other earth" by the beast with the seven heads. Just as there were four heads back then, before humanity had the ability to overcome its animal nature, so those who have remained in their animal nature appear as a collective whole—as the beast with the seven heads.

Thus, in the future, after the Earth has united with the Sun, while the spiritualized Earth is above, everything below that has not absorbed the spiritual principle will emerge, and the animal heads that once existed will appear again—only now they are out of place. Now they are the adversaries; before, during the time of preparation, they were in their proper time. Thus we see that, just as the monster with the seven heads—the seven-headed beast—once rose from the physical sea, so now it rises from the astral sea—for the Sun, too, has become astralized. Everything that is imprinted in the human being through the etheric body—please bear this in mind—is called a "head" in the language of the mysteries, which the apocalyptic writers also use, because it evokes a typical head-like form, such as a lion's head, when viewed clairvoyantly. The etheric forces must be at work here. If we trace Atlantean development, we see that the etheric body was still outside the head at that time. That which is imprinted in the human being from the etheric is called a "head" in the language of the apocalyptic mysteries. This refers, then, to that which appears to the clairvoyant gaze primarily as a head. But that which is physically brought about in the human being through any limb of the etheric body is called a "horn." A "horn," then, is a very mysterious thing in the language of the mysteries. That which, for example, has been physically brought about in a human being by the fact that he once passed through that race of the Atlantean epoch in which the lion was the typical group soul—that is called a horn. Thus, the physical aspect that originates from some part of the etheric body is called a "horn." A horn is, for example, the organ that serves as the outward physical expression of something etheric.

Now I would like to speak to you in concrete terms. All of the human physical organs are actually condensed etheric organs; they have emerged from the condensed etheric body. Let us consider the human heart. Today it is a physical organ, but it has been condensed from an etheric organ. This present-day human heart received its blueprint back when humanity passed through the stage of group-soul affinity, which is symbolized by the lion. Thus, the heart is the "horn" of the lion's head, for when the etheric body had developed to the point where the human being emerged with the group soul—symbolized by the lion's head—the rudiment formed that later became the physical heart. From this rudiment of the lion-man arose the rudiment of the modern human physical heart. So while we trace the origin of the etheric body back to the transformation of one "head" into another—to the addition of one head to another—we understand the human physical body as the addition of one "horn" to another. In fact, the human etheric body consists of "heads," and the human physical body of "horns." This is the language of the mysteries. All of the human organs are formed from the etheric body and are therefore nothing but "horns."

And now we must reflect on everything we have heard, for this is something about which even the apocalyptic writer says: "Here is wisdom." — We will only understand this wisdom, which the author of the Book of Revelation has embedded in the vision of the seven-headed beast that has ten horns, when we carefully consider what "horn" actually is in relation to "head" in the language of the Mysteries. We will see that those beings who have retained these seven heads—because they have

stagnated in their development—have in fact taken on a physical body in the Abyss consisting of ten hardened physical limbs.

We have seen that we pass through 343 states. But now things really get complicated when we realize that this is not the end of the matter—that, rather, a human being must also pass through various states within a single state of form. The current physical state of form was preceded by three others and will be followed by three more. But now the physical state, in turn, passes through seven states, and these are precisely the seven we have spoken of in the preceding days: the first, where the Sun is still connected to the Earth; the second, where it breaks away; the third, where the Moon departs; and the fourth, that of the Atlantean humanity. The Atlantean humanity lives in the fourth period of development of the physical form. And for each form, there are in turn seven so-called racial states, although the term “race” applies only to our middle state. And now we ourselves are in the fifth state, the one in which we live: the post-Atlantean era between the Great Atlantean Flood and the Great War of All Against All. We are living in this period. Then another follows—the sixth—and then the seventh. The sixth period is foreshadowed for us in the Book of Revelation through the seven seals; the seventh through the seven trumpets. Then it transitions into the astral realm. This is a new state of form, which in turn will have seven states. Our outline is not yet complete. We must divide each such state—as it unfolds between an event such as the Great Flood and the Great War of All Against All—into seven sub-states. For the fifth state, these are: the Indian cultural epoch, the Persian cultural epoch, the Chaldean-Babylonian-Assyrian-Egyptian-Jewish epoch, the Greek-Latin epoch, our own epoch; then the sixth, alluded to in the Apocalypse by the church in Philadelphia; and the seventh cultural epoch, which in turn will succeed it.

So if we imagine the entire process of evolution as consisting entirely of such small stages—which are, however, still long enough—we have 7 times 7 times 7 times 7 times 7 such stages of development as the ancient Indian or ancient Persian ones. Humans pass through that many different such states between Saturn and Vulcan.

7-7-7
343 - 7
2401 - 7
16 807 States

Now let us recall that of the 16807 such states in our era—between the Great Atlantean Flood and the Great War of All Against All—we have seven; and that we also had seven during the Atlantean era. But we also recall that humankind experienced four of these seven states of the Atlantean era under conditions entirely different from those of the three later ones. So now we know what these states are and how we are to count them. During the Atlantean epoch, humanity experienced four of these states—which are numerous—in such a way that it felt itself to be a group soul, as we have described them: the eagle, the lion, the bull, and the human. Humanity gradually developed these four group souls over the course of the four fundamental races of the Atlantean epoch. Since races always persist—as the Indian race, for example, has persisted even though later ones have developed—for things exist within one another—the four heads that represented the group souls at the beginning of the fifth Atlantean cultural epoch also remained. We have this four-headed animal.

At the same time that human beings began to harden from the etheric into the physical, they developed four different types of bodily members in accordance with their four-grouped soul. And because what was formerly group-soul consciousness has transformed into individual consciousness, human beings, at the beginning of the fifth period of Atlantis, experience a convergence of the former fourfold nature.

They carry within themselves the four heads, which come together in their head as it gradually develops. This head is composed of the four group heads as it develops over the course of the fifth period. Corresponding to these four heads, the human being has four parts of his physical body. These are, first of all, the four "horns," so that you can imagine: Because the human being was an etheric human, he had four heads, four animal heads—only the last one is already a human-animal—for that is what is meant. He was four-headed, and each force system corresponding to one of these heads formed physical organs. We saw yesterday that it was a force system that formed our heart, namely the one associated with the lion's head. The individual organs of the human being are like condensations of the corresponding members of the etheric body.

This is how the apocalyptic thinker reasons. He tells himself: That which is physical is a thickening of the ethereal. — Just as you might think: "This skin thickens and forms a callus," so the apocalyptic thinker thinks: "The human being exists in an etheric form, and that thickens and becomes physical." — And because the human being exists in fourfold form as four group souls, four such thickenings are formed. These make up his physical body. That is why what corresponds to the etheric body in the physical body is called a "horn." A horn is a calloused thickening. The human being, as he has just become in the fourth period of the Atlantean era, is described as an animal with four heads and four horns.

Now he continues to develop into an individual human being. This process begins in the region of present-day Ireland. Humanity passes through three final periods in such a way that it possesses the potential to become a human being with an "I." At this stage, if you observe its physical development from the outside, it no longer forms an animal body but has ascended to the level of a human being. It increasingly develops into humanity until it assimilates the Christ principle. When we look at modern human beings, we will say: He was not always as he stands before us today. In order to become what he is, he had to pass through four animal group souls; he had to be embodied in bodies corresponding to the present-day forms of the lion, the bull, the eagle, and the human. Then he ascended higher and became increasingly human-like, and the form of the earlier group soul disappeared. It is no longer there; the human being has become human-like.

It is only with the emergence of the first inclination toward self-awareness that human beings become aware of their sexuality. This is the moment depicted in the Bible when Adam and Eve become aware that such a thing as sexuality exists. We must place this significant, dramatic moment here in the development of the Earth. And if you look back clairvoyantly at the time that preceded it, you will see in human beings only those aspects that are the instruments of the spirit. The other aspect was not visible at all. Human beings could only be seen in their higher form. And from that point onward, people began to see human beings in their entirety. It is now understandable to us why people began to cover themselves. Before that, they saw nothing that they needed to cover. Thus, human beings gradually emerged into the outer world.

If we regard the outer human form as the condensed manifestation of the etheric, then in the fourth Atlantean stage we have the four horns corresponding to the four group-soul heads. Now, however, a duality begins to take shape in the physical realm during the last three Atlantean epochs. For each stage in which a group soul head was to develop further, a dual physical form—male and female—took shape. For the first four stages, they formed the human being with four heads—the condensed etheric body with four horns. Now we have the following three heads, which are not visible because the outer human form absorbs them; they do not manifest. These three can only be perceived by the clairvoyant: three etheric heads—the main human heads—and, in addition, two horns each, which stand beside him like shadows, like double shadows. Thus, when the Atlantic Flood struck, we had seven group-soul

heads, of which the last three always appear such that they have their physical form in a dual aspect, always as male and female. From this you can see that the entire group-soul nature of the human being at the end of the Atlantean era—even if what comes later remains invisible—consists of seven heads and ten horns. The first four heads do not have separate male and female horns, but the last three do have separate male and female horns.

Human beings have within themselves the seven heads and ten horns. They must now work on these through the incorporation of the Christ principle so that they are, so to speak, destroyed. For every time a person dies today, the seven heads and ten horns can be clearly seen in their astral body. These are held together only like rubber that has been shaped accordingly. Suppose a person hardened his heart against the Christ principle during our time and arrived in the era of the great war of all against all without having had the Christ experience—suppose he arrived having cast Christ aside— then, when the Earth passes into the astral realm, that which was there—what he has brought about, what he should have transformed—would spring forth, spring forth in its old form. The beast would appear with the seven heads and ten horns, whereas for those who have taken in the Christ principle, sexuality will once again have been overcome. Those who have hardened their hearts will likely retain their six-horned sexuality and will appear in their entirety as the beast with seven heads and ten horns, traits that were imprinted during the Atlantean era. They can be transformed by receiving the Christ impulse. But if Christ is rejected, they will remain and reappear in that time, which is signified by the pouring out of the bowls of wrath and the earth appearing, so to speak, split into two parts: the part where the Christ-people appear in white robes as the chosen ones—as early as the time of the seals—and the other part, where people appear in the form of the beast with seven heads and ten horns. Then another beast with two horns also appears, symbolized by the number 666.

Now, from everything that has been said, you have been able to understand the relationship between what we call “heads” and what we call “horns.” But there is still a question that will, so to speak, weigh on your mind: Why is it that precisely what appears in the physical body as this or that organ is actually called a “horn”? Why are the physical organs and their remnants in the astral realm—once the Earth has become astral—referred to as “horns”? — It is, of course, easy to understand that those human beings who have not taken the Christ principle into themselves must fall back into the state in which humanity existed before it could partake of the Christ principle. Humanity was previously a non-individual being with a group soul, and we have seen that throughout the first four epochs of the Atlantean period, it was endowed with group souls that are symbolically represented by the head of a bull, the head of a lion, the head of an eagle, and the human head—the latter of which we must imagine as the ‘head of a beast-man.’ We must therefore certainly consider that, when the human being reappears on the spiritualized Earth and has left the Christ Principle unused during our epoch, he will then—precisely because he has contributed nothing toward elevating his former animal group-soul nature—reappear in the old form, and not only in this form, but with three additional heads that he has acquired during the later epochs. Before the great flood of Atlantis struck, three further epochs had indeed followed the first four. During these three epochs, those who later embraced the Christ principle also possessed, in a certain sense, the capacity to incorporate three additional group-soul heads within themselves; but they transformed them, elevating the animal nature within the human being to a higher level. They will appear in a spiritualized form when the Earth is spiritualized. The others, who rejected the Christ principle, will appear with seven heads, because there were seven periods during which the animal nature was developed before the Flood. And because dual gender prevailed during the last three Atlantean epochs—in contrast to the first four—each head, so to speak, appears with two possibilities leading toward the animal nature—the male and the female—so that each head for these last three epochs appears with two horns; thus, the human being as a whole appears with ten horns.

Now someone might say: I understand well enough that those people who do nothing to shed the form they have and elevate it to the human level will reappear in animal form, but I don't understand why we speak of horns. It is easy to understand why one speaks of heads, but why of horns? — Now I will explain why one not only speaks of horns but must speak of them. The expression is not to be understood merely symbolically; it is reality. In fact, people who fail to take in the Christ principle within themselves will indeed appear in astral form. But because they have shaped their instincts in such a way that they have, so to speak, clung to the animal group soul, the corresponding instincts appear in the astral body that these people will then possess, in the form of horn-like protrusions. It is a real form.

I will explain this using an organ as an example: how it comes to be that a person who does not take in the Christ principle will, in fact, appear with horns when the Earth has become spiritualized. Consider the human larynx and the trachea. You are constantly inhaling and exhaling air through this trachea. This is an activity that human beings perform. In a person who is spiritualizing, this activity serves the spiritual realm; but in a person who does not align themselves with the Christ principle, it is connected to the ancient forces associated with the seven heads. Let us therefore illustrate this schematically as follows:



Air constantly flows in from the outside through the larynx. But you know that the human astral body surrounds the person. The stream of air that enters will always be connected to the astral. When the Earth becomes spiritualized, it will become evident whether a person's breathing was a servant of the Christ principle or a servant of the lower forces that existed in the world even before the Christ principle. If it was a servant of the Christ principle, then it loses the form that is adapted to the present body. The human being then has the power to transform everything that is astral into a higher, spiritualized form. If he does not embrace the Christ Principle, he is unable to extract from the present physical form that which is adapted to it. And the consequence of this is that, after the physical body has fallen away and disappeared, after the physical larynx has departed, this form of the astral body remains—the one that continually inserts itself into the larynx with the breath. This form remains in the shape of a horn. Wherever the outer astral forces enter and exit the human being, they remain adapted to the previous animal form when the human being passes into the astral form; that is to say, the human being then appears with true astral horns. These are real astral forms; they correspond exactly to the penetration of astral substance during earthly life. The fact is that these images do not present us with arbitrary symbols, but rather take on the true form of what will one day appear. This is what must be understood.

Now let us consider the following: Once the Earth has become spiritualized and evolved into its next states, more and more stages will have been passed through. And a time must eventually come when the following will have been passed through: 6 states of the first kind, 6 of the second, and 6 of the third. Just as we now have the number 344 as the number of evolution, so too must the number "666" (read as six, six, six) apply at some point in the future—when 6 kingdoms of life or cycles, 6 main races, and 6 subraces have been passed through—though this is not the literal reading; rather, it is the correct way the Apocalyptic writer chose to write it. So there will come a time when the number "666" is the number of evolution. This will not happen until a very distant future, but that future is already being prepared in our time. After three major states [major races] have been passed through, we are now living in the fourth. But when the time has passed that is marked by the seven seals following the great war of all against all—when we have arrived [at the age of the seven trumpets]—then we will have gone through six of these intermediate stages. When the first trumpet sounds, we will have gone through 6 such major stages, and when we then move on into the time of the trumpet blasts and the periods marked by the first six trumpets have passed, then we will have experienced "66." By then,

humanity will have had time to prepare for the dreadful moment that will follow much later—namely, when not only 66 but “666” will be reached.

Everything that is to come is already being prepared in the present. The time that will follow the great war of all against all—the time of the seventh trumpet—will see people who, by excluding themselves from the Christ principle, will have attained a high degree of wickedness and a predisposition to sink into the abyss. By then, these people will have ensured that, when the time of 666 comes, they will be able to descend quite deeply into evil, into the abyss. People will already have absorbed within themselves the predisposition for this descent into the abyss in the distant future, following the Great War of All Against All, in the Age [of the Trumpets], when the seventh trumpet sounds. It will, however, still be possible for a long time for those who have then taken on this predisposition to turn back, to repent, and to retrace their steps in their development so that they may still embrace the Christ principle. But the initial predisposition has been established, and those who remain with this predisposition will, when that distant future arrives—a future signified not by 466 but by 666—no longer be able to transform this predisposition into a good one. They will succumb to that terrible fate of which we are yet to speak.

Thus we see that something dire for the development of humanity is linked to this number six, whether it appears once, twice, or three times. We are living in the fifth main period and the fifth subperiod. We will live on into the sixth period after the great war. But before the great war comes, the sixth subperiod —characterized by the Church of Philadelphia—will follow immediately after our fifth subperiod. Now we know that today is the time in which materialism has spread throughout humanity. We have seen how, over the centuries, people have become increasingly materialistic, but this materialism is such that a turnaround is possible at any time. The materialistic person still has time today to turn back. Therefore, a spiritual worldview must also take hold in our present age—that worldview which leads a small group of people toward this very occult, spiritual understanding of the world. Those who will establish the great brotherhood in its initial form during the sixth epoch—which will follow our own time and is not so far off, its beginning lying in a time measured only in millennia—will bring about the very first division among humanity. Those who stubbornly cling to materialism, as well as those who will be inclined to embrace a spiritual perspective—those who form the Brotherhood within this small group—both will already appear in our sixth period. This simple “6” may already prove fateful for many people, but not irrevocably so, for repentance will still be possible even then. But people will survive the great war of all against all. [The Age of the Seven Seals and] the five periods [of the Age of the Trumpets] will pass, and the number six will return. Afterward, the temptations and seductions will return once more to further develop the materialistic disposition, carrying it over into the time of the trumpet sounds; and when 6 major and 6 additional minor periods have elapsed—after 66—there will already be very significant tendencies present in humanity that are not as easily remedied as ours.

Thus we see that, in fact, the world of evil inclinations is exerting an ever-greater influence within humanity, and that good people are separating themselves from the wicked—in the sense described by the apocalyptic writer—in an ever clearer and more stark manner. The final great separation will occur when the number six is fulfilled—not only for the shorter periods but also for the longer ones. This will be the case when our Earth has completed its six kingdoms of life, or six cycles, and, within the seventh cycle, six states of form. Once it has completed this, humanity’s predispositions toward evil will have developed into a terrible form. With terrifyingly devastating force, evil will then manifest only in those who have remained evil.

So we ask ourselves: How often does humanity have the opportunity to succumb to the temptation toward evil within our Earth? — First, during the period that follows our own, before the Great War.

Then it has a second and a third opportunity to do so. Thus, this descent into evil develops gradually. As for the period when the Earth first transitioned into a spiritual state, we are initially faced with two possibilities. When the Earth has once again united with the Sun, those who have taken the Christ principle into themselves will be ready to merge into the forces of the Earth that are uniting with the Sun; those who have taken the potential for evil into themselves will be excluded. These are, as it were, such that they repel the Sun; they reject that which would enable them to unite with the forces of the Sun. They are the opponents of union with the Sun. That is why the apocalyptic writer designates that power, that being, which leads human beings to spiritualize themselves in such a way that they can unite with the sun, as the Christ in the very truest sense, and, as we shall hear, as the Lamb. The Christ-being is described as the Genius of the Sun, who unites with the Earth and also becomes the Genius of the Earth. He has already begun to become this since the event at Golgotha.

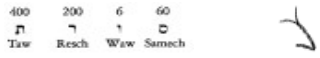
But there is also a principle opposed to this Lamb: there is also a sun demon, the so-called “demonium of the sun,” which acts within the evil forces of human beings, repelling the power of the Lamb. And it works in such a way that a certain portion of the human race is cast out of the evolution leading to the Sun. These are the opposing forces of the Sun, which stand in opposition to the Sun. At the same time, these are the forces that are destined, once the 666 stages of development have passed, to be completely cast out of our evolution; they will then be definitively cast into the abyss. So we must say: In that time when the Earth is united with the Sun, not only will that which is symbolized by the beast with seven heads and ten horns be cast out, but also that which is endowed with forces that are opposed to the Sun. All of this is destined to vanish into the abyss when the 666 is fulfilled.

Now, this number 666 has always been recorded in a very mysterious way. We shall see that there is every reason to shroud these facts, which we are now discussing, in the mystery of secrets; there is every reason to do so. And because that is the case, they were shrouded in such mystery, and 666 was written. In the mysteries from which the Apocalyptic writer received his initiation, 400 200 6 60 was written. This is written in such a way that the layperson cannot recognize it. This 666 has been concealed; it was meant to be kept as a secret, as you see here: 400 200 6 60. And by rearranging everything, an illusion is created. Now, there is a certain principle in the writings of the initiates that consists of expressing letters through corresponding numbers. Some of the peculiar individuals who, in the course of the nineteenth century, sought to unveil the secret of the number 666 stumbled upon this principle; but given the way they arrived at it, one might say: they heard the bells ringing, but did not hear them clanging together. For they have appropriated, in an imprecise manner, what I have now explained to you here and what has always been taught esoterically. They found that if one substitutes Hebrew letters for these numbers, one gets “Nero”; they therefore concluded that 666 means Nero.

That is not the case. 666 must first be written as follows: 400 200 6 60; only then can you figure out what it represents. Then you must write: 400 as, 200 as, 6 as, and 60 as D. These four letters represent the four numbers 400, 200, 6, and 60. You have been drawn into this mystery in a marvelous way—marvelous because of the insight of those who drew you in—because at the same time, these four letters, as sounds, also had a very special occult meaning. Just think for a moment: what must the number 666 actually mean if it is to express what we have described? It must signify the principle that leads a person to complete hardening in their outer physical life, so that they actively reject what enables them to shed the lower principles and ascend to the higher ones. What the human being has received in terms of the physical body, the etheric body, the astral body, and the lower ego—before it rises to the higher—these four principles are simultaneously expressed by these four letters: the Samech represents the physical body, the Waw the etheric body, the Resh the astral body, and the Tav the lower ego. Thus we see that the hardened aspect of these four principles, before they begin their divine development, is expressed by the four letters. The apocalyptic writer can truly say, “Here is

wisdom!” for wisdom is contained within it. “Let him who has understanding calculate the number—the number 666!”

And now let's read it. You read it like this—backwards, of course:




Then one must add the vowels, and it reads “Sorat.” Sorat is the name of the sun demon, the adversary of the Lamb. And each such spiritual being has been designated not only by its name, but also by a very specific symbol, a symbolic sign. For Sorat, the Sun Demon, this sign was: a thick line that curves back on itself and has two curved tips at the front.

But now we must understand the author of the Apocalypse correctly. Right at the beginning, he uses a strange word that is usually mistranslated. The opening of the Apocalypse reads: “This is the revelation of Jesus Christ, which God gave him to show his servants what must soon take place, and he set it forth in symbols and gave it to us through his angel to the servant, John.” “Set forth in symbols”: so we must be prepared for the fact that he expresses the important, the actual content of the mystery in symbols. He has expressed what 666 signifies in symbols. What he describes is the symbol, and he describes it as follows (Chapter 13:11): “And I saw another beast coming up out of the earth, which had two horns like a lamb.” These are nothing other than the two lines at the top of the drawing, and to conceal this, he simply calls the two lines here “horns.” It has always been the practice in the language of the mysteries to use a word ambiguously so as not to give the uninitiated the opportunity to understand the matter so readily. So what he describes here—“it had two horns like a lamb”—is the sign of the sun demon, which in the language of the mysteries is expressed by the word “Sorat,” and which, if we substitute the numerical values of the individual letters, is represented by the four numbers 400, 200, 6, and 60. This amounts to 666 in a highly veiled form of expression.

Thus we see that the author of the Apocalypse points to the adversary of the Lamb. Below, where the earthly realm transitions into the spiritual, human figures appear in such a way that they retain their former animal forms. The beast with the seven heads and ten horns appears, but so does its seducer—the adversary of Christ—who possesses the great power to prevent them from returning to the sun. Human beings themselves cannot be adversaries of Christ; they can only, so to speak, fail to take in the Christ principle within themselves because of the false power within them. But there is such an adversary: the solar demon. It appears as soon as there is something that can fall prey to it. Before the prey is there—before human beings with the seven heads and ten horns are present—there is nothing to seduce, and the seducer has no business being there. But then, when a human being with such dispositions appears, the seducer comes. And he appears as the second of the beasts and seduces.

At the very moment, then, when the Earth passes into the astral state, that which was present in human beings when the Earth was still enveloped in a shell of water appears. It rises up into the human-animal. Out of the water, one sees the beast with seven heads and ten horns rising up. The fact that this beast has been left unused by the Earth means that Sorat—the adversary of the Sun, the tempter—can now rise from the Earth; thereby he can draw near to humanity and drag it down into the abyss with all his might. Thus, from this point onward, we see a being clinging to humanity that possesses terrible power. What, then, does this being do to lead people into such horrifying things as we can only imagine? To tempt people into mere immorality—into what they already know as ordinary human beings—there would be no need for this monster, which appears as a sun demon. Only when that which, in the best sense, distinguishes the beings who bring salvation to the human race—only when spiritual elevation is transformed into its opposite, when spiritual power is placed in the service of the lower ego-principle—only then can it lead humanity to the point where the beast, depicted with two horns, gains power over them. The misuse of spiritual powers is connected to the seductive power of the beast with two horns.

And we call this misuse of spiritual power “black magic,” in contrast to its proper use, which we call “white magic.”

Thus, by dividing itself, the human race will prepare itself, on the one hand, to enter into ever more spiritual states and thereby to begin using spiritual powers—to enter into white magic— and on the other hand, those who abuse spiritual powers will prepare themselves for the wildest power of the two-horned beast: black magic. Ultimately, humanity will split into those who practice white magic and those who practice black magic. Thus, the mystery of 666, or Sorat, conceals the mystery of black magic. And the tempter toward black magic—that most terrible crime in Earth’s evolution, to which no other crime can be compared—is represented by the apocalyptic writer as the two-horned beast. Thus, so to speak, the division of humanity in the distant future comes into view: the chosen ones of Christ, who will ultimately become the white magicians, and the adversaries, the wild sorcerers, the black magicians, who cannot detach themselves from matter and whom the Apocalyptic writer depicts as those who commit fornication with matter. Therefore, this entire activity of black magic—everything that arises as a “marriage” between humanity and the hardening of matter—is brought before his inner eye in the great Babylon, in the community that unites all those who practice black magic, in the terrible marriage—or rather, the wild union—between humanity and the forces of fallen matter.

And so, in a distant future, we see two forces facing off against one another: on the one hand, those who sail into the population of the great Babylon, and on the other, those who rise above matter, uniting as human beings with what is presented as the principle of the Lamb. We see how, on the one hand, the blackest elements separate themselves within Babylon, led by all the forces opposed to the sun, by Sorat, the two-horned beast; and we see humanity—which has developed from the chosen ones—uniting with the Christ who appears to them, the Lamb: the Wedding of the Lamb on one side, and that of Babylon—the setting Babylon—on the other. And we see Babylon sinking into the abyss, and the Chosen Ones, who have celebrated the Wedding with the Lamb, rising to master the forces of white magic. And because they not only recognize the spiritual forces but also know how to wield these spiritual forces magically, they can prepare what they have on Earth for the next planetary incarnation, Jupiter. They are, so to speak, drawing the grand blueprints that Jupiter is to have. We see emerging from the power of the white magicians the preparatory forms that are to live on as the forms of the next earthly incarnation, Jupiter: we see the New Jerusalem rising from white magic.

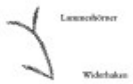
But first, that which is characterized by Sorat, 666, must be cast out. That which has fallen prey to the principle of the two-horned beast and has therefore hardened into the beast with seven heads and ten horns is cast out. The power through which the Solar Genius overcomes these outcasts—driving them down into the abyss—is called the face of the Solar Genius. And the face of the Solar Genius is Michael, who, as it were, acting as the Solar Genius’s representative, overcomes the beast with the two horns, the deceiver, who is also called the great dragon. This is depicted by the image that appears to the seer of Michael, who holds the key to the abyss and the chain in his hand, who stands before God and keeps the opposing forces bound. Thus, in Christian-Rosicrucian esotericism, the casting out of those who belong to 666 and the overcoming of the dragon, the deceiver, are characterized. Thus, what the apocalyptic writer shrouded in mystery—what must first be brought to light through revelation—now appears before our eyes, and of which he says: “Here is wisdom! Let anyone with understanding calculate the number of the beast”—that is, the two-horned beast—“for this number is 666” (Revelation 13:18).
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Zarathustra also referred to the Christ being, who has been working in the central regions of the earth from the event of Golgotha onward. After working on the earth from the sun in earlier times, he has united with the planet earth. It is the power of Christ that has descended from the sun and retrieved the useful part of earthly humanity, uniting it with the sun again. But he has an adversary—every such being has an adversary. Christ is the good spirit, the intelligence of the sun; the adversary is the demon of the sun. Certain forces that are constantly working on the human astral body come forth from the demon of the sun. This demon of the sun is the opponent of the Christ spirit and is called Sorat. Earlier, in cabalistic sections of occultism, the custom of writing letters with numbers prevailed. The letters of the name Sorat, the demon of the sun, have the value 666. In the picture found at Rev. 13:11 – 18 the sun demon becomes visible.

It has two horns like a lamb. The writer of the Apocalypse describes the sign of the beast. Already at the beginning of the Apocalypse he clearly stated he was describing everything in signs and then adds: Wisdom is necessary in order to solve this riddle. In this way, the number of the beast has been explained in occult schools by real experts who do not explain it materialistically. We hear how the worst and coarsest elements are thrown out and how the noblest, spiritualized portion of humanity remains united with the sun. The newly spiritualized human body can then again be a temple for the soul.

If one had written correctly with Hebrew letters (right to left) and then read correctly (also from right to left), the following would have resulted: 60, Samech, 6 Waw; 600 was written by esotericists as 200 + 400: 200 Resch + 400 Taw. Hence, we get 666, which in Hebrew letters spells “Sorat.” Sorat is also the corresponding word in Greek. Sorat has meant “Demon of the Sun” since ancient times. Every star has its good spirit—its intelligence—and its evil spirit—its demon. The adversary of the good powers of the sun is called Sorat. Christ was always the representative of the sun, namely, the intelligence of the Sun. Sorat is, then, the adversary of Christ Jesus. The sign for Sorat looks like this:



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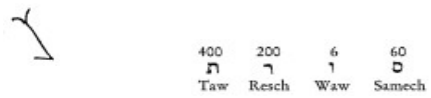
Let's imagine what happens here in a vivid way. One will look back into the Atlantean epoch—the Apocalypticer does it in advance: he has the vision of the sun-clad woman who gives birth to the little Jesus boy and who has the dragon at her feet—, but this becomes fainter and fainter the closer we get to the end of Atlantean evolution. New continents rise out of the ocean at the end of Atlantean evolution the continents which now contain the forces through which the post Atlantean epoch entered into its various aberrations. The beast with the seven heads rises up from the sea. Sevenfold land rises up from the sea and pulls men down through the spiritual elements which evaporate from the earth into their emotions.

The Atlantean catastrophe appears to the Apocalypticer in the form of this seven headed beast which rises from the sea, and it will appear in the future when what the Apocalypticer is pointing to will begin again in the Michaelic age. The Apocalypticer is speaking of very real events which concern us a great deal, in connection with the spiritual life of humanity. And the content of this Imagination is connected with the being of Christ.

Now if we mainly have to look upon Christianity as an evolution which is in accordance with the impulses of the sun genius or sun intelligence, we have to see the sun demon in what opposes the evolution of Christianity. And this is what the Apocalypticer saw. He saw the mighty counter principle of Arabism breaking in behind the scenes of the Christianity which was threatened by maya in two

directions as Christianity fled from Rome towards the east and as Christianity had taken on other cognitional forms. But when he looked behind the scenes of the outer Arabian and Islamic deeds it was obvious to him that the sun demon was working there against the sun genius or sun intelligence. Hence he had to present the sun demon as something which works against the actual Christian principle in man, so that if he yields to the sun demon he will not want to make the connection with the divinity of Christ, but he will want to remain in the subhuman element. If the Apocalypticer had been asked what kind of human souls were devoted to the sun demon, he would have pointed to the supporters of Arabism in Europe. It was clear to him that everything which brings men in the direction of bestiality in their views and also gradually in their will impulses has arisen from Arabism. And this is obviously, in them.

And so the Apocalypticer sensed that the sun demon was particularly active around the year 666. He describes him in such a way that every initiate can recognize him. For each of these spiritual beings which one calls the intelligences of the planets, the intelligences of the sun, the demons of the planets and of the sun has a key symbol in the mysteries, and they are also actually present in the latter on special occasions. The sun demon has this sign: The Apocalypticer describes him as the two horned beast. The kind of reading which interprets numbers had become somewhat externalized during the Latin period where one combined Greek and Latin in the mystery language, but it could still interpret them. The Apocalypticer uses the special kind of reading which was customary at his time. He writes the number 666 = 400, 200, 60, 6. He writes it with the Hebraic letters:




He writes these letters with their numerical values and one reads them from right to left. After one adds the corresponding vowels to the consonants they give the name of the demon who has this sign, the sun demon: Sorat. At that time Sorat was the name of the sun demon, and he describes this sign and we know it very well. The Apocalypticer looks upon everything which works against Christianity in the way that Arabism does as an emanation from those spiritual forces which are represented by Sorat the sun demon.
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**Chapter 15.**

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We will now try to imagine how what is said about the woes, etc., in the Apocalypse often plays into our time, and how the consciousness soul can be taken hold of by this and how it of course points back to previous experiences on earth at a certain level,—germinally indicating tremendous upheavals in advance. We should realize that what I interpreted for you yesterday has an important influence on the overall shaping of human evolution.

This alternation on earth between the greening summer which dissipates moisture into warmth and the withering winter that solidifies moisture into ice and snow, did not always exist, and a time is coming when it will no longer exist. Instead a condition will arise in which there will be something that doesn't exist today.

1. Summer, dissolving watery matter through heat,
2. Winter, hardening watery matter into ice and snow through cold.

You see, we have the alternating states today—I would like to emphasize this and I would like it if you grasp this quite clearly—we have the present state of affairs: Firstly, summer, which evaporates watery things through warmth, and secondly winter, which uses cold to harden the same watery things into ice and snow. Fall and spring is a condition that oscillates between these two. All of this will gradually become evened out. Summer will no longer evaporate aqueous things as much, and winter won't harden them into ice and snow as much. Instead there'll be an intermediate condition where watery things will have a different consistency, namely a considerably thicker one than in the summer time, where it remains and doesn't just pass over into another one. Snow and ice will not look like they do today; they will look like a reflective, transparent mass that will remain in both summer and winter. This is the emergence of the “glassy sea” which the Apocalypticer refers to.

We have pointed to a natural phenomenon which we grasped through an observation of events in nature and we have placed it in time. Now since we know that everything that is done around us really comes from us, and that we help to make the meadows on which our karma places us when we incarnate, we should also be able to extend this to the great transformation of the earth. And it is quite correct to say that men will contribute ever more towards the creation of the glassy sea through their inner dynamic qualities and through the intellectuality that they experience and develop in the conscious soul age, so that men will work together on the great events of the future. Here you have a unified working of what occurs in men and of what takes place outside in nature and not just a parallelism.
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**Chapter 16.**

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The opposite of divine love is called divine wrath. That is the technical term. Just as this love has become imprinted during the course of humanity’s fourth cultural stage, and just as it grows warmer and warmer through the final cultural stages of our time—the sixth and seventh—so, on the other hand, that which hardens matter around itself grows: divine wrath. And this activity of divine wrath—this repulsion of matter—is hinted at to us in the Book of Revelation through the pouring out of the seven bowls of divine wrath. Imagine how the whole thing will be, so to speak, figuratively: The Earth will become ever finer and finer in its matter, and human beings will also become ever more spiritual in their matter, and the coarsest parts will be visible only within the fine substance, like shells—as, for example, reptiles shed them or snails do. Thus, the hard parts will become more and more integrated into the refining matter. In the final period—the period of the trumpet blasts—you would already be able to see with clairvoyant eyes how human beings consist of subtle bodies, of spiritualized bodies, and how those who have hardened the material principle within themselves—who have retained within themselves what today are the most important constituents of matter— and how these will fall away like husks into this material sphere, which will remain as a remnant after this period signaled by the sounds of the trumpets.
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Now you will also be able to understand something else, and that is the following. We should realize that when we come into the divine element that is connected with human evolution and into the state of equilibrium between the Luciferic and Ahrimanic forces that is continually being maintained,—if we grasp the real essence of this, then whenever we rim into this, when we rightly perceive what is not an

influence from Lucifer and what is not an influence from Ahriman, that is, when we perceive what comes from this progressive, divine spirituality that is really connected with human evolution,—if we approach the divine element that keeps a balance between the realms where Luciferic elements are continuously flowing in and Ahrimanic things are continuously flowing in, we find that the basic force in everything that is streaming through here and which forms men outwardly, and which inwardly ensouls them and permeates them with spirit—is pure love. This fundamental force is pure love.

The universe consists of pure love, as far as its inner substance and being is concerned and in so far as it relates to human beings. It is nothing else; we don't find anything besides pure love in the divine things that are assigned to men. However, this love is an inner element and it can be experienced by souls in an inner way. It would never become outwardly manifest if it didn't create its body from the etheric elements that we know as light. If we really look at the world in an occult way, we get to the point where we tell ourselves: the fundamental essence of the world is inner love substantiality that becomes manifest outwardly as light.

That is not an opinion or a belief for someone who has an insight into these things; it is knowledge that was gained in a quite objective way. To the extent that man Is rooted in the universe, the latter is essentially love that becomes manifest outwardly as light. Essentially, because we have to do with all the essences or beings of the higher hierarchies who are carried by this love and who experience this love inwardly, which however becomes manifest as love, if we want to use an abstract idea. The outer sheen of beings is love and the outer sheen of love is light. That is something that one repeatedly emphasized in all the mysteries, and which is real knowledge that has been acquired by every true occultist, and it is not just an opinion or a belief.

However, if you take some very clean water, some absolutely crystal clear water and dip a dirty sponge in it and squeeze it, and let the water run out again, you will see that it is cloudy and dirty. You have let the dirty sponge suck up the crystal clear water and you have squeezed it out again and it has become dirty water. The crystal clear, pure water can't help it that it flows out as dirty water when one squeezes the sponge. And the divine love that is springing up in pure light can't help it that it is being absorbed by the age of materialism, by a sponge that is permeated by impurities and that it thereby becomes something quite different when it reemerges. So when crystal clear water is absorbed by a dirty sponge it becomes cloudy, undrinkable water, and by analogy we can imagine that when divine love that appears in light is sucked up by all the evil ingredients that are latently or openly raging in humanity, it becomes divine wrath.

The secret of the next age is that divine love will appear in the form of divine wrath through what happens in humanity. It will appear in the form of the divine wrath that will stop the harmful effects of the materialistic arrangements that are arising in our materialistic, consciousness age by destroying them. Proceeding from what appears to the Apocalypticer in pictures, he speaks of the pouring out of the vials of wrath in the next age. That is something that was expressed in the mysteries in a sentence that had a terribly shocking effect upon the neophytes: Divine love appears in the form of divine wrath in the sphere of human illusions.

That is a statement that was handed down in the mysteries many millennia ago and it lives in a prophetic way in John's visions in the Apocalypse. He describes how divine love becomes sullied through the preceding events and what will have to happen as the necessary fulfillment of the preceding, namely, the pouring out of divine wrath in an age when men's actions will have a much greater effect upon events in nature than they do today. For the parallelism that gives men the illusory idea that nature and man's soul and spirit run side by side, only applies in the middle parts of

evolutionary periods. Even in the smaller evolutions such as the present period between the Atlantean catastrophe and the war of all against all, men had a greater influence upon events in nature at the beginning and end of these periods through what went on in them. Hence it is not just a fable that a large part of humanity was using black magic on a large scale near the end of the Atlantean period of evolution. The consequence of the crimes that men committed through their dealings with black magic was the events in nature that brought about the Atlantean catastrophe.

Therefore, many things that are happening now will give rise to later events in nature. One of these is the Russian revolution, which also had many occult causes; its storms of thunder and lightning will pour out over the heads of men all summer long for years to come. Other world elements that are gathering in our time are clouding the gods' love, and will appear as events in nature that we can only look upon as a transformation of divine love into divine wrath through the illusions of men.

Looked at from a real and true point of view, the divine wrath that is poured out over men is still a manifestation of divine love, and that is why the sentence was formulated in the way that I gave it. If divine love would become weak and if it would seemingly take pity on men in this age, it would be no real compassion, for it would ignore the necessary consequences of human thoughts and actions. That would be very loveless, for then humanity would become corrupt. The deleterious things that men did and that would have an unspeakably harmful effect on further human evolution can only be eliminated by the outpouring of divine wrath, which is a metamorphosis of divine love. This sentence in the manuscripts is so old that it is often stated in its oriental form in Europe, so that one says: In the region of mayadivine love becomes manifest as divine wrath. Here again one can see how completely the Apocalypse is taken from the really active ingredients in the world. The deeper one goes into it the more one realizes that one can really rely on this Apocalypse; although that is a rather trivial way of putting it. It is basically something that tells priests what is happening in the course of human and world evolution. It was originally given to priests as the really esoteric part of Christianity in addition to the other part that was exoteric.

We should point out how much more intimate the terminology of the Apocalypticer is, for if you take everything that has been said so far you will realize that when the Apocalypticer how man stands in the whole world he basically looks upon the stars and the earth as a unity. He connects man's real nature with both the stars and the earth. We will now have to point to the real thing that the Apocalypticer is referring to when he speaks about the seven-headed beast, the two-horned beast and about beasts in general. Up till now we have looked for these real things by pointing to what man can experience inwardly. However, you will find that whenever the Apocalypticer speaks about fixed stars he is talking about the divine spirit, as people continued to do during the whole Middle Ages. Whenever he speaks about planets he's speaking of angelic intelligences or intelligences which, have a hierarchical, angelic character. But when he speaks about beasts he's also referring to something concrete like this. He lets human beings participate in the crystal heavens, fixed stars and planets but also in the whole development that underlies the beasts that are continuously being mentioned in the Apocalypse. Now what outer physical reality do these beasts correspond to?

Whenever the Apocalypticer refers to beasts, he's really speaking about the forces and activities of comets. Once you know about this terminology you will begin to understand a number of things that the Apocalypticer knew about the nature of comets, although mankind in general then forgot about these things. So let's take a look at the nature of comets in connection with the Apocalypse. I would like to present this as follows.

This justifies one in saying that the Apocalypse is a book with seven seals. One has to unseal it in this way so that one finds out what is meant. It doesn't seem much wiser to me to ask why the Apocalypticer wrote something that has seals than to ask why we seal our letters when we mail them. We seal them so that people for whom they weren't intended will not read them. The same goes for the Apocalypticer. He wanted the Apocalypse to be read by people who are qualified to do so and who know how to open the seals. No one knows how to open them if he isn't competent in a certain sense, that is, if he doesn't, as it were, get a knife from the spiritual powers to cut the scroll open.

Aside from the more obvious content of the Apocalypse which we have discussed, it is also an initiation book. We can definitely look upon the Apocalypse as an initiation book through the way that the successive stages of evolution are presented—through the inner nature of the thing—, the stages that can be experienced by those who have eyes to see and ears to hear, whereas they will of course pass people by who have no eyes or ears.

We should realize that when we enter the world with our cognition that increasingly becomes a perception, that content of our soul life which is basically a kind of a reflection of outer nature disappears. In other words, the physical sense world disappears and the spiritual world gradually appears from the other side as if out of the background. The Apocalyptist clearly shows that he has a very intense, correct idea of this way of entering into a relation with the spiritual world. This enabled him to find the things in his imaginative visions as objectively as he found them.

It is simply a fact that one can arrive at a view of the world in two ways. The one way is to lovingly devote oneself to the physical sense world and to become familiar with all its aspects; thereby one increasingly becomes familiar with the work of the gods. If one looks at nature in an inner, spiritual way and not just in an external mechanical one, one then has what one could call nature in the widest sense of the word. However, one could also imagine—and the idea is a correct one—that one can get the same world content in a purely spiritual way from within through one's own soul. So that someone with sufficient inner force will be able to see that some natural phenomenon is involved at a particular point in world events, even if he has no access to any historical reports about it. One can definitely say that it's possible to arrive inwardly at the knowledge that earthquakes or something else occurred in some year when something was going on in mankind. Many people have the more or less clear feeling that they can know concrete details about the world from within, and it is a perfectly correct one. Now one can ask what is actually involved when a man gets into the spiritual world in this Imaginative way.

We can definitely discuss what is involved here in connection with the Apocalypse, for we encounter a number of series of stages where the Apocalyptist sees something that leads into the spiritual world in each case, first he presents the letters, then the seals, then he passes on to what can only be expressed in auditory terms in our human language, namely, to the trumpets, and then he goes on to what I described yesterday as divine love, whose counterpart is divine wrath.

If we understand the Apocalyptist rightly, he's saying that wherever he gives the content of the Apocalypse through the letters he was inspired to write, it refers to the physical world. The moment he goes over to the seals and treats them seriously, what he has to say with these seals refers to the astral, Imaginative world or to what one can call the soul world. When he passes over to the trumpet sounds we get into spirit land, and when we experience divine love and divine wrath in accordance with their content we really get into the interior regions of spirit land.

Now one should consider that while man treads this Imaginative path, he's basically standing in the world with his experiences, so that his experience of things is the world's experience. However, he

doesn't notice this at first. During the course of his esoteric training he gradually becomes aware that everything that happens to him, through him and in him is a world event at the same time. He increasingly feels that he is poured out into the objective world content, and the Apocalyptist makes this very clear. So that we can say: physical world = the content of the letters.

Now let's take a look at the way the physical world appears to us. This physical world is more than it seems to be. This physical world would not present us with its manifold nuances of color and warmth and all the rest of what inundates us from all parts of our environment if it weren't permeated by spirit. We should realize that what we think of as a physical content in our present age is really spiritual.

One could say that one has to learn the soul language of someone like the Apocalyptist if one wants to try to imagine what his soul is like. And when we adopt this soul language for our own personal, spiritual use we must become so united with it that it passes over into our flesh and blood, to use a rather trivial expression.

I would like to give you a few examples of the inner soul language of an initiate, which he doesn't always use outwardly or exoterically, but inwardly in order to form his ideas about his particular experience of the spiritual world. For instance, he might say: Dampen lightning and you will understand color. That is initiates' language. What does it mean? An initiate sees flashes of lightning; he sees something flaming up as it comes out of the universe; he looks upon it as a flickering up of the spirit in world space, and he imagines that when this lightning becomes ever dimmer or milder he gets a dampened or mild development of colors. Lightning spreads out, as it were, and becomes a colored surface. This is the way initiates think of it.

Or an initiate says: Let thunder become quieter and ever more quiet; then listen to its modulation—and musical things will arise. Thus initiates look upon the sensory tapestry that is spread out before us as one side of revelation, and it is a real idea for them to think the following: One has the colored manifold world content;—what I'm drawing here could be sounds just as well as colors. It could be like the world content that approaches our senses, that is, like the sensory, physical veil that is spread out before us as our world of perceptions, into which we weave our abstract, unreal thoughts.

If you imagine that this blackboard is a tapestry that is spread out everywhere and that it consists of sounds, colors and warmth, an initiate sees lightning flashes behind it. The real flashes of lightning that are sometimes visible simply break through this sensory tapestry from behind and from the spiritual world. Wherever lightning appears there is a radiating in of the spiritual world. And if we look at the way this lightning is dampened and toned down to an even display of colors in nature we have our colorful earth before us.

If we look up to the heavens and its stars, we have points that also appear to us out of the spirit, except that they are an enduring, living revelation of flashing lightning. However, an initiate looks upon all of this as the outer I manifestation of what is behind it. He tells himself: You should really see—and he does see it, as his soul becomes increasingly active—you should really see the red in a rose begin to spray out above and below as tiny flashes of lightning, and whereas the front part becomes dulled, the red in the rear interacts with the sphere of the Seraphim, and all sounds are linked with the sphere of the Cherubim, and everything that we touch I is connected with the sphere of the Thrones. When one sees nature around one in the physical world it is really all an illusion, for in reality it is the toned down work of the Seraphim, Cherubim and Thrones.

If we look out into the colorful world and at the way it appears,—it is only the evenly toned down lightning flashes and action of the Seraphim. People in ancient times used to speak about the Maya character of the sensory, physical world, but that was only because they didn't know that there are Seraphim, Cherubim and Thrones everywhere in it. Now let's go a little further on the path of initiation. Let's go to where the Apocalyptist emphasizes the opening of the seals. What is going on there? Here color and warmth separate off from the world and increasingly spiritual effects appear which become similar to the true shapes of the lightning-like things which form. Instead of the spiritual world breaking through the sensory tapestry in a zig zag way, we see more gentle lightning flashes, etc., behind it (drawing). We know that the beings who live in them are the servants of the Seraphim, Cherubim and Thrones. Something similar applies to sounds, warmth and barely perceptible touches.

Now just as the earthly, sensory tapestry fades away and such lightning-like and enclosed figures behind it form out of the astral fire and expand ever more, so the stars begin to shine down and their threads of light enable us to see what they are. Starry threads, starry radiations or lights mingle with things that work in an elemental way. Earthly and heavenly things become connected, and we realize that we are in a second world—that was the first one—, and we arrive at the first condition of the second world, where everything is still shining in a natural way, and where we have an inkling that there are beings behind it. At most we perceive elemental beings here, but we know that these beings are the agents of powerful, important and sublime beings; we get to the first precinct, as it were, of the Kyriotetes, Dynamis and Exusiai. They are still behind this, as it were, but they mingle with these beings. The real nature of the Kyriotetes, Dynamis and Exusiai is gradually revealed, the further we go on the path of initiation. This is connected with the emergence of the harmony of the spheres that resounds through the world. The Apocalyptist presents the individual sounds of this world harmony as trumpet sounds, although they really only combine into harmonies and melodies during the course of long periods of time, when time becomes a unity. So we have the pure life of the second hierarchy in the clear sounds of the trumpets, whereas the very powerful beings in the first hierarchy underlie actual sense experiences. This is a world in which one could say that all the sensory effects have become flowing, grand and majestic, so that they're not just located around the things and processes of the physical world, but they have become the expression of beings who work in and with the second hierarchy and through elemental beings. Then we eventually arrive at a third region where we no longer perceive anything natural, or any natural things that have been broken up into elemental things, for if we want to perceive something there we have to perceive it in a spiritual way.

We arrive at a region of the spiritual world which we have to describe as follows. When you went through what is like a dissolving and a reshaping of earthly sense perceptions, that are taken hold of by the expanding sense perception of the stars, you were able to see everything that is working in the universe in Kyriotetes, Exusiai and Dynamis as if it were in the last residues of sense perception—in such a way that these beings are as if inwardly bound to the real substantiality of the stars.

The starry world has become transformed into the beings of the hierarchies for us; instead of looking up to the stars' sensory semblance we live in the world of the hierarchies. Here the hierarchies are still saturated with what I would like to call sprayed and dissolved sensory knowledge. We now get to the third region where we no longer perceive earthly things in a sensory way and where we must perceive souls and supersensible things without sensory inclusions. We arrive in the actual spiritual world, and we become acquainted with its angels, archangels and Archai.

We get to know the spiritual aspects of these beings, and when we depict them in paintings and the like we should realize that they only have the sensory forms we give them because they are woven into the soul, spiritual elements and essences of the higher hierarchies. For instance, the wings we paint on

them get their substantiality from the beings of the second hierarchy, and the shape and contents of their heads are derived from the first hierarchy. We should realize that we can only see what is within the third hierarchy of angels, archangels and Archai in a spiritual way.

What I'm telling you here is of very great historical importance, because you won't be able to read books that are basedon ancient ideas, and which deal with these spiritual worlds in an intimate way unless you are aware of the fact that when we investigate the spiritual world we perceive the lowest hierarchy in a spiritual way, as it were, whereas the higher hierarchies that we perceive still contain the ingredients of the sense world. This is why quite a few misunderstandings gradually arose when spiritual life became decadent, concerning the descriptions that are found in the ancient initiation wisdom.

We find that the more worldly initiates in the Middle Ages always describe the matter in such a way that the Seraphim, Cherubim and Thrones stand close to the earth, as the lowest hierarchy, and that one ascends through Dynamis, Kyriotetes and Exusiai to the angels, archangels and Principalities. If you look at illustrated books from the Middle Ages you will be confused about what you're seeing and you will ask yourself why the angels are sitting above the Seraphim. This came about because one no longer knew the exact details that are connected with these processes and one didn't imagine these things in a very organic way anymore. The error first arose during the Jews' Babylonian captivity in B.C. times when the whole doctrine became contaminated with Babylonian symbols through the contact of the Jews with the Babylonians, and this error in the order of precedence of the spiritual hierarchies was perpetuated by the Jewish cabala in the Middle Ages.

However, one must be familiar with such matters if one wants to understand the development of ideas about spiritual things in the course of human evolution, and this is the right place in our clarification of the Apocalypse to discuss these things. So we get out to the spiritual world, and the first beings we meet there are those in the third hierarchy. The Apocalyptist shows how well acquainted he is with all of these things whenever he describes something now, because he increasingly tries to let angels appear, and they carry the events. The phenomenal thing is that earth regions can reflect something that angels bring in as the messengers of higher hierarchies; and namely these angel appearances bring us into a region where we see that divine love is the real ingredient of the world to which we human beings belong. For we become aware that the as it were normal angels, archangels and Archai are something like the embodiments of higher hierarchies, just as we look at| the hands, arms, feet, legs and the rest of a person's body and we have the feeling that this is a body for the soul and spirit.

Thus as one ascends into the world of the third hierarchy one gets the impression: these are angels, but they are like the limbs of higher, divine spirits. They are really the soul, spiritual corporeality of higher divine spirits. So that one feels that one is in a pure spirituality and in God's corporeality at the same time. That is something to which one ascends; one has to occupy oneself with such an idea, and that is something which anyone who really wants to get to know the occultism that underlies spiritual life must do.

If you look at a human being on earth in his physical body, one cannot really think of this body's structure in terms of mere growth or in terms of the shooting and sprouting that goes on in it. You must add some degradative processes to the organism, that lead to excretions. They represent degradation and they show that the physical body is in a continual process of destruction which, however, is destined to absorb spiritual things, since it is degradation at the physical level; so that the spirit can then live in the physical, degradative processes. We know that spiritual things don't live in a human organism's anabolic processes. Spiritual things are suppressed and not promoted when man grows and

when physical processes are becoming more active. Materialists are very silly when they say that man only has to purify the shooting and sprouting life in his brain, and that a continuation of biological processes becomes refined and transformed there—and that this amounts to thinking. If the brain would only be a continuation of digestive processes it would have dull, vegetative inner experiences. Spiritual things only enter the brain because it is continuously punctured by physical processes, as it were, so that it decomposes and falls apart. Spiritual things intervene in physical things in a creative way via degradation. The physical body absorbs degradative processes. We see that an inhibition and a holding back is built into the growth.

When one realizes that the world of angels, archangels and Archai is really the corporeality of the divine spirit, and when one sees the weaving and moving and working of the angels, archangels and Archai and when one sees how individual soul lives are taken care of by their angel, groups of men by an archangel, and how streams of world events are pushed on from age to age by Archai, if one takes this whole weaving of this wonderful garment that is woven there, which is so nicely described in the Proserpina saga—, if one takes this whole garment of the world, one sees that divine love flows in it like the red blood in our bodies, and that this is necessarily accompanied by a stream of divine wrath. The latter is always formed from hindrances to world events by beings who feel things in a really moral way and who must first harmonize their moral characteristics with the course of world events.

We see the sprouting and shooting of the divine corporeality in divine love, as it were, and through its connection with the weak creatures which nevertheless characterize the ways that the gods want to direct the world we see that this spiritual body is permeated by something which is like the secretory products in man's physical body. Something like human glandular secretions become exuded here; the secretory centers appear as the divine vials of wrath which are woven into the course of world events.

We see the connection between divine love and divine wrath within these three worlds, and this gives rise to the idea, which must be accompanied by inner reverence; What happens when the vials of wrath are poured out? Here divine spiritual beings are stimulated by the misdeeds of weak creatures, and they think of how they can keep world events going and of how they can transform the hindrances into a vehicle for spirit-filled events that are pressing forwards, just as a man can make soul and spiritual progress in his body through the degradative processes that occur in it, so that he doesn't just vegetate. The Apocalyptist imagines all of this in accordance with the paths of initiation. As we saw yesterday and also earlier, the Apocalypse acquaints us with concrete physical things that are happening in the world, and it also makes us familiar with the path of initiation in a marvelous way.

If one looks at the Apocalypse in this way it firstly enables us to get an insight into the course of world events, so that we're looking into things in the future that we need and which we can add to our ideas, and it also becomes a meditation book, and it can be used as a meditation book in a wonderful way; it is really marvelous in this respect. If you come to a place in the Apocalypse that seems to be paradoxical or difficult to understand, stop thinking about it and start to meditate on it; for it is always accompanied by a passage where you can become spiritual, as you inwardly absorb and elaborate what you can't grasp intellectually anymore.

For instance, if one runs into a passage that refers to a bad gland, then of course intellectual types will say that glands can only be in men and animals, so what is that supposed to mean, it must be a poetic image—and they race on; but they're wrong about this. The Apocalyptist uses the word gland because he knows that it's just as justified to think of this real thing in the microcosm, as it is to think about the corresponding thing in the macrocosm. You begin to realize that the introduction of such a glandular thing that has to do with secretions leads over to the functions of divine wrath. Thus seemingly

paradoxical things in the Apocalypse enable one to pass over from a merely intellectual course of the soul life, which is so common today, to a spiritual one.
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**Chapter 17.**

GA104a
In the age when the sixth seal is broken the “people of twelve” will appear. The salvation of the “great whore of Babylon” will also occur in the sixth age. In this sixth age the earth will have repeated the Saturn, Sun, and Moon stages, as well as the earth condition itself and Jupiter-Earth. On Venus-Earth the earth will finally have the five rounds behind it. Then the sixth state will have come. Nevertheless, the Vulcan state for the chosen will not be present yet. For this reason we read [“And there are seven kings: five are fallen, and one is, and the other is not yet come ...”] “... five are fallen ...” and the remnant that has maintained itself: “... one is ...” and the seventh: “the other has not yet come.” (Rev. 17:10) We see how we again find the messages of the writer of the Apocalypse in Theosophy.
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However, I would like to say that very deep wisdom is connected with the magnificent Imagination that appears here. Just consider what appears in close proximity to this significant vision, as it were. The reader is told how active the beast that I described is—the beast which induces human beings to go down from the spiritual to the physical, which the Apocalypticer divided into three stages; the beast whose one form is a materialistic way of living and not just a materialistic view of life. However, the Apocalypticer refers to two points in time. He tells us how the beast is overcome, and on the other hand he tells us that the adversary of mankind, the stronger adversary of mankind, is bound for a thousand years and is then released again for a short time. Thus we really have to do with two adversaries of the good principle, with the beast and with what is traditionally referred to as Satan.

Now the beast is overcome with respect to the outer physical world, in the sense that a spiritual world view can always be opposed to materialism. And Satan is chained at the present time in a certain way. But he will be released again. Satan is fettered, and anyone who sees through the important things in evolution knows that he is fettered. For if Satan was not chained at the present time and if everything which could really pour out the vials of wrath would appear—if Satan was not bound,—the connection between the materialistic way of living and the materialistic view of life which is present on earth today would show up in the outer world in a ghastly way. Then the people who proclaim materialism as a truth with the deepest inner cynicism today would arouse such a desire in the unbound Satan that one would see this extraction of the materialistic view and a materialistic way of living and their acquisition by Ahrimanic powers, one would see this as the most horrible and most terrible diseases.

If Satan was not bound one would not only have to speak of materialism as a view and a way of living, one would have to speak of materialism as the worst kind of a disease. Instead of this people go through the world with the cynicism and frivolity of materialism and even with religious materialism, and nothing happens to them. But the only reason nothing happens to them is because Satan is bound and the Godhead still makes it possible for one to come to spiritual things without succumbing to Satan. If Satan was here, many a teacher who is standing in some confession and is infected by materialism would be a terrible, gruesome sight for mankind. The idea which arises when one points to the possible disease of materialism, to the leprosy of materialism which would really be there if Satan were not bound, if one points to this, it certainly gives rise to a terrible mental image.

However, anyone who is aware of his spiritual responsibility towards knowledge today will not make use of such an idea within any other context than the context of the Apocalypse. I myself would not speak of the leprosy of materialism in any other context than in the one I'm speaking of it here, where I have to connect things with the Apocalypse and where the one who becomes familiar with the ideas of the Apocalypse has these gruesome pictures before him, which however definitely correspond to the real state of the spiritual affairs.

Let's imagine that we are in the world into which the Apocalypticer wants to translate men during the next earthly period. He describes his visions of the breaking in of spiritual worlds and of how they will take possession of earthly human beings. He precedes this by three stages which we must become familiar with; three stages,—in a certain sense each of these represents something which must fall before mankind will become worthy and capable of obtaining the spiritual world in a pure form for their working, thinking and feeling.

The first stage is the fall of Babylon; we will call it this to begin with. The second stage is the fall of the beast and his companion the false prophet who spreads the teaching of the beast. The third stage is the fall of the divine counter powers which are usually called Satan. These three stages become quite objective and real in connection with the spiritual perception of future human evolution.

A great deal concerning human evolution will be decided in our century, and one has good reason to direct the eye of one's soul upon these three falls'. For they will break in upon us in a certain form; they will occur after the first appearance of Christ on earth in his etheric body, which is really his second appearance upon earth. And mankind will have to prepare itself and make itself strong enough in order to go through this threefold fall of the adversaries of the Christ impulse without endangering their soul development. We shouldn't forget how precise the Apocalypticer really is, for each time such a fall occurs he lets an angel come down from the spiritual worlds, and we notice something which can give someone who hasn't acquired a spiritual conception of the world a rather strange feeling. He lets the angel who comes down rejoice about the great suffering and terrible things which accompany this terrible fall, and it will be necessary for us to understand this rejoicing. But before we do that let's take a look at the three stages of the fall of the powers who oppose the Christ.

First comes what is called the fall of Babylon. Here we can place the sum of all the errors which men and mankind can fall into through their human nature before our souls. Everything which tends to drag human beings down below the spiritual level at which they really belong is included in what the Apocalypticer calls the Babylonian temptation.

Man is really only a human being—although of course he has to acquire this humanness first, and he can't just have it at every moment in his evolution—man is only truly human if there is a complete harmony between the material and spiritual principles in him, that is, if the material doesn't play up into emotions which are not controlled by the spiritual. This is the important thing and we must understand it quite well, for even the Apocalypticer could not speak the way he does if he assumed that passions, desires and everything which comes from the will sphere was quite unjustified right from the beginning. To say that this is unjustified—this ascetic striving in a false sense—also arises from the sphere of passions and desires, for someone who doesn't feel strong enough to permeate his passions from the spiritual side in such a way, that he places them in the service of good world evolution is indulgencing his weak emotions. He wants the good evolution, but he wants to impoverish it in this way and he wants to indulge his weakness. For the Apocalypticer it's not a question of tearing out

emotions or of tearing out passions and desires, it's a question of their not remaining uncontrolled by the spiritual world.

Babylon is the city in which a falling away from spirituality through passions held sway in an almost stereotyped way at a certain period in its mystery development, and everything which represents emotions in human life, which remain out of control on a smaller or larger scale is summarized by this city. Here we should translate the strong, coarse expressions which were used at that time (they weren't coarse then) into our language. The people in ancient times didn't form abstract concepts, they always referred to concrete things, always pointed to something characteristic and looked at concrete things. And so the Apocalypticer speaks of Babylon. Why of Babylon?

Really deep mysteries existed in Babylon or in the mystery centers of Babylon in which one could be initiated into the secrets of the super-earthly cosmos, far out into star worlds, and in which one could learn about starry secrets concerning the star worlds and their spiritual content. The earliest priests in ancient Babylon used human powers of clairvoyance and dreams in a way which we would call mediumistic today; this was the case in ancient Babylon. A wonderful, ancient Babylonian teaching developed in this somewhat mediumistic way. However, as one can also see today, mediums—even though they are suited for spiritual mediations, and they are often used in this way, although the process must be controlled by discerning initiates—have very questionable moral characteristics. Mediums become morally degenerate, and because there is a certain discrepancy between what they reveal and what they are, they can eventually no longer distinguish between truth and lies. Here one gets into a region where morality and immorality are no longer distinct.

You must understand how mediums get into this condition. Someone is a medium if his ego and astral body are pulled out of his physical and etheric bodies by an external force, and this was also what happened at the time of the Babylonian priests. However, another power sits in this ego and astral body as soon as they have been pulled out of the medium's physical and etheric body. Depending on whether the initiate who brings this about has good or bad intentions and belongs to the left or the right, this can be a good power or an evil one. Excellent things came to light in this way in ancient Babylonian times, but the problem was with what occurred when the medium returned to his physical body. You see, one cannot get by in the spiritual world with the logic and discrimination between lies and truth which one has in the physical world. It is a complete error to think that one can use the concepts of lies and truth which one rightly uses in the physical world, in the spiritual world. There is nothing there which one could distinguish in such a way. Some of the beings there are good and others are evil. One has to know them through themselves, and in fact, they tell one the kind of being they are. Even the evil ones are truthful in their own way. Of course this is difficult to understand, just as it is difficult to understand what happens in the spiritual world as soon as one enters it. For instance, here in the physical world we say that a straight line is the shortest path between two points. However, in the spiritual world it is the longest distance between two points and every other one is shorter. So that we cannot apply anything which we have to use in the physical world to the spiritual world.

Hence a true initiate must have the right attitude of soul for the spiritual world, but he must also feel fully responsible for the fact that the moment he returns to the physical world he has to work with physical concepts. A medium cannot do this because he doesn't leave his body consciously. When he comes back again his ego and astral body fill the physical and etheric bodies with a line of thought which is no doubt appropriate for the spiritual world, but it corrupts all moral feelings in the physical world. Hence mediums become corrupted, and the corruption with respect to truth and lies then' extends to other forms of corruption. Hence the fact is that Babylon went through this development from the greatest revelations of spiritual worlds to a terrible corruption; first with respect to the

principle of spiritual revelation, and then also with respect to human life in general, so that the previous corruption in the spiritual sphere extended to the latter. This spiritual corruption is very powerful; so that someone becomes more immoral if he becomes corrupt after he has gone into spiritual realms than he did before with his ordinary human tendencies. This is why Babylon was considered to be a representative of moral corruption.

The expressions for corruption which we find here are ones which were in common use. The whole of humanity over the entire earth imitated the Babylonians and thereby became a kind of city of Babylon. And this is what the Apocalypticer means. The city of Babylon is to be found among mankind on earth; it exists wherever human beings have succumbed to the Babylonian temptation. It is this human attitude which must fall before that fin—al condition of which the Apocalypticer speaks can come. And if we investigate what is active in the Babylonian corruption, we find that the Ahrimanic principle is active in it everywhere. Ahriman is sitting in men, and he is a power who stands close to them in the whole world, as it were. He is in our emotions, which thereby degenerate. The Ahrimanic and Luciferic principles are opposite poles. The Ahrimanic element is present in what falls here, as for instance when Babylon falls, and it is opposed to the Luciferic element. What kind of an image must the Apocalypticer use when he sees this? The image of jubilating Luciferic, angelic sentiments. We must be aware of this.

It's a big mistake to look upon the worst world conceptions as the best ones, as for instance the idea about the evil principle being down below and the good principle being in everything which comes to meet it from above. This is not the actual state of affairs. The Ahrimanic principle is down below and one has the Luciferic principle above where the angels are rejoicing about the falls. The rejoicing one hears is the voice of Lucifer which accompanies the diving angels, for the actual Christ principle is the balance between the two.

One can only understand something like what the Apocalypticer is presenting if one understands this threefoldedness in the world's makeup in the right way. For anyone with ordinary human feelings it is completely incomprehensible why pure and good spirits would begin to scream for joy when the misery which is described here befalls other beings. This is of course immediately comprehensible if one sees it as the jubilant cries of those who were basically opposed to the creation of the world in which man experiences his spiritual development. They want to keep his whole evolution on a very different spiritual level. They didn't want that connection or marriage of the spirit with matter which took place in earthly existence. So that when what is grasped by Ahriman is eliminated from earthly existence, what they're really feeling in their souls is: we now have the satisfaction that one part of earth-existence will no longer be continued; it is falling during earth evolution he world view which speaks out of the images which the Apocalypticer describes for each fall is wonderfully honest in this respect.

Now the first one, the fall of Babylon, is all the errors men can fall into when they are also influenced by the initiation principle, it is human perversions. When Babylon falls the remaining human aberrations will be eliminated from further world evolution, at a point in time which we will discuss later. To begin with we will place coming events before our soul in a qualitative way.

The second thing is where man is no longer just involved by himself. The beings who fall with Babylon are men; it is human aberration. However, in the case of the fall of the beast and the false prophet who supports the teaching of the beast, what falls is something spiritual and superhuman, and not something human.

Something which is outside of the human kingdom falls, namely, the beast who breaks in upon human communities, and the one who proclaims the teaching of this beast. Hence one is dealing with something which can take possession of' human beings where something superhuman is working directly in men with an evil impulse, and it's not a matter of a weak nature working, as in the case of a medium. We can add the following to make the Imagination even clearer. All those who will participate in the fall of Babylon will have become degenerate through the fact that they tried to do things which their organization couldn't stand; their organization became weak with respect to these things, and therefore they became corrupt. In the fall of Babylon man's organization acts out of weakness. In the fall of the beast and the false prophet it's not as if a medium became corrupt because he got weak, but it's as if the spirit which overpowers the ego and astral body of the medium during hypnosis would then go into his physical and etheric body and make use of the physical body in order to wreak havoc on earth through the human being.

This is exactly the idea which we encounter here in the Apocalypticer. He wants to say that a time will come when we will see human beings walking around on earth who couldn't stand what really, lay in the Christian annunciation who took the Christ into their souls, but who didn't get to the level of the Christ with their etheric and physical bodies, and therefore became corrupt and devoted to other spirits; but they didn't devote themselves to them with full consciousness, so that they became corrupt. These are the first ones, who are included in the fall of Babylon.

The other ones walk around like men, but their fate is that their human ego is not in them, so that one can no longer speak of them as human beings, for they are possessed by the beast and the false prophet. This will come after the fall of Babylon. There will be people walking around on earth who will be demons, for Ahrimanic powers will act in them directly.

Many of the preliminary conditions for all of these things already exist today; one could say that all of this is already present in a germinal form. After all we already have the terrible case where Ahriman appeared amongst us as an author, perhaps not through a human being entirely, but at least through the temporary weakness of a human being. Nietzsche was a wonderful and brilliant writer, but the Nietzsche individuality was not in him when he wrote the AntiChrist and Ecce Homo. I know this individuality in Nietzsche, and I even described it in my autobiography; but Ahriman becomes a direct author here, and Ahriman is a much more brilliant writer than Nietzsche.

Ahrimanic powers will intervene more and more and Ahrimanic spirits will also use human bodies for other things. A time will come when Christians will have to ask themselves seriously when they meet this or that human being: Is that really a human being or is it a very loose mantle for Ahrimanic spirits? In the future one will have to make this distinction in addition to the other ones one has to make today. This will be the second fall, and the beast and his herald will take possession of human bodies. Thereby these demons will have fallen. So first we have the fall of corrupt human beings and then the fall of certain corrupt spirits, who are close to men. These spirits take a tumble in the second fall.

Then we have the third fall, which is the fall of Satan in the Apocalypse. Here we have a very high being who does a different kind of work than the one which can be done on earth. The beast and the false prophet are powers who lead mankind astray; they want to steer men in the wrong direction in a moral and intellectual respect. However, the power which is meant in the fall of Satan wants something quite different. It wants to throw the whole earth off its course, and not just mankind. Seen from a human, earthly standpoint, this power is a terrible adversary of the Godhead.

One can only ask the following in a hypothetical way, and one can't look at it from the viewpoint of human or earthly evolution, if one doesn't want to commit an intellectual or spiritual sin. If one looks at it from other viewpoints, how does this satanic power in the universe compare with other spirits?

Now Michael has a different standpoint than human beings do, and it's no wonder that his opinion about Satan is quite different from that of men. Human beings tend to be rather abstract, and they think that Satan is an evil power. But he is also a great power from the viewpoints which are important for the earth, a great power that has gone astray. And archangel Michael does not have the rank of Satan, who is at the level of a principality or an archai; Michael is only an archangel. Satan is a very terrifying power from Michael's standpoint and not a despicable one, because he thinks that this power who belongs to the Archai is higher than he is. Except that Michael holds views which are in line with earth evolution.

With respect to everything which is connected with the orbits of the planets, Michael decided a long time ago to travel in the orbits which are prescribed by the sun's existence. Satan is a power who is continually lurking around in our cosmos. There is something sinister about this lurking of Satan. One can perceive this at the moments when one sees a comet shooting through our cosmos, with its different orbit (drawing).

If one draws it according to Copernicus which is not quite correct, although it doesn't make much difference here one has sun, Mercury, Venus, earth, Mars; those are the inner planets: Jupiter, Saturn, Uranus, Neptune—one can see that such comets have very irregular orbits with respect to these regular orbits. The view that these comets describe long ellipses is nonsense, but we don't have to go into that now. But in any case, the segments of the cometary orbits which lie within our planetary system do not agree with the planetary orbits at all.

And so this Satan lies in wait in order to catch every comet that comes along, and to use its momental inertia so that—when he has collected enough comets—he can throw the planets out of their orbits, and the earth with them. This situation exists in the universe; Satanic powers are continually lying in wait so that they can transform the entire planetary system. Thereby this planetary system would be taken away from the divine, spiritual powers in whose footsteps men should be walking, and it would be taken into quite different directions of world evolution. This intention is a terrible mistake from Michael's point of view, but an intention about which Michael would have to say: I couldn't even do it, for it would be impossible for a being who is in the archangel class to do something like that. Only beings who are in the archai class might have enough forces to carry out something along these lines. Michael—who decided to move in the sun's orbit a long time ago, and who therefore (in the sense of the Ptolemaic system) has become what is known in occultism as an archangel of the rotation of time for the planets and has decided to remain entirely within the orbital periods.

The angels had to decide to remain in these scheduled orbits at some point. In a certain epoch of Atlantean evolution the gods descended into the mystery centers, and one could really perceive that the hosts of archangels which include Oriphiel, Anael, Zachariel and so on, resolved to move within the prescribed planetary orbits. So this came about at a certain time.

However, the mighty hosts which are led by Satan have not made this decision up to the present time and they're still trying to use every cometary orbit in order to give a different configuration to the entire planetary system. Here one is dealing with an adversary of Christ who not only wants to corrupt individual human beings, and who doesn't just want to corrupt groups of human beings like the beast and the false prophet, but we have to do with Satan and his hosts and with direct attacks upon the

earth's connection with the planetary system, as it were. This will have to be the third fall. In both of these last two falls we again have the rejoicing of the Luciferic kind of spiritual beings.

One must foresee these things. For the first stage, the Babylonian stage, will have straying human beings who have drawn an aberration into themselves through their physical constitution, so that there is no hope that anything particularly good will become of these walking human bodies over which the ego and astral body have entirely lost control. These bodies must be given up for lost although perhaps not the ego and astral body which belong to them. The former will then go on as such along the karmic paths of humanity. At a particular point in time we see certain men walking around in their bodies, who are men who have succumbed to the Babylonian temptation and whose bodies and what is in them fall out of evolution: the fall of Babylon.

The second thing is that human beings will walk around—one will be able to see this—of whom one will have to say that Ahrimanic power's, are living in them. Here Ahriman is acting directly; this is the beast; the fall of the beast and of the false prophet of the beast, who is a superhuman being and not a man.

The third thing is that one will notice that something about the laws of nature is becoming unexplainable. This will be the greatest and most important experience that people will be able to have, when they notice that something is becoming unexplainable about natural laws and that phenomena are not taking place in accordance with the laws of nature. It will often happen that one will have something which is not merely an erroneous calculation, but is calculated correctly, let's say that a planet should be in a certain place, but it doesn't get there.

Satan will make some first successful attempts to bring disorder into the planetary system. Mankind will have to develop a very strong spirituality in order to counteract this. For the disorder that can be brought about in this way will and can only be harmonized through the strong spirituality of human beings. These are the things which we can foresee today if we place future stages of human and earth evolution before our soul. This is what we see again when the Apocalypticer speaks to us. You should try to feel your way into this coincidence with what can really be gained from Anthroposophy or can gradually be disclosed through Anthroposophy.

For one will be able to speak of comets and one can already speak about them today to the effect that Satan is lying in wait for them in the cosmos, and that he wants to use their orbits to replace cosmos with chaos. For if you take what can be gained through Anthroposophic understanding into yourself and you can discover it again in the Apocalypse, there is something important about this rediscovery. A kind of soul encounter with the Apocalypse and therewith the Apocalypticer himself is present in this; that is important,—thereby with the Apocalypticer himself. For this will be very important, that the priest who is living into the future should increasingly get the longing to meet the Apocalypticer who looked into the future in this way after the Mystery of Golgotha,—the Apocalypticer at any time, regardless of whether he is living on earth or not.

For priests must get the feeling that the help that can come from John, the creator of the Apocalypse, to the one who wants to work in a Christian way that this help is an extremely important one, and one that one needs. However, we will only really be able to accompany John the Apocalypticer if we approach the Apocalypse with the attitude of soul that I described. Then John becomes our ally, and after all he is closely connected with Christ Jesus, he was initiated by Christ Jesus himself, he is an initiate of Christ Jesus. Therefore, he is an important ally. It is tremendously important to come to the Christ through him.

It is really true that a real understanding of the Apocalypse leads deep down into the region where one has the greatest imaginable prospects of meeting John and then the Christ himself. There is a deep truth connected with this and a truth which one can hope will have a very deep aftereffect upon your thinking and feeling, for it is a real priests' truth, that is, a truth which draws a priest into the spiritual realm in a legitimate way.
GA346

**Chapter 19.**

GA104a
In this way spiritual seers have spoken to other spiritual seers through the millennia and we find all of this again even unto the names in the Apocalypse. As Paul said, “... it is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me.” (Gal. 2:20) This, too, we find again in the Apocalypse. The I is permeated by Christ. The one who can fructify the I with his name is the Christ: “... and he has a name inscribed which no one knows but he himself.” (Rev. 19:12)
GA104a

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Now we have the magnificent concluding picture of the new Jerusalem before us, which has the experiential backgrounds of which I spoke. We will do well to go backwards from this picture a little bit. Here we have the important passage where another magnificent picture appears before our soul, namely, that magnificent picture where the Apocalypticer sees what he calls heaven open, and where a power approaches him on a white horse of whom he speaks in such a way that we become aware: he doesn't just have the trichotomy or the threefoldedness of the Godhead in his intellectuality—he has it in his whole I human being. He speaks in such a way that he is really still aware with his whole soul that one has the three forms of the one God before one, and that if one places oneself outside of the physical world one can alternately speak of the one or the other of them, because they intermingle.

Of course, when they're put into the physical World one gets a picture of three persons, so that one has to distinguish between the Father God who underlies all facts of nature, including the ones which work into human nature, the Son God who has to do with everything which leads to freedom in the soul's experience and the Spirit God who lives in a spiritual, cosmic order which is far away from nature and foreign to nature. This is how sharply contoured the three persons of the Godhead appear here upon the physical plane.

Now when man crosses the threshold to the spiritual world, he gets into the condition which I described in my book How Does One Attain Knowledge of Higher Worlds? where he splits up into three beings, so that thinking, feeling and willing become somewhat independent. However, if we go to higher worlds from the physical plane we see the triune Godhead approaching us ever more as a unity. And so of course, the Apocalypse must be read in this light. One shouldn't distinguish between the Father God, the Son God and the Spirit God as directly as one would do this in the physical world.

Thus the one who approaches us on a white horse in that magnificent Imagination is none other than the unified God. And in the form in which he is' the Son of God, we have to see Him more in the free soul development of human beings on earth. But now something very strange occurs, which is what makes the picture that comes before the concluding one seem very magnificent. It is quite natural and a matter of course that John sees heaven open—I will call the one who wrote the Apocalypse John—for

the new thing which is descending from the spiritual world. The whole culture must be arranged in such a way that it comes down from the spiritual world to the physical world. Now if we place this before our soul correctly, then of course the condition which must precede this is that John looks into the spiritual world. But this means: heaven is opened for him. However, he wants to indicate a future situation which will exist for human beings. He's actually saying nothing less than the following.

Before that state of affairs will arise on earth where the spiritual ingredients for the building up of the new Jerusalem will sink down from the spiritual world and will be received by men—just as men previously raised material ingredients from the earth upwards—before this state will come, before men become aware that they must build from above downwards—as I said recently, he considers this state to be a real one—before this will come, the state of affairs where man is mainly engaged with his will will be replaced by another one where he is only concerned with knowledge and where he has to look into the spiritual world: heaven is opened. The one who underlies the beings of the world in a radiating and creative and sanctifying way appears. And now the significant reason which makes the picture so magnificent: He has a name written on him which is known to no one besides himself. That is very significant. When one comes to the place in the Apocalypse where this is written, one sees another clear sign that one is dealing with one of the greatest spiritual revelations. The name which is given to the ego varies considerably in various languages, but I have pointed to the spiritually trivial fact that the name for the ego can never be spoken by someone in such a way that it can be given to someone else. I cannot say I to someone else; this distinguishes the name of the self from all other names. They are given to objects, to either inner or outer objects. But when I say “I” in any language I can only say it to myself; I can only say it to another person if I have slipped into him—which must be a real spiritual process; but there is no need to speak about that now.

Now let's imagine the things which describe the self in various languages the self was not given a name in the older languages; it was in the verb. The ego was not a direct designation. One described oneself through what one did in a kind of demonstrative way, but no name for the self-existed. This name for the self of one's human being only began to be used later; it's a significant symbolic fact that the German word for I—“ich”—contains the initials of Jesus Christ. But now let's think of an enhancement of this fact that we have a name in our languages which every one can only say in connection with himself. The enhancement consists in what is now said in the Apocalypse—that He who comes down from the supersensible world has a name written on Himself where He not only is the only one who can use it to refer to Himself, but where He is the only one who understands it; no one else understands it.

Now just think that this Revealer approaches John showing him in a prophetic picture what will later occur for humanity. There He comes down in future times the one who has the name which He alone understands. What can all of this really mean? If one honestly wants to understand it, the whole thing seems to be meaningless at first. Why does He come, the one who is to bring the salvation of the world, the justice of the world all of this is written in the Apocalypse—, “who shall make faith and knowledge true;” not what the (King James version has: “was called Faithful and True”) but “who shall make faith and knowledge true.” This is really like hide-and-seek, for if He has an inscribed name which only He understands, what is that supposed to mean? It makes us ask a question which goes deeper. What is this really all about?

Imagine it quite vividly: He has a name which only He understands. How can we relate to this name? It should really acquire a significance for us; this name should really be able to live in us. How can this occur? It can occur if the being who understands this name becomes united with us and enters our own self, then this being in us will understand the name and we will understand it also. We will have Him in us and we will continually have the awareness of Christ in us. He is the only one who understands the

things, which are connected with His being; but He understands them in us, and the Christ-insight of the Christ being in us gives the light which is rayed out in us, because He becomes this light in us, in our own being. It will be an insight which dwells in men.

You see, something has occurred thereby. The first thing which has occurred is an intended, necessary consequence of the Mystery of Golgotha. This being who went through the Mystery of Golgotha, this being who must enter us, so that we comprehend the world with his understanding and not with our understanding, this being wears a garment which is sprinkled with blood, the blood of Golgotha. And we take in this picture. However, John the Apocalypticer tells us that this garment which is sprinkled with the blood of Golgotha has a name. This is not the same name he was talking about before; this is the name of the garment which is sprinkled with blood. And the name of this vesture dipped in blood is the logos of God, the Logos, God, the word of God. Thus the one who should live in us and should give the light in us through his own understanding fills us with the word of God.

The pagans read the word of God in natural phenomena. They had to receive it through outer manifestations. Christians must receive the word of God or the Creative word by taking the Christ into themselves. The time will come when all human beings who take Christianity into their souls in an honest way will know through the course of the events that the word of God is with Christ, and that this word of God has its seed in the understanding of the Mystery of Golgotha and of the garment which is sprinkled with blood. Thus we have the Christ, enclosed in the Mystery of Golgotha in the language of the Apocalypticer.

However, a third thing appears. Christ in three forms: firstly, through himself, secondly through his garment, and thirdly through the deeds which he does for men on earth. Here again a condition is described which must set in, and which will of course not begin in such a way that one can point to a particular year but Christian development must move in that direction.

The third thing that our attention is drawn to is the sword with which he works, which is the sword of his will, the sword of his deeds, the sword of what he has done among human beings upon earth by living in them. But what he's doing now, what he does in his comings and goings, as it were, bears the third name: King of all Kings, Lord of all Lords. That is the third form. What is the nature of a king or the nature of a lord? If we go into the real inner meaning of the Latin word dominus, we arrive at what linguistic usage indicates in this case, quite independently of spiritual investigation: A lord is someone who is designated to give guidance to some other being on earth or in the whole world. 3ut how long will external lords be necessary upon earth? How long will one need the commands of outer lords upon earth and even the commands of external spiritual lords above the earth? Until that point in time when Christ lives in men with the name which only he understands. Then everyone will be able to follow Christ in his own being and in his own soul. Then everyone will try to realize in himself what man's will wants to realize out of inner love. Then the Lord of lords and King of kings will live in each individual.
GA346

**Chapter 20.**

GA346
At present man can only form ideas about how he should use the intellectuality that is breaking into his individuality. However, before this age of consciousness soul development is over souls will be taken hold of by intellectuality right down into their deepest emotions, feelings and passions. And then what

was still sought in the stars during the Middle Ages, when one spoke of angelic intelligences in the stars and planets will live even more deeply and pervasively in men.

All of this will be deposited in men, and later on when the Jupiter period comes even man's corporeality will be taken hold of by intellectuality. However, at present, where the soul has still not been taken hold of by intellectuality in its innermost structure and men can grasp the important things in their thoughts and words, it is possible to orient priestly activities in such a way that the world goals can really be attained.

So you see things are like this; when men grab intellectuality from the cosmos—and after all, it is a wise arrangement of the world powers that he is taking possession of it—there are always unguarded moments when it becomes possible for the Ahrimanic power who is called Satan in Christian tradition to take hold of this intellectuality that men have. Satan must not be confused with the ordinary devil, who is a lower power with different characteristics. Satan has the rank of a Principality (Archai), and he took hold of this intellectuality in the course of world evolution long before it approached men in the described manner, and one could say that he possesses more intellectuality than any other being. He is trying to bind human intellectuality to his own to such an extent that men can fall out of their evolution in this way. In other words, this Ahrimanic power is trying to nullify the Mystery of Golgotha and Christ's activity.

Now this Ahrimanic power who is called Satan in Christian tradition lacks the strength to work up further than the human level of cosmic beings. So one shouldn't think that the intelligence of an angel, for instance, could be taken hold of directly by this Satanic power; this can only happen in certain exceptional cases. These exceptional cases that could occur in the future, where it might not only be possible for the Satanic power to chain men to himself through their intellects, but also to bind beings from the spheres of the angels and namely of the archangels to himself—these things still belong to the higher secrets of occultism that cannot be spoken about at present, and that can only be disclosed under certain conditions. So we can only indicate that a temptation and a seduction of beings in the hierarchy of angels and namely of archangels might be possible in the future, but we must reckon with the fact that the power who is called Satan in Christian tradition has the ability to cling to something in man's inner life that is as independent as his intellectuality. And then when the intellectuality which men contain is taken hold of by the Ahrimanic power, a man can be torn out of evolution and can be put on an entirely different course, simply because his being is pulled along with the intelligence with which Satan is able to connect himself.

This is only possible with man's intellectuality, and not with any other psychical, spiritual or bodily force in him. For a man's intelligence sits in him in such a way that it is the most independent thing in him. Everything else is connected with certain divine powers, and so if Satan were to do anything with men's feelings, sensations, desires and wishes he would still have to deal with the superhuman forces that are in these soul-capacities. Intellectuality is the first thing through which each human being can separate himself entirely from the beings who bring about his personal evolution, and it is the first thing in which he must freely connect himself through his own efforts with those powers who have accompanied his evolution right from the beginning. So that he has to identify himself freely with the last goals of the Apocalypse, where the Apocalypticer clearly indicates that the power who is the Alpha and Omega of the creator beings who go through evolution will appear, and each human being has to decide for himself to attach himself to the being who led him during the time when he was becoming cosmically mature.

To be sure, Satan can use this great moment in the evolution of humanity and he can pull men's intelligences and the men with it into his own realm. We can already see how the Satanic power is trying to bring men into its evolution in this way. The way to do this is to bring people together in the kind of associations that we see arising everywhere in a germinal form today, where the old group souls end and a new group-soulness can begin.

That is why what is occurring in eastern Europe today, for instance, is so terribly Satanic because it all tends very forcibly in the direction of putting people together in such a way that group souls become necessary. If the most intelligent people are then taken over into the lower Ahrimanic regions in this way, the groups that are formed here can only be assigned to Ahrimanic powers as groups. That would be a way for the Satanic powers to tear mankind out of earth evolution and to bring it into another planetary evolution. That kind of activity with a group soul character can only succeed if the intellectual element becomes completely emancipated in a certain way.

Very clever beginnings in this direction are being made in the east today, and priests should understand these beginnings for their work, because they are becoming manifest in a very forcible way in the east, but they're also present in central and western Europe.

For example, something that seems to be more or less harmless in exoteric life but which must be discussed very seriously is the way that psychology is being allowed to pass over into an experimental observation of human souls. This is one of the methods that will eventually prevent the soul elements from working from man to man in the way that the old divine powers intended, and psychical things will be determined in a numerical way or some other way instead by the emancipated intellectuality.

Thus this Satanic power is working hard today and he turns to people everywhere and appeals to their emancipated intellect that is disconnected with things in some way. This applies to the soul, to the spirit, to inner conversions, etc. If Satan were to succeed in bringing about what he wants to do within a certain time, what has to approach then would occur in a harmful way for the evolution of humanity.

For the events of which the Apocalypticer speaks will come. It's just a question of how they will occur. There's only two possibilities: either human evolution will proceed in accordance with the intentions of the gods, or it will not. Intellectuality is breaking in now and men are becoming more and more intelligent through their own efforts, and not through inspiration. That is breaking in. But on the other hand mankind has been kept weak by influences that come from the Luciferic side. Even though the individual element is the only salutary thing for mankind in this age of the individuality, which is really a Christian age, groups will form, but these group formations must be taken away from the danger that they're in.

Through the efforts that the Satanic power is making to acquire the intellectual forces of humanity, a time will come when this Satanic power will be so strong that it will approach all groups that will have formed. So that it will really come about that Satan's power will work towards the four corners of the world, and these smaller and larger groups—Gog and Magog—will be exposed to the temptation and the seduction of the Satanic power. What will be decided then is whether or not those who have begun to work with spirituality have developed such an intensity that human intellectuality can be led to where it belongs with the aid of the Michael power, namely, to the starting powers who were connected with the origins of human evolution, and who want to lead what men have become further, although men are left free. A great deal will depend upon whether; men will get to the point where they will fully understand real spirituality that has an inner order. In priestly work one must already look at these affairs of humanity now, for only if one succeeds in directing everything into channels that run along

these lines will the great seduction scene that Satan intends with Gog and Magog turn out in a way that is beneficial for human evolution.

So one would like to say that a church is outwardly real, and it embraces the faithful members of the congregation. And the priesthood must look upon itself as that group of people in the church through whose activity a spiritual element flows into humanity. For this they need the right understanding and a little chapel for the sacraments and the consecrated bread and wine, which contains the secret of transubstantiation.

And one would like to say: If we imagine that we have a chalice, in which transubstantiation takes place, then men look for a way to the Father through transubstantiation. They look for a way to that creative power in the primal world which is present in there in a fully real way, and which therefore cannot be found if one only goes towards the material or only towards the spiritual. It can only be found if one discovers that the spiritual and the material are a unity. An understanding of the world is only present today when a transubstantiation is carried out at an altar. A sacred search for the Father really still occurs there, and here the Son always shows men the way to the Father; the Son who now mediates the way to the spirit.

And so when a man looks at what appears everywhere in the physical things during transubstantiation he can find the completely hidden spirit and the working of the Seraphim, Cherubim and Thrones in the physical things. Their concealed activity becomes manifest as physical substances. If one wants to have the latter as something spiritual, one has to take the path to the Father. The path to the Father is indicated by the Son, and he then brings it about that the spiritual appears out of the physical.

Bread is bread, but one can look for the Father in it; this can also be shown for the wine. Christ shows the way; the transubstantiation puts an aura around the bread; man experiences the spirit in the aura. The wine reinforces what is present in the bread (drawing: sun). And so one can say that the longing for the Father is present in the sensory aspect that conceals the Seraphim, Cherubim and Thrones. Christ leads each human being on the path, so that Kyriotetes, Dynamis and Exusiai become active before him in the way ye indicated yesterday, and he ascends into that region where he can only perceive the spirituality of the spiritual world today in angels, archangels and Archai, who however have the Holy Spirit in their midst.
GA346

**Chapter 21.**

GA008
The latter part of the Apocalypse describes graphically the dangers threatening Christianity through Antichristian powers, and how the Christian powers must be victorious nevertheless. All other gods are united in the One Christian Divinity: “And the city has no need of sun or moon to shine upon it: for the revelation of God lights it, and its light is the Lamb” (chapter 21, verse 23). The mystery of the “Revelation of Saint John” is that the Mysteries shall no longer be kept hidden. “And he said to me: Do not seal up the words of the prophecy of this book, for the Godhead is near.”—The author of the Apocalypse has set forth what he believes to be the relationship of his church to the churches of antiquity. He wished to express what he thought about the Mysteries in the form of a spiritual Mystery. He wrote his Mystery on the island of Patmos. He is said to have received the “Revelation” in a grotto. These details indicate that the revelation was of the character of a Mystery. Thus Christianity emerged from the Mysteries. In the Apocalypse its wisdom is itself born as a Mystery, but as a Mystery which

transcends the frame of the old Mystery world. The unique Mystery is to become the universal Mystery. It may appear contradictory to say that the secrets of the Mysteries became revealed through Christianity, and that nevertheless a Christian Mystery is to be seen again in the experience of the spiritual visions of the writer of the Apocalypse. The contradiction disappears at once when we reflect that the secrets of the ancient Mysteries were revealed through the events in Palestine. Through these events was laid bare what previously had been veiled in the Mysteries. A new Mystery has been introduced into the evolution of the world through the appearance of the Christ. The initiate of ancient times experienced, in the spiritual world, how evolution points the way to the as yet “hidden Christ;” the Christian initiate experiences the hidden effects of the “revealed Christ.”
GA008

GA094
Humanity will bear the mark of the seven great earthly phases. The book with the seven seals, mentioned in the Book of Revelation, will be opened. The woman clothed with the sun, who has the moon under her feet, refers to the time when the Earth will once again be united with the sun and the moon. The trumpets of the Last Judgment will sound, for the Earth will have reached the devachanic state, where sound, not light, will reign. The end of the Earth’s evolution will be marked by the Christ Principle, which will permeate all of humanity. Having become like Christ, people will gather around him as the flocks gather around the Lamb, and as the fruit of this evolution, the New Jerusalem will arise, representing the crowning achievement of the world.
GA094

GA096
Humanity’s evolution originates from a divine being, and it returns to a divine being. The various “I’s” will be individual, but at the same time, by being united in the brotherhood, they will form a unity that will give birth to a new star—that new star which is called “the New Jerusalem” in the Book of Revelation. The human “I’s” will be affirmed in their individuality, and then the harmonies of the spheres will echo the words in which the Mystery of Golgotha was fulfilled: “My God, my God, how have you glorified me!”

These words were spoken back then, and they are repeated as people ascend to the highest levels and on to ever greater heights, where they will have passed through the Son to the Father. The Son guides people to the end of the Earth’s evolution; then they are welcomed back into the cosmos with their “I” intact. Then the Earth returns to the Father. “No one comes to the Father except through me.”
GA096

GA104
As you can see, the apocalyptic writer offers you much if you take to heart the individual insights we have shared. He offers much of what we today call anthroposophical truths. He delivers what he promises. He leads people to a vision of what is to come: to a vision of the beings and powers that guide the world. He leads us to the spirit revealed to us on the first seal, and to the figure revealed to us on the last seal. There one sees how the regularity of the New Jerusalem is expressed to him through clairvoyance. That is the visionary aspect of it. The regularity of the New Jerusalem is expressed here; in chapter 21, you can see how this New Jerusalem is described, so to speak, as a cube (verse 16). To describe what is depicted in this final image would take us too far afield. (See the image of the seventh seal.)
GA104

GA104a

We are also told that the earth will be spiritualized in the New Jerusalem. There will be no external sun present then; the corresponding spiritual beings will provide the light. We read, “And the city has no need of sun or moon to shine upon it ...” (Rev. 21:23)

The writer of the Apocalypse always shows the evolution of humankind in pictures. He sees the leader who was first proclaimed as Vishva Karman, and then as Ahura Mazdao, and he points to him, to Christ.

In order to illuminate what is found in the Apocalypse, we must refer to the transformation of organs that are developed in human beings into other forms. They now have the ability to change their forms.

The heart muscle is distinguished from other muscles under our voluntary control by the fact that the heart is an involuntary muscle, and yet is striated in the same way as voluntary muscle. The heart is on the way to becoming an organ with entirely different functions. We see this indicated in the structure of the muscle.

What comes forth from the voice box will become increasingly powerful. What we speak forth in order to express our thoughts shapes the air—already now it forms it according to how we think. But the word will become increasingly powerful. One day the human being will create the human being's equal through the word that comes forth from the larynx. The one who has the sword coming forth from his mouth is an indication of the being who is the alpha and the omega.

The lamb, who will be the lord over the lower nature, forms one of the seals. Sorat is as if expelled in the eighth sphere by the woman who shows us another seal of the Rosicrucian. The seer can also see this in the spiritual world. In this way, these Rosicrucian seals have an awakening effect when we meditate upon them with understanding.

We have seen how we must understand ancient religious texts literally, taking them at their word. Theosophy is the only possible commentary for the Apocalypse and it should prepare the community of Philadelphia. It is therefore within the plan for the evolution of the earth that Theosophy exists.

Therefore, at various locations on the earth, great individualities are at work to give Theosophy to those able to receive it.

If we consider that the human physical body was prepared for the human being during the ancient Saturn state, the etheric body during the Sun state, the astral body during ancient Moon, then we see how, in its way, this physical body is the most perfect member. It is the most evolved. If we could look into the miraculous structure of the physical heart, or the brain that is structured and organized with so much wisdom that physical science has not yet solved the riddles it presents, we would recognize this. The astral body is, indeed, a higher member but far less perfect; the etheric body has been perfected more than the astral but less than the physical. The I is the least perfect of all. For example, how little does the I understand the structures of the physical body.

This is even precisely described in the Bible where it is said: “... then the Lord God formed man of dust from the ground and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life; and man became a living being ...” (Genesis 2:7) This happened during Lemurian times. At that time luciferic beings worked into the astral body of the human being. However, it was just by doing this, by slipping into the astral body that they caught up with what they themselves had neglected in the past. What they should have accomplished on the Moon they went through vicariously within the human being.

When the sun will have again united with the earth, then human beings—through the fact that they will have purified their instincts, desires, and passions—will redeem the luciferic beings. The luciferic beings who do not go on to the Sun remain in their original condition. They then appear as expelled into the evil, lower astral world. This is the ancient snake and it emerges as the first dragon. Therefore, when the earth enters the sun, a dragon appears. But there are yet other beings left behind: such human beings who could not prevent themselves from dropping back into animality, who remain slaves to their animal instincts. While the other human beings go to the sun, these will form an evil power over and against the higher. These form the second monster, and the writer of the Apocalypse says in his exact fashion: The luciferic dragon appears in heaven because he comes from higher worlds; the second beast arises from the sea—this consists of the souls of animalistic human beings who have remained behind. (Compare: (Rev. 12:3–13:10)

We have still a third vision, that of the black magicians. They do not remain stuck in animality; they develop spiritual abilities. In full consciousness they have turned away, and provide a bodily incarnation for Sorat. That will be the incarnation in flesh of the demon of the sun.

But then we see how the earth emerges from the sun yet again in the future. If the spiritual human beings were to remain united with the sun forever, then the other human beings who, without guilt, had remained behind in animality would never he saved. So, these spiritualized people come forth once more and unite with what has fallen out of evolution in an attempt to save these backward souls.

When the earth began its existence as “earth” it had to briefly repeat the Saturn, Sun, and Moon conditions once again. It went through recapitulations of those conditions before it became the present-day earth. Now, when actual earth conditions prevail, it must prophetically mirror the future embodiments of Jupiter, Venus, and Vulcan. In this way the earth goes through seven states during its actual earth condition. These states are usually called “rounds.” During the prophetically mirrored Jupiter state, the earth will actually unite with the sun. On this Jupiter-Earth all the great cultural ages will appear again—with the seven intervals between them—but they will be far less sharply delineated. On this Jupiter-Earth, many beings still have the possibility of being saved, even the black magicians.

This will also be the case on the Venus-Earth, when we have a sixth planetary interval. Here also the beings that have remained behind will stubbornly struggle against help; but this Venus-Earth will at last be decisive.

Then, on the Vulcan-Earth, nothing more can be saved. On the Venus-Earth the last moment for salvation has come in the last sub-epoch. That is why the ancient cabalists formed the word “Sorat,” because the number 666 is contained within it. That is also the number of those human beings who, out of their own cunning free will, have become black magicians by placing spiritual forces in the service of their own egotism.

The first dragon is not a human being. It came out of the spiritual world. The second dragon is ascribed to animalistic nature but in a fundamental sense the Bible ascribes this number of the third group to human beings. So the number 666 is not a sign of the beast but a human number.

The Apocalypse is an outline of the whole of evolution. Venus-Earth is portrayed to clairvoyant sight in such a way that there is not much hope for those left behind. Human powers at that time will not be capable of very much. That is why everything appears so desolate and the worst vices will reign there in the most depraved ways. They must be expelled during the Venus state of the earth. On the Jupiter-

Earth there are still many, many who will allow themselves to be saved and who will unite with the sun.

But during the Venus-Earth evil must be overcome and driven into the abyss; that is the “Fall of Babylon.” (Rev. 17–18) The people who have been saved can develop themselves further to a new sun state. What has been cleansed and purified will arise for the Vulcan-Earth.

The place that humanity has prepared and will find waiting is called the “New Jerusalem” by the writer of the Apocalypse. (Rev. 21) A new world will arise, inhabitable by human beings who will have achieved the requisite state of maturity. In a new state, in the Jupiter existence, they will find the place where, out of love and out of human work, peace will reign.
GA104a

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By contrast with this another time was to be prepared, and it was foreseen by the Apocalypticer and announced in advance. He looked for an image or the right Imagination in order to place what is behind these secrets before the soul in imaginative pictures. And so he renewed and summarized an idea which was commonplace in esoteric Hebraic teachings. But only there. One pointed out the following there. Souls come out of the spiritual world. These souls which come out of the spiritual world clothe themselves in what comes out of the earth, and when they build houses for the most external work of the spirit, cities arise. But when they ensheathe the inner activity of the human soul, the human body arises out of the earth's building blocks. Thereby the concept of the construction of outer dwelling places merged with the concept of the building of one's own body. That was a beautiful and wonderful image, because it has such a factual foundation, namely, that one looked upon a house as a sheathe for the more extensive and extended part of one's deeds, soul processes and soul functions that—one saw the sheathe for this in the outer house. However, one had the beautiful and wonderful idea: If I do an outer deed in a house which is built for me out of earthly matter, and I use the house walls and the whole house as a sheathe, this is just the hardened, scleroticized extension of what is there when I do the inner deeds of the soul. Whereas man's body is the first house which man builds for the innermost deeds of the soul.

Then when he has his body and he extends what he has, he builds himself a second house; this second house is built out of the earth's ingredients. That was a very common idea, that one really looked upon one's body as a house, and that one looked upon a house as the outermost garment which man puts on here in the physical earth world.

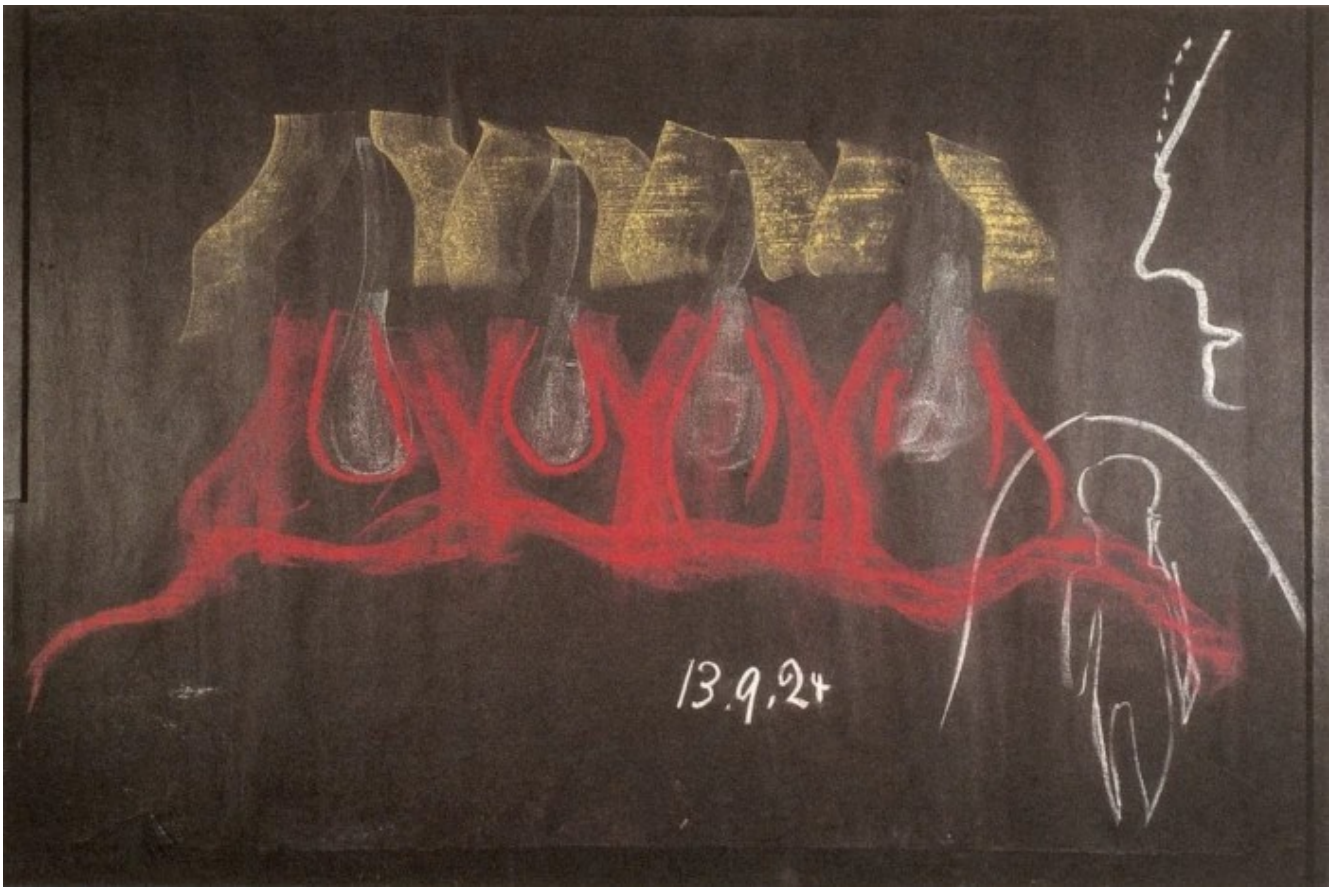
Therefore, one looked upon man's housebuilding activity as something which proceeds from the soul's creative activity. In past times man was very much grown together with his house and the like, namely when he could think: O.K., he certainly has this body and this skin (See drawing). And now if he would get another skin in the course of his life for the more extensive activity of his soul, it would be a tent; except that this doesn't grow, he has to make it himself.

Now one feature of the Hebraic esoteric doctrine was that one looked upon the absorption of earthly ingredients for human development and the flowing together and control of earthly things in a quite particular way. You see, with respect to the physical, one will always admit: The earth is arranged in such a way that it has a north pole where cold accumulates, as it were. And one will describe this north pole from the nature of the earth in a physical, geographic way, and one will consider it to be an important part of the earth. Hebraic esoteric doctrine also did this with the soul activities which are contained in the earth's forces and in a way which was the opposite of the situation with the north pole

on the earth it looked upon Jerusalem, the very concrete Jerusalem, as the place where cultures run together and the most perfect houses are collected. This was a pole for the concentration of outer culture around the human soul, and its culmination was Solomon's temple.

Now one felt that this was exhausted in the evolution of the earth, and the people who knew something about the Hebraic esoteric teaching looked upon the destruction of Jerusalem after the Mystery of Golgotha as something which was not an outer event that was brought about by the Romans; they thought that the Romans were the puppets of spiritual powers and that they only carried out the plan of the spiritual powers. For they thought that this method of looking for ingredients from the earth in order to build human bodies and houses was no longer usable. When Jerusalem became great all the substances and materials from the earth which were to be used in order to build human bodies and houses had become exhausted.

If one translates this Hebraic esoteric teaching into the Christian one, it means that: If the Mystery of Golgotha had not taken place, Jerusalem would have been destroyed anyway. But what can be a new construction by men who create with the aid of the earth would not have been inserted into this destruction. A kind of a seed of a completely new structure was laid into what was destined to be destroyed in Jerusalem. Mother earth dies in Jerusalem. Daughter earth is expectant or lives in the expectation of another seed. Bodies and houses are not built from the earth here through the gathering together of ingredients as in the old Jerusalem which stands there as the culmination of what occurs on the earth, but the earth rises as a spiritual pole of the old Jerusalem. One will no longer be able to or it will be increasingly difficult to make something like the old Jerusalem from the earth's ingredients. Another time arises instead which was laid down as a seed by the Mystery of Golgotha. Men receive something from above which envelopes them, more on the outside, or more on the inside. The new city sinks down from above and pours over the earth—the new Jerusalem. The old Jerusalem was made out of the earth and its substances: the new Jerusalem is made out of spiritual ingredients from heaven.
In das Christliche umgesetzt, bedeutet diese hebräische Geheimlehre: Wäre das Mysterium von Golgatha nicht geschehen, so wäre dennoch die Zerstörung Jerusalems gekommen. Aber es wäre nicht hineingelegt worden in diesen Untergang des mit Hilfe der Erde schaffenden Menschenwesens dasjenige, was Neugestaltung werden kann. Gewissermaßen der Keim zu einer völligen Neugestaltung ist in das Jerusalem hineingelegt, das zum Untergang bestimmt war. Die Mutter Erde erstirbt in Jerusalem. Die Tochter Erde lebt in der Erwartung eines anderen Keimes. Da werden dann nicht mehr durch Heranziehen der Ingredienzien aus der Erde die Leiber gebaut und die Häuser des alten Jerusalem, das dastand als die Krönung desjenigen, was auf der Erde vor sich geht, sondern die Erde erhebt sich als ein geistiger Pol des alten Jerusalem. Nicht mehr wird man imstande sein, aus den Ingredienzien der Erde heraus so etwas zustande zu bringen wie das alte Jerusalem. Dafür tritt aber die andere Zeit ein, die im Keime veranlagt wurde durch das Mysterium von Golgatha. Die Menschen bekommen nun von oben herunter das, was ihr Inneres umhüllt (Tafel 7), mehr von außen. Die neue Stadt senkt sich von oben herunter und gießt sich über die Erde aus: das neue Jerusalem. Das alte Jerusalem war aus der Erde und ihren Stoffen, das neue Jerusalem ist aus dem Himmel und seinen geistigen Ingredienzien.




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**Images of Occult Seals.**

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The seven images that adorn the hall are symbolic expressions of very specific ancient wisdoms. They represent the so-called seven seals of ancient and ever-new wisdom. The Apocalypse of John also talks about it, and this apocalypse is also a kind of interpretation of an occult sign language. Those who study it will recognize these very seals in the visions of the writer of the Apocalypse.

Every letter, every color of the images means something. If we look at things in the right way and sense the context, then very specific feelings are triggered that can become the creators of inner strength. The point is that we are not dealing here with leather allegories, but with a living expression of what anyone [initiate] can experience as real facts on the astral plane.

The first picture is the man with the fire sword in his mouth. This sword – and this one move is crucial – is connected with a secret of development. Speech has always been compared to the sword. But this is not just a poetic image. In occultism, everything is to be taken literally. One must only understand it.

There is a certain mysterious connection between what lives in our language, what expresses itself through our larynx in our words, and today's lower human drives of reproduction. The human form is undergoing transformation. Some can already see on the astral plane today what will be physically available in the future. In such a picture, the seer sees a state that man will one day reach, as in the first

of the seven. This picture is an astral one today. It expresses a state of evolution of the physical human body in the future.

If we want to imagine this state, we have to think of it in this way: through his present, lower reproductive power, man exercises a production in the involuntary and unconscious. Through the reproductive instinct he can bring forth forms filled with matter. Now there is another power in man that does not yet enable him to produce lasting forms: that is the power of his speech. By speaking here, I also produce something. If you follow what is happening in this room while I speak, you can follow oscillating air waves. These are nothing other than words set in motion: movement. In the distant past, such words set in motion were also what is expressed today in the reproductive life. What is condensed today was, when it was still spirit, a word set in motion. What man today can only do out of his word as movement will later become truly reproductive power. Imagine you were able to freeze my words in a moment, so that the solidified air waves would fall down. You would find a special form for each word: a different one for “and” than for “God” ; a shell shape, for all I care. When I say “God”, other forms would be there than when I say “and”. Occultism shows us that everything around us in the form of physical objects has really come into being in this way. The spirit of the Logos resounded into space and matter took shape; the rest is a process of solidification. What is around us today are formed words, condensed divine word. The forces within us are condensed divine forces. What was once created through the word is now being transformed into natural forms. Thus, in the course of evolution, the human larynx will become a reptile-reproducing organ. We will not only be able to create movements, but the larynx will become the true reproductive organ. What is language today will become the creator of its own kind. The larynx is the future organ of reproduction, elevated to spirituality; hence, in man, the parallel in sexual development and laryngeal development can already be seen. The transformation of the voice at sexual maturity points to the creative power that will one day develop from the human voice. The true power of reproduction will arise from speech, the conscious power of human beings to bring forth. And just as you know that we give the name fire spirits to the spirits who were our ancestors because they were related to fire as we are to air, so we will develop from an air spirit to a fire spirit again as we ascend. Not only will the one power flow from the larynx, but also the power of the fire spirits.

You can see this expressed in the first picture, in the fiery sword of the one who represents the eternal essence of man that continues through all incarnations. This eternal element in man is at the same time the divine creator. It is true that what passes through our incarnations as our eternal essence is of the same nature as that which created the sevenfold planetary series. Therefore, the man in his right hand holds the symbols of the seven planets.

The second picture shows the so-called apocalyptic animals: the lion, eagle, bull and human. We get an idea of them when we remember that the animal today does not have an ego soul like we do. The animal does not have its ego soul on the physical plane; the individual animal relates to the ego of a group like a limb of the human being relates to the whole ego. Therefore, we speak of group souls in animals, and if you investigate these group souls, you will find them on the astral plane. Now everyone will realize that man, in his evolution, has also gone through conditions where that which was on the physical plane did not yet have the I-soul. Man also went through conditions where he had a group soul. At the same time — which is called the Lemurian Age — that the soul descended into physical corporeality, the group soul transformed into the individual soul. In the distant future, man will again rise to the state of the group soul, only consciously, in a higher sense. The symbol for that higher group soul is the second picture. The unity in the distant future is represented by the outer forms of those group souls that humanity had in the past. These group souls, from which the human individual soul has emerged and to which it will return, are divided into four typical groups. These are four real astral

groups. One is characterized by the group soul as it is still embodied today in rudiments of the soul of Taurus; the other as it develops in the soul of Leo; the third as in the soul of the bird; but the soul that elevated man, allowed him to enter into individuality, is called the human being. Man emerged from these four group souls and into them he will return. The group soul that is the most advanced, which is already individualized on the astral plane as a human soul, we see in the middle of the symbol. It is the Christ-soul, symbolized by the lamb. It complements the four other group souls.

Then you see here in the rainbow, which surrounds the whole in the seven colors, the creative world principle in a second form. It is the sevenfold creative principle that effectively underlay the inner, human path of evolution when man was still at that stage. And regarding the numbers I to XII, which can be read like the numbers on a clock on the colors of the rainbow, we must remember that the earth, moon and sun were once one body.

This unity is connected with conditions as shown here. This form of cosmic order was necessary for man to be a group soul. Our present time division is connected with the position of the world bodies. In that very distant past, when there was not yet an earth revolving around the sun, all time relationships must have been different. In those days there was no day and hour. The sun itself made its way, and there was a great cosmic clock face. This represented the places the sun passed through. The hour hand on our clocks passes the clock twice a day; so in that ancient cosmic calendar, the sun did not pass through the zodiac once, but twice, through a period of brightness and darkness. This double passage, this double passing through these stations, is called passing by the elder brothers of the cosmic order. They are the twenty-four elders of the Apocalypse. Hence a kind of world clock is arranged.

If we look at the distant future, you will see cosmic, future states expressed in the sixth picture, where man will have risen again in his outer form; we see that the earth and sun will be united and what is eliminated will be eliminated as a moon body. Remember that Goethe calls the highest thing the soul can strive for the eternal feminine. What overcomes the unusable substances in human nature is called feminine. When the earth has united with the sun, then man himself will be the sun-woman; man will have created the union. The unusable substance is represented as the moon, which is trampled underfoot. What must come out when the earth becomes the sun again is represented by the dragon. It will be overcome when the earth becomes the sun again.

The third image shows an open book, surrounded by bowls and angels blowing trumpets, surrounded by flowing light and colors.

The trumpeting angels express the harmony of the spheres. When one ascends from the astral plane to the devachan plane, one experiences the floating world of light and color of the astral plane being permeated by the harmony of the spheres. That which can be seen within the astral plane as floating light and color begins to resound, revealing itself as an expression of the essence of the mental plane. The Pythagorean school called this harmony the music of the spheres. Goethe also speaks of it when he says: “The sun sounds according to ancient ways...” and “The new day is already born sounding for spiritual ears!”

The bowls signify the so-called bowls of wrath, that is to say that the human being will have attained the spirit when he has overcome and transformed what is called wrath. All that is wrathful must be cast out; therefore the bowls of wrath are poured out.

The book is not intended to imply anything other than that man himself, in his development, if we know how to solve his secrets correctly, represents an image of the eternal evolution of the world.

When he recognizes this, that man is an image of the evolution of the world, then he can read himself, he has become a book to himself. Then the moment will arrive of which it says in the Apocalypse that John must devour the book. This is explained in more detail in the next seal.

The two columns of the fourth picture represent the devouring red and blue blood tree. The cloud is the present-day air, which the larynx only controls. From this, the productive power of man, which creates into the solid, will arise in the future. Above the two blood columns, the initiated human being who has devoured the book will emerge. And man generates within himself the power that will transform the earth into the sun. This power is characterized in the face that is born out of the sun. When man has reached this stage, his vision is a vision into the astral world. This is indicated to you in the rainbow above the face of the sun. This rainbow indicates the power that man will have acquired when he himself becomes a cosmic creator being.

In the fifth picture we have a being that conquers the dragon. This is the future human being who will have completely subdued what is called the lower self. This is connected with cosmic conditions that arise when what is called Kama is trampled underfoot.

The state that will occur when this has happened is symbolized in the Holy Grail of the narrated image. The transparent cube below represents a transparent diamond cube made of pure carbon. When man has progressed to the point where he uses carbon itself to build his body - without the help of plants - he will create the cube. This cube of crystallized pure carbon is the best indication of the future state of man. Man will have progressed so far that he will not only recognize the three dimensions, but also the oncoming contra-dimensions: hence the three other dimensions meet the three in the mirror image. These counter-dimensions represent what man will one day achieve when he has overcome the physical in spirit. The serpents signify the upward development to the higher. This is indicated in the seal in violet-bluish coils as a luminous image. This luminous image of the serpent signifies the devoted nature of knowledge. Only this devoted nature can grasp the world spiral in the Caduceus, which will then be fiery, which winds itself out of pure knowledge. Then it transforms into the downward-pointing pure chalice. The chalice of the plant is today directed upwards, pure and chaste; in man it is the other way round. But the human chalice will again be chaste and will turn downwards - that is why the Grail is represented here as a chalice turned downwards. The pure man, the man who has become innocent, is represented by the dove. The rainbow indicates the sevenfold creative man.
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Paracelsus used a beautiful comparison to demonstrate this connection of the human being with nature. He said that the individual beings in nature are letters, and men are the words that are composed from them. Outside, the great world, the macrocosmos; in us, the small world, the microcosmos. Outside, everything exists separately. In men it is determined by the harmonious relation with other organs. Just this enables us to illustrate through human beings the development of the whole universe insofar as it belongs to us.

You have in the seven seals that were hung in the Festival Hall during the Munich Congress a picture of this evolution of men in connection with the world to which they belong. Let us see what they show us.

The first seal presents a person clad in white, his feet of molten metal, and a fiery sword projecting from the mouth. His right hand is surrounded by the signs of our planets—Saturn, Sun, Moon, Mars, Mercury, Jupiter, Venus. Those familiar with the Apocalypse of St. John will remember that there is to be found in it a description that closely corresponds to this picture, for St. John was an initiate. It can be

said that this seal represents the idea of total humanity. This will be understood when we recall some ideas already known to the older members here.

When we go back in human evolution, we come to a time when men were at an imperfect stage. Thus, for example, they did not have heads like the ones you carry on your shoulders today. It would sound grotesque, indeed, were you to hear a description of the men of that time. Only gradually was the head developed, and it will continue developing. Men also have organs today that have come to the end of their development and in the future they will no longer form part of the human body. There are others that will transform themselves. An example is the larynx, which, to be sure, has a great future connection with the heart. At present the larynx is at the beginning of its development, but in times to come it will be transformed into a spiritualized organ of reproduction. You will get an idea of this mystery if you make clear to yourselves just what it is that a man achieves with his larynx today. While I speak to you, you hear my words. Through the fact that this sound fills the air and that certain vibrations are produced in it, my words are transported to your ears and to your souls. When I say a word, for example, “world,” the air vibrates in an embodiment of that word. What we produce in this way today is called “creation in the mineral kingdom.” The movements of the air are mineral movements, so to speak, and thus through the larynx we have a mineral effect on our environment. But men will progress and will also become effective in the plant kingdom. Then they will call forth not only mineral, but also plant-like vibrations. They will speak “plants.” The next step will be that men will be able to speak “feeling beings.” On the highest stage of their development, they will generate their like through the larynx. A man now can only express the contents of his soul through his larynx, but then he will express himself. As men in the future will be able to call people into being through their speaking, so it was that the forerunners of mankind, the gods, were gifted with an organ with which they expressed all things that are around us today. It is they who have made all men, animals and everything else that is manifest. In the literal sense of the word, all of you are words uttered by divine beings.

“In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and a God was the Word!” This does not mean a philosophical word in the speculative sense; St. John set down a primal fact that is to be taken quite literally.

At the end there will be the Word. Creation is a realization of the Word, and men in the future will bring forth a realizations of what today is the Word. Then men will no longer have the physical forms they have today; they will have progressed to the form that existed on Saturn, to fire matter.

So verbindet sich die schöpferische Kraft im Anfang der Weltenentwickelung mit unserer eigenen Schöpferkraft am Ende der Weltenentwickelung.

That being who spoke forth all that is in the world today is the great prototype of men. He spoke forth Saturn into the universe, the Sun, Moon, Earth, Mercury, Jupiter and Venus. The seven planets in the seal point to this. They are the sign that indicates the height to which a man will be able to develop himself. His planet then will consist of fiery matter, and he will be able to speak creatively into this fiery matter. The fiery sword that projects from the mouth of the figure in the seal represents this. All will be fiery, hence the feet of flowing metal.

When you compare a man of today with the animals, the difference between them forces one to say that the man, as an individual, has within him what cannot be found in the single animal. The man has an individual soul, the animal a group soul. The individual human being is, in himself, a whole animal species. All lions together, for example, have only one soul. Such group-egos are like human egos

except that they have not descended into the physical world, but are to be found only in the astral world. Here on earth one sees physical men, each of whom bears his ego. In the astral world one finds beings like one's self, but in astral sheaths rather than physical. One can speak with them as to one's peers. These are the animal group souls.

In earlier times, men also had group souls. Only gradually have they developed themselves to their present independence. These group souls were originally in the astral world and then descended to live in the physical body. When one investigates the original human group souls in the astral world, one finds four species from which humans have sprung. Were one to compare these four kinds of beings with the group souls that belong to the present-day animal species, one would find that one of the four is comparable to the lion, another to the eagle, a third to the cow, and a fourth to the man of ancient times before his ego had descended. Thus, in the second picture, in the apocalyptic animals, lion, eagle, cow and man, we are shown an evolutionary stage of mankind. There is, and always will be as long as the earth shall exist, a group soul for the higher manifestation of men, which is represented by the lamb in the center of the seal, the mystical lamb, the sign of the Redeemer. This grouping of the five group souls, the four of man around the great group soul, which still belongs to all men in common, is represented by the second seal.

Were we to go far back millions of years in human evolution, another picture would come toward us. At present, men are physically on earth, but there was a time when what wandered about here on earth was not yet able to take up a human soul because it was on the astral plane. Even further back in time, we come to a period when the soul was on the spiritual plane, in devachan. In the future, when it will have purified itself on earth, the soul will again ascend to this high plane. Its course moves from the spiritual, through the astral, the physical and then again up to the spirit. This seems a long development for the human being, yet it still appears brief compared to the other planets. During those times men went through not only physical transformations, but spiritual and astral transformations as well. To follow these requires that we rise to spiritual worlds. There the music of the spheres can be heard, tones that swell and flood through space in this world, the harmony of the spheres, called by the occultist “the trumpet tones of the angels,” will sound forth for them. Hence, the trumpets in the third seal.

From the spiritual world there come the revelations that disclose themselves to men only when they continue to progress; then there will be opened for them the Book with the Seven Seals. These seals are just what we are considering here, and they will be revealed. Hence, you find the book in the middle of the seal and below it the four stages of mankind represented by four horses, which signify mankind's stages in its development down through time. But there is still higher initiation. Men derive from still higher worlds and they will ascend to them again. Then men and world will have ceased to exist in their present forms. What is now outside in the world—the single letters of which a man is composed—he will again have taken into himself, and his form will become identical with the world's form. In a rather trivial theosophical teaching, one says that one searches for God within one's self. But those who would find God must look for him in his works that are spread out in the world. Nothing in the world is just matter, this is but seeming. In reality, all matter is an expression of spirituality, a message of the activity of God. Men will extend their beings, as it were, in the course of times to come, identifying themselves more and more with the world; thus it will become possible to represent them in the form of the cosmos instead of the human form. This you can see in the fourth seal with its rock, sea and columns. What passes as clouds through the world today will offer its matter so that the body of a man may be formed from it, and the forces that today are with the Sun spirits will in future provide men with what will develop their spiritual forces in a much higher way. It is this sun force to which men are striving. Contrary to the plant that sends its head-like roots towards the earth's center, a man turns his head to the sun. He will ultimately unite his head with the sun and receive higher forces. This is to be

seen in the fourth seal in the sun's face that rests on the body of clouds, on the rock and columns. In that future time, the human being will have become self-creative. As symbol of the perfect creation, the many coloured rainbow surrounds him. In the Apocalypse of St. John you can find a similar seal in which there is a book in the middle of the clouds. St. John says that the initiate must swallow this book. Here is indicated the time when men will receive wisdom not only outwardly, but will be penetrated by it as is the case today with food, when they, themselves, will be an embodiment of wisdom.

The time will then draw near in which great changes will take place in the cosmos. When men will have attracted the sun power, the sun will once again be united with the earth. Men will become sun beings, and through the power of the sun, they will be able to bring forth suns. Hence, the woman that bears the sun in the fifth seal. Mankind will be so far along morally and ethically that all destructive forces resting in his lower human nature will have been overcome. This is represented by the animal with the seven heads and the ten horns. At the feet of the sun woman is the moon, which contains all those base substances that the earth could not use but had not tossed out. Everything in the way of magical forces that the moon still exerts on the earth at present will then be overcome. When man becomes united with the sun, he will have overcome the moon.

The next picture shows us that the human being, when he had achieved the highest spirituality, takes on the form of Michael fettering the evil in the world, symbolized by the dragon.

In a certain way we have seen that both at the beginning and at the end of human evolution there are the same conditions and transformations. We have seen them portrayed in the man with the feet of molten fire and the sword projecting from his mouth. In a symbolism of great profundity, the world's whole being is now revealed to us in the symbol of the Holy Grail. Let me set this seal before your eyes in a few words.

The occultist who has acquainted himself with our world knows that space in the physical world is not simple emptiness, but something quite different. Space is the source from which all beings have, so to speak, physically crystallized. Imagine a cube-shaped, transparent glass vessel filled with water. Now imagine that certain cooling streams are led through this water so that it congeals in the most manifold forms into ice. This will give you an idea of the world's creation, of space, and of the divine creative word spoken into it.

The occultist presents this space into which the divine creative Word has been spoken as the water-clear cube. Within this space various beings develop. The ones standing nearest to us can be characterized as follows. The cube has three perpendicular directions, three axes, length, height and breadth. It thus represents the three dimensions in space. Now imagine the counter-dimensions to these three outside dimensions of the physical world. You may visualize this by imagining someone moving in one direction and colliding with someone else coming from another direction. Similarly, there is a counter-dimension to every dimension of space, so that in all we have six counter-rays. These counter-rays represent the primal beginnings of the highest human members. The physical body, crystallized from out of space, is the lowest. The spiritual, the highest, is the opposite counter-dimension. In their development, these counter-dimensions first form themselves in a being that is best described when we let them flow together into the world of passions, sensual appetites and instincts. This it is at first. Later, it becomes something else. It becomes ever more purified—we have seen to what height—but it issued from the lower impulses, which are here symbolized by the snake. The process of purification is symbolized by the counter-dimensions converging in two snakes standing opposite each other.

As mankind purifies itself, it rises through what is called the world spiral. The purified body of the snake, this world spiral, has deep significance. The following example will give you an idea of it. Modern astronomy is supported by two postulates of Copernicus, but a third has not been taken into account. Copernicus said that the sun also moves. It advances in a spiral so that the earth, following the sun, moves in a complicated curve. The same is true for the moon that revolves around the earth. These movements are far more complicated than is assumed in elementary astronomy. You see here how the spiral has significance for celestial bodies, and these describe a form with which men will one day identify themselves. At that time, a man's generative power will be cleansed and purified, and his larynx will become his generative organ. What the human being will have developed as purified snake body will no longer work upwards, but from above downwards. The transformed larynx will become the chalice known as the Holy Grail. Even as one is purified, so also the other, which unites with this generative organ. It will be an essence of world force and of great cosmic essence. This world spirit in its essence is represented by the dove facing the Holy Grail. Here it symbolizes the spiritualized fructification that will be active out of the cosmos when men will have identified themselves with the cosmos. The complete creativity of this process is represented by the rainbow. This is the all-embracing seal of the Holy Grail.

The whole gives the sense of the connection between world and men in a wonderful way, as a summation of the meaning of the other seals. The world secret is found here as a circular inscription on the seal's outer edge, which shows how men in the beginning are born out of the primal forces of the world. Everyone, when he looks back, sees that he has gone through the process in the beginning of time that he goes through spiritually today when he is born anew out of the forces of consciousness. This is expressed in the Rose Cross by E. D. N., Ex Deo Nascimur, out of God I am born.

We have seen that within the manifest world a second is added to life, that is, death. That he find life again in this death, a man must find the death of the senses in the primal source of all that lives. This is the center of all cosmic development because we have had to experience death in order to gain consciousness. We will be able to overcome death when we find its meaning in the mystery of the Redeemer. Just as we are born out of God, so, in the sense of esoteric wisdom, we die in Christ—I. C. M., In Christo Morimur.

Because a duality is disclosed wherever something reveals itself, with which a third member must unite, the man who has overcome death will identify himself with the spirit that permeates the world, symbolized by the dove. He will rise from death and again live in the spirit—P. S. S. R., Per Spiritum Sanctum Reviviscimus.

Here stands the theosophical Rose Cross. It rays forth to those times in which religion and science will be reconciled.
GA101

























